The Collected Works

WALLACE D. WATTLES

Wallace D. Wattles

The Collected Works

ANNOTATED EDITION

Ten works in one volume
with a plain-language note on every chapter
and a 30-day practice

INTRODUCTION AND NOTES BY ANDREAS RUPP

The Collected Works of Wallace D. Wattles (Annotated)
The Science of Getting Rich, The Science of Being Well, The Science of Being Great and Seven More Works – with a Plain-Language Note on Every Chapter and a 30-Day Practice

The works of Wallace D. Wattles (1860–1911) collected here were first published between 1905 and 1910 and are in the public domain. This edition follows the first editions or early printings where available: *The Science of Getting Rich*, *The Science of Being Well* and *The Science of Being Great* (Elizabeth Towne, Holyoke, 1910); *Hell-Fire Harrison* (L. C. Page & Company, Boston, 1910); *What Is Truth?* (*The Nautilus*, 1909); *The New Science of Living and Healing* (1924 reissue, without the later commentary); *A New Christ*, *Jesus: The Man and His Work*, *Making the Man Who Can* and *How to Get What You Want* from later printings. Wattles' wording and spelling are kept; obvious printing errors are corrected. The chapter titles of *How to Get What You Want* are editorial.

Introduction, biography, introductions to each work, a note on every chapter, practices, the 30-Day Practice, the Quick Finder, the glossary, the afterword, cover and interior design © 2026 Andreas Rupp. All rights reserved.

Please note: This book is about a practice of thought and character. It is not medical, psychological, financial or legal advice. The practices in this book can go alongside professional help, never instead of it. If you are ill or in crisis, please see a doctor or a qualified professional. In an emergency, call 911 (US) or 999 (UK).

Edited by Andreas Rupp

The very best thing you can do for the whole world is to make the most of yourself.

WALLACE D. WATTLES, THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH

Contents

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

How to Use This Book 15
Who Was Wallace D. Wattles? 17
New Thought in Brief 19
A Note on the Texts 21

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH

About This Work 25
Preface 27
The Right to Be Rich 29
There is a Science of Getting Rich 33
Is Opportunity Monopolized? 38
The First Principle in the Science of Getting Rich 43
Increasing Life 50
How Riches Come to You 57
Gratitude 63
Thinking in the Certain Way 68
How to Use the Will 74
Further Use of the Will 80
Acting in the Certain Way 87
Efficient Action 94
Getting into the Right Business 100
The Impression of Increase 105
The Advancing Man 110
Some Cautions, and Concluding Observations 115
Summary of the Science of Getting Rich 121

THE SCIENCE OF BEING WELL

About This Work 126
Preface 128
The Principle of Health 130
The Foundations of Faith 135
Life and Its Organisms 141
What to Think 146
Faith 153
Use of the Will 159
Health From God 165
Summary of the Mental Actions 170
When to Eat 174
What to Eat 180
How to Eat 186
Hunger and Appetites 192
In a Nutshell 197
Breathing 203
Sleep 208
Supplementary Instructions 212
A Summary of the Science of Being Well 219

THE SCIENCE OF BEING GREAT

About This Work 225
Any Person May Become Great 227
Heredity and Opportunity 232
The Source of Power 236
The Mind of God 240
Preparation 244
The Social Point of View 248
The Individual Point of View 254
Consecration 258
Identification 262
Idealization 266
Realization 270

Hurry and Habit 274
Thought 278
Action at Home 283
Action Abroad 288
Some Further Explanations 293
More About Thought 297
Jesus' Idea of Greatness 302
A View of Evolution 307
Serving God 312
A Mental Exercise 317
A Summary of the Science of Being Great 322

HOW TO GET WHAT YOU WANT

About This Work 333
The Definition of Success 335
The Something Which Those Who Succeed Possess 339
The Right Way to Get What You Want 343
Having the Best of Everything 348
Concluding Thoughts 353

MAKING THE MAN WHO CAN

About This Work 359
The Powerful Life—Whence Comes the Power? 361
The Business Attitude 366
What You Desire 369
Becoming What You Want to Be 372
Promoting Yourself 375
The Advancing Thought 378
The Law of Opulence 381
Man and Money 391
Talk That Builds 397

THE NEW SCIENCE OF LIVING AND HEALING

About This Work 404

The Source of Work-Power 406
Sleep 416
How to Use Sleep 424
Scientific Living and Healing 430
Mind Cures 438
Nature and Development of Will Power 445
The Living One 452
New Light on Immortality 458
Suffering in Sickness 463

WHAT IS TRUTH?

About This Work 470
Time 472
Space 476
Substance 480
Consciousness 484
Motion 489
The Beginning of Motion 494
Man and His Powers 498

A NEW CHRIST

About This Work 503
His Personality 505
His Attitude 511
His Teachings About Man 516
His Teachings About Wealth 522
The Apostles and Their Failure 528
The Source of Power 534
Attaining Cosmic Consciousness 540
Demonstration and Attainment 546

JESUS: THE MAN AND HIS WORK

About This Work 554
Foreword 556

Jesus: The Man and His Work 558

HELL-FIRE HARRISON

About This Work 583
Chapter One 585
Chapter Two 591
Chapter Three 597
Chapter Four 602
Chapter Five 608
Chapter Six 613
Chapter Seven 619
Chapter Eight 625

PUTTING IT INTO PRACTICE

The 30-Day Practice 631
Quick Finder 663

AFTER THE BOOK

A Glossary 667
Afterword: The Certain Way Today 671
Further Reading 674

How to Use This Book

This volume brings together ten works by Wallace D. Wattles, and each one is printed complete. Nothing has been shortened or modernized, so you read Wattles in his own words, with all the force and all the period flavor of the originals.

Around those texts we have added a set of tools meant to help you understand and use them. Each work opens with a short introduction that tells you when it appeared, what it is about, and how it fits into the rest of Wattles' writing. After every chapter you will find three short pieces. The **Reflection** explains in plain modern language what the chapter says and what it might mean for a reader today. The **Practice** suggests one small, concrete exercise. The **Key Thought** is a single line from the chapter to carry with you. Below these there is space for your own notes. Write in it. A book like this works best when you argue with it, agree with it, and record what actually happens when you try its ideas.

After the works comes **The 30-Day Practice**: one short passage from Wattles for each day, with a simple task and room to write. It takes about fifteen minutes a day. The **Quick Finder** points you to the chapters that speak to a particular situation, such as feeling stuck at work, worrying about money, or struggling to stay calm. The **Glossary** explains the terms Wattles uses again and again, from "the Certain Way" to "use value."

There is no wrong way to read this book, but here is a path that works well for most people. Begin with *The Science of Getting Rich*. It is Wattles' best-known book and the clearest statement of his method. Then read *The Science of Being Great* and *The Science of Being Well*, which apply the

same ideas to character and to health. *How to Get What You Want* and *Making the Man Who Can* are short, practical companions to the first book. *A New Christ*, the Jesus lecture and *What Is Truth?* show the religious and philosophical ground he stood on. *The New Science of Living and Healing* adds his thoughts on sleep, will and healing. Keep the novel, *Hell-Fire Harrison*, for when you want a story.

You can start the 30-Day Practice at any time, even before you have finished the reading.

Who Was Wallace D. Wattles?

Wallace Delois Wattles was born in the United States in 1860 and died in February 1911. He is remembered today almost entirely for one book, *The Science of Getting Rich*, but in his own time he was known as a writer, a lecturer and a social reformer who held strong convictions about religion and justice.

Not much is known for certain about his life, and a good deal of what circulates about him is family recollection or later legend. This book sticks to what can be stated with confidence.

Wattles belonged to New Thought, a loose American movement of the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries. New Thought writers taught that the mind shapes a person's life, that there is one divine or living Substance behind everything, and that health, prosperity and character can be improved by changing the way one thinks. The movement had no single church and no single founder. It spread through lectures, small study groups, pamphlets and, above all, magazines.

One of the most widely read of those magazines was *The Nautilus*, published by Elizabeth Towne in Holyoke, Massachusetts. Wattles was one of its contributors. His series *What Is Truth?* appeared there in 1909, and in the Preface to *The Science of Getting Rich* he points readers to it. Towne also published his books. In 1910 alone she brought out *The Science of Getting Rich*, *The Science of Being Well* and *The Science of Being Great*, the three short volumes that hold the core of his teaching. Writing as fast as this suggests a man who believed he had something urgent to say.

Wattles was also a Christian socialist. He believed that the teaching of Jesus, read honestly, called for a society in which everyone had equal access to the good things of the earth, and he said so in public. His lecture *Jesus: The Man and His Work* was delivered in Cincinnati on November 11, 1905, under the auspices of the local branch of the Socialist Party, and *A New Christ* develops the same themes at greater length. He ran for public office as a Socialist candidate. He made his home in Elwood, Indiana.

To modern readers the two sides of Wattles can look like a contradiction: the socialist who wrote a manual on getting rich. He did not see it that way. In his view, poverty was not part of God's plan, there was more than enough for everyone, and the way forward was to create new wealth rather than to fight over existing wealth. He called this the creative mind, as opposed to the competitive mind. Whether or not one agrees, the idea connects his political lectures with his success books, and it is one of the threads that run through this volume.

He also wrote fiction. *Hell-Fire Harrison*, a historical romance, was published by L. C. Page & Company of Boston in 1910.

Wattles died in February 1911, only months after his three "Science" books appeared. He did not live to see what became of them. *The Science of Getting Rich* never quite disappeared. It was reprinted again and again, passed between readers, and in the early twenty-first century it reached a new, global audience when it inspired Rhonda Byrne's *The Secret* (2006). Many people who know Wattles' ideas today met them secondhand in that book or one of its many successors.

This edition invites you to meet him firsthand. He wrote in the confident, sometimes absolute language of his era, and some of his claims will strike you as too sweeping. But you will also meet a writer who was earnest and generous, practical about daily work, and convinced that every person carries possibilities larger than their present circumstances.

New Thought in Brief

You do not need to know the history of New Thought to read Wattles. Still, a few key ideas recur throughout his books, and it helps to have them in view before you begin.

One Substance. Wattles taught that everything, from stars to human beings, is made of one original, formless Substance, and that this Substance is alive and intelligent. He calls it by many names: the Formless Substance, Thinking Stuff, the Supreme, God. Because we are made of it and live in it, we are connected with everything else.

Thought is creative. If the Substance takes the form of its thoughts, then human thought, clearly held and backed by faith, can influence what comes into being. This is the heart of his method. He asks for a clear, definite picture of what you want, held steadily over time.

The Certain Way. Wattles insists that results follow from doing things "in a Certain Way": clear vision, firm purpose, faith, gratitude, and steady, efficient action in your present place. Thought on its own is not enough. "By thought, the thing you want is brought to you; by action you receive it."

Gratitude. For Wattles gratitude is more than good manners. It is the attitude that keeps the mind fixed on the best, strengthens faith, and holds a person in harmony with the source of life.

The creative versus the competitive mind. One of his most useful distinctions is between the creative mind and the competitive mind. The competitive mind assumes the supply is limited and tries to win by taking. The creative mind assumes there is enough and tries to add

something. In business this means giving every person "more in use value" than you take "in cash value."

Health and greatness. The same principles reach beyond money. In *The Science of Being Well* Wattles teaches a Principle of Health moved by faith, along with habits of eating, breathing and sleep. In *The Science of Being Great* he describes a Principle of Power in every person and a greatness of character that shows itself in calm, kindness and service.

Honest limits. New Thought has inspired many people to take their lives in hand, and that is real. But it is fair to name its limits. Wattles says that whoever follows his method will get rich "with mathematical certainty." No book can promise that. Results depend on action, on circumstances, on opportunity and on luck, and many hard-working, clear-thinking people stay poor through no fault of their own. His health teaching, including fasting, skipping breakfast and the idea that thought alone heals disease, is a historical record and should not be taken as medical advice. Illness is never the patient's fault. Anyone with a health concern, and especially anyone with diabetes, an eating disorder, a pregnancy or a need for regular medication, should see a doctor before changing how they eat.

The most helpful way to read New Thought is probably as a training in attention, gratitude and purposeful action. It does not override the facts of the world.

A Note on the Texts

All ten works are given complete, and they follow the earliest reliable sources we could find.

The Science of Getting Rich, *The Science of Being Well* and *The Science of Being Great* follow the first editions or early printings published by Elizabeth Towne, Holyoke, Massachusetts, in 1910. *Hell-Fire Harrison* follows the edition of L. C. Page & Company, Boston, 1910. *What Is Truth?* is taken from the series Wattles published in *The Nautilus* in 1909.

The New Science of Living and Healing follows the 1924 reissue. We give Wattles' text without the commentary Elizabeth Towne added to that printing. *A New Christ* and the lecture *Jesus: The Man and His Work* are based on a later transcription, which we checked against page images of the earlier printing. *Making the Man Who Can* was available to us mainly in a 2005 re-edition that had recast the language in gender-neutral form. For this volume Wattles' own wording has been restored. *How to Get What You Want* follows a later reprint, and its chapter titles were supplied by an editor, not by Wattles.

Throughout, Wattles' spelling, punctuation and wording are kept, including forms like "to-day" and his habit of writing "man" for every human being. Only obvious printing errors have been corrected. A few passages reflect the attitudes of his time on race, nationality, gender and poverty, and they include at least one ethnic slur. We have not removed them, because an honest edition shows an author as he was. The notes point out such passages where it seems helpful.

The Science of Getting Rich

1910 · SEVENTEEN CHAPTERS

About This Work

THE SCIENCE of Getting Rich appeared in 1910, published by Elizabeth Towne in Holyoke, Massachusetts, the same house that printed The Nautilus, the New Thought magazine Wattles wrote for. It is his best-known book. The Preface calls it "a practical manual, not a treatise upon theories," and he means it: the chapters are short, the sentences plain, and the same few principles are repeated until they stick.

The core teaching can be stated simply. Wattles believed that everything comes from one living, thinking Substance, and that a clear, steady mental picture, held with faith and gratitude, sets that Substance moving toward you. But he did not stop at thought. Half of the book insists on action: do all you can each day, do each task well, and in every deal give people more in real usefulness ("use value") than you take from them in money. He contrasts the "competitive mind," which grabs at a supply it believes is limited, with the "creative mind," which adds to the world. For him, honest wealth was a spiritual duty, because things are the tools a person needs to grow in body, mind, and soul.

Read today, the book has real strengths: its stress on clarity of purpose, gratitude, focused daily effort, and fair dealing is sensible and humane. It also has limits that a careful reader should keep in view. Wattles repeatedly promises that anyone who follows his method will get rich "with certainty" and that "failure is impossible." No book can promise that. Results depend on your actions, but also on health,

education, the economy, discrimination, timing, and plain luck. Take the practices as habits worth trying, not as a guarantee.

Some passages need extra care. Wattles tells readers to look away from poverty, to avoid charity work, and to stop reading about suffering; he also suggests that health depends on wealth and that disease is "only an appearance." These views belong to their time. Poverty and illness are not personal failures, and no one is poor or sick because of how they think. Wattles himself was a Christian socialist, which makes his advice to ignore the trusts and politics worth reflecting on. A few terms and examples are dated. If money worries are weighing heavily on you, a qualified financial counselor and, where needed, a mental health professional can help in ways a book cannot.

Preface

THIS BOOK is pragmatical, not philosophical; a practical manual, not a treatise upon theories. It is intended for the men and women whose most pressing need is for money; who wish to get rich first, and philosophize afterward. It is for those who have, so far, found neither the time, the means, nor the opportunity to go deeply into the study of metaphysics, but who want results and who are willing to take the conclusions of science as a basis for action, without going into all the processes by which those conclusions were reached.

It is expected that the reader will take the fundamental statements upon faith, just as he would take statements concerning a law of electrical action if they were promulgated by a Marconi or an Edison; and, taking the statements upon faith, that he will prove their truth by acting upon them without fear or hesitation. Every man or woman who does this will certainly get rich; for the science herein applied is an exact science, and failure is impossible. For the benefit, however, of those who wish to investigate philosophical theories and so secure a logical basis for faith, I will here cite certain authorities.

The monistic theory of the universe—the theory that One is All, and that All is One; that one Substance manifests itself as the seeming many elements of the material world—is of Hindu origin, and has been gradually winning its way into the thought of the western world for two hundred years. It is the foundation of all the Oriental philosophies,

and of those of Descartes, Spinoza, Leibnitz, Schopenhauer, Hegel, and Emerson.

The reader who would dig to the philosophical foundations is advised to read Hegel and Emerson; and he will do well to read "The Eternal News," a very excellent pamphlet published by J. J. Brown, 300 Cathcart Road, Govanhill, Glasgow, Scotland. He may also find some help in a series of articles written by the author, which were published in *Nautilus* (Holyoke, Mass.) during the spring and summer of 1909, under the title "What is Truth?"

In writing this book I have sacrificed all other considerations to plainness and simplicity of style, so that all might understand. The plan of action laid down herein was deduced from the conclusions of philosophy; it has been thoroughly tested, and bears the supreme test of practical experiment; it works. If you wish to know how the conclusions were arrived at, read the writings of the authors mentioned above; and if you wish to reap the fruits of their philosophies in actual practice, read this book and do exactly as it tells you to do.

THE AUTHOR.

CHAPTER

I

The Right to Be Rich

WHATEVER MAY be said in praise of poverty, the fact remains that it is not possible to live a really complete or successful life unless one is rich. No man can rise to his greatest possible height in talent or soul development unless he has plenty of money; for to unfold the soul and to develop talent he must have many things to use, and he cannot have these things unless he has money to buy them with.

Man develops in mind, soul, and body by making use of things, and society is so organized that man must have money in order to become the possessor of things; therefore, the basis of all advancement for man must be the science of getting rich.

The object of all life is development; and everything that lives has an inalienable right to all the development it is capable of attaining.

Man's right to life means his right to have the free and unrestricted use of all the things which may be necessary to his fullest mental, spiritual, and physical unfoldment; or, in other words, his right to be rich.

In this book, I shall not speak of riches in a figurative way; to be really rich does not mean to be satisfied or contented with a little. No man ought to be satisfied with a little if he is capable of using and enjoying more. The purpose of Nature is the advancement and unfoldment of

life; and every man should have all that can contribute to the power, elegance, beauty, and richness of life; to be content with less is sinful.

The man who owns all he wants for the living of all the life he is capable of living is rich; and no man who has not plenty of money can have all he wants. Life has advanced so far, and become so complex, that even the most ordinary man or woman requires a great amount of wealth in order to live in a manner that even approaches completeness. Every person naturally wants to become all that he is capable of becoming; this desire to realize innate possibilities is inherent in human nature; we cannot help wanting to be all that we can be. Success in life is becoming what you want to be; you can become what you want to be only by making use of things, and you can have the free use of things only as you become rich enough to buy them. To understand the science of getting rich is therefore the most essential of all knowledge.

There is nothing wrong in wanting to get rich. The desire for riches is really the desire for a richer, fuller, and more abundant life; and that desire is praiseworthy. The man who does not desire to live more abundantly is abnormal, and so the man who does not desire to have money enough to buy all he wants is abnormal.

There are three motives for which we live; we live for the body, we live for the mind, and we live for the soul. No one of these is better or holier than the other; all are alike desirable, and no one of the three—body, mind, or soul—can live fully if either of the others is cut short of full life and expression. It is not right or noble to live only for the soul and deny mind or body; and it is wrong to live for the intellect and deny body and soul.

We are all acquainted with the loathsome consequences of living for the body and denying both mind and soul; and we see that real life means the complete expression of all that man can give forth through body, mind, and soul. Whatever he may say, no man can be really happy or satisfied unless his body is living fully in every function, and unless the same is true of his mind and his soul. Wherever there is unexpressed

possibility, or function not performed, there is unsatisfied desire. Desire is possibility seeking expression, or function seeking performance.

Man cannot live fully in body without good food, comfortable clothing, and warm shelter; and without freedom from excessive toil. Rest and recreation are also necessary to his physical life.

He cannot live fully in mind without books and time to study them, without opportunity for travel and observation, or without intellectual companionship.

To live fully in mind he must have intellectual recreations, and must surround himself with all the objects of art and beauty he is capable of using and appreciating.

To live fully in soul, man must have love; and love is denied expression by poverty.

Man's highest happiness is found in the bestowal of benefits on those he loves; love finds its most natural and spontaneous expression in giving. The man who has nothing to give cannot fill his place as a husband or father, as a citizen, or as a man. It is in the use of material things that man finds full life for his body, develops his mind, and unfolds his soul. It is therefore of supreme importance to him that he should be rich.

It is perfectly right that you should desire to be rich; if you are a normal man or woman you cannot help doing so. It is perfectly right that you should give your best attention to the Science of Getting Rich, for it is the noblest and most necessary of all studies. If you neglect this study, you are derelict in your duty to yourself, to God, and to humanity; for you can render God and humanity no greater service than to make the most of yourself.

REFLECTION

Wattles opens with a bold claim: you cannot live a full life without enough money. His reasoning is practical. We grow by using things, such as books, tools, travel, time to rest, and the means to care for people we love, and in our society those things cost money. So wanting more is not greed; it is the natural wish to become all you can be. He insists that body, mind, and soul all deserve full expression, and that none is holier than the others. Today this chapter can free readers who feel guilty about wanting financial security. Its weakness is its sweep: saying a person without money cannot be "really complete" can sound harsh to anyone living on little. A fair reading keeps his main point, that your desire to grow is legitimate, without ranking anyone's worth by income.

PRACTICE

List three things you would do with more money that would help you grow in body, mind, or soul, such as a class, better rest, or a gift for someone you love. Beside each, write one small step you can take this month.

KEY THOUGHT

Desire is possibility seeking expression,
or function seeking performance.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

II

There is a Science of Getting Rich

THERE IS a Science of getting rich, and it is an exact science, like algebra or arithmetic. There are certain laws which govern the process of acquiring riches; once these laws are learned and obeyed by any man, he will get rich with mathematical certainty.

The ownership of money and property comes as a result of doing things in a certain way; those who do things in this Certain Way, whether on purpose or accidentally, get rich; while those who do not do things in this Certain Way, no matter how hard they work or how able they are, remain poor.

It is a natural law that like causes always produce like effects; and, therefore, any man or woman who learns to do things in this Certain Way will infallibly get rich.

That the above statement is true is shown by the following facts:—

Getting rich is not a matter of environment, for, if it were, all the people in certain neighborhoods would become wealthy; the people of one city would all be rich, while those of other towns would all be poor; or the inhabitants of one state would roll in wealth, while those of an adjoining state would be in poverty.

But everywhere we see rich and poor living side by side, in the same environment, and often engaged in the same vocations. When two men are in the same locality, and in the same business, and one gets rich while the other remains poor, it shows that getting rich is not, primarily, a matter of environment. Some environments may be more favorable than others, but when two men in the same business are in the same neighborhood, and one gets rich while the other fails, it indicates that getting rich is the result of doing things in a Certain Way.

And further, the ability to do things in this Certain Way is not due solely to the possession of talent, for many people who have great talent remain poor, while others who have very little talent get rich.

Studying the people who have got rich, we find that they are an average lot in all respects, having no greater talents and abilities than other men. It is evident that they do not get rich because they possess talents and abilities that other men have not, but because they happen to do things in a Certain Way.

Getting rich is not the result of saving, or "thrift"; many very penurious people are poor, while free spenders often get rich.

Nor is getting rich due to doing things which others fail to do; for two men in the same business often do almost exactly the same things, and one gets rich while the other remains poor or becomes a bankrupt.

From all these things, we must come to the conclusion that getting rich is the result of doing things in a Certain Way.

If getting rich is the result of doing things in a Certain Way, and if like causes always produce like effects, then any man or woman who can do things in that way can become rich, and the whole matter is brought within the domain of exact science.

The question arises here, whether this Certain Way may not be so difficult that only a few may follow it. This cannot be true, as we have seen, so far as natural ability is concerned. Talented people get rich, and blockheads get rich; intellectually brilliant people get rich, and very

stupid people get rich; physically strong people get rich, and weak and sickly people get rich.

Some degree of ability to think and understand is, of course, essential; but in so far as natural ability is concerned, any man or woman who has sense enough to read and understand these words can certainly get rich.

Also, we have seen that it is not a matter of environment. Location counts for something; one would not go to the heart of the Sahara and expect to do successful business.

Getting rich involves the necessity of dealing with men, and of being where there are people to deal with; and if these people are inclined to deal in the way you want to deal, so much the better. But that is about as far as environment goes.

If anybody else in your town can get rich, so can you; and if anybody else in your state can get rich, so can you.

Again, it is not a matter of choosing some particular business or profession. People get rich in every business, and in every profession; while their next door neighbors in the same vocation remain in poverty.

It is true that you will do best in a business which you like, and which is congenial to you; and if you have certain talents which are well developed, you will do best in a business which calls for the exercise of those talents.

Also, you will do best in a business which is suited to your locality; an ice-cream parlor would do better in a warm climate than in Greenland, and a salmon fishery will succeed better in the Northwest than in Florida, where there are no salmon.

But, aside from these general limitations, getting rich is not dependent upon your engaging in some particular business, but upon your learning to do things in a Certain Way. If you are now in business, and anybody else in your locality is getting rich in the same business, while you are *not* getting rich, it is because you are not doing things in the same Way that the other person is doing them.

No one is prevented from getting rich by lack of capital. True, as you get capital the increase becomes more easy and rapid; but one who has capital is already rich, and does not need to consider how to become so. No matter how poor you may be, if you begin to do things in the Certain Way you will begin to get rich; and you will begin to have capital. The getting of capital is a part of the process of getting rich; and it is a part of the result which invariably follows the doing of things in the Certain Way.

You may be the poorest man on the continent, and be deeply in debt; you may have neither friends, influence, nor resources; but if you begin to do things in this Way, you must infallibly begin to get rich, for like causes must produce like effects. If you have no capital, you can get capital; if you are in the wrong business, you can get into the right business; if you are in the wrong location, you can go to the right location; and you can do so *by beginning in your present business and in your present location* to do things in the Certain Way which causes success.

✦

REFLECTION

Here Wattles argues that wealth follows a pattern he calls "doing things in a Certain Way." He notes that rich and poor live side by side, in the same towns and trades, with similar talents, so he concludes that location, talent, thrift, and starting capital are not the deciding factors. His encouraging point is that you can begin where you are, in your present work and place. Modern readers will notice what his argument leaves out. Circumstances such as family wealth, health, education, access to credit, and discrimination matter a great deal, and research on mobility shows it. Still, the chapter's practical core is useful: rather than waiting for a perfect situation, look at how you do your current work and what you can change today. Read it as a call to agency, not as proof that outcomes are fully in your control.

PRACTICE

Think of someone in your field whose results you admire. Write down three specific things they do differently from you, such as habits, skills, or ways of treating customers. Pick one and try it this week.

KEY THOUGHT

If you have no capital, you can get capital; if you are in the wrong business, you can get into the right business

---

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

III

Is Opportunity Monopolized?

NO MAN is kept poor because opportunity has been taken away from him; because other people have monopolized the wealth, and have put a fence around it. You may be shut off from engaging in business in certain lines, but there are other channels open to you. Probably it would be hard for you to get control of any of the great railroad systems; that field is pretty well monopolized. But the electric railway business is still in its infancy, and offers plenty of scope for enterprise; and it will be but a very few years until traffic and transportation through the air will become a great industry, and in all its branches will give employment to hundreds of thousands, and perhaps to millions, of people. Why not turn your attention to the development of aerial transportation, instead of competing with J. J. Hill and others for a chance in the steam railway world?

It is quite true that if you are a workman in the employ of the steel trust you have very little chance of becoming the owner of the plant in which you work; but it is also true that if you will commence to act in a Certain Way, you can soon leave the employ of the steel trust; you can buy a farm of from ten to forty acres, and engage in business as a producer of foodstuffs. There is great opportunity at this time for men

who will live upon small tracts of land and cultivate the same intensively; such men will certainly get rich. You may say that it is impossible for you to get the land, but I am going to prove to you that it is not impossible, and that you can certainly get a farm if you will go to work in a Certain Way.

At different periods the tide of opportunity sets in different directions, according to the needs of the Whole, and the particular stage of social evolution which has been reached. At present, in America, it is setting toward agriculture and the allied industries and professions. To-day, opportunity is open before the farmer in his line more than before the factory worker in his line. It is open before the business man who supplies the farmer more than before the one who supplies the factory worker; and before the professional man who waits upon the farmer more than before the one who serves the working class.

There is abundance of opportunity for the man who will go with the tide, instead of trying to swim against it.

So the factory workers, either as individuals or as a class, are not deprived of opportunity. The workers are not being "kept down" by their masters; they are not being "ground" by the trusts and combinations of capital. As a class, they are where they are because they do not do things in a Certain Way. If the workers of America chose to do so, they could follow the example of their brothers in Belgium and other countries, and establish great department stores and co-operative industries; they could elect men of their own class to office, and pass laws favoring the development of such co-operative industries; and in a few years they could take peaceable possession of the industrial field.

The working class may become the master class whenever they will begin to do things in a Certain Way; the law of wealth is the same for them as it is for all others. This they must learn; and they will remain where they are as long as they continue to do as they do. The individual worker, however, is not held down by the ignorance or the mental

slothfulness of his class; he can follow the tide of opportunity to riches, and this book will tell him how.

No one is kept in poverty by a shortness in the supply of riches; there is more than enough for all. A palace as large as the capitol at Washington might be built for every family on earth from the building material in the United States alone; and under intensive cultivation, this country would produce wool, cotton, linen, and silk enough to clothe each person in the world finer than Solomon was arrayed in all his glory; together with food enough to feed them all luxuriously. The visible supply is practically inexhaustible; and the invisible supply really IS inexhaustible.

> *Everything you see on earth is made from one original substance, out of which all things proceed.*

New forms are constantly being made, and older ones are dissolving; but all are shapes assumed by One Thing.

There is no limit to the supply of Formless Stuff, or Original Substance. The universe is made out of it; but it was not all used in making the universe. The spaces in, through, and between the forms of the visible universe are permeated and filled with the Original Substance; with the Formless Stuff; with the raw material of all things. Ten thousand times as much as has been made might still be made, and even then we should not have exhausted the supply of universal raw material.

No man, therefore, is poor because nature is poor, or because there is not enough to go around.

Nature is an inexhaustible storehouse of riches; the supply will never run short. Original Substance is alive with creative energy, and is constantly producing more forms. When the supply of building material is exhausted, more will be produced; when the soil is exhausted

so that foodstuffs and materials for clothing will no longer grow upon it, it will be renewed or more soil will be made. When all the gold and silver has been dug from the earth, if man is still in such a stage of social development that he needs gold and silver, more will be produced from the Formless. The Formless Stuff responds to the needs of man; it will not let him be without any good thing.

This is true of man collectively; the race as a whole is always abundantly rich, and if individuals are poor, it is because they do not follow the Certain Way of doing things which makes the individual man rich.

The Formless Stuff is intelligent; it is stuff which thinks. It is alive, and is always impelled toward more life.

It is the natural and inherent impulse of life to seek to live more; it is the nature of intelligence to enlarge itself, and of consciousness to seek to extend its boundaries and find fuller expression. The universe of forms has been made by Formless Living Substance, throwing itself into form in order to express itself more fully.

The universe is a great Living Presence, always moving inherently toward more life and fuller functioning.

Nature is formed for the advancement of life; its impelling motive is the increase of life. For this cause, everything which can possibly minister to life is bountifully provided; there can be no lack unless God is to contradict himself and nullify his own works.

You are not kept poor by lack in the supply of riches; it is a fact which I shall demonstrate a little farther on that even the resources of the Formless Supply are at the command of the man or woman who will act and think in a Certain Way.

REFLECTION

Wattles answers his title question with a firm no. Some fields are closed off, he admits, but new ones keep opening; in 1910 he pointed to electric railways and, with real foresight, to air travel. He then introduces his central idea: everything is made from one Original Substance, a living, thinking "Formless Stuff" whose supply never runs out. Scarcity, in his view, is an appearance. Readers should note one passage in particular: he says factory workers as a class are "where they are because they do not do things in a Certain Way." That claim reflects his era and his method, not a fair account of working people, who often faced brutal conditions not of their making. The lasting value of the chapter is its habit of looking for where opportunity is growing, instead of fighting for the few spots everyone else wants.

PRACTICE

Write down one area in your town or industry that is growing and one that is crowded. Spend twenty minutes learning about the growing one: read an article, ask someone who works in it, or look at job postings.

KEY THOUGHT

There is abundance of opportunity for the man who will go with the tide, instead of trying to swim against it.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

IV

The First Principle in the Science of Getting Rich

THOUGHT IS the only power which can produce tangible riches from the Formless Substance. The stuff from which all things are made is a substance which thinks, and a thought of form in this substance produces the form.

Original Substance moves according to its thoughts; every form and process you see in nature is the visible expression of a thought in Original Substance. As the Formless Stuff thinks of a form, it takes that form; as it thinks of a motion, it makes that motion. That is the way all things were created. We live in a thought world, which is part of a thought universe.

The thought of a moving universe extended throughout Formless Substance, and the Thinking Stuff moving according to that thought, took the form of systems of planets, and maintains that form. Thinking Substance takes the form of its thought, and moves according to the thought. Holding the idea of a circling system of suns and worlds, it takes the form of these bodies, and moves them as it thinks. Thinking the form of a slow-growing oak tree, it moves accordingly, and produces the tree, though centuries may be required to do the work. In creating, the Formless seems to move according to the lines of motion it has

established; the thought of an oak tree does not cause the instant formation of a full-grown tree, but it does start in motion the forces which will produce the tree, along established lines of growth.

Every thought of form, held in thinking Substance, causes the creation of the form, but always, or at least generally, along lines of growth and action already established.

The thought of a house of a certain construction, if it were impressed upon Formless Substance, might not cause the instant formation of the house; but it would cause the turning of creative energies already working in trade and commerce into such channels as to result in the speedy building of the house. And if there were no existing channels through which the creative energy could work, then the house would be formed directly from primal substance, without waiting for the slow processes of the organic and inorganic world.

> *No thought of form can be impressed upon Original Substance without causing the creation of the form.*

Man is a thinking center, and can originate thought. All the forms that man fashions with his hands must first exist in his thought; he cannot shape a thing until he has thought that thing.

And so far man has confined his efforts wholly to the work of his hands; he has applied manual labor to the world of forms, seeking to change or modify those already existing. He has never thought of trying to cause the creation of new forms by impressing his thoughts upon Formless Substance.

When man has a thought-form, he takes material from the forms of nature, and makes an image of the form which is in his mind. He has, so far, made little or no effort to co-operate with Formless Intelligence; to work "with the Father." He has not dreamed that he can "do what he

seeth the Father doing." Man re-shapes and modifies existing forms by manual labor; he has given no attention to the question whether he may not produce things from Formless Substance by communicating his thoughts to it. We propose to prove that he may do so; to prove that any man or woman may do so, and to show how. As our first step, we must lay down three fundamental propositions.

First, we assert that there is one original formless stuff, or substance, from which all things are made. All the seemingly many elements are but different presentations of one element; all the many forms found in organic and inorganic nature are but different shapes, made from the same stuff. And this stuff is thinking stuff; a thought held in it produces the form of the thought. Thought, in thinking substance, produces shapes. Man is a thinking center, capable of original thought; if man can communicate his thought to original thinking substance, he can cause the creation, or formation, of the thing he thinks about. To summarize this:—

There is a thinking stuff from which all things are made, and which, in its original state, permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe.

✦

A thought, in this substance, produces the thing that is imaged by the thought.

✦

Man can form things in his thought, and, by impressing his thought upon formless substance, can cause the thing he thinks about to be created.

It may be asked if I can prove these statements; and without going into details, I answer that I can do so, both by logic and experience.

Reasoning back from the phenomena of form and thought, I come to one original thinking substance; and reasoning forward from this thinking substance, I come to man's power to cause the formation of the thing he thinks about.

And by experiment, I find the reasoning true; and this is my strongest proof.

If one man who reads this book gets rich by doing what it tells him to do, that is evidence in support of my claim; but if every man who does what it tells him to do gets rich, that is positive proof until some one goes through the process and fails. The theory is true until the process fails; and this process will not fail, for every man who does exactly what this book tells him to do will get rich.

I have said that men get rich by doing things in a Certain Way; and in order to do so, men must become able to think in a certain way.

A man's way of doing things is the direct result of the way he thinks about things.

To do things in the way you want to do them, you will have to acquire the ability to think the way you want to think; this is the first step toward getting rich.

To think what you want to think is to think TRUTH, regardless of appearances.

Every man has the natural and inherent power to think what he wants to think, but it requires far more effort to do so than it does to think the thoughts which are suggested by appearances. To think according to appearances is easy; to think truth regardless of appearances is laborious,

and requires the expenditure of more power than any other work man is called upon to perform.

There is no labor from which most people shrink as they do from that of sustained and consecutive thought; it is the hardest work in the world. This is especially true when truth is contrary to appearances. Every appearance in the visible world tends to produce a corresponding form in the mind which observes it; and this can only be prevented by holding the thought of the TRUTH.

To look upon the appearance of disease will produce the form of disease in your own mind, and ultimately in your body, unless you hold the thought of the truth, which is that there is no disease; it is only an appearance, and the reality is health.

To look upon the appearances of poverty will produce corresponding forms in your own mind, unless you hold to the truth that there is no poverty; there is only abundance.

To think health when surrounded by the appearances of disease, or to think riches when in the midst of appearances of poverty, requires power; but he who acquires this power becomes a MASTER MIND. He can conquer fate; he can have what he wants.

This power can only be acquired by getting hold of the basic fact which is behind all appearances; and that fact is that there is one Thinking Substance, from which and by which all things are made.

Then we must grasp the truth that every thought held in this substance becomes a form, and that man can so impress his thoughts upon It as to cause them to take form and become visible things.

When we realize this, we lose all doubt and fear, for we know that we can create what we want to create; we can get what we want to have, and can become what we want to be. As a first step toward getting rich, you must believe the three fundamental statements given previously in this chapter; and in order to emphasize them, I repeat them here:—

There is a thinking stuff from which all things are made, and which, in its original state, permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe.

✦

A thought, in this substance, produces the thing that is imaged by the thought.

✦

Man can form things in his thought, and, by impressing his thought upon formless substance, can cause the thing he thinks about to be created.

You must lay aside all other concepts of the universe than this monistic one; and you must dwell upon this until it is fixed in your mind, and has become your habitual thought. Read these creed statements over and over again; fix every word upon your memory, and meditate upon them until you firmly believe what they say. If a doubt comes to you, cast it aside as a sin. Do not listen to arguments against this idea; do not go to churches or lectures where a contrary concept of things is taught or preached. Do not read magazines or books which teach a different idea; if you get mixed up in your faith, all your efforts will be in vain.

Do not ask why these things are true, nor speculate as to how they can be true; simply take them on trust.

The science of getting rich begins with the absolute acceptance of this faith.

✦

REFLECTION

This is the philosophical heart of the book. Wattles states three "creed" ideas: there is one thinking Substance from which all things are made; a thought held

in it produces a form; and a person can impress thoughts on it and so cause things to be created. He adds a psychological insight that still holds up: "A man's way of doing things is the direct result of the way he thinks about things," and steady, deliberate thought is hard work. Two parts need care. He says disease is "only an appearance" and that the reality is health; this is a metaphysical claim, not medical guidance, and illness is never caused by wrong thinking. He also tells readers to avoid all opposing ideas and to treat doubt as sin. Today, honest questioning tends to strengthen good habits rather than destroy them. You can test his practices while keeping your mind open.

PRACTICE

Write one sentence describing how you usually think about money, such as "There's never enough." Then write one truthful, more hopeful sentence to replace it. Read the new sentence each morning for a week and notice whether your choices change.

KEY THOUGHT

A man's way of doing things is the direct result of the way he thinks about things.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

V

Increasing Life

YOU MUST get rid of the last vestige of the old idea that there is a Deity whose will it is that you should be poor, or whose purposes may be served by keeping you in poverty.

The Intelligent Substance which is All, and in all, and which lives in All and lives in you, is a consciously Living Substance. Being a consciously living substance, It must have the natural and inherent desire of every living intelligence for increase of life. Every living thing must continually seek for the enlargement of its life, because life, in the mere act of living, must increase itself.

A seed, dropped into the ground, springs into activity, and in the act of living produces a hundred more seeds; life, by living, multiplies itself. It is forever Becoming More; it must do so, if it continues to be at all.

Intelligence is under this same necessity for continuous increase. Every thought we think makes it necessary for us to think another thought; consciousness is continually expanding. Every fact we learn leads us to the learning of another fact; knowledge is continually increasing. Every talent we cultivate brings to the mind the desire to cultivate another talent; we are subject to the urge of life, seeking expression, which ever drives us on to know more, to do more, and to be more.

In order to know more, do more, and be more we must have more; we must have things to use, for we learn, and do, and become, only by using things. We must get rich, so that we can live more.

The desire for riches is simply the capacity for larger life seeking fulfillment; every desire is the effort of an unexpressed possibility to come into action. It is power seeking to manifest which causes desire. That which makes you want more money is the same as that which makes the plant grow; it is Life, seeking fuller expression.

The One Living Substance must be subject to this inherent law of all life; it is permeated with the desire to live more; that is why it is under the necessity of creating things.

The One Substance desires to live more in you; hence it wants you to have all the things you can use.

It is the desire of God that you should get rich. He wants you to get rich because he can express himself better through you if you have plenty of things to use in giving him expression. He can live more in you if you have unlimited command of the means of life.

The universe desires you to have everything you want to have.

Nature is friendly to your plans.

Everything is naturally for you.

Make up your mind that this is true.

It is essential, however, that *your purpose should harmonize with the purpose that is in All*.

You must want real life, not mere pleasure or sensual gratification. Life is the performance of function; and the individual really lives only when he performs every function, physical, mental, and spiritual, of which he is capable, without excess in any.

You do not want to get rich in order to live swinishly, for the gratification of animal desires; that is not life. But the performance of every physical function is a part of life, and no one lives completely who denies the impulses of the body a normal and healthful expression.

You do not want to get rich solely to enjoy mental pleasures, to get knowledge, to gratify ambition, to outshine others, to be famous. All these are a legitimate part of life, but the man who lives for the pleasures of the intellect alone will only have a partial life, and he will never be satisfied with his lot.

You do not want to get rich solely for the good of others, to lose yourself for the salvation of mankind, to experience the joys of philanthropy and sacrifice. The joys of the soul are only a part of life; and they are no better or nobler than any other part.

You want to get rich in order that you may eat, drink, and be merry when it is time to do these things; in order that you may surround yourself with beautiful things, see distant lands, feed your mind, and develop your intellect; in order that you may love men and do kind things, and be able to play a good part in helping the world to find truth.

But remember that extreme altruism is no better and no nobler than extreme selfishness; both are mistakes.

Get rid of the idea that God wants you to sacrifice yourself for others, and that you can secure his favor by doing so; God requires nothing of the kind.

What he wants is that you should make the most of yourself, for yourself, and for others; and *you can help others more by making the most of yourself than in any other way*.

You can make the most of yourself only by getting rich; so it is right and praiseworthy that you should give your first and best thought to the work of acquiring wealth.

Remember, however, that the desire of Substance is for all, and its movements must be for more life to all; it cannot be made to work for less life to any, because it is equally in all, seeking riches and life.

Intelligent Substance will make things for you, but it will not take things away from some one else and give them to you.

You must get rid of the thought of competition. You are to create, not to compete for what is already created.

You do not have to take anything away from any one.

You do not have to drive sharp bargains.

You do not have to cheat, or to take advantage. You do not need to let any man work for you for less than he earns.

You do not have to covet the property of others, or to look at it with wishful eyes; no man has anything of which you cannot have the like, and that without taking what he has away from him.

You are to become a creator, not a competitor; you are going to get what you want, but in such a way that when you get it every other man will have more than he has now.

I am aware that there are men who get a vast amount of money by proceeding in direct opposition to the statements in the paragraph above, and may add a word of explanation here. Men of the plutocratic type, who become very rich, do so sometimes purely by their extraordinary ability on the plane of competition; and sometimes they unconsciously relate themselves to Substance in its great purposes and movements for the general racial upbuilding through industrial evolution. Rockefeller, Carnegie, Morgan, *et al.*, have been the unconscious agents of the Supreme in the necessary work of systematizing and organizing productive industry; and in the end, their work will contribute immensely toward increased life for all. Their day is nearly over; they have organized production, and *will soon be succeeded by the agents of the multitude, who will organize the machinery of distribution*.

The multi-millionaires are like the monster reptiles of the prehistoric eras; they play a necessary part in the evolutionary process, but the same Power which produced them will dispose of them. And it is well to bear in mind that they have never been really rich; a record of the private lives of most of this class will show that they have really been the most abject and wretched of the poor.

Riches secured on the competitive plane are never satisfactory and permanent; they are yours to-day, and another's to-morrow. Remember, if you are to become rich in a scientific and certain way, you must rise entirely out of the competitive thought. You must never think for a moment that the supply is limited. Just as soon as you begin to think that all the money is being "cornered" and controlled by bankers and others, and that you must exert yourself to get laws passed to stop this process, and so on; in that moment you drop into the competitive mind, and your power to cause creation is gone for the time being; and what is worse, you will probably arrest the creative movements you have already instituted.

KNOW that there are countless millions of dollars' worth of gold in the mountains of the earth, not yet brought to light; and know that if there were not, more would be created from Thinking Substance to supply your needs.

KNOW that the money you need will come, even if it is necessary for a thousand men to be led to the discovery of new gold mines to-morrow.

Never look at the visible supply; look always at the limitless riches in Formless Substance, and KNOW that they are coming to you as fast as you can receive and use them. Nobody, by cornering the visible supply, can prevent you from getting what is yours.

So never allow yourself to think for an instant that all the best building spots will be taken before you get ready to build your house, unless you hurry. Never worry about the trusts and combines, and get anxious for fear they will soon come to own the whole earth. Never get afraid that you will lose what you want because some other person "beats you to it." That cannot possibly happen; you are not seeking anything that is possessed by anybody else; you are causing what you want to be created from Formless Substance, and the supply is without limits. Stick to the formulated statement:—

There is a thinking stuff from which all things are made, and which, in its original state, permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe.

✦

A thought, in this substance, produces the thing that is imaged by the thought.

✦

Man can form things in his thought, and, by impressing his thought upon formless substance, can cause the thing he thinks about to be created.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles describes life as something that always seeks to grow: a seed becomes a hundred seeds, each fact leads to another, each talent wakes the wish for the next. The desire for money, he says, is that same life force asking for room. God, in his view, wants you to prosper, because life expresses itself more fully through someone who has the means to live well. The most important move in the chapter is ethical: you are to "create, not to compete." You never need to cheat, underpay, or take from anyone, and your gain should leave others better off. He also warns against both extreme selfishness and extreme self-sacrifice. His remarks about the great industrialists and his advice not to worry about monopolies reflect his time; as a Christian socialist he expected their era to pass. The creative-not-competitive ideal is the part most worth keeping.

PRACTICE

Think about a goal you are working toward. Ask yourself, "Who else could benefit if I reach it?" Write down one way to shape your plan so that at least one other person gains too.

KEY THOUGHT

You are to become a creator, not a competitor

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VI

How Riches Come to You

WHEN I say that you do not have to drive sharp bargains, I do not mean that you do not have to drive any bargains at all, or that you are above the necessity for having any dealings with your fellow men. I mean that you will not need to deal with them unfairly; you do not have to get something for nothing, *but can give to every man more than you take from him*.

You cannot give every man more in cash market value than you take from him, but you can give him more in use value than the cash value of the thing you take from him. The paper, ink, and other material in this book may not be worth the money you paid for it; but if the ideas suggested by it bring you thousands of dollars, you have not been wronged by those who sold it to you; they have given you a great use value for a small cash value.

Let us suppose that I own a picture by one of the great artists, which, in any civilized community, is worth thousands of dollars. I take it to Baffin Bay, and by "salesmanship" induce an Eskimo to give a bundle of furs worth $500 for it. I have really wronged him, for he has no use for the picture; it has no use value to him; it will not add to his life.

But suppose I give him a gun worth $50 for his furs; then he has made a good bargain. He has use for the gun; it will get him many more furs

and much food; it will add to his life in every way; it will make him rich.

When you rise from the competitive to the creative plane, you can scan your business transactions very strictly, and if you are selling any man anything which does not add more to his life than the thing he gives you in exchange, you can afford to stop it. You do not have to beat anybody in business. And if you are in a business which does beat people, get out of it at once.

Give every man more in use value than you take from him in cash value; then you are adding to the life of the world by every business transaction.

If you have people working for you, you must take from them more in cash value than you pay them in wages; but *you can so organize your business that it will be filled with the principle of advancement*, and so that each employee who wishes to do so may advance a little every day.

You can make your business do for your employees what this book is doing for you. You can so conduct your business that it will be a sort of ladder, by which every employee who will take the trouble may climb to riches himself; and given the opportunity, if he will not do so it is not your fault.

And finally, because you are to cause the creation of your riches from Formless Substance which permeates all your environment, it does not follow that they are to take shape from the atmosphere and come into being before your eyes.

If you want a sewing machine, for instance, I do not mean to tell you that you are to impress the thought of a sewing machine on Thinking Substance until the machine is formed without hands, in the room where you sit, or elsewhere. But if you want a sewing machine, hold the mental image of it with the most positive certainty that it is being made, or is on its way to you. After once forming the thought, have the most absolute and unquestioning faith that the sewing machine is coming; never think of it, or speak of it, in any other way than as being sure to arrive. Claim it as already yours.

It will be brought to you by the power of the Supreme Intelligence, acting upon the minds of men. If you live in Maine, it may be that a man will be brought from Texas or Japan to engage in some transaction which will result in your getting what you want.

If so, the whole matter will be as much to that man's advantage as it is to yours.

Do not forget for a moment that the Thinking Substance is through all, in all, communicating with all, and can influence all. The desire of Thinking Substance for fuller life and better living has caused the creation of all the sewing machines already made; and it can cause the creation of millions more, and will, whenever men set it in motion by desire and faith, and by acting in a Certain Way.

You can certainly have a sewing machine in your house; and it is just as certain that you can have any other thing or things which you want, and which you will use for the advancement of your own life and the lives of others.

You need not hesitate about asking largely; "it is your Father's pleasure to give you the kingdom," said Jesus.

Original Substance wants to live all that is possible in you, and wants you to have all that you can or will use for the living of the most abundant life.

If you fix upon your consciousness the fact that the desire you feel for the possession of riches is one with the desire of Omnipotence for more complete expression, your faith becomes invincible.

Once I saw a little boy sitting at a piano, and vainly trying to bring harmony out of the keys; and I saw that he was grieved and provoked by his inability to play real music. I asked him the cause of his vexation, and he answered, "I can feel the music in me, but I can't make my hands go right." The music in him was the URGE of Original Substance, containing all the possibilities of all life; all that there is of music was seeking expression through the child.

God, the One Substance, is trying to live and do and enjoy things through humanity. He is saying, "I want hands to build wonderful structures, to play divine harmonies, to paint glorious pictures; I want feet to run my errands, eyes to see my beauties, tongues to tell mighty truths and to sing marvelous songs," and so on.

All that there is of possibility is seeking expression through men. God wants those who can play music to have pianos and every other instrument, and to have the means to cultivate their talents to the fullest extent; He wants those who can appreciate beauty to be able to surround themselves with beautiful things; He wants those who can discern truth to have every opportunity to travel and observe; He wants those who can appreciate dress to be beautifully clothed, and those who can appreciate good food to be luxuriously fed.

He wants all these things because it is Himself that enjoys and appreciates them; it is God who wants to play, and sing, and enjoy beauty, and proclaim truth, and wear fine clothes, and eat good foods.

"It is God that worketh in you to will and to do," said Paul.

The desire you feel for riches is the Infinite, seeking to express Himself in you as He sought to find expression in the little boy at the piano.

So you need not hesitate to ask largely.

Your part is to focalize and express the desires of God.

This is a difficult point with most people; they retain something of the old idea that poverty and self-sacrifice are pleasing to God. They look upon poverty as a part of the plan, a necessity of nature. They have the idea that God has finished His work, and made all that He can make, and that the majority of men must stay poor because there is not enough to go around. They hold to so much of this erroneous thought that they feel ashamed to ask for wealth; they try not to want more than a very modest competence, just enough to make them fairly comfortable.

I recall now the case of one student who was told that he must get in mind a clear picture of the things he desired, so that the creative thought

of them might be impressed on Formless Substance. He was a very poor man, living in a rented house, and having only what he earned from day to day; and he could not grasp the fact that all wealth was his. So, after thinking the matter over, he decided that he might reasonably ask for a new rug for the floor of his best room, and an anthracite coal stove to heat the house during the cold weather. Following the instructions given in this book, he obtained these things in a few months; and then it dawned upon him that he had not asked enough. He went through the house in which he lived, and planned all the improvements he would like to make in it; he mentally added a bay window here and a room there, until it was complete in his mind as his ideal home; and then he planned its furnishings.

Holding the whole picture in his mind, he began living in the Certain Way, and moving toward what he wanted; and he owns the house now, and is rebuilding it after the form of his mental image. And now, with still larger faith, he is going on to get greater things. It has been unto him according to his faith, and it is so with you and with all of us.

✦

REFLECTION

This chapter offers one of Wattles' most practical rules: give every person more in "use value" than you take in "cash value." A book may cost little in paper and ink, but if its ideas help you, the exchange has made you richer. His example contrasts a painting sold to someone who has no use for it with a gun that helps a hunter thrive; the illustration uses dated language and assumptions of its time, but the point is clear. If a deal does not add to the other person's life, rethink it. He also says riches come through ordinary channels, other people and normal trade, not out of thin air. The chapter ends with his story of a poor man who first asked only for a rug and a stove, then learned to ask for more. Aim generously, he says, but build through honest exchange.

PRACTICE

Choose one product or service you offer, at work or in your personal life. Write down what the other person pays and what real value they receive. Find one way to add value this week without raising the price.

KEY THOUGHT

Give every man more in use value than you take from him in cash value; then you are adding to the life of the world by every business transaction.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VII

Gratitude

THE ILLUSTRATIONS given in the last chapter will have conveyed to the reader the fact that the first step toward getting rich is to convey the idea of your wants to the Formless Substance.

This is true, and you will see that in order to do so it becomes necessary to relate yourself to the Formless Intelligence in a harmonious way.

To secure this harmonious relation is a matter of such primary and vital importance that I shall give some space to its discussion here, and give you instructions which, if you will follow them, will be certain to bring you into perfect unity of mind with God.

The whole process of mental adjustment and atonement can be summed up in one word, *gratitude*.

First, you believe that there is one Intelligent Substance, from which all things proceed; second, you believe that this Substance gives you everything you desire; and third, you relate yourself to It by a feeling of deep and profound gratitude.

Many people who order their lives rightly in all other ways are kept in poverty by their lack of gratitude. Having received one gift from God, they cut the wires which connect them with Him by failing to make acknowledgment.

It is easy to understand that the nearer we live to the source of wealth, the more wealth we shall receive; and it is easy also to understand that the soul that is always grateful lives in closer touch with God than the one which never looks to Him in thankful acknowledgment.

The more gratefully we fix our minds on the Supreme when good things come to us, the more good things we will receive, and the more rapidly they will come; and the reason simply is that the mental attitude of gratitude draws the mind into closer touch with the source from which the blessings come.

If it is a new thought to you that gratitude brings your whole mind into closer harmony with the creative energies of the universe, consider it well, and you will see that it is true. The good things you already have have come to you along the line of obedience to certain laws. Gratitude will lead your mind out along the ways by which things come; and it will keep you in close harmony with creative thought and prevent you from falling into competitive thought.

Gratitude alone can keep you looking toward the All, and prevent you from falling into the error of thinking of the supply as limited; and to do that would be fatal to your hopes.

There is a Law of Gratitude, and it is absolutely necessary that you should observe the law, if you are to get the results you seek.

The law of gratitude is the natural principle that action and reaction are always equal, and in opposite directions.

The grateful outreaching of your mind in thankful praise to the Supreme *is a liberation or expenditure of force; it cannot fail to reach that to which it is addressed, and the reaction is an instantaneous movement toward you*.

"Draw nigh unto God, and He will draw nigh unto you." That is a statement of psychological truth.

And if your gratitude is strong and constant, the reaction in Formless Substance will be strong and continuous; the movement of the things you want will be always toward you. Notice the grateful attitude that

Jesus took; how He always seems to be saying, "I thank Thee, Father, that Thou hearest me." You cannot exercise much power without gratitude; for it is gratitude that keeps you connected with Power.

But the value of gratitude does not consist solely in getting you more blessings in the future. Without gratitude you cannot long keep from dissatisfied thought regarding things as they are.

The moment you permit your mind to dwell with dissatisfaction upon things as they are, you begin to lose ground. You fix attention upon the common, the ordinary, the poor, and the squalid and mean; and your mind takes the form of these things. Then you will transmit these forms or mental images to the Formless, and the common, the poor, the squalid, and mean will come to you.

To permit your mind to dwell upon the inferior is to become inferior and to surround yourself with inferior things.

On the other hand, to fix your attention on the best is to surround yourself with the best, and to become the best.

The Creative Power within us makes us into the image of that to which we give our attention.

We are Thinking Substance, and thinking substance always takes the form of that which it thinks about.

The grateful mind is constantly fixed upon the best; therefore it tends to become the best; it takes the form or character of the best, and will receive the best.

Also, faith is born of gratitude. The grateful mind continually expects good things, and expectation becomes faith. The reaction of gratitude upon one's own mind produces faith; and every outgoing wave of grateful thanksgiving increases faith. He who has no feeling of gratitude cannot long retain a living faith; and without a living faith you cannot get rich by the creative method, as we shall see in the following chapters.

It is necessary, then, to cultivate the habit of being grateful for every good thing that comes to you; and to give thanks continuously.

And because all things have contributed to your advancement, you should include all things in your gratitude.

Do not waste time thinking or talking about the shortcomings or wrong actions of plutocrats or trust magnates. Their organization of the world has made your opportunity; all you get really comes to you because of them.

Do not rage against corrupt politicians; if it were not for politicians we should fall into anarchy, and your opportunity would be greatly lessened.

God has worked a long time and very patiently to bring us up to where we are in industry and government, and He is going right on with His work. There is not the least doubt that He will do away with plutocrats, trust magnates, captains of industry, and politicians as soon as they can be spared; but in the meantime, behold they are all very good. Remember that they are all helping to arrange the lines of transmission along which your riches will come to you, and be grateful to them all. This will bring you into harmonious relations with the good in everything, and the good in everything will move toward you.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles makes gratitude the bridge between a person and the creative power he calls God or Substance. A grateful mind, he argues, stays focused on what is good and growing, and that focus shapes both your expectations and your actions. Dwelling with dissatisfaction on what is poor or mean, he says, pulls you toward it. Modern psychology supports part of this: regular gratitude practice is linked to better mood and resilience, though not to guaranteed income. His claim that people are "kept in poverty by their lack of gratitude" goes too far; hardship has many causes and is not a moral failing. The chapter also asks readers to be thankful even for powerful industrialists and politicians,

which is a striking position from a socialist author. Taken gently, the chapter's best lesson is that gratitude keeps you from fear-driven, grasping thinking.

PRACTICE

Each evening for one week, write down three specific things that went well that day and who or what made them possible. Include at least one person you could thank directly, and thank them.

KEY THOUGHT

The Creative Power within us makes us into the image of that to which we give our attention.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VIII

Thinking in the Certain Way

TURN BACK to chapter VI., and read again the story of the man who formed a mental image of his house, and you will get a fair idea of the initial step toward getting rich. You must form a clear and definite mental picture of what you want; you cannot transmit an idea unless you have it yourself.

You must have it before you can give it; and many people fail to impress Thinking Substance because they have themselves only a vague and misty concept of the things they want to do, to have, or to become.

It is not enough that you should have a general desire for wealth "to do good with"; everybody has that desire.

It is not enough that you should have a wish to travel, see things, live more, etc. Everybody has those desires also. If you were going to send a wireless message to a friend, you would not send the letters of the alphabet in their order, and let him construct the message for himself; nor would you take words at random from the dictionary. You would send a coherent sentence; one which meant something. When you try to impress your wants upon Substance, remember that it must be done by a coherent statement; you must know what you want, and be definite.

You can never get rich, or start the creative power into action, by sending out unformed longings and vague desires.

Go over your desires just as the man I have described went over his house; see just what you want, and get a clear mental picture of it as you wish it to look when you get it.

That clear mental picture you must have continually in mind, as the sailor has in mind the port toward which he is sailing the ship; you must keep your face toward it all the time. You must no more lose sight of it than the steersman loses sight of the compass.

It is not necessary to take exercises in concentration, nor to set apart special times for prayer and affirmation, nor to "go into the silence," nor to do occult stunts of any kind. These things are well enough, but all you need is to know what you want, and to want it badly enough so that it will stay in your thoughts.

Spend as much of your leisure time as you can in contemplating your picture, but no one needs to take exercises to concentrate his mind on a thing which he really wants; it is the things you do not really care about which require effort to fix your attention upon them.

And unless you really want to get rich, so that the desire is strong enough to hold your thoughts directed to the purpose as the magnetic pole holds the needle of the compass, it will hardly be worth while for you to try to carry out the instructions given in this book.

The methods herein set forth are for people whose desire for riches is strong enough to overcome mental laziness and the love of ease, and make them work.

The more clear and definite you make your picture, then, and the more you dwell upon it, bringing out all its delightful details, the stronger your desire will be; and the stronger your desire, the easier it will be to hold your mind fixed upon the picture of what you want.

Something more is necessary, however, than merely to see the picture clearly. If that is all you do, you are only a dreamer, and will have little or no power for accomplishment.

Behind your clear vision must be the purpose to realize it; to bring it out in tangible expression.

And behind this purpose must be an invincible and unwavering FAITH that the thing is already yours; that it is "at hand" and you have only to take possession of it.

Live in the new house, mentally, until it takes form around you physically. In the mental realm, enter at once into full enjoyment of the things you want.

"Whatsoever things ye ask for when ye pray, believe that ye receive them, and ye shall have them," said Jesus.

See the things you want as if they were actually around you all the time; see yourself as owning and using them. Make use of them in imagination just as you will use them when they are your tangible possessions. Dwell upon your mental picture until it is clear and distinct, and then take the Mental Attitude of Ownership toward everything in that picture. Take possession of it, in mind, in the full faith that it is actually yours. Hold to this mental ownership; do not waver for an instant in the faith that it is real.

And remember what was said in a preceding chapter about gratitude; be as thankful for it all the time as you expect to be when it has taken form. The man who can sincerely thank God for the things which as yet he owns only in imagination, has real faith. He will get rich; he will cause the creation of whatsoever he wants.

You do not need to pray repeatedly for the things you want; it is not necessary to tell God about it every day.

"Use not vain repetitions as the heathen do," said Jesus to His pupils, "for your Father knoweth that ye have need of these things before ye ask Him."

Your part is to intelligently formulate your desire for the things which make for a larger life, and to get these desires arranged into a coherent whole; and then to impress this Whole Desire upon the Formless Substance, which has the power and the will to bring you what you want.

You do not make this impression by repeating strings of words; you make it by holding the vision with unshakable PURPOSE to attain it, and with steadfast FAITH that you do attain it.

The answer to prayer is not according to your faith while you are talking, but according to your faith while you are working.

You cannot impress the mind of God by having a special Sabbath day set apart to tell Him what you want, and then forgetting Him during the rest of the week. You cannot impress Him by having special hours to go into your closet and pray, if you then dismiss the matter from your mind until the hour of prayer comes again.

Oral prayer is well enough, and has its effect, especially upon yourself, in clarifying your vision and strengthening your faith; but it is not your oral petitions which get you what you want. In order to get rich you do not need a "sweet hour of prayer"; you need to "pray without ceasing." And by prayer I mean holding steadily to your vision, with the purpose to cause its creation into solid form, and the faith that you are doing so.

"Believe that ye *receive* them."

The whole matter turns on receiving, once you have clearly formed your vision. When you *have* formed it, it is well to make an oral statement, addressing the Supreme in reverent prayer; and from that moment you must, in mind, receive what you ask for. Live in the new house; wear the fine clothes; ride in the automobile; go on the journey, and confidently plan for greater journeys. Think and speak of all the things you have asked for in terms of actual present ownership. Imagine an environment, and a financial condition exactly as you want them, and live all the time in that imaginary environment and financial condition. Mind, however, that you do not do this as a mere dreamer and castle builder; hold to the FAITH that the imaginary is being realized, and to the PURPOSE to realize it. Remember that it is faith and purpose in the use of the imagination which make the difference between the scientist

and the dreamer. And having learned this fact, it is here that you must learn the proper use of the Will.

✦

REFLECTION

Vague wishes, Wattles says, produce nothing. You must know exactly what you want and picture it clearly, the way a sailor keeps a port in mind or a sender writes a clear message instead of random letters. He adds two more elements: a firm purpose to make the picture real and steady faith that it is already on its way. He even suggests living in the imagined house and being thankful for it in advance. Interestingly, he says special rituals and long prayers are unnecessary; what matters is holding the vision while you work. His line "according to your faith while you are working" is a useful corrective to passive daydreaming, which he openly rejects. Today, goal-setting research agrees that specific goals help, especially when they are paired with planning and effort. A clear picture gives your daily choices direction.

PRACTICE

Write a one-page description of a goal as if it were already true: where you are, what you do each day, how it feels. Make it concrete. Then underline one detail you could start acting on tomorrow.

KEY THOUGHT

The answer to prayer is not according to your faith while you are talking, but according to your faith while you are working.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

IX

How to Use the Will

TO SET about getting rich in a scientific way, you do not try to apply your will power to anything outside of yourself.

You have no right to do so, anyway.

It is wrong to apply your will to other men and women, in order to get them to do what you wish done.

It is as flagrantly wrong to coerce people by mental power as it is to coerce them by physical power. If compelling people by physical force to do things for you reduces them to slavery, compelling them by mental means accomplishes exactly the same thing; the only difference is in methods. If taking things from people by physical force is robbery, then taking things by mental force is robbery also; there is no difference in principle.

You have no right to use your will power upon another person, even "for his own good"; for you do not know what is for his good.

The science of getting rich does not require you to apply power or force to any other person, in any way whatsoever. There is not the slightest necessity for doing so; indeed, any attempt to use your will upon others will only tend to defeat your purpose.

You do not need to apply your will to things, in order to compel them to come to you.

That would simply be trying to coerce God, and would be foolish and useless, as well as irreverent.

You do not have to compel God to give you good things, any more than you have to use your will power to make the sun rise.

You do not have to use your will power to conquer an unfriendly deity, or to make stubborn and rebellious forces do your bidding.

Substance is friendly to you, and is more anxious to give you what you want than you are to get it.

To get rich, you need only to use your will power upon yourself.

When you know what to think and do, then you must use your will to compel yourself to think and do the right things. That is the legitimate use of the will in getting what you want—to use it in holding yourself to the right course. Use your will to keep yourself thinking and acting in the Certain Way.

Do not try to project your will, or your thoughts, or your mind out into space, to "act" on things or people.

Keep your mind at home; it can accomplish more there than elsewhere.

Use your mind to form a mental image of what you want, and to hold that vision with faith and purpose; and use your will to keep your mind working in the Right Way.

The more steady and continuous your faith and purpose, the more rapidly you will get rich, because you will make only POSITIVE impressions upon Substance; and you will not neutralize or offset them by negative impressions.

The picture of your desires, held with faith and purpose, is taken up by the Formless, and permeates it to great distances,—throughout the universe, for all I know.

As this impression spreads, all things are set moving toward its realization; every living thing, every inanimate thing, and the things yet uncreated, are stirred toward bringing into being that which you want. All force begins to be exerted in that direction; all things begin to move

toward you. The minds of people, everywhere, are influenced toward doing the things necessary to the fulfilling of your desires; and they work for you, unconsciously.

But you can check all this by starting a negative impression in the Formless Substance. Doubt or unbelief is as certain to start a movement away from you as faith and purpose are to start one toward you. It is by not understanding this that most people who try to make use of "mental science" in getting rich make their failure. Every hour and moment you spend in giving heed to doubts and fears, every hour you spend in worry, every hour in which your soul is possessed by unbelief, sets a current away from you in the whole domain of intelligent Substance. All the promises are unto them that believe, and unto them only. Notice how insistent Jesus was upon this point of belief; and now you know the reason why.

Since belief is all important, it behooves you to guard your thoughts; and as your beliefs will be shaped to a very great extent by the things you observe and think about, it is important that you should command your attention.

And here the will comes into use; for it is by your will that you determine upon what things your attention shall be fixed.

If you want to become rich, you must not make a study of poverty.

Things are not brought into being by thinking about their opposites. Health is never to be attained by studying disease and thinking about disease; righteousness is not to be promoted by studying sin and thinking about sin; and no one ever got rich by studying poverty and thinking about poverty.

Medicine as a science of disease has increased disease; religion as a science of sin has promoted sin, and economics as a study of poverty will fill the world with wretchedness and want.

Do not talk about poverty; do not investigate it, or concern yourself with it. Never mind what its causes are; you have nothing to do with them.

What concerns you is the cure.

Do not spend your time in charitable work, or charity movements; all charity only tends to perpetuate the wretchedness it aims to eradicate.

I do not say that you should be hard-hearted or unkind, and refuse to hear the cry of need; but you must not try to eradicate poverty in any of the conventional ways. Put poverty behind you, and put all that pertains to it behind you, and "make good."

Get rich; that is the best way you can help the poor.

And you cannot hold the mental image which is to make you rich if you fill your mind with pictures of poverty. Do not read books or papers which give circumstantial accounts of the wretchedness of the tenement dwellers, of the horrors of child labor, and so on. Do not read anything which fills your mind with gloomy images of want and suffering.

You cannot help the poor in the least by knowing about these things; and the wide-spread knowledge of them does not tend at all to do away with poverty.

What tends to do away with poverty is not the getting of pictures of poverty into your mind, but getting pictures of wealth into the minds of the poor.

You are not deserting the poor in their misery when you refuse to allow your mind to be filled with pictures of that misery.

Poverty can be done away with, not by increasing the number of well-to-do people who think about poverty, but by increasing the number of poor people who propose with faith to get rich.

The poor do not need charity; they need inspiration. Charity only sends them a loaf of bread to keep them alive in their wretchedness, or gives them an entertainment to make them forget for an hour or two; but inspiration will cause them to rise out of their misery. If you want to help the poor, demonstrate to them that they can become rich; prove it by getting rich yourself.

The only way in which poverty will ever be banished from this world is by getting a large and constantly increasing number of people to

practice the teachings of this book.

People must be taught to become rich by creation, not by competition.

Every man who becomes rich by competition throws down behind him the ladder by which he rises, and keeps others down; but every man who gets rich by creation opens a way for thousands to follow him, and inspires them to do so.

You are not showing hardness of heart or an unfeeling disposition when you refuse to pity poverty, see poverty, read about poverty, or think or talk about it, or to listen to those who do talk about it. Use your will power to keep your mind OFF the subject of poverty, and to keep it fixed with faith and purpose ON the vision of what you want.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles draws a clear ethical line: never use willpower, pressure, or "mental force" on other people. Coercing someone by the mind is as wrong as coercing them by the body. The will is for one job only, keeping yourself thinking and acting in the right way. That part of the chapter is wise and respectful. The second half is harder. He tells readers not to study poverty, to avoid charity work, and not to read about tenement life or child labor, because such images will weaken their focus. Many readers today will disagree, and fairly so: understanding suffering and helping others are real goods, and charity often keeps people safe in hard times. His underlying hope, that people be inspired and not just pitied, has merit. A balanced reading might be: care about others' struggles, but do not let fear and despair run your own life.

PRACTICE

Notice one news source or conversation that leaves you anxious without helping you act. Replace fifteen minutes of it this week with something that helps you or others move forward: a skill, a plan, or a concrete act of help.

KEY THOUGHT

Keep your mind at home; it can accomplish more there than elsewhere.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

X

Further Use of the Will

YOU CANNOT retain a true and clear vision of wealth if you are constantly turning your attention to opposing pictures, whether they be external or imaginary.

Do not tell of your past troubles of a financial nature, if you have had them; do not think of them at all. Do not tell of the poverty of your parents, or the hardships of your early life; to do any of these things is to mentally class yourself with the poor for the time being, and it will certainly check the movement of things in your direction.

"Let the dead bury their dead," as Jesus said.

Put poverty and all things that pertain to poverty completely behind you.

You have accepted a certain theory of the universe as being correct, and are resting all your hopes of happiness on its being correct; and what can you gain by giving heed to conflicting theories?

Do not read religious books which tell you that the world is soon coming to an end; and do not read the writings of muck-rakers and pessimistic philosophers who tell you that it is going to the devil.

The world is not going to the devil; it is going to God.

It is a wonderful Becoming.

True, there may be a good many things in existing conditions which are disagreeable; but what is the use of studying them when they are certainly passing away, and when the study of them only tends to check their passing and keep them with us? Why give time and attention to things which are being removed by evolutionary growth, when you can hasten their removal only by promoting the evolutionary growth as far as your part of it goes?

No matter how horrible in seeming may be the conditions in certain countries, sections, or places, you waste your time and destroy your own chances by considering them.

You should interest yourself in the world's becoming rich.

Think of the riches the world is coming into, instead of the poverty it is growing out of; and bear in mind that the only way in which you can assist the world in growing rich is by growing rich yourself through the creative method—not the competitive one.

Give your attention wholly to riches; ignore poverty.

Whenever you think or speak of those who are poor, think and speak of them as those who are becoming rich; as those who are to be congratulated rather than pitied. Then they and others will catch the inspiration, and begin to search for the way out.

Because I say that you are to give your whole time and mind and thought to riches, it does not follow that you are to be sordid or mean.

To become really rich is the noblest aim you can have in life, for it includes everything else.

On the competitive plane, the struggle to get rich is a Godless scramble for power over other men; but when we come into the creative mind, all this is changed.

All that is possible in the way of greatness and soul unfoldment, of service and lofty endeavor, comes by way of getting rich; all is made possible by the use of things.

If you lack for physical health, you will find that the attainment of it is conditional on your getting rich.

Only those who are emancipated from financial worry, and who have the means to live a care-free existence and follow hygienic practices, can have and retain health.

Moral and spiritual greatness is possible only to those who are above the competitive battle for existence; and only those who are becoming rich on the plane of creative thought are free from the degrading influences of competition. If your heart is set on domestic happiness, remember that love flourishes best where there is refinement, a high level of thought, and freedom from corrupting influences; and these are to be found only where riches are attained by the exercise of creative thought, without strife or rivalry.

You can aim at nothing so great or noble, I repeat, as to become rich; and you must fix your attention upon your mental picture of riches, to the exclusion of all that may tend to dim or obscure the vision.

You must learn to see the underlying TRUTH in all things; you must see beneath all seemingly wrong conditions the Great One Life ever moving forward toward fuller expression and more complete happiness.

It is the truth that there is no such thing as poverty; that there is only wealth.

Some people remain in poverty because they are ignorant of the fact that there is wealth for them; and these can best be taught by showing them the way to affluence in your own person and practice.

Others are poor because, while they feel that there is a way out, they are too intellectually indolent to put forth the mental effort necessary to find that way and travel it; and for these the very best thing you can do is to arouse their desire by showing them the happiness that comes from being rightly rich.

Others still are poor because, while they have some notion of science, they have become so swamped and lost in the maze of metaphysical and occult theories that they do not know which road to take. They try a mixture of many systems and fail in all. For these, again, the very best

thing to do is to show the right way in your own person and practice; an ounce of doing things is worth a pound of theorizing.

The very best thing you can do for the whole world is to make the most of yourself.

You can serve God and man in no more effective way than by getting rich; that is, if you get rich by the creative method, and not by the competitive one.

Another thing. We assert that this book gives in detail the principles of the science of getting rich; and if that is true, you do not need to read any other book upon the subject. This may sound narrow and egotistical, but consider: there is no more scientific method of computation in mathematics than by addition, subtraction, multiplication, and division; no other method is possible. There can be but one shortest distance between two points. There is only one way to think scientifically, and that is to think in the way that leads by the most direct and simple route to the goal. No man has yet formulated a briefer or less complex "system" than the one set forth herein; it has been stripped of all non-essentials. When you commence on this, lay all others aside; put them out of your mind altogether.

Read this book every day; keep it with you; commit it to memory, and do not think about other "systems" and theories. If you do, you will begin to have doubts, and to be uncertain and wavering in your thought; and then you will begin to make failures.

After you have made good and become rich, you may study other systems as much as you please; but until you are quite sure that you have gained what you want, do not read anything on this line but this book, unless it be the authors mentioned in the Preface.

And read only the most optimistic comments on the world's news; those in harmony with your picture.

Also, postpone your investigations into the occult. Do not dabble in Theosophy, Spiritualism, or kindred studies. It is very likely that the

dead still live, and are near; but if they are, let them alone; mind your own business.

Wherever the spirits of the dead may be, they have their own work to do, and their own problems to solve; and we have no right to interfere with them. We cannot help them, and it is very doubtful whether they can help us, or whether we have any right to trespass upon their time if they can. Let the dead and the hereafter alone, and solve your own problem; get rich. If you begin to mix with the occult, you will start mental cross-currents which will surely bring your hopes to shipwreck. Now, this and the preceding chapters have brought us to the following statement of basic facts:—

There is a thinking stuff from which all things are made, and which, in its original state, permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe.

✦

A thought, in this substance, produces the thing that is imaged by the thought.

✦

Man can form things in his thought, and, by impressing his thought upon formless substance, can cause the thing he thinks about to be created.

✦

In order to do this, man must pass from the competitive to the creative mind; he must form a clear mental picture of the things he wants, and hold this picture in his thoughts with the fixed PURPOSE to get what he wants, and the unwavering FAITH that he does get what he wants, closing his mind against all that may tend to shake his purpose, dim his vision, or quench his faith.

And in addition to all this, we shall now see that he must live and act in a Certain Way.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles continues his advice on guarding attention. Do not keep retelling past money troubles or the hardships of your childhood, he says; such stories tie you to them. Read hopeful accounts of the world, which he believes is "going to God," not to ruin. He also asks readers to read only this book while practicing, and to avoid spiritualism and the occult. Some claims here need a frank note. He says health depends on getting rich, and he describes some poor people as "intellectually indolent"; both reflect the attitudes of his era and should not be taken as truth about anyone's situation. Talking through past hardship, especially with a counselor, can be healing rather than harmful. What remains useful is the idea that the stories we repeat shape us, and that we can choose to tell our own story as one of growth.

PRACTICE

Write a short version of your life story focused on moments when you grew, learned, or recovered. If past hardship still feels heavy, consider talking it through with a trusted friend or a counselor rather than pushing it away.

KEY THOUGHT

The world is not going to the devil; it is going to God.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XI

Acting in the Certain Way

THOUGHT IS the creative power, or the impelling force which causes the creative power to act; thinking in a Certain Way will bring riches to you, but you must not rely upon thought alone, paying no attention to personal action. That is the rock upon which many otherwise scientific metaphysical thinkers meet shipwreck—the failure to connect thought with personal action.

We have not yet reached the stage of development, even supposing such a stage to be possible, in which man can create directly from Formless Substance without nature's processes or the work of human hands; man must not only think, but his personal action must supplement his thought.

By thought you can cause the gold in the hearts of the mountains to be impelled toward you; but it will not mine itself, refine itself, coin itself into double eagles, and come rolling along the roads seeking its way into your pocket.

Under the impelling power of the Supreme Spirit, men's affairs will be so ordered that some one will be led to mine the gold for you; other men's business transactions will be so directed that the gold will be brought toward you, and you must so arrange your own business affairs that you may be able to receive it when it comes to you. Your thought

makes all things, animate and inanimate, work to bring you what you want; but your personal activity must be such that you can rightly receive what you want when it reaches you. You are not to take it as charity, nor to steal it; you must give every man more in use value than he gives you in cash value.

The scientific use of thought consists in forming a clear and distinct mental image of what you want; in holding fast to the purpose to get what you want; and in realizing with grateful faith that you *do* get what you want.

Do not try to "project" your thought in any mysterious or occult way, with the idea of having it go out and do things for you; that is wasted effort, and will weaken your power to think with sanity.

The action of thought in getting rich is fully explained in the preceding chapters; your faith and purpose positively impress your vision upon Formless Substance, which has THE SAME DESIRE FOR MORE LIFE THAT YOU HAVE; and this vision, received from you, sets all the creative forces at work IN AND THROUGH THEIR REGULAR CHANNELS OF ACTION, but directed toward you.

It is not your part to guide or supervise the creative process; all you have to do with that is to retain your vision, stick to your purpose, and maintain your faith and gratitude.

But you must act in a Certain Way, so that you can appropriate what is yours when it comes to you; so that you can meet the things you have in your picture, and put them in their proper places as they arrive.

You can readily see the truth of this. When things reach you, they will be in the hands of other men, who will ask an equivalent for them.

And you can only get what is yours by giving the other man what is his.

Your pocketbook is not going to be transformed into a Fortunatus's purse, which shall be always full of money without effort on your part.

This is the crucial point in the science of getting rich; right here, where thought and personal action must be combined. There are very

many people who, consciously or unconsciously, set the creative forces in action by the strength and persistence of their desires, but who remain poor because they do not provide for the reception of the thing they want when it comes.

By thought, the thing you want is brought to you; by action you receive it.

Whatever your action is to be, it is evident that you must act NOW. You cannot act in the past, and it is essential to the clearness of your mental vision that you dismiss the past from your mind. You cannot act in the future, for the future is not here yet. And you cannot tell how you will want to act in any future contingency until that contingency has arrived.

Because you are not in the right business, or the right environment now, do not think that you must postpone action until you get into the right business or environment. And do not spend time in the present taking thought as to the best course in possible future emergencies; have faith in your ability to meet any emergency when it arrives.

If you act in the present with your mind on the future, your present action will be with a divided mind, and will not be effective.

Put your whole mind into present action.

Do not give your creative impulse to Original Substance, and then sit down and wait for results; if you do, you will never get them. Act now. There is never any time but now, and there never will be any time but now. If you are ever to begin to make ready for the reception of what you want, you must begin now.

And your action, whatever it is, must most likely be in your present business or employment, and must be upon the persons and things in your present environment.

You cannot act where you are not; you cannot act where you have been, and you cannot act where you are going to be; you can act only where you are.

Do not bother as to whether yesterday's work was well done or ill done; do to-day's work well.

Do not try to do to-morrow's work now; there will be plenty of time to do that when you get to it.

Do not try, by occult or mystical means, to act on people or things that are out of your reach.

Do not wait for a change of environment before you act; get a change of environment by action.

You can so act upon the environment in which you are now, as to cause yourself to be transferred to a better environment.

Hold with faith and purpose the vision of yourself in the better environment, but act upon your present environment with all your heart, and with all your strength, and with all your mind.

Do not spend any time in day dreaming or castle building; hold to the one vision of what you want, and act NOW.

Do not cast about seeking some new thing to do, or some strange, unusual, or remarkable action to perform as a first step toward getting rich. It is probable that your actions, at least for some time to come, will be those you have been performing for some time past; but you are to begin now to perform these actions in the Certain Way, which will surely make you rich.

If you are engaged in some business, and feel that it is not the right one for you, do not wait until you get into the right business before you begin to act.

Do not feel discouraged, or sit down and lament because you are misplaced. No man was ever so misplaced but that he could find the right place, and no man ever became so involved in the wrong business but that he could get into the right business.

Hold the vision of yourself in the right business, with the purpose to get into it, and the faith that you will get into it, and are getting into it; but ACT in your present business. Use your present business as the means of getting a better one, and use your present environment as the

means of getting into a better one. Your vision of the right business, if held with faith and purpose, will cause the Supreme to move the right business toward you; and your action, if performed in the Certain Way, will cause you to move toward the business.

If you are an employee, or wage earner, and feel that you must change places in order to get what you want, do not "project" your thought into space and rely upon it to get you another job. It will probably fail to do so.

Hold the vision of yourself in the job you want, while you ACT with faith and purpose on the job you have, and you will certainly get the job you want.

Your vision and faith will set the creative force in motion to bring it toward you, and your action will cause the forces in your own environment to move you toward the place you want. In closing this chapter, we will add another statement to our syllabus:—

There is a thinking stuff from which all things are made, and which, in its original state, permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe.

✦

A thought, in this substance, produces the thing that is imaged by the thought.

✦

Man can form things in his thought, and, by impressing his thoughts upon formless substance, can cause the thing he thinks about to be created.

✦

In order to do this, man must pass from the competitive to the creative mind; he must form a clear mental picture of the things he wants, and hold this picture in his thoughts with the fixed PURPOSE to get what he wants, and the unwavering FAITH that he does get what he wants, closing his mind to all that may tend to shake his purpose, dim his vision, or quench his faith.

✦

That he may receive what he wants when it comes, man must act NOW upon the people and things in his present environment.

✦

REFLECTION

This may be the most practical chapter in the book. Wattles warns that many people who believe in the power of thought fail because they never connect thinking to action. Gold, he says, will not "mine itself" and roll into your pocket.

Your vision sets things in motion, but you must be ready to receive results through real work and fair exchange. He stresses acting now, in your present job and place, instead of waiting for better conditions. Do today's work well, don't fret over yesterday, and don't try to do tomorrow's work early. If you are in the wrong job, use the one you have as a step toward the right one. This advice holds up well today: progress usually comes from steady effort where you stand, not from waiting for the perfect moment to begin.

PRACTICE

Pick one task in your current job or project that you have been putting off. Do it today, fully and carefully. Afterward, write one sentence about how it connects to the bigger goal you hold.

KEY THOUGHT

By thought, the thing you want is
brought to you; by action you receive it.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XII

Efficient Action

YOU MUST use your thought as directed in previous chapters, and begin to do what you can do where you are; and you must do ALL that you can do where you are.

You can advance only by being larger than your present place; and no man is larger than his present place who leaves undone any of the work pertaining to that place.

The world is advanced only by those who more than fill their present places.

If no man quite filled his present place, you can see that there must be a going backward in everything. Those who do not quite fill their present places are a dead weight upon society, government, commerce, and industry; they must be carried along by others at a great expense. The progress of the world is retarded only by those who do not fill the places they are holding; they belong to a former age and a lower stage or plane of life, and their tendency is toward degeneration. No society could advance if every man was smaller than his place; social evolution is guided by the law of physical and mental evolution. In the animal world, evolution is caused by excess of life.

When an organism has more life than can be expressed in the functions of its own plane, it develops the organs of a higher plane, and

a new species is originated.

There never would have been new species had there not been organisms which more than filled their places. The law is exactly the same for you; your getting rich depends upon your applying this principle to your own affairs.

Every day is either a successful day or a day of failure; and it is the successful days which get you what you want. If every day is a failure, you can never get rich; while if every day is a success, you cannot fail to get rich.

If there is something that may be done to-day, and you do not do it, you have failed in so far as that thing is concerned; and the consequences may be more disastrous than you imagine.

You cannot foresee the results of even the most trivial act; you do not know the workings of all the forces that have been set moving in your behalf. Much may be depending on your doing some simple act; it may be the very thing which is to open the door of opportunity to very great possibilities. You can never know all the combinations which Supreme Intelligence is making for you in the world of things and of human affairs; your neglect or failure to do some small thing may cause a long delay in getting what you want.

Do, every day, ALL that can be done that day.

There is, however, a limitation or qualification of the above that you must take into account.

You are not to overwork, nor to rush blindly into your business in the effort to do the greatest possible number of things in the shortest possible time.

You are not to try to do to-morrow's work to-day, nor to do a week's work in a day.

It is really not the number of things you do, but the EFFICIENCY of each separate action that counts.

Every act is, in itself, either a success or a failure.

Every act is, in itself, either effective or inefficient.

Every inefficient act is a failure, and if you spend your life in doing inefficient acts, your whole life will be a failure.

The more things you do, the worse for you, if all your acts are inefficient ones.

On the other hand, every efficient act is a success in itself, and if every act of your life is an efficient one, your whole life MUST be a success.

The cause of failure is doing too many things in an inefficient manner, and not doing enough things in an efficient manner.

You will see that it is a self-evident proposition that if you do not do any inefficient acts, and if you do a sufficient number of efficient acts, you will become rich. If, now, it is possible for you to make each act an efficient one, you see again that the getting of riches is reduced to an exact science, like mathematics.

The matter turns, then, on the question whether you can make each separate act a success in itself. And this you can certainly do.

You can make each act a success, because All Power is working with you; and All Power cannot fail.

Power is at your service; and to make each act efficient you have only to put power into it.

Every action is either strong or weak; and when every one is strong, you are acting in the Certain Way which will make you rich.

Every act can be made strong and efficient by holding your vision while you are doing it, and putting the whole power of your FAITH and PURPOSE into it.

It is at this point that the people fail who separate mental power from personal action. They use the power of mind in one place and at one

time, and they act in another place and at another time. So their acts are not successful in themselves; too many of them are inefficient. But if All Power goes into every act, no matter how commonplace, every act will be a success in itself; and as in the nature of things every success opens the way to other successes, your progress toward what you want, and the progress of what you want toward you, will become increasingly rapid.

Remember that successful action is cumulative in its results. Since the desire for more life is inherent in all things, when a man begins to move toward larger life more things attach themselves to him, and the influence of his desire is multiplied.

Do, every day, all that you can do that day, and do each act in an efficient manner.

In saying that you must hold your vision while you are doing each act, however trivial or commonplace, I do not mean to say that it is necessary at all times to see the vision distinctly to its smallest details. It should be the work of your leisure hours to use your imagination on the details of your vision, and to contemplate them until they are firmly fixed upon your memory.

If you wish speedy results, spend practically all your spare time in this practice.

By continuous contemplation you will get the picture of what you want, even to the smallest details, so firmly fixed upon your mind, and so completely transferred to the mind of Formless Substance, that in your working hours you need only to mentally refer to the picture to stimulate your faith and purpose, and cause your best effort to be put forth. Contemplate your picture in your leisure hours until your consciousness is so full of it that you can grasp it instantly. You will become so enthused with its bright promises that the mere thought of it will call forth the strongest energies of your whole being.

Let us again repeat our syllabus, and by slightly changing the closing statements bring it to the point we have now reached.

There is a thinking stuff from which all things are made, and which, in its original state, permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe.

✦

A thought, in this substance, produces the thing that is imaged by the thought.

✦

Man can form things in his thought, and, by impressing his thought upon formless substance, can cause the thing he thinks about to be created.

✦

In order to do this, man must pass from the competitive to the creative mind; he must form a clear mental picture of the things he wants, and do, with faith and purpose, all that can be done each day, doing each separate thing in an efficient manner.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles asks readers to do all they can each day, and to do each act well. He calls it "more than filling your present place": the person who gives more than the role requires is the one who grows beyond it. He compares this to evolution, where surplus life produces new forms. Crucially, he warns against overwork. The goal is not to cram more tasks into a day but to make each one count, done with full attention and a clear sense of purpose. His line about people who do not fill their places being "a dead weight" is harsh and ignores the many reasons people struggle, including illness, care duties, and poor conditions. Set that aside and the chapter offers a sound message for a

distracted age: focus on quality, give each task your full presence, and let small successes build on each other.

PRACTICE

Tomorrow, choose three tasks only. Before each one, pause for a moment and recall why it matters to you. Do it with full attention, without multitasking. In the evening, note which task felt most effective and why.

KEY THOUGHT

It is really not the number of things you do, but the EFFICIENCY of each separate action that counts.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XIII

Getting into the Right Business

SUCCESS, IN any particular business, depends for one thing upon your possessing in a well-developed state the faculties required in that business.

Without good musical faculty no one can succeed as a teacher of music; without well-developed mechanical faculties no one can achieve great success in any of the mechanical trades; without tact and the commercial faculties no one can succeed in mercantile pursuits. But to possess in a well-developed state the faculties required in your particular vocation does not insure getting rich. There are musicians who have remarkable talent, and who yet remain poor; there are blacksmiths, carpenters, and so on who have excellent mechanical ability, but who do not get rich; and there are merchants with good faculties for dealing with men who nevertheless fail.

The different faculties are tools; it is essential to have good tools, but it is also essential that the tools should be used in the Right Way. One man can take a sharp saw, a square, a good plane, and so on, and build a handsome article of furniture; another man can take the same tools and set to work to duplicate the article, but his production will be a botch. He does not know how to use good tools in a successful way.

The various faculties of your mind are the tools with which you must do the work which is to make you rich; it will be easier for you to succeed if you get into a business for which you are well equipped with mental tools.

Generally speaking, you will do best in that business which will use your strongest faculties; the one for which you are naturally "best fitted." But there are limitations to this statement, also. No man should regard his vocation as being irrevocably fixed by the tendencies with which he was born.

You can get rich in ANY business, for if you have not the right talent for it you can develop that talent; it merely means that you will have to make your tools as you go along, instead of confining yourself to the use of those with which you were born. It will be EASIER for you to succeed in a vocation for which you already have the talents in a well-developed state; but you CAN succeed in any vocation, for you can develop any rudimentary talent, and there is no talent of which you have not at least the rudiment.

You will get rich most easily in point of effort, if you do that for which you are best fitted; but you will get rich most satisfactorily if you do that which you WANT to do.

Doing what you want to do is life; and there is no real satisfaction in living if we are compelled to be forever doing something which we do not like to do, and can never do what we want to do. And it is certain that you can do what you want to do; the desire to do it is proof that you have within you the power which can do it.

Desire is a manifestation of power.

The desire to play music is the power which can play music seeking expression and development; the desire to invent mechanical devices is the mechanical talent seeking expression and development.

Where there is no power, either developed or undeveloped, to do a thing, there is never any desire to do that thing; and where there is strong

desire to do a thing, it is certain proof that the power to do it is strong, and only requires to be developed and applied in the Right Way.

All things else being equal, it is best to select the business for which you have the best developed talent; but if you have a strong desire to engage in any particular line of work, you should select that work as the ultimate end at which you aim.

You can do what you want to do, and it is your right and privilege to follow the business or avocation which will be most congenial and pleasant.

You are not obliged to do what you do not like to do, and should not do it except as a means to bring you to the doing of the thing you want to do.

If there are past mistakes whose consequences have placed you in an undesirable business or environment, you may be obliged for some time to do what you do not like to do; but you can make the doing of it pleasant by knowing that it is making it possible for you to come to the doing of what you want to do.

If you feel that you are not in the right vocation, do not act too hastily in trying to get into another one. The best way, generally, to change business or environment is by growth.

Do not be afraid to make a sudden and radical change if the opportunity is presented, and you feel after careful consideration that it is the right opportunity; but never take sudden or radical action when you are in doubt as to the wisdom of doing so.

There is never any hurry on the creative plane; and there is no lack of opportunity.

When you get out of the competitive mind you will understand that you never need to act hastily. No one else is going to beat you to the thing you want to do; there is enough for all. If one place is taken, another and a better one will be opened for you a little farther on; there is plenty of time. When you are in doubt, wait. Fall back on the

contemplation of your vision, and increase your faith and purpose; and by all means, in times of doubt and indecision, cultivate gratitude.

A day or two spent in contemplating the vision of what you want, and in earnest thanksgiving that you are getting it, will bring your mind into such close relationship with the Supreme that you will make no mistake when you do act.

There is a mind which knows all there is to know; and you can come into close unity with this mind by faith and the purpose to advance in life, if you have deep gratitude.

Mistakes come from acting hastily, or from acting in fear or doubt, or in forgetfulness of the Right Motive, which is more life to all, and less to none.

As you go on in the Certain Way, opportunities will come to you in increasing number; and you will need to be very steady in your faith and purpose, and to keep in close touch with the All Mind by reverent gratitude.

Do all that you can do in a perfect manner every day, but do it without haste, worry, or fear. Go as fast as you can, but never hurry.

Remember that in the moment you begin to hurry you cease to be a creator and become a competitor; you drop back upon the old plane again.

Whenever you find yourself hurrying, call a halt; fix your attention on the mental image of the thing you want, and begin to give thanks that you are getting it. The exercise of GRATITUDE will never fail to strengthen your faith and renew your purpose.

REFLECTION

Talents are tools, Wattles says, and success comes more easily in work that uses your strongest ones. But talent alone guarantees nothing; what counts is how you use it. More hopefully, he insists you are not locked in by birth. You can

develop almost any ability, and a strong desire to do something is a sign that the capacity exists within you. He advises against rash career changes: grow into the new path, wait when in doubt, and use gratitude to calm a hurried mind. "Go as fast as you can, but never hurry," he writes, because hurry is a sign of fear and competition. This is thoughtful counsel for anyone considering a career shift today. His claim that desire always proves ability is optimistic, but the patient, step-by-step approach he recommends is sensible and humane.

PRACTICE

Write down work you would love to do. List one skill it needs that you lack. Find one small, low-cost way to start building it this month, such as a free course, a conversation, or a weekend project.

KEY THOUGHT

Go as fast as you can, but never hurry.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XIV

The Impression of Increase

WHETHER YOU change your vocation or not, your actions for the present must be those pertaining to the business in which you are now engaged.

You can get into the business you want by making constructive use of the business you are already established in; by doing your daily work in a Certain Way.

And in so far as your business consists in dealing with other men, whether personally or by letter, the key-thought of all your efforts must be to convey to their minds the impression of increase.

Increase is what all men and all women are seeking; it is the urge of the Formless Intelligence within them, seeking fuller expression.

The desire for increase is inherent in all nature; it is the fundamental impulse of the universe. All human activities are based on the desire for increase; people are seeking more food, more clothes, better shelter, more luxury, more beauty, more knowledge, more pleasure—increase in something, more life.

Every living thing is under this necessity for continuous advancement; where increase of life ceases, dissolution and death set in at once.

Man instinctively knows this, and hence he is forever seeking more. This law of perpetual increase is set forth by Jesus in the parable of the talents; only those who gain more retain any; from him who hath not shall be taken away even that which he hath.

The normal desire for increased wealth is not an evil or a reprehensible thing; it is simply the desire for more abundant life; it is aspiration.

And because it is the deepest instinct of their natures, all men and women are attracted to him who can give them more of the means of life.

In following the Certain Way as described in the foregoing pages, you are getting continuous increase for yourself, and you are giving it to all with whom you deal.

You are a creative center, from which increase is given off to all.

Be sure of this, and convey assurance of the fact to every man, woman, and child with whom you come in contact. No matter how small the transaction, even if it be only the selling of a stick of candy to a little child, put into it the thought of increase, and make sure that the customer is impressed with the thought.

Convey the impression of advancement with everything you do, so that all people shall receive the impression that you are an Advancing Man, and that you advance all who deal with you. Even to the people whom you meet in a social way, without any thought of business, and to whom you do not try to sell anything, give the thought of increase.

You can convey this impression by holding the unshakable faith that you, yourself, are in the Way of Increase; and by letting this faith inspire, fill, and permeate every action.

Do everything that you do in the firm conviction that you are an advancing personality, and that you are giving advancement to everybody.

Feel that you are getting rich, and that in so doing you are making others rich, and conferring benefits on all.

Do not boast or brag of your success, or talk about it unnecessarily; true faith is never boastful.

Wherever you find a boastful person, you find one who is secretly doubtful and afraid. Simply feel the faith, and let it work out in every transaction; let every act and tone and look express the quiet assurance that you are getting rich; that you are already rich. Words will not be necessary to communicate this feeling to others; they will feel the sense of increase when in your presence, and will be attracted to you again.

You must so impress others that they will feel that in associating with you they will get increase for themselves. See that you give them a use value greater than the cash value you are taking from them.

Take an honest pride in doing this, and let everybody know it; and you will have no lack of customers. People will go where they are given increase; and the Supreme, which desires increase in all, and which knows all, will move toward you men and women who have never heard of you. Your business will increase rapidly, and you will be surprised at the unexpected benefits which will come to you. You will be able from day to day to make larger combinations, secure greater advantages, and to go on into a more congenial vocation if you desire to do so.

But in doing all this, you must never lose sight of your vision of what you want, or your faith and purpose to get what you want.

Let me here give you another word of caution in regard to motives.

Beware of the insidious temptation
to seek for power over other men.

Nothing is so pleasant to the unformed or partially developed mind as the exercise of power or dominion over others. The desire to rule for selfish gratification has been the curse of the world. For countless ages kings and lords have drenched the earth with blood in their battles to

extend their dominions; this not to seek more life for all, but to get more power for themselves.

To-day, the main motive in the business and industrial world is the same; men marshal their armies of dollars, and lay waste the lives and hearts of millions in the same mad scramble for power over others. Commercial kings, like political kings, are inspired by the lust for power.

Jesus saw in this desire for mastery the moving impulse of that evil world He sought to overthrow. Read the twenty-third chapter of Matthew, and see how He pictures the lust of the Pharisees to be called "Master," to sit in the high places, to domineer over others, and to lay burdens on the backs of the less fortunate; and note how He compares this lust for dominion with the brotherly seeking for the Common Good to which He calls His disciples.

Look out for the temptation to seek for authority, to become a "master," to be considered as one who is above the common herd, to impress others by lavish display, and so on.

The mind that seeks for mastery over others is the competitive mind; and the competitive mind is not the creative one. In order to master your environment and your destiny, it is not at all necessary that you should rule over your fellow men; and indeed, when you fall into the world's struggle for the high places, you begin to be conquered by fate and environment, and your getting rich becomes a matter of chance and speculation.

Beware of the competitive mind! No better statement of the principle of creative action can be formulated than the favorite declaration of the late "Golden Rule" Jones of Toledo: "What I want for myself, I want for everybody."

REFLECTION

Wattles believes everyone is seeking "increase," more life, more beauty, more knowledge, and that people are drawn to those who help them get it. So in every transaction, even selling a stick of candy to a child, leave the other person with a sense that they have gained. He warns against bragging, which he sees as a sign of hidden doubt, and against the much deeper temptation to seek power over others. Kings and business magnates, he says, have caused great harm through the lust for mastery, and he points to Jesus' criticism of those who wanted to be called "Master." He ends with the motto of Toledo mayor "Golden Rule" Jones: "What I want for myself, I want for everybody." The chapter turns business into a form of service and is one of the book's most generous passages.

PRACTICE

In your next three interactions at work or home, aim to leave each person better off than before: a helpful idea, a sincere thank-you, or extra care. Afterward, notice how they responded and how you felt.

KEY THOUGHT

Beware of the competitive mind!

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XV

The Advancing Man

WHAT I have said in the last chapter applies as well to the professional man and the wage-earner as to the man who is engaged in mercantile business.

No matter whether you are a physician, a teacher, or a clergyman, if you can give increase of life to others and make them sensible of the fact, they will be attracted to you, and you will get rich. The physician who holds the vision of himself as a great and successful healer, and who works toward the complete realization of that vision with faith and purpose, as described in former chapters, will come into such close touch with the Source of Life that he will be phenomenally successful; patients will come to him in throngs.

No one has a greater opportunity to carry into effect the teachings of this book than the practitioner of medicine; it does not matter to which of the various schools he may belong, for the principle of healing is common to all of them, and may be reached by all alike. The Advancing Man in medicine, who holds to a clear mental image of himself as successful, and who obeys the laws of faith, purpose, and gratitude, will cure every curable case he undertakes, no matter what remedies he may use.

In the field of religion, the world cries out for the clergyman who can teach his hearers the true science of abundant life. He who masters the details of the science of getting rich, together with the allied sciences of being well, of being great, and of winning love, and who teaches these details from the pulpit, will never lack for a congregation. This is the gospel that the world needs; it will give increase of life, and men will hear it gladly, and will give liberal support to the man who brings it to them.

What is now needed is a demonstration of the science of life from the pulpit. We want preachers who can not only tell us how, but who in their own persons will show us how. We need the preacher who will himself be rich, healthy, great, and beloved, to teach us how to attain to these things; and when he comes he will find a numerous and loyal following.

The same is true of the teacher who can inspire the children with the faith and purpose of the advancing life. He will never be "out of a job." And any teacher who has this faith and purpose can give it to his pupils; he cannot help giving it to them if it is part of his own life and practice.

What is true of the teacher, preacher, and physician is true of the lawyer, dentist, real estate man, insurance agent—of everybody.

The combined mental and personal action I have described is infallible; it cannot fail. Every man and woman who follows these instructions steadily, perseveringly, and to the letter, will get rich. The law of the Increase of Life is as mathematically certain in its operation as the law of gravitation; getting rich is an exact science.

The wage-earner will find this as true of his case as of any of the others mentioned. Do not feel that you have no chance to get rich because you are working where there is no visible opportunity for advancement, where wages are small and the cost of living high. Form your clear mental vision of what you want, and begin to act with faith and purpose.

Do all the work you can do, every day, and do each piece of work in a perfectly successful manner; put the power of success, and the purpose to get rich, into everything that you do.

But do not do this merely with the idea of currying favor with your employer, in the hope that he, or those above you, will see your good work and advance you; it is not likely that they will do so.

The man who is merely a "good" workman, filling his place to the very best of his ability, and satisfied with that, is valuable to his employer; and it is not to the employer's interest to promote him; he is worth more where he is.

To secure advancement, something more is necessary than to be too large for your place.

The man who is certain to advance is the one who is too big for his place, and who has a clear concept of what he wants to be; who knows that he can become what he wants to be, and who is determined to BE what he wants to be.

Do not try to more than fill your present place with a view to pleasing your employer; do it with the idea of advancing yourself. Hold the faith and purpose of increase during work hours, after work hours, and before work hours. Hold it in such a way that every person who comes in contact with you, whether foreman, fellow workman, or social acquaintance, will feel the power of purpose radiating from you; so that every one will get the sense of advancement and increase from you. Men will be attracted to you, and if there is no possibility for advancement in your present job, you will very soon see an opportunity to take another job.

There is a Power which never fails to present opportunity to the Advancing Man who is moving in obedience to law.

God cannot help helping you, if you act in a Certain Way; He must do so in order to help Himself.

There is nothing in your circumstances or in the industrial situation that can keep you down. If you cannot get rich working for the steel trust, you can get rich on a ten-acre farm; and if you begin to move in the Certain Way, you will certainly escape from the "clutches" of the steel trust and get on to the farm or wherever else you wish to be.

If a few thousands of its employees would enter upon the Certain Way, the steel trust would soon be in a bad plight; it would have to give its workingmen more opportunity, or go out of business. Nobody has to work for a trust; the trusts can keep men in so-called hopeless conditions only so long as there are men who are too ignorant to know of the science of getting rich, or too intellectually slothful to practice it.

Begin this way of thinking and acting, and your faith and purpose will make you quick to see any opportunity to better your condition.

Such opportunities will speedily come, for the Supreme, working in All, and working for you, will bring them before you.

Do not wait for an opportunity to be all that you want to be; when an opportunity to be more than you are now is presented and you feel impelled toward it, take it. It will be the first step toward a greater opportunity.

There is no such thing possible in this universe as a lack of opportunities for the man who is living the advancing life.

It is inherent in the constitution of the cosmos that all things shall be for him and work together for his good; and he must certainly get rich if he acts and thinks in the Certain Way. So let wage-earning men and women study this book with great care, and enter with confidence upon the course of action it prescribes; it will not fail.



REFLECTION

Wattles applies his method to professionals and wage earners. Doctors, teachers, ministers, lawyers, and salespeople, he says, will thrive if they truly add to others' lives and make people feel it. For employees he gives subtle advice: being merely a "good" worker can keep you where you are, because you are valuable in that seat. Instead, do excellent work for your own growth, hold a clear picture of who you want to become, and take any opportunity to be more than you are now. Two notes of care. His claim that a confident doctor "will

cure every curable case" overstates what attitude can do in medicine. And his statement that people stay in poor jobs because they are "too intellectually slothful" ignores real barriers. Still, his core message, that you can grow from wherever you are, can encourage someone feeling stuck.

PRACTICE

Write a short description of the role you want next. Identify one person in that role and ask them a single question about how they got there. Then do one thing this week that someone in that role would do.

KEY THOUGHT

Do not wait for an opportunity to be all that you want to be; when an opportunity to be more than you are now is presented and you feel impelled toward it, take it.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XVI

Some Cautions, and Concluding Observations

MANY PEOPLE will scoff at the idea that there is an exact science of getting rich; holding the impression that the supply of wealth is limited, they will insist that social and governmental institutions must be changed before even any considerable number of people can acquire a competence.

But this is not true.

It is true that existing governments keep the masses in poverty, but this is because the masses do not think and act in the Certain Way.

If the masses begin to move forward as suggested in this book, neither governments nor industrial systems can check them; all systems must be modified to accommodate the forward movement.

If the people have the Advancing Mind, have the Faith that they can become rich, and move forward with the fixed purpose to become rich, nothing can possibly keep them in poverty.

Individuals may enter upon the Certain Way at any time, and under any government, and make themselves rich; and when any considerable number of individuals do so under any government, they will cause the system to be so modified as to open the way for others.

The more men who get rich on the competitive plane, the worse for others; the more who get rich on the creative plane, the better for others.

The economic salvation of the masses can only be accomplished by getting a large number of people to practice the scientific method set down in this book, and become rich. These will show others the way, and inspire them with a desire for real life, with the faith that it can be attained, and with the purpose to attain it.

For the present, however, it is enough to know that neither the government under which you live nor the capitalistic or competitive system of industry can keep you from getting rich. When you enter upon the creative plane of thought you will rise above all these things and become a citizen of another kingdom.

But remember that your thought must be held upon the creative plane; you are never for an instant to be betrayed into regarding the supply as limited, or into acting on the moral level of competition.

Whenever you do fall into old ways of thought, correct yourself instantly; for when you are in the competitive mind, you have lost the co-operation of the Mind of the Whole.

Do not spend any time in planning as to how you will meet possible emergencies in the future, except as the necessary policies may affect your actions to-day. You are concerned with doing to-day's work in a perfectly successful manner, and not with emergencies which may arise to-morrow; you can attend to them as they come.

Do not concern yourself with questions as to how you shall surmount obstacles which may loom upon your business horizon, unless you can see plainly that your course must be altered to-day in order to avoid them.

No matter how tremendous an obstruction may appear at a distance, you will find that if you go on in the Certain Way it will disappear as you approach it, or that a way over, through, or around it will appear.

No possible combination of circumstances can defeat a man or woman who is proceeding to get rich along strictly scientific lines. No

man or woman who obeys the law can fail to get rich, any more than one can multiply two by two and fail to get four.

Give no anxious thought to possible disasters, obstacles, panics, or unfavorable combinations of circumstances; it is time enough to meet such things when they present themselves before you in the immediate present, and you will find that every difficulty carries with it the wherewithal for its overcoming.

Guard your speech. Never speak of yourself, your affairs, or of anything else in a discouraged or discouraging way.

Never admit the possibility of failure, or speak in a way that infers failure as a possibility.

Never speak of the times as being hard, or of business conditions as being doubtful. Times may be hard and business doubtful for those who are on the competitive plane, but they can never be so for you; you can create what you want, and you are above fear.

When others are having hard times and poor business, you will find your greatest opportunities.

Train yourself to think of and to look upon the world as a something which is Becoming, which is growing; and to regard seeming evil as being only that which is undeveloped. Always speak in terms of advancement; to do otherwise is to deny your faith, and to deny your faith is to lose it.

Never allow yourself to feel disappointed. You may expect to have a certain thing at a certain time, and not get it at that time; and this will appear to you like failure.

But if you hold to your faith you will find that the failure is only apparent.

Go on in the certain way, and if you do not receive that thing, you will receive something so much better that you will see that the seeming failure was really a great success.

A student of this science had set his mind on making a certain business combination which seemed to him at the time to be very desirable, and he worked for some weeks to bring it about. When the

crucial time came, the thing failed in a perfectly inexplicable way; it was as if some unseen influence had been working secretly against him. He was not disappointed; on the contrary, he thanked God that his desire had been overruled, and went steadily on with a grateful mind. In a few weeks an opportunity so much better came his way that he would not have made the first deal on any account; and he saw that a Mind which knew more than he knew had prevented him from losing the greater good by entangling himself with the lesser.

That is the way every seeming failure will work out for you, if you keep your faith, hold to your purpose, have gratitude, and do, every day, all that can be done that day, doing each separate act in a successful manner.

When you make a failure, it is because you have not asked for enough; keep on, and a larger thing than you were seeking will certainly come to you. Remember this.

You will not fail because you lack the necessary talent to do what you wish to do. If you go on as I have directed, you will develop all the talent that is necessary to the doing of your work.

It is not within the scope of this book to deal with the science of cultivating talent; but it is as certain and simple as the process of getting rich.

However, do not hesitate or waver for fear that when you come to any certain place you will fail for lack of ability; keep right on, and when you come to that place, the ability will be furnished to you. The same source of Ability which enabled the untaught Lincoln to do the greatest work in government ever accomplished by a single man is open to you; you may draw upon all the mind there is for wisdom to use in meeting the responsibilities which are laid upon you. Go on in full faith.

Study this book. Make it your constant companion until you have mastered all the ideas contained in it. While you are getting firmly established in this faith, you will do well to give up most recreations and pleasures; and to stay away from places where ideas conflicting with these

are advanced in lectures or sermons. Do not read pessimistic or conflicting literature, or get into arguments upon the matter. Do very little reading, outside of the writers mentioned in the Preface. Spend most of your leisure time in contemplating your vision, and in cultivating gratitude, and in reading this book. It contains all you need to know of the science of getting rich; and you will find all the essentials summed up in the following chapter.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles answers critics who say social systems must change before many people can prosper. He believes individuals can rise under any system, and that enough people doing so will reshape the system itself. He urges readers not to worry about distant obstacles, to guard their speech, and never to speak of failure or hard times. When a hoped-for result doesn't come, he says, trust that something better is on the way, and he tells of a student whose failed deal led to a better one. There is value here: dwelling on worst cases rarely helps. But his claim that no circumstance can defeat someone following his method is not something any book can promise. Real setbacks happen to careful, faithful people. Planning for risk, keeping savings, and asking for help are wise, not signs of weak faith.

PRACTICE

Think of a recent disappointment. Write down one thing it taught you and one door it may have opened. Then take one sensible precaution for the future, such as a small savings step or a backup plan.

KEY THOUGHT

Train yourself to think of and to look upon the world as a something which is Becoming, which is growing

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XVII

Summary of the Science of Getting Rich

THERE IS a thinking stuff from which all things are made, and which, in its original state, permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe.

A thought in this substance produces the thing that is imaged by the thought.

Man can form things in his thought, and by impressing his thought upon formless substance can cause the thing he thinks about to be created.

In order to do this, man must pass from the competitive to the creative mind; otherwise he cannot be in harmony with the Formless Intelligence, which is always creative and never competitive in spirit.

Man may come into full harmony with the Formless Substance by entertaining a lively and sincere gratitude for the blessings it bestows upon him. Gratitude unifies the mind of man with the intelligence of Substance, so that man's thoughts are received by the Formless. Man can remain upon the creative plane only by uniting himself with the Formless Intelligence through a deep and continuous feeling of gratitude.

Man must form a clear and definite mental image of the things he wishes to have, to do, or to become; and he must hold this mental image in his thoughts, while being deeply grateful to the Supreme that all his desires are granted to him. The man who wishes to get rich must spend his leisure hours in contemplating his Vision, and in earnest thanksgiving that the reality is being given to him. Too much stress cannot be laid on the importance of frequent contemplation of the mental image, coupled with unwavering faith and devout gratitude. This is the process by which the impression is given to the Formless, and the creative forces set in motion.

The creative energy works through the established channels of natural growth, and of the industrial and social order. All that is included in his mental image will surely be brought to the man who follows the instructions given above, and whose faith does not waver. What he wants will come to him through the ways of established trade and commerce.

In order to receive his own when it shall come to him, man must be active; and this activity can only consist in more than filling his present place. He must keep in mind the Purpose to get rich through the realization of his mental image. And he must do, every day, all that can be done that day, taking care to do each act in a successful manner. He must give to every man a use value in excess of the cash value he receives, so that each transaction makes for more life; and he must so hold the Advancing Thought that the impression of Increase will be communicated to all with whom he comes in contact.

The men and women who practice the foregoing instructions will certainly get rich; and the riches they receive will be in exact proportion to the definiteness of their vision, the fixity of their purpose, the steadiness of their faith, and the depth of their gratitude.

REFLECTION

The final chapter gathers the whole method into a few paragraphs. There is one thinking Substance; thought impressed on it creates; to work with it, move from a competitive to a creative mind; stay in harmony through deep, continuous gratitude; hold a clear mental image of what you want; act every day by doing all you can and doing each act well; give more in use value than you take in cash value; and let others feel a sense of increase from you. Wattles closes by promising that those who do this "will certainly get rich." Read today, the summary works best as a checklist of habits: clarity, gratitude, focused effort, fairness, and generosity. Those habits can improve your work and relationships, but your outcomes will still depend on circumstances and luck as well as effort.

PRACTICE

Copy the habits from this chapter onto a card: vision, gratitude, daily action, efficiency, use value, increase. Each evening for two weeks, mark which ones you practiced. At the end, choose one to strengthen.

KEY THOUGHT

He must give to every man a use value in excess of the cash value he receives, so that each transaction makes for more life

---

MY OWN NOTES

The Science of Being Well

1910 · SEVENTEEN CHAPTERS

About This Work

THE SCIENCE of Being Well appeared in 1910 from Elizabeth Towne in Holyoke, Massachusetts. The Preface calls it the second book in a series that began with The Science of Getting Rich: "as that book is intended solely for those who want money, so this is for those who want health." The structure mirrors the first book. Wattles starts from his idea of one living, thinking Substance, argues that a steady "conception of health" held with faith and gratitude sets that Substance to work in the body, and then turns to what he calls the voluntary functions: eating, drinking, breathing, and sleeping.

Several ideas in the book have held up well. He urges readers to eat slowly and attentively, to notice the difference between real hunger and habit, to stop before they are stuffed, to get fresh air, to stand up straight, to exercise through play, and to go to bed grateful rather than anxious. Many readers will find these habits calming and useful.

Other parts need a clear warning. This is a historical text, not medical advice. Wattles teaches that thought alone heals disease, that no medicine has healing power, that everyone should skip breakfast, that you should never eat without an "earned hunger" even after days without food, that long fasts are safe, that pain is always a sign of healing, and that readers should avoid medical books. None of this is reliable. Skipping meals or fasting can be dangerous, especially for people with diabetes, people who are pregnant or breastfeeding, children and teenagers, older adults, anyone with a history of an eating disorder,

and anyone taking medication. Do not stop treatment or change your diet in a major way without talking to a doctor, and seek care promptly for severe or lasting pain.

Wattles also says that disease comes from wrong thinking. Read that as a belief of the New Thought movement, not as fact. Illness is never the patient's fault, and no one stays sick because they lacked faith. Some remarks about other peoples and about the sick reflect the attitudes of his time. Take the book as a window into an early-twentieth-century hope that mind, faith, and simple living could make people whole, and keep the parts that support, rather than replace, good medical care. If health worries are affecting your mood, a doctor or counselor can help.

Preface

THIS VOLUME is the second of a series, the first of which is "THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH." As that book is intended solely for those who want money, so this is for those who want health, and who want a practical guide and handbook, not a philosophical treatise. It is an instructor in the use of the universal Principle of Life, and my effort has been to explain the way in so plain and simple a fashion that the reader, though he may have given no previous study to New Thought or metaphysics, may readily follow it to perfect health. While retaining all essentials, I have carefully eliminated all non-essentials; I have used no technical, abstruse, or difficult language, and have kept the one point in view at all times.

As its title asserts, the book deals with science, not speculation. The monistic theory of the universe—the theory that matter, mind, consciousness, and life are all manifestations of one Substance—is now accepted by most thinkers; and if you accept this theory, you cannot deny the logical conclusions you will find herein. Best of all, the methods of thought and action prescribed have been tested by the author in his own case, and in the case of hundreds of others during twelve years of practice, with continuous and unfailing success. I can say of the Science of Being Well that it works; and that wherever its laws are complied with, it can no more fail to work than the science of geometry can fail to work. If the tissues of your body have not been so destroyed

that continued life is impossible, you can get well; and if you will think and act in a Certain Way, you will get well.

If the reader wishes to fully understand the monistic theory of the cosmos, he is recommended to read Hegel and Emerson; to read also "The Eternal News," a pamphlet by J. J. Brown, 300 Cathcart Road, Govanhill, Glasgow, Scotland. Some enlightenment may also be found in a series of articles by the author, which were published in *The Nautilus*, Holyoke, Mass., during the year 1909, under the title, "What Is Truth?"

Those who wish more detailed information as to the performance of the voluntary functions—eating, drinking, breathing, and sleeping—may read "New Science of Living and Healing," "Letters to a Woman's Husband," and "The Constructive Use of Foods," booklets by W. D. Wattles, which may be obtained from the publishers of this book. I would also recommend the writings of Horace Fletcher, and of Edward Hooker Dewey. Read all these, if you like, as a sort of buttress to your faith; but let me warn you against making the mistake of studying many conflicting theories, and practicing, at the same time, parts of several different "systems"; for if you get well, it must be by giving your WHOLE MIND to the *right* way of thinking and living. Remember that the SCIENCE OF BEING WELL claims to be a complete and sufficient guide in every particular. Concentrate upon the way of thinking and acting it prescribes, and follow it in every detail, and you will get well; or if you are already well, you will remain so. Trusting that you will go on until the priceless blessing of perfect health is yours, I remain,

Very truly yours,

WALLACE D. WATTLES.

CHAPTER

I

The Principle of Health

IN THE personal application of the Science of Being Well, as in that of the Science of Getting Rich, certain fundamental truths must be known in the beginning, and accepted without question. Some of these truths we state here:—

The perfectly natural performance of function constitutes health; and the perfectly natural performance of function results from the natural action of the Principle of Life. There is a Principle of Life in the universe; it is the One Living Substance from which all things are made. This Living Substance permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe; it is in and through all things, like a very refined and diffusible ether. All life comes from it; its life is all the life there is.

Man is a form of this Living Substance, and has within him a Principle of Health. (The word Principle is used as meaning source.) The Principle of Health in man, when in full constructive activity, causes all the involuntary functions of his life to be perfectly performed.

It is the Principle of Health in man which really works all healing, no matter what "system" or "remedy" is employed; and this Principle of Health is brought into Constructive Activity by thinking in a Certain Way.

I proceed now to prove this last statement. We all know that cures are wrought by all the different, and often opposite, methods employed in the various branches of the healing art. The allopath, who gives a strong dose of a counter-poison, cures his patient; and the homeopath, who gives a diminutive dose of the poison most similar to that of the disease, also cures it. If allopathy ever cured any given disease, it is certain that homeopathy never cured that disease; and if homeopathy ever cured an ailment, allopathy could not possibly cure that ailment. The two systems are radically opposite in theory and practice; and yet both "cure" most diseases. And even the remedies used by physicians in any one school are not the same. Go with a case of indigestion to half a dozen doctors, and compare their prescriptions; it is more than likely that none of the ingredients of any one of them will be in the others. Must we not conclude that their patients are healed by a Principle of Health within themselves, and not by something in the varying "remedies"?

Not only this, but we find the same ailments cured by the osteopath with manipulations of the spine; by the faith healer with prayer, by the food scientist with bills of fare, by the Christian Scientist with a formulated creed statement, by the mental scientist with affirmation, and by the hygienists with differing plans of living. What conclusion can we come to in the face of all these facts but that there is a Principle of Health which is the same in all people, and which really accomplishes all the cures; and that there is something in all the "systems" which, under favorable conditions, arouses the Principle of Health to action? That is, medicines, manipulations, prayers, bills of fare, affirmations, and hygienic practices cure whenever they cause the Principle of Health to become active; and fail whenever they do not cause it to become active. Does not all this indicate that the results depend upon the way the patient thinks about the remedy, rather than upon the ingredients in the prescription?

There is an old story which furnishes so good an illustration on this point that I will give it here. It is said that in the middle ages, the bones

of a saint, kept in one of the monasteries, were working miracles of healing; on certain days a great crowd of the afflicted gathered to touch the relics, and all who did so were healed. On the eve of one of these occasions, some sacrilegious rascal gained access to the case in which the wonder-working relics were kept and stole the bones; and in the morning, with the usual crowd of sufferers waiting at the gates, the fathers found themselves shorn of the source of the miracle-working power. They resolved to keep the matter quiet, hoping that by doing so they might find the thief and recover their treasures; and hastening to the cellar of the convent they dug up the bones of a murderer, who had been buried there many years before. These they placed in the case, intending to make some plausible excuse for the failure of the saint to perform his usual miracles on that day; and then they let in the waiting assemblage of the sick and infirm. To the intense astonishment of those in the secret, the bones of the malefactor proved as efficacious as those of the saint; and the healing went on as before. One of the fathers is said to have left a history of the occurrence, in which he confessed that, in his judgment, the healing power had been in the people themselves all the time, and never in the bones at all.

Whether the story is true or not, the conclusion applies to all the cures wrought by all the systems. The Power that Heals is in the patient himself; and whether it shall become active or not does not depend upon the physical or mental means used, but upon the way the patient thinks about these means. There is a Universal Principle of Life, as Jesus taught; a great spiritual Healing Power; and there is a Principle of Health in man which is related to this Healing Power. This is dormant or active, according to the way a man thinks. He can always quicken it into activity by thinking in a Certain Way.

Your getting well does not depend upon the adoption of some system, or the finding of some remedy; people with your identical ailments have been healed by all systems and all remedies. It does not depend upon climate; some people are well and others are sick in all

climates. It does not depend upon avocation, unless in case of those who work under poisonous conditions; people are well in all trades and professions. Your getting well depends upon your beginning to think—and act—in a Certain Way.

The way a man thinks about things is determined by what he believes about them. His thoughts are determined by his faith, and the results depend upon his making a personal application of his faith. If a man has faith in the efficacy of a medicine, and is able to apply that faith to himself, that medicine will certainly cause him to be cured; but though his faith be great, he will not be cured unless he applies it to himself. Many sick people have faith for others but none for themselves. So, if he has faith in a system of diet, and can personally apply that faith, it will cure him; and if he has faith in prayers and affirmations and personally applies his faith, prayers and affirmations will cure him. Faith, personally applied, cures; and no matter how great the faith or how persistent the thought, it will not cure without personal application. The Science of Being Well, then, includes the two fields of thought and action. To be well it is not enough that man should merely think in a Certain Way; he must apply his thought to himself, and he must express and externalize it in his outward life by acting in the same way that he thinks.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles begins with his foundation: health is the natural working of the body, and it comes from a "Principle of Health" inside each person, part of the one Living Substance that fills the universe. To prove that this inner principle does all real healing, he points out that rival medical schools, prayer, diet plans, and spinal manipulation all claim cures. He adds an old legend in which a murderer's bones healed pilgrims just as well as a saint's. His conclusion is that what heals is belief, personally applied. Modern readers will recognize something true here: expectation and hope do affect how we feel, a fact later

studied as the placebo effect. But his leap to "faith cures" goes much too far. Medicines, surgery, and vaccines work whether or not we believe in them. Keep the insight that mindset matters, and keep your doctor too.

PRACTICE

Think of a time you felt better simply because you expected to, such as after a reassuring talk or a good night's rest. Write two sentences about it, then note one way you could bring that hopeful expectation into your next medical appointment.

KEY THOUGHT

The way a man thinks about things is determined by what he believes about them.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

II

The Foundations of Faith

BEFORE MAN can think in the Certain Way which will cause his diseases to be healed, he must believe in certain truths which are here stated:—

All things are made from one Living Substance, which, in its original state, permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe. While all visible things are made from It, yet this Substance, in its first formless condition is in and through all the visible forms that It has made. Its life is in All, and its intelligence is in All.

This Substance creates by thought, and its method is by taking the form of that which it thinks about. The thought of a form held by this substance causes it to assume that form; the thought of a motion causes it to institute that motion. Forms are created by this substance in moving itself into certain attitudes or positions. When Original Substance wishes to create a given form, it thinks of the motions which will produce that form. When it wishes to create a world, it thinks of the motions, perhaps extending through ages, which will result in its coming into the attitude and form of the world; and these motions are made. When it wishes to create an oak tree, it thinks of the sequences of movement, perhaps extending through ages, which will result in the form of an oak tree; and these motions are made. The particular

sequences of motion by which differing forms should be produced were established in the beginning; they are changeless. Certain motions instituted in the Formless Substance will forever produce certain forms.

Man's body is formed from the Original Substance, and is the result of certain motions, which first existed as thoughts of Original Substance. The motions which produce, renew, and repair the body of man are called functions, and these functions are of two classes: voluntary and involuntary. The involuntary functions are under the control of the Principle of Health in man, and are performed in a perfectly healthy manner so long as man thinks in a certain way. The voluntary functions of life are eating, drinking, breathing, and sleeping. These, entirely or in part, are under the direction of man's conscious mind; and he can perform them in a perfectly healthy way if he will. If he does not perform them in a healthy way, he cannot long be well. So we see that if man thinks in a certain way, and eats, drinks, breathes, and sleeps in a corresponding way, he will be well.

The involuntary functions of man's life are under the direct control of the Principle of Health, and so long as man thinks in a perfectly healthy way, these functions are perfectly performed; for the action of the Principle of Health is largely directed by man's conscious thought, affecting his sub-conscious mind.

Man is a thinking center, capable of originating thought; and as he does not know everything, he makes mistakes and thinks error. Not knowing everything, he believes things to be true which are not true. Man holds in his thought the idea of diseased and abnormal functioning and conditions, and so perverts the action of the Principle of Health, causing diseased and abnormal functioning and conditions within his own body. In the Original Substance there are held only the thoughts of perfect motion; perfect and healthy function; complete life. God never thinks disease or imperfection. But for countless ages men have held thoughts of disease, abnormality, old age, and death; and the perverted functioning resulting from these thoughts has become a part of the

inheritance of the race. Our ancestors have, for many generations, held imperfect ideas concerning human form and functioning; and we begin life with racial sub-conscious impressions of imperfection and disease.

This is not natural, or a part of the plan of nature. The purpose of nature can be nothing else than the perfection of life. This we see from the very nature of life itself. It is the nature of life to continually advance toward more perfect living; advancement is the inevitable result of the very act of living. Increase is always the result of active living; whatever lives must live more and more. The seed, lying in the granary, has life, but it is not living. Put it into the soil and it becomes active, and at once begins to gather to itself from the surrounding substance, and to build a plant form. It will so cause increase that a seed head will be produced containing thirty, sixty, or a hundred seeds, each having as much life as the first.

Life, by living, increases.

Life cannot live without increasing, and the fundamental impulse of life is to live. It is in response to this fundamental impulse that Original Substance works, and creates. God must live; and he cannot live except as he creates and increases. In multiplying forms, He is moving on to live more.

The universe is a Great Advancing Life, and the purpose of nature is the advancement of life toward perfection; toward perfect functioning. The purpose of nature is perfect health.

The purpose of Nature, so far as man is concerned, is that he should be continuously advancing into more life, and progressing toward perfect life; and that he should live the most complete life possible in his present sphere of action.

This must be so, because That which lives in man is seeking more life.

Give a little child a pencil and paper, and he begins to draw crude figures; That which lives in him is trying to express Itself in art. Give him a set of blocks, and he will try to build something; That which lives in him is seeking expression in architecture. Seat him at a piano, and he will

try to draw harmony from the keys; That which lives in him is trying to express Itself in music. That which lives in man is always seeking to live more; and since man lives most when he is well, the Principle of Nature in him can seek only health. The natural state of man is a state of perfect health; and everything in him, and in nature, tends toward health.

Sickness can have no place in the thought of Original Substance, for it is by its own nature continually impelled toward the fullest and most perfect life; therefore, toward health. Man, as he exists in the thought of the Formless Substance, has perfect health. Disease, which is abnormal or perverted function—motion imperfectly made, or made in the direction of imperfect life—has no place in the thought of the Thinking Stuff.

The Supreme Mind never thinks of disease. Disease was not created or ordained by God, or sent forth from him. It is wholly a product of separate consciousness; of the individual thought of man. God, the Formless Substance, does not see disease, think disease, know disease, or recognize disease. Disease is recognized only by the thought of man; God thinks nothing but health.

From all the foregoing, we see that health is *a fact* or TRUTH in the original substance from which we are all formed; and that disease is imperfect functioning, resulting from the imperfect thoughts of men, past and present. If man's thoughts of himself had always been those of perfect health, man could not possibly now be otherwise than perfectly healthy.

Man in perfect health is the thought of Original Substance, and man in imperfect health is the result of his own failure to think perfect health, and to perform the voluntary functions of life in a healthy way. We will here arrange in a syllabus the basic truths of the Science of Being Well:—
There is a Thinking Substance from which all things are made, and which, in its original state, permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe. It is the life of All.

The thought of a form in this Substance causes the form; the thought of a motion produces the motion. In relation to man, the thoughts of this Substance are always of perfect functioning and perfect health.

Man is a thinking center, capable of original thought; and his thought has power over his own functioning. By thinking imperfect thoughts he has caused imperfect and perverted functioning; and by performing the voluntary functions of life in a perverted manner, he has assisted in causing disease.

If man will think only thoughts of perfect health, he can cause within himself the functioning of perfect health; all the Power of Life will be exerted to assist him. But this healthy functioning will not continue unless man performs the external, or voluntary, functions of living in a healthy manner.

Man's first step must be to learn how to think perfect health; and his second step to learn how to eat, drink, breathe, and sleep in a perfectly healthy way. If man takes these two steps, he will certainly become well, and remain so.

✦

REFLECTION

This chapter lays out the beliefs Wattles thinks a reader must accept. One living Substance makes all things by thinking of them; it thinks only of perfect health; human beings, with limited knowledge, think of disease and so pass "racial" impressions of illness down the generations. His most attractive idea is that life by nature grows: a seed put into soil multiplies itself, and whatever lives wants to live more. Seen that way, the urge to heal and grow is built into us. The weak point is his claim that disease is "wholly a product" of human thought. That is a religious and philosophical belief, not a medical finding; genes, germs, injuries, and environment cause illness regardless of anyone's thinking. You can take comfort in his picture of life as constantly reaching toward wholeness without blaming yourself or anyone else for being sick.

PRACTICE

Plant a seed, or look closely at a plant growing near you. Each day this week, spend one minute noticing how it changes. Let it remind you that growth and repair are natural, even when they are slow.

KEY THOUGHT

Life, by living, increases.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

III

Life and Its Organisms

THE HUMAN body is the abiding place of an energy which renews it when worn; which eliminates waste or poisonous matter, and which repairs the body when broken or injured. This energy we call life. Life is not generated or produced within the body; *it produces the body*.

The seed which has been kept in the storehouse for years will grow when planted in the soil; it will produce a plant. But the life in the plant is not generated by its growing; it is the life which makes the plant grow.

The performance of function does not cause life; it is life which causes function to be performed. Life is first; function afterward.

It is life which distinguishes organic from inorganic matter, but it is not produced after the organization of matter.

Life is the principle or force which causes organization; it builds organisms.

It is a principle or force inherent in Original Substance; all life is One.

This Life Principle of the All is the Principle of Health in man, and becomes constructively active whenever man thinks in a certain way. Whoever, therefore, thinks in this Certain Way will surely have perfect health if his external functioning is in conformity with his thought. But the external functioning must conform to the thought; man cannot

hope to be well by thinking health, if he eats, drinks, breathes, and sleeps like a sick man.

The universal Life Principle, then, is the Principle of Health in man. It is one with original substance. There is one Original Substance from which all things are made; this substance is alive, and its life is the Principle of Life of the universe. This Substance has created from itself all the forms of organic life by thinking them, or by thinking the motions and functions which produce them.

Original Substance thinks only health, because It knows all truth; there is no truth which is not known in the Formless, which is All, and in all. It not only knows all truth, but it has all power; its vital power is the source of all the energy there is. A conscious life which knows all truth and which has all power cannot go wrong or perform function imperfectly; knowing all, it knows, too much to go wrong, and so the Formless cannot be diseased or think disease.

Man is a form of this original substance, and has a separate consciousness of his own; but his consciousness is limited, and therefore imperfect. By reason of his limited knowledge man can and does think wrongly, and so he causes perverted and imperfect functioning in his own body. Man has not known too much to go wrong. The diseased or imperfect functioning may not instantly result from an imperfect thought, but it is bound to come if the thought becomes habitual. Any thought continuously held by man tends to the establishment of the corresponding condition in his body.

Also, man has failed to learn how to perform the voluntary functions of his life in a healthy way. He does not know when, what, and how to eat; he knows little about breathing, and less about sleep. He does all these things in a wrong way, and under wrong conditions; and this because he has neglected to follow the only sure guide to the knowledge of life. He has tried to live by logic rather than by instinct; he has made living a matter of art, and not of nature. And he has gone wrong.

His only remedy is to begin to go right; and this he can surely do. It is the work of this book to teach the whole truth, so that the man who reads it shall know too much to go wrong.

The thoughts of disease produce the forms of disease. Man must learn to think health; and being Original Substance which takes the form of its thoughts, he will become the form of health and manifest perfect health in all his functioning. The people who were healed by touching the bones of the saint were really healed by thinking in a certain way, and not by any power emanating from the relics. There is no healing power in the bones of dead men, whether they be those of saint or sinner.

The people who were healed by the doses of either the allopath or the homeopath were also really healed by thinking in a certain way; there is no drug which has within itself the power to heal disease.

The people who have been healed by prayers and affirmations were also healed by thinking in a certain way; there is no curative power in strings of words.

All the sick who have been healed, by whatsoever "system," have thought in a certain way; and a little examination will show us what this way is.

The two essentials of the Way are Faith,
and a Personal Application of the Faith.

The people who touched the saint's bones had faith; and so great was their faith that in the instant they touched the relics they SEVERED ALL MENTAL RELATIONS WITH DISEASE, AND MENTALLY UNIFIED THEMSELVES WITH HEALTH.

This change of mind was accompanied by an intense devotional FEELING which penetrated to the deepest recesses of their souls, and so aroused the Principle of Health to powerful action. By faith they

claimed that they were healed, or appropriated health to themselves; and in full faith they ceased to think of themselves in connection with disease and thought of themselves only in connection with health.

These are the two essentials to thinking in the Certain Way which will make you well: first, claim or appropriate health by faith; and, second, sever all mental relations with disease, and enter into mental relations with health. That which we make ourselves, mentally, we become physically; and that with which we unite ourselves mentally we become unified with physically. If your thought always relates you to disease, then your thought becomes a fixed power to cause disease within you; and if your thought always relates you to health, then your thought becomes a fixed power exerted to keep you well.

In the case of the people who are healed by medicines, the result is obtained in the same way. They have, consciously or unconsciously, sufficient faith in the means used to cause them to sever mental relations with disease and enter into mental relations with health. Faith may be unconscious. It is possible for us to have a sub-conscious or inbred faith in things like medicine, in which we do not believe to any extent objectively; and this sub-conscious faith may be quite sufficient to quicken the Principle of Health into constructive activity. Many who have little conscious faith are healed in this way; while many others who have great faith in the means are not healed because they do not make the personal application to themselves; their faith is general, but not specific for their own cases.

In the Science of Being Well we have two main points to consider: first, how to think with faith; and, second, how to so apply the thought to ourselves as to quicken the Principle of Health into constructive activity. We begin by learning What to Think.

REFLECTION

Wattles argues that life is not a product of the body; life comes first and builds the body, the way the life in a seed builds the plant. He then names "the two essentials of the Way": faith, and the personal application of that faith. The pilgrims at the saint's shrine, he says, were healed because they mentally cut themselves off from disease and joined themselves to health. He also insists that thought is not enough on its own; you cannot "think health" while eating, breathing, and sleeping badly. That pairing of mind and habit is the most useful part of the chapter. His claim that "there is no drug which has within itself the power to heal disease" is simply wrong, and following it could be dangerous. A hopeful attitude can support treatment; it cannot replace it.

PRACTICE

Write one sentence describing yourself as a person who is growing healthier. Then pair it with one concrete action you will take today, such as a short walk, a glass of water, or taking your prescribed medicine on time.

KEY THOUGHT

Life is first; function afterward.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

IV

What to Think

IN ORDER to sever all mental relations with disease, you must enter into mental relations with health, making the process positive not negative; one of assumption, not of rejection. You are to receive or appropriate health rather than to reject and deny disease. Denying disease accomplishes next to nothing; it does little good to cast out the devil and leave the house vacant, for he will presently return with others worse than himself. When you enter into full and constant mental relations with health, you must of necessity cease all relationship with disease. The first step in the Science of Being Well is, then, to enter into complete thought connection with health.

The best way to do this is to form a mental image or picture of yourself as being well, imagining a perfectly strong and healthy body; and to spend sufficient time in contemplating this image to make it your habitual thought of yourself.

This is not so easy as it sounds; it necessitates the taking of considerable time for meditation, and not all persons have the imaging faculty well enough developed to form a distinct mental picture of themselves in a perfect or idealized body. It is much easier, as in "The Science of Getting Rich," to form a mental image of the things one wants to have; for we have seen these things, or their counterparts, and

know how they look; we can picture them very easily from memory. But we have never seen ourselves in a perfect body, and a *clear* mental image is hard to form.

It is not necessary or essential, however, to have a clear mental image of yourself as you wish to be; it is only essential to form a CONCEPTION of perfect health, and to relate yourself to it. This Conception of Health is not a mental picture of a particular thing; it is an understanding of health, and carries with it the idea of perfect functioning in every part and organ.

You may TRY to picture yourself as perfect in physique; that helps; and you MUST *think of yourself as doing everything in the manner of a perfectly strong and healthy person*. You can picture yourself as walking down the street with an erect body and a vigorous stride; you can picture yourself as doing your day's work easily and with surplus vigor, never tired or weak; you can picture in your mind how all things would be done by a person full of health and power, and you can make yourself the central figure in the picture, doing things in just that way. Never think of the ways in which weak or sickly people do things; always think of the way strong people do things. Spend your leisure time in thinking about the Strong Way, until you have a good conception of it; and always think of yourself in connection with the Strong Way of Doing Things. That is what I mean by having a Conception of Health.

In order to establish perfect functioning in every part, man does not have to study anatomy or physiology, so that he can form a mental image of each separate organ and address himself to it. He does not have to "treat" his liver, his kidneys, his stomach, or his heart. There is one Principle of Health in man, which has control over all the involuntary functions of his life; and the thought of perfect health, impressed upon this Principle, will reach each part and organ. Man's liver is not controlled by a liver-principle, his stomach by a digestive principle, and so on; the Principle of Health is One.

The less you go into the detailed study of physiology, the better for you. Our knowledge of this science is very imperfect, and leads to imperfect thought. Imperfect thought causes imperfect functioning, which is disease. Let me illustrate: Until quite recently, physiology fixed ten days as the extreme limit of man's endurance without food; it was considered that only in exceptional cases could he survive a longer fast. So the impression became universally disseminated that one who was deprived of food must die in from five to ten days; and numbers of people, when cut off from food by shipwreck, accident, or famine, did die within this period. But the performances of Dr. Tanner, the forty-day faster, and the writings of Dr. Dewey and others on the fasting cure, together with the experiments of numberless people who have fasted from forty to sixty days, have shown that man's ability to live without food is vastly greater than had been supposed. Any person, properly educated, can fast from twenty to forty days with little loss in weight, and often with no apparent loss of strength at all. The people who starved to death in ten days or less did so because they believed that death was inevitable; an erroneous physiology had given them a wrong thought about themselves. When a man is deprived of food he will die in from ten to fifty days, according to the way he has been taught; or, in other words, according to the way he thinks about it. So you see that an erroneous physiology can work very mischievous results.

No Science of Being Well can be founded on current physiology; it is not sufficiently exact in its knowledge. With all its pretensions, comparatively little is really known as to the interior workings and processes of the body. It is not known just how food is digested; it is not known just what part food plays, if any, in the generation of force. It is not known exactly what the liver, spleen, and pancreas are for, or what part their secretions play in the chemistry of assimilation. On all these and most other points we theorize, but we do not really know. When man begins to study physiology, he enters the domain of theory and disputation; he comes among conflicting opinions, and he is bound to

form mistaken ideas concerning himself. These mistaken ideas lead to the thinking of wrong thoughts, and this leads to perverted functioning and disease. All that the most perfect knowledge of physiology could do for man would be to enable him to think only thoughts of perfect health, and to eat, drink, breathe, and sleep in a perfectly healthy way; and this, as we shall show, he can do without studying physiology at all.

This, for the most part, is true of all hygiene. There are certain fundamental propositions which we should know; and these will be explained in later chapters, but aside from these propositions, ignore physiology and hygiene. They tend to fill your mind with thoughts of imperfect conditions, and these thoughts will produce the imperfect conditions in your own body. You cannot study any "science" which recognizes disease, if you are to think nothing but health.

Drop all investigation as to your present condition, its causes, or possible results, and set yourself to the work of forming a conception of health.

Think about health and the possibilities of health; of the work that may be done and the pleasures that may be enjoyed in a condition of perfect health. Then make this conception your guide in thinking of yourself; refuse to entertain for an instant any thought of yourself which is not in harmony with it. When any idea of disease or imperfect functioning enters your mind, cast it out instantly by calling up a thought which is in harmony with the Conception of Health.

Think of yourself at all times as realizing conception; as being a strong and perfectly healthy personage; and do not harbor a contrary thought.

KNOW that as you think of yourself in unity with this conception, the Original Substance which permeates and fills the tissues of your body is taking form according to the thought; and know that this

Intelligent Substance or mind stuff will cause function to be performed in such a way that your body will be rebuilt with perfectly healthy cells.

The Intelligent Substance, from which all things are made, permeates and penetrates all things; and so it is in and through your body. It moves according to its thoughts; and so if you hold only the thoughts of perfectly healthy function, it will cause the movements of perfectly healthy function within you.

Hold with persistence to the thought of perfect health in relation to yourself; do not permit yourself to think in any other way. Hold this thought with perfect faith that it is the fact, the truth. It is the truth so far as your mental body is concerned. You have a mind-body and a physical body; the mind-body takes form just as you think of yourself, and any thought which you hold continuously is made visible by the transformation of the physical body into its image. Implanting the thought of perfect functioning in the mind-body will, in due time, cause perfect functioning in the physical body.

The transformation of the physical body into the image of the ideal held by the mind-body is not accomplished instantaneously; we cannot transfigure our physical bodies at will as Jesus did. In the creation and recreation of forms, Substance moves along the fixed lines of growth it has established; and the impression upon it of the health thought causes the healthy body to be built cell by cell. Holding only thoughts of perfect health will ultimately cause perfect functioning; and perfect functioning will in due time produce a perfectly healthy body. It may be as well to condense this chapter into a syllabus:—

Your physical body is permeated and fitted with an Intelligent Substance, which forms a body of mind-stuff. This mind-stuff controls the functioning of your physical body. A thought of disease or of imperfect function, impressed upon the mind-stuff, causes disease or imperfect functioning in the physical body. If you are diseased, it is because wrong thoughts have made impressions on this mind-stuff; these may have been either your own thoughts or those of your parents; we begin life with many sub-conscious impressions, both right and wrong. But the natural tendency of all mind is toward health, and if no thoughts are held in the conscious mind save those of health, all internal functioning will come to be performed in a perfectly healthy manner.

✦

The Power of Nature within you is sufficient to overcome all hereditary impressions, and if you will learn to control your thoughts, so that you shall think only those of health, and if you will perform the voluntary functions of life in a perfectly healthy way, you can certainly be well.

✦

REFLECTION

Here Wattles gives his main mental method. Instead of fighting or denying illness, build a "conception of health": imagine how a strong, well person walks, works, and lives, and see yourself doing things that way. You do not need a perfect mental picture, he says, only a clear sense of the "Strong Way of Doing Things." That is close to the visualization many coaches and therapists use today, and it can lift mood and motivation. The chapter also contains some of

the book's most risky statements. Wattles tells readers to stop studying their condition and to ignore physiology, and he claims that people who starved died mainly because they believed they would, and that "any person" can fast twenty to forty days. These claims are false and can be dangerous. Imagining strength is a fine practice; ignoring your actual health is not.

PRACTICE

Close your eyes for three minutes and picture yourself moving through an ordinary task, like climbing stairs or carrying groceries, with ease and energy. Afterward, write down one detail of that picture you want to carry into your day.

KEY THOUGHT

Think about health and the possibilities of health;
of the work that may be done and the pleasures
that may be enjoyed in a condition of perfect health.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

V

Faith

THE PRINCIPLE of Health is moved by Faith; nothing else can call it into action, and only faith can enable you to relate yourself to health, and sever your relation with disease, in your thoughts.

You will continue to think of disease unless you have faith in health. If you do not have faith you will doubt; if you doubt, you will fear; and if you fear, you will relate yourself in mind to that which you fear.

If you fear disease, you will think of yourself in connection with disease; and that will produce within yourself the form and motions of disease. Just as Original Substance creates from itself the forms of its thoughts, so your mind-body, which is original substance, takes the form and motion of whatever you think about. If you fear disease, dread disease, have doubts about your safety from disease, or if you even contemplate disease, you will connect yourself with it and create its forms and motions within you.

Let me enlarge somewhat upon this point. The potency, or creative power, of a thought is given to it *by the faith that is in it*.

Thoughts which contain no faith create no forms.

The Formless Substance, which knows all truth and therefore thinks only truth, has perfect faith in every thought, because it thinks only truth; and so all its thoughts create.

But if you will imagine a thought in Formless Substance in which there was no faith, you will see that such a thought could not cause the Substance to move or take form.

Keep in mind the fact that only those thoughts which are conceived in faith have creative energy. Only those thoughts which have faith with them are able to change function, or to quicken the Principle of Health into activity.

If you do not have faith in health, you will certainly have faith in disease. If you do not have faith in health, it will do you no good to think about health, for your thoughts will have no potency, and will cause no change for the better in your conditions. If you do not have faith in health, I repeat, you will have faith in disease; and if, under such conditions, you think about health for ten hours a day, and think about disease for only a few minutes, the disease thought will control your condition because it will have the potency of faith, while the health thought will not. Your mind-body will take on the form and motions of disease and retain them, because your health thought will not have sufficient dynamic force to change form or motion.

In order to practice the Science of Being Well, you must have complete faith in health.

Faith begins in belief; and we now come to the question: *What must you believe in order to have faith in health?*

You must believe that there is more health-power than disease-power in both yourself and your environment; and you cannot help believing this if you consider the facts. These are the facts:—

There is a Thinking Substance from which all things are made, and which, in its original state, permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe.

The thought of a form, in this Substance, produces the form; the thought of a motion institutes the motion. In relation to man, the thoughts of Original Substance are always of perfect health and perfect functioning. This Substance, within and without man, always exerts its power toward health.

Man is a thinking center, capable of original thought. He has a mind-body of Original Substance permeating a physical body; and the functioning of his physical body is determined by the FAITH of his mind-body. If man thinks with faith of the functioning of health, he will cause his internal functions to be performed in a healthy manner, provided that he performs the external functions in a corresponding manner. But if man thinks, with faith, of disease, or of the power of disease, he will cause his internal functioning to be the functioning of disease.

The Original Intelligent Substance is in man, moving toward health; and it is pressing upon him from every side. Man lives, moves, and has his being in a limitless ocean of health-power; and he uses this power according to his faith. If he appropriates it and applies it to himself it is all his; and if he unifies himself with it by unquestioning faith, he cannot fail to attain health, for the power of this Substance is all the power there is.

A belief in the above statements is a foundation for faith in health. If you believe them, you believe that health is the natural state of man, and that man lives in the midst of Universal Health; that all the power of nature makes for health, and that health is possible to all, and can surely be attained by all. You will believe that the power of health in the universe is ten thousand times greater than that of disease; in fact, that disease has no power whatever, being only the result of perverted thought and faith. And if you believe that health is possible to you, and that it may surely be attained by you, and that you know exactly what to do in order to attain it, you will have faith in health. You will have this faith and knowledge if you read this book through with care and determine to believe in and practice its teachings.

It is not merely the possession of faith, but the personal application of faith which works healing. You must claim health in the beginning, and form a conception of health, and, as far as may be, of yourself as a perfectly healthy person; and then, by faith, you must claim that you ARE REALIZING this conception.

Do not assert with faith that you are going to get well; assert with faith that you ARE well.

Having faith in health, and applying it to yourself, means having faith that you are healthy; *and the first step in this is to claim that it is the truth*.

Mentally take the attitude of being well, and do not say anything or do anything which contradicts this attitude. Never speak a word or assume a physical attitude which does not harmonize with the claim: "I am perfectly well." When you walk, go with a brisk step, and with your chest thrown out and your head held up; watch that at all times your physical actions and attitudes are those of a healthy person. When you find that you have relapsed into the attitude of weakness or disease, change instantly; straighten up; think of health and power. Refuse to consider yourself as other than a perfectly healthy person.

One great aid—perhaps the greatest aid—in applying your faith you will find in the exercise of gratitude.

Whenever you think of yourself, or of your advancing condition, give thanks to the Great Intelligent Substance for the perfect health you are enjoying.

Remember that, as Swedenborg taught, there is a continual inflow of life from the Supreme, which is received by all created things according to their forms; and by man according to his faith. Health from God is continually being urged upon you; and when you think of this, lift up your mind reverently to Him, and give thanks that you have been led to the Truth and into perfect health of mind and body. Be, all the time, in a grateful frame of mind, and let gratitude be evident in your speech.

Gratitude will help you to own and control your own field of thought.

Whenever the thought of disease is presented to you, instantly claim health, and thank God for the perfect health you have. Do this so that there shall be no room in your mind for a thought of ill. Every thought connected in any way with ill health is unwelcome, and you can close the

door of your mind in its face by asserting that you are well, and by reverently thanking God that it is so. Soon the old thoughts will return no more.

Gratitude has a twofold effect; it strengthens your own faith, and it brings you into close and harmonious relations with the Supreme. You believe that there is one Intelligent Substance from which all life and all power come; you believe that you receive your own life from this substance; and you relate yourself closely to It by feeling continuous gratitude. It is easy to see that the more closely you relate yourself to the Source of Life the more readily you may receive life from it; and it is easy also to see that your relation to It is a matter of mental attitude. We cannot come into physical relationship with God, for God is mind-stuff and we also are mind-stuff; our relation with Him must therefore be a mind relation. It is plain, then, that the man who feels deep and hearty gratitude will live in closer touch with God than the man who never looks up to Him in thankfulness. The ungrateful or unthankful mind really denies that it receives at all, and so cuts its connection with the Supreme. The grateful mind is always looking toward the Supreme, and is always open to receive from it; and it will receive continually.

The Principle of Health in man receives its vital power from the Principle of Life in the universe; and man relates himself to the Principle of Life by faith in health, and by gratitude for the health he receives.

✦

Man may cultivate both faith and gratitude by the proper use of his will.

REFLECTION

For Wattles, faith gives a thought its power. A thought without faith, he says, creates nothing, so ten hours of hopeful thinking will lose to a few minutes of fearful belief. He urges readers to believe that there is far more health-power than disease-power in themselves and the world, to claim health as present fact, to stand and walk like a healthy person, and above all to practice gratitude. His point about fear is worth taking seriously: constant dread can make people feel worse and act less wisely. His advice to say "I am perfectly well" while you are sick, however, can feel false and may lead people to ignore warning signs. A gentler modern version is to be honest about where you are while trusting that improvement is possible, and to give thanks for what is working.

PRACTICE

Each evening this week, write down three things your body did well that day, such as breathing, healing a small cut, or carrying you to work. Thank it, or thank God, in whatever words feel honest to you.

KEY THOUGHT

Gratitude will help you to own and control your own field of thought.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VI

Use of the Will

IN THE practice of the Science of Being Well the will is not used to compel yourself to go when you are not really able to go, or to do things when you are not physically strong enough to do them. You do not direct your will upon your physical body or try to compel the proper performance of internal function by will power.

> *You direct the will upon the mind, and use it in determining what you shall believe, what you shall think, and to what you shall give your attention.*

The will should never be used upon any person or thing external to you, and it should never be used upon your own body. The sole legitimate use of the will is in determining to what you shall give your attention, and what you shall think about the things to which your attention is given.

All belief begins in the will to believe.

You cannot always and instantly believe what you will to believe; but you can always will to believe what you want to believe. You want to believe truth about health, and you can will to do so. The statements

you have been reading in this book are the truth about health, and you can will to believe them; this must be your first step toward getting well.

These are the statements you must will to believe:—

That there is a Thinking Substance from which all things are made, and that man receives the Principle of Health, which is his life, from this Substance.

✦

That man himself is Thinking Substance; a mind-body, permeating a physical body, and that as man's thoughts are, so will the functioning of his physical body be.

✦

That if man will think only thoughts of perfect health, he must and will cause the internal and involuntary functioning of his body to be the functioning of health, provided that his external and voluntary functioning and attitude are in accordance with his thoughts.

When you will to believe these statements, you must also begin to act upon them. You cannot long retain a belief unless you act upon it; you cannot increase a belief until it becomes faith unless you act upon it; and you certainly cannot expect to reap benefits in any way from a belief so long as you act as if the opposite were true. You cannot long have faith in health if you continue to act like a sick person. If you continue to act like a sick person, you cannot help continuing to think of yourself as a sick person; and if you continue to think of yourself as a sick person, you will continue to be a sick person.

The first step toward acting externally like a well person is to begin to act internally like a well person. Form your conception of perfect health, and get into the way of thinking about perfect health until it begins to

have a definite meaning to you. Picture yourself as doing the things a strong and healthy person would do, and have faith that you can and will do those things in that way; continue this until you have a vivid CONCEPTION of health, and what it means to you. When I speak in this book of a conception of health, I mean a conception that carries with it the idea of the way a healthy person looks and does things. Think of yourself in connection with health until you form a conception of how you would live, appear, act, and do things as a perfectly healthy person. Think about yourself in connection with health until you conceive of yourself, in imagination, as always doing everything in the manner of a well person; until the thought of health conveys the idea of what health means to you. As I have said in a former chapter, you may not be able to form a clear mental image of yourself in perfect health, but you can form a conception of yourself as acting like a healthy person.

Form this conception, and then think only thoughts of perfect health in relation to yourself, and, so far as may be possible, in relation to others. When a thought of sickness or disease is presented to you, reject it; do not let it get into your mind; do not entertain or consider it at all. Meet it by thinking health; by thinking that you are well, and by being sincerely grateful for the health you are receiving. Whenever suggestions of disease are coming thick and fast upon you, and you are in a "tight place," fall back upon the exercise of gratitude. Connect yourself with the Supreme; give thanks to God for the perfect health He gives you, and you will soon find yourself able to control your thoughts, and to think what you want to think. In times of doubt, trial, and temptation, the exercise of gratitude is always a sheet anchor which will prevent you from being swept away. Remember that the great essential thing is to SEVER ALL MENTAL RELATIONS WITH DISEASE, AND TO ENTER INTO FULL MENTAL RELATIONSHIP WITH HEALTH. This is the KEY to all mental healing; it is the whole thing. Here we see the secret of the great success of Christian Science; more than any other

formulated system of practice, it insists that its converts shall sever relations with disease, and relate themselves fully with health. The healing power of Christian Science is not in its theological formulae, nor in its denial of matter; but in the fact that it induces the sick to ignore disease as an unreal thing and accept health by faith as a reality. Its failures are made because its practitioners, while thinking in the Certain Way, do not eat, drink, breathe, and sleep in the same way.

While there is no healing power in the repetition of strings of words, yet it is a very convenient thing to have the central thoughts so formulated that you can repeat them readily, so that you can use them as affirmations whenever you are surrounded by an environment which gives you adverse suggestions. When those around you begin to talk of sickness and death, close your ears and mentally assert something like the following:—

There is One Substance, and I am that Substance.

✦

That Substance is eternal, and it is Life; I am that Substance, and I am Eternal Life.

✦

That Substance knows no disease; I am that Substance, and I am Health.

Exercise your will power in choosing only those thoughts which are thoughts of health, and arrange your environment so that it shall suggest thoughts of health. Do not have about you books, pictures, or other things which suggest death, disease, deformity, weakness, or age; have only those which convey the ideas of health, power, joy, vitality, and youth. When you are confronted with a book, or anything else which suggests disease, do not give it your attention. Think of your conception

of health, and your gratitude, and affirm as above; use your will power to fix your attention upon thoughts of health. In a future chapter I shall touch upon this point again; what I wish to make plain here is that you must think only health, recognize only health, and give your attention only to health; and that you must control thought, recognition, and attention by the use of your will.

Do not try to use your will to compel the healthy performance of function within you. The Principle of Health will attend to that, if you give your attention only to thoughts of health.

Do not try to exert your will upon the Formless to compel It to give you more vitality or power; it is already placing all the power there is at your service.

You do not have to use your will to conquer adverse conditions, or to subdue unfriendly forces; there are no unfriendly forces; there is only One Force, and that force is friendly to you; it is a force which makes for health.

Everything in the universe wants you to be well; you have absolutely nothing to overcome but your own habit of thinking in a certain way about disease, and you can do this only by forming a habit of thinking in another Certain Way about health.

Man can cause all the internal functions of his body to be performed in a perfectly healthy manner by continuously thinking in a Certain Way, and by performing the external functions in a certain way.

He can think in this Certain Way by controlling his attention, and he can control his attention by the use of his will.

He can decide what things he will think about.



REFLECTION

Wattles narrows the job of willpower. It is not for forcing your body beyond its strength, controlling other people, or ordering your organs to behave. Its one

proper use is choosing what to believe and where to place your attention. He suggests short affirmations for moments when others talk of sickness and death, and recommends filling your surroundings with things that suggest strength, joy, and vitality. The distinction is sensible: we cannot will a fever away, but we can choose what we focus on and what we let into our minds. Today we might call this attention management. One caution applies. Turning away from all talk of illness is not the same as ignoring your own symptoms, and choosing hopeful thoughts works best alongside real information and care. Willpower here means steering the mind, not overruling the body.

PRACTICE

Look around the room where you spend the most time. Remove or move one thing that drags your mood down, and add one thing that suggests energy or joy: a plant, a photo of a favorite walk, or open curtains.

KEY THOUGHT

He can decide what things he will think about.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VII

Health From God

I WILL give a chapter here to explaining how man may receive health from the Supreme. By the Supreme I mean the Thinking Substance from which all things are made, and which is in all and through all, seeking more complete expression and fuller life. This Intelligent Substance, in a perfectly fluid state, permeates and penetrates all things, and is in touch with all minds. It is the source of all energy and power, and constitutes the "inflow" of life which Swedenborg saw, vitalizing all things. It is working to one definite end, and for the fulfillment of one purpose; and that purpose is the advancement of life toward the complete expression of Mind. When man harmonizes himself with this Intelligence, it can and will give him health and wisdom. When man holds steadily to the purpose to live more abundantly, he comes into harmony with this Supreme Intelligence.

The purpose of the Supreme Intelligence is the most Abundant Life for all; the purpose of this Supreme Intelligence for you is that you should live more abundantly. If, then, your own purpose is to live more abundantly, you are unified with the Supreme; you are working with It, and it must work with you. But as the Supreme Intelligence is in all, *if you harmonize with it you must harmonize with all; and you must desire*

more abundant life for all as well as for yourself. Two great benefits come to you from being in harmony with the Supreme Intelligence.

First, you will receive wisdom. By wisdom I do not mean knowledge of facts so much as ability to perceive and understand facts, and to judge soundly and act rightly in all matters relating to life. Wisdom is the power to perceive truth, and the ability to make the best use of the knowledge of truth. It is the power to perceive at once the best end to aim at, and the means best adapted to attain that end. With wisdom comes poise, and the power to think rightly; to control and guide your thoughts, and to avoid the difficulties which come from wrong thinking. With wisdom you will be able to select the right courses for your particular needs, and to so govern yourself in all ways as to secure the best results. You will know how to do what you want to do. You can readily see that wisdom must be an essential attribute of the Supreme Intelligence, since That which knows all truth must be wise; and you can also see that just in proportion as you harmonize and unify your mind with that Intelligence you will have wisdom.

But I repeat that since this Intelligence is All, and in all, you can enter into Its wisdom only by harmonizing with all. If there is anything in your desires or your purpose which will bring oppression to any, or work injustice to, or cause lack of life for any, you cannot receive wisdom from the Supreme. Furthermore, your purpose for your own self must be the best.

Man can live in three general ways: for the gratification of his body, for that of his intellect, or for that of his soul. The first is accomplished by satisfying the desires for food, drink, and those other things which give enjoyable physical sensations. The second is accomplished by doing those things which cause pleasant mental sensations, such as gratifying the desire for knowledge or those for fine clothing, fame, power, and so on. The third is accomplished by giving way to the instincts of unselfish love and altruism. Man lives most wisely and completely when he functions most perfectly along all of these lines, without excess in any of

them. The man who lives swinishly, for the body alone, is unwise and out of harmony with God; that man who lives solely for the cold enjoyments of the intellect, though he be absolutely moral, is unwise and out of harmony with God; and the man who lives wholly for the practice of altruism, and who throws himself away for others, is as unwise and as far from harmony with God as those who go to excess in other ways.

To come into full harmony with the Supreme, you must purpose to LIVE; to live to the utmost of your capabilities in body, mind, and soul. This must mean the full exercise of function in all the different ways, but without excess; for excess in one causes deficiency in the others. Behind your desire for health is your own desire for more abundant life; and behind that is the desire of the Formless Intelligence to live more fully in you. So, as you advance toward perfect health, hold steadily to the purpose to attain complete life, physical, mental, and spiritual; to advance in all ways, and in every way to live more; if you hold this purpose you will be given wisdom. "He that willeth to do the will of the Father shall KNOW," said Jesus. Wisdom is the most desirable gift that can come to man, for it makes him rightly self-governing.

But wisdom is not all you may receive from the Supreme Intelligence; you may receive physical energy, vitality, life force. The energy of the Formless Substance is unlimited, and permeates everything; you are already receiving or appropriating to yourself this energy in an automatic and instinctive way, but you can do so to a far greater degree if you set about it intelligently. The measure of a man's strength is not what God is willing to give him, but what he, himself, has the will and the intelligence to appropriate to himself. God gives you all there is; your only question is how much to take of the unlimited supply.

Professor James has pointed out that there is apparently no limit to the powers of men; and this is simply because man's power comes from the inexhaustible reservoir of the Supreme. The runner who has reached the stage of exhaustion, when his physical power seems entirely gone, by

running on in a Certain Way may receive his "second wind"; his strength is renewed in a seemingly miraculous fashion, and he can go on indefinitely. And by continuing in the Certain Way, he may receive a third, fourth, and fifth "wind"; we do not know where the limit is, or how far it may be possible to extend it. The conditions are that the runner must have absolute faith that the strength will come; that he must think steadily of strength, and have perfect confidence that he has it, and that he must continue to run on. If he admits a doubt into his mind, he falls exhausted, and if he stops running to wait for the accession of strength, it will never come. His faith in strength, his faith that he *can* keep on running, his unwavering purpose *to* keep on running, and his action *in* keeping on seem to connect him to the source of energy in such a way as to bring him a new supply.

In a very similar manner, the sick person who has unquestioning faith in health, whose purpose brings him into harmony with the source, and who performs the voluntary functions of life in a certain way, will receive vital energy sufficient for all his needs, and for the healing of all his diseases. God, who seeks to live and express himself fully in man, delights to give man all that is needed for the most abundant life. Action and reaction are equal, and when you desire to live more, if you are in mental harmony with the Supreme, the forces which make for life begin to concentrate about you and upon you. The One Life begins to move toward you, and your environment becomes surcharged with it. Then, if you appropriate it by faith, it is yours. "Ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you." Your Father giveth not his spirit by measure; he delights to give good gifts to you.

✦

REFLECTION

This is the book's most openly spiritual chapter. Wattles describes the Supreme as the thinking Substance that seeks fuller life in everyone, and says we come

into harmony with it when our own purpose is to live more abundantly, wishing the same for all others. The rewards are wisdom, which he defines as the ability to see the right aim and the right means, and fresh energy, like a runner's "second wind." He warns against living only for the body, only for the intellect, or only for others to the point of self-neglect; balance is the healthy way. Readers of any faith, or none, can value the call to a life that is full in body, mind, and soul and harmful to no one. His promise of energy "for the healing of all his diseases" is a statement of faith, not a guarantee.

PRACTICE

Draw three columns labeled body, mind, and soul. Under each, write one thing you did for it this week. If a column is empty, choose one small, enjoyable act to fill it before Sunday.

KEY THOUGHT

Wisdom is the power to perceive truth, and the ability to make the best use of the knowledge of truth.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VIII

Summary of the Mental Actions

LET ME now summarize the mental actions and attitudes necessary to the practice of the Science of Being Well: first, you believe that there is a Thinking Substance, from which all things are made, and which, in its original state, permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe. This Substance is the Life of All, and is seeking to express more life in all. It is the Principle of Life of the universe, and the Principle of Health in man.

Man is a form of this Substance, and draws his vitality from it; he is a mind-body of original substance, permeating a physical body, and the thoughts of his mind-body control the functioning of his physical body. If man thinks no thoughts save those of perfect health, the functions of his physical body will be performed in a manner of perfect health.

If you would consciously relate yourself to the All-Health, your purpose must be to live fully on every plane of your being. You must want all that there is in life for body, mind, and soul; and this will bring you into harmony with all the life there is. The person who is in conscious and intelligent harmony with All will receive a continuous inflow of vital power from the Supreme Life; and this inflow is prevented by angry, selfish or antagonistic mental attitudes. If you are

against any part, you have severed relations with all; you will receive life, but only instinctively and automatically; not intelligently and purposefully. You can see that if you are mentally antagonistic to any part, you cannot be in complete harmony with the Whole; therefore, as Jesus directed, be reconciled to everybody and everything before you offer worship.

Want for everybody all that you want for yourself.

The reader is recommended to read what we have said in a former work[1] concerning the Competitive mind and the Creative mind. It is very doubtful whether one who has lost health can completely regain it so long as he remains in the competitive mind.

[1] *The Science of Getting Rich.*

Being on the Creative or Good-Will plane in mind, the next step is to form a conception of yourself as in perfect health, and to hold no thoughts which are not in full harmony with this conception. Have FAITH that if you think only thoughts of health you will establish in your physical body the functioning of health; and use your will to determine that you will think only thoughts of health. Never think of yourself as sick, or as likely to be sick; never think of sickness in connection with yourself at all. And, as far as may be, shut out of your mind all thoughts of sickness in connection with others. Surround yourself as much as possible with the things which suggest the ideas of strength and health.

Have faith in health, and accept health as an actual present fact in your life. Claim health as a blessing bestowed upon you by the Supreme Life, and be deeply grateful at all times. Claim the blessing by faith; know that it is yours, and never admit a contrary thought to your mind.

Use your will-power to withhold your attention from every appearance of disease in yourself and others; do not study disease, think about it, nor speak of it. At all times, when the thought of disease is thrust upon you, move forward into the mental position of prayerful gratitude for your perfect health.

The mental actions necessary to being well may now be summed up in a single sentence: Form a conception of yourself in perfect health, and think only those thoughts which are in harmony with that conception.

That, with faith and gratitude, and the purpose to really live, covers all the requirements. It is not necessary to take mental exercises of any kind, except as described in Chapter VI, or to do wearying "stunts" in the way of affirmations, and so on. It is not necessary to concentrate the mind on the affected parts; it is far better not to think of any part as affected. It is not necessary to "treat" yourself by auto-suggestion, or to have others treat you in any way whatever. The power that heals is the Principle of Health within you; and to call this Principle into Constructive Action it is only necessary, having harmonized yourself with the All-Mind, to claim by FAITH the All-Health; and to hold that claim until it is physically manifested in all the functions of your body.

In order to hold this mental attitude of faith, gratitude, and health, however, your external acts must be only those of health. You cannot long hold the internal attitude of a well person if you continue to perform the external acts of a sick person. It is essential not only that your every thought should be a thought of health, but that your every act should be an act of health, performed in a healthy manner. If you will make every thought a thought of health, and every conscious act an act of health, it must infallibly follow that every internal and unconscious function shall come to be healthy; for all the power of life is being continually exerted toward health. We shall next consider how you may make every act an act of health.

REFLECTION

Wattles gathers the mental side of his method into one line: form a conception of yourself in perfect health, and think only thoughts that agree with it. Around that core he places faith, gratitude, the purpose to really live, and good will toward everyone. He points back to The Science of Getting Rich and its contrast between the competitive mind and the creative mind, suggesting that anger, selfishness, and rivalry block the inflow of life. Many people will recognize that resentment and constant competition are exhausting, and that goodwill feels better. The chapter ends by saying the mind cannot hold a healthy attitude while the body acts like a sick one, which leads into his practical chapters. As before, the advice to never think of sickness should not stop anyone from noticing symptoms and seeking help when needed.

PRACTICE

Name one person you feel competitive with or resentful toward. Silently wish them one specific good thing, such as rest, success, or a good day. Notice how your body feels before and after.

KEY THOUGHT

Want for everybody all that you want for yourself.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

IX

When to Eat

YOU CANNOT build and maintain a perfectly healthy body by mental action alone, or by the performance of the unconscious or involuntary functions alone. There are certain actions, more or less voluntary, which have a direct and immediate relation with the continuance of life itself; these are eating, drinking, breathing, and sleeping. No matter what man's thought or mental attitude may be, he cannot live unless he eats, drinks, breathes, and sleeps; and, moreover, he cannot be well if he eats, drinks, breathes, and sleeps in an unnatural or wrong manner. It is therefore vitally important that you should learn the right way to perform these voluntary functions, and I shall proceed to show you this way, beginning with the matter of eating, which is most important.

There has been a vast amount of controversy as to when to eat, what to eat, how to eat, and how much to eat; and all this controversy is unnecessary, for the Right Way is very easy to find. You have only to consider the Law which governs all attainment, whether of health, wealth, power, or happiness; and that law is *that you must do what you can do now, where you are now; do every separate act in the most perfect manner possible, and put the power of faith into every action*.

The processes of digestion and assimilation are under the supervision and control of an inner division of man's mentality, which is generally called the sub-conscious mind; and I shall use that term here in order to be understood. The sub-conscious mind is in charge of all the functions and processes of life; and when more food is needed by the body, it makes the fact known by causing a sensation called hunger. Whenever food is needed, and can be used, there is hunger; and whenever there is hunger it is time to eat. When there is no hunger it is unnatural and wrong to eat, no matter how great may APPEAR to be the need for food. Even if you are in a condition of apparent starvation, with great emaciation, if there is no hunger you may know that FOOD CANNOT BE USED, and it will be unnatural and wrong for you to eat. Though you have not eaten for days, weeks, or months, if you have no hunger you may be perfectly sure that food cannot be used, and will probably not be used if taken. Whenever food is needed, if there is power to digest and assimilate it, so that it can be normally used, the sub-conscious mind will announce the fact by a decided hunger. Food, taken when there is no hunger, will sometimes be digested and assimilated, because Nature makes a special effort to perform the task which is thrust upon her against her will; but if food be habitually taken when there is no hunger, the digestive power is at last destroyed, and numberless evils caused.

If the foregoing be true—and it is indisputably so—it is a self-evident proposition that the natural time, and the healthy time, to eat is when one is hungry; and that it is never a natural or a healthy action to eat when one is not hungry. You see, then, that it is an easy matter to scientifically settle the question when to eat. ALWAYS eat when you are hungry; and NEVER eat when you are not hungry. This is obedience to nature, which is obedience to God.

We must not fail, however, to make clear the distinction between hunger and appetite. Hunger is the call of the sub-conscious mind for more material to be used in repairing and renewing the body, and in keeping up the internal heat; and hunger is never felt unless there is need

for more material, and unless there is power to digest it when taken into the stomach. Appetite is a desire for the gratification of sensation. The drunkard has an appetite for liquor, but he cannot have a hunger for it. A normally fed person cannot have a hunger for candy or sweets; the desire for these things is an appetite. You cannot hunger for tea, coffee, spiced foods, or for the various taste-tempting devices of the skilled cook; if you desire these things, it is with appetite, not with hunger. Hunger is nature's call for material to be used in building new cells, and nature never calls for anything which may not be legitimately used for this purpose.

Appetite is often largely a matter of habit; if one eats or drinks at a certain hour, and especially if one takes sweetened or spiced and stimulating foods, the desire comes regularly at the same hour; but this habitual desire for food should never be mistaken for hunger. Hunger does not appear at specified times. It only comes when work or exercise has destroyed sufficient tissue to make the taking in of new raw material a necessity.

For instance, if a person has been sufficiently fed on the preceding day, it is impossible that he should feel a genuine hunger on arising from refreshing sleep. In sleep the body is recharged with vital power, and the assimilation of the food which has been taken during the day is completed; the system has no need for food immediately after sleep, unless the person went to his rest in a state of starvation. With a system of feeding, which is even a reasonable approach to a natural one, no one can have a real hunger for an early morning breakfast. There is no such thing possible as a normal or genuine hunger immediately after arising from sound sleep. The early morning breakfast is always taken to gratify appetite, never to satisfy hunger. No matter who you are, or what your condition is; no matter how hard you work, or how much you are exposed, unless you go to your bed starved, you cannot arise from your bed hungry.

Hunger is not caused by sleep, but by work. And it does not matter who you are, or what your condition, or how hard or easy your work, the so-called no-breakfast plan is the right plan for you. It is the right plan for everybody, because it is based on the universal law that hunger never comes until it is EARNED.

I am aware that a protest against this will come from the large number of people who "enjoy" their breakfasts; whose breakfast is their "best meal"; who believe that their work is so hard that they cannot "get through the forenoon on an empty stomach," and so on. But all their arguments fall down before the facts. They enjoy their breakfast as the toper enjoys his morning dram, because it gratifies a habitual appetite and not because it supplies a natural want. It is their best meal for the same reason that his morning dram is the toper's best drink. And they CAN get along without it, because millions of people, of every trade and profession, DO get along without it, and are vastly better for doing so. If you are to live according to the Science of Being Well, you must NEVER EAT UNTIL YOU HAVE AN EARNED HUNGER.

But if I do not eat on arising in the morning, when shall I take my first meal?

In ninety-nine cases out of a hundred twelve o'clock, noon, is early enough; and it is generally the most convenient time. If you are doing heavy work, you will get by noon a hunger sufficient to justify a good-sized meal; and if your work is light, you will probably still have hunger enough for a moderate meal. The best general rule or law that can be laid down is that you should eat your first meal of the day at noon, if you are hungry; and if you are not hungry, wait until you become so.

And when shall I eat my second meal?

Not at all, unless you are hungry for it; and that with a genuine earned hunger. If you do get hungry for a second meal, eat at the most convenient time; but do not eat until you have a really earned hunger. The reader who wishes to fully inform himself as to the reasons for this way of arranging the mealtimes will find the best books thereon cited in

the preface to this work. From the foregoing, however, you can easily see that the Science of Being Well readily answers the question: When, and how often shall I eat? The answer is: Eat when you have an earned hunger; and never eat at any other time.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles begins his practical section with eating, which he calls the most important voluntary function. His rule is absolute: eat only when you feel real hunger, never when you do not. He separates hunger, a need the body can use, from appetite, a desire for taste or habit. From this he builds the "no-breakfast plan": since sleep restores you, he argues, no one can be truly hungry on waking, so the first meal should come around noon, or later, and a second meal only if hunger is earned. The distinction between hunger and habit is genuinely helpful. But the claim that one plan is "right for everybody" is not. Skipping meals can be unsafe for people with diabetes, low blood sugar, pregnancy, eating disorders, certain medications, or growing bodies. Talk to a doctor before changing when you eat.

PRACTICE

For three days, before each meal or snack, pause and rate your hunger from one to five. Write the number down. You do not need to change anything; simply notice how often you eat from habit, stress, or real hunger.

KEY THOUGHT

We must not fail, however, to make clear
the distinction between hunger and appetite.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

X

What to Eat

THE CURRENT sciences of medicine and hygiene have made no progress toward answering the question, What shall I eat? The contests between the vegetarians and the meat eaters, the cooked food advocates, raw food advocates, and various other "schools" of theorists, seem to be interminable; and from the mountains of evidence and argument piled up for and against each special theory, it is plain that if we depend on these scientists we shall never know what is the natural food of man. Turning away from the whole controversy, then, we will ask the question of nature herself, and we shall find that she has not left us without an answer.

Most of the errors of dietary scientists grow out of a false premise as to the natural state of man. It is assumed that civilization and mental development are unnatural things; that the man who lives in a modern house, in city or country, and who works in modern trade or industry for his living is leading an unnatural life, and is in an unnatural environment; that the only "natural" man is a naked savage, and that the farther we get from the savage the farther we are from nature. This is wrong. The man who has all that art and science can give him is leading the most natural life, because he is living most completely in all his faculties. The dweller in a well-appointed city flat, with modern

conveniences and good ventilation, is living a far more naturally human life than the Australian savage who lives in a hollow tree or a hole in the ground.

That Great Intelligence, which is in all and through all, has in reality practically settled the question as to what we shall eat. In ordering the affairs of nature, It has decided that man's food shall be according to the zone in which he lives. In the frigid regions of the far North, fuel foods are required. The development of brain is not large, nor is the life severe in its labor-tax on muscle; and so the Esquimaux live largely on the blubber and fat of aquatic animals. No other diet is possible to them; they could not get fruits, nuts, or vegetables even if they were disposed to eat them; and they could not live on them in that climate if they could get them. So, notwithstanding the arguments of the vegetarians, the Esquimaux will continue to live on animal fats.

On the other hand, as we come toward the tropics, we find fuel foods less required; and we find the people naturally inclining toward a vegetarian diet. Millions live on rice and fruits; and the food regimen of an Esquimaux village, if followed upon the equator, would result in speedy death. A "natural" diet for the equatorial regions would be very far from being a natural diet near the North Pole; and the people of either zone, if not interfered with by medical or dietary "scientists," will be guided by the All Intelligence, which seeks the fullest life in all, to feed themselves in the best way for the promotion of perfect health. In general, you can see that God, working in nature and in the evolution of human society and customs, has answered your question as to what you shall eat; and I advise you to take His answer in preference to that of any man.

In the temperate zone the largest demands are made on man in spirit, mind, and body; and here we find the greatest variety of foods provided by nature. And it is really quite useless and superfluous to theorize on the question what the masses shall eat, for they have no choice; they must eat the foods which are staple products of the zone in which they

live. It is impossible to supply all the people with a nut-and-fruit or raw food diet; and the fact that it is impossible is proof positive that these are not the foods intended by nature, for nature, being formed for the advancement of life, has not made the obtaining of the means of life an impossibility. So, I say, the question, What shall I eat? has been answered for you. Eat wheat, corn, rye, oats, barley, buckwheat; eat vegetables; eat meats, eat fruits, eat the things that are eaten by the masses of the people around the world, for in this matter the voice of the people is the voice of God. They have been led, generally, to the selection of certain foods; and they have been led, generally, to prepare these foods in generally similar ways; and you may depend upon it that in general they have the right foods and are preparing them in the right way. In these matters the race has been under the guidance of God. The list of foods in common use is a long one, and you must select therefrom according to your individual taste; if you do, you will find that you have an infallible guide, as shown in the next two chapters.

If you do not eat until you have an EARNED hunger, you will not find your taste demanding unnatural or unhealthy foods. The woodchopper, who has swung his axe continuously from seven in the morning until noon does not come in clamoring for cream puffs and confectionery; he wants pork and beans, or beefsteak and potatoes, or corn bread and cabbage; he asks for the plain solids. Offer to crack him a few walnuts and give him a plate of lettuce, and you will be met with huge disdain; those things are not natural foods for a workingman. And if they are not natural foods for a workingman, they are not for any other man; for work hunger is the only real hunger, and requires the same materials to satisfy it, whether it be in woodchopper or banker, in man, woman or child.

It is a mistake to suppose that food must be selected with anxious care to fit the vocation of the person who eats. It is not true that the woodchopper requires “heavy” or “solid” foods and the bookkeeper “light” foods. If you are a bookkeeper, or other brain worker, and do not

eat until you have an EARNED hunger, you will want exactly the same foods that the woodchopper wants. Your body is made of exactly the same elements as that of the woodchopper, and requires the same materials for cell-building; why, then, feed him on ham and eggs and corn bread and you on crackers and toast? True, most of his waste is of muscle, while most of yours is of brain and nerve tissue; but it is also true that the woodchopper's diet contains all the requisites for brain and nerve building in far better proportions than they are found in most "light" foods. The world's best brain work has been done on the fare of the working people. The world's greatest thinkers have invariably lived on the plain solid foods common among the masses.

Let the bookkeeper wait until he has an earned hunger before he eats; and then, if he wants ham, eggs, and corn bread, by all means let him eat them; but let him remember that he does not need one-twentieth of the amount necessary for the woodchopper. It is not eating "hearty" foods which gives the brain worker indigestion; it is eating as much as would be needed by a muscle worker. Indigestion is never caused by eating to satisfy hunger; it is always caused by eating to gratify appetite. If you eat in the manner prescribed in the next chapter, your taste will soon become so natural that you will never WANT anything that you cannot eat with impunity; and you can drop the whole anxious question of what to eat from your mind forever, and simply eat what you want. Indeed, that is the only way to do if you are to think no thoughts but those of health; for you cannot think health so long as you are in continual doubt and uncertainty as to whether you are getting the right bills of fare.

"Take no thought what ye shall eat," said Jesus, and he spoke wisely. The foods found on the table of any ordinary middle-class or working class family will nourish your body perfectly if you eat at the right times and in the right way. If you want meat, eat it; and if you do not want it, do not eat it, and do not suppose that you must find some special

substitute for it. You can live perfectly well on what is left on any table after the meat has been removed.

It is not necessary to worry about a "varied" diet, so as to get in all the necessary elements. The Chinese and Hindus build very good bodies and excellent brains on a diet of few variations, rice making almost the whole of it. The Scotch are physically and mentally strong on oatmeal cakes; and the Irishman is husky of body and brilliant of mind on potatoes and pork. The wheat berry contains practically all that is necessary for the building of brain and body; and a man can live very well on a monodiet of navy beans.

Form a conception of perfect health for yourself, and do not hold any thought which is not a thought of health.

NEVER eat until you have an EARNED HUNGER. Remember that it will not hurt you in the least to go hungry for a short time; but it will surely hurt you to eat when you are not hungry.

Do not give the least thought to what you should or should not eat; simply eat what is set before you, selecting that which pleases your taste most. In other words, eat what you want. This you can do with perfect results if you eat in the right way; and how to do this will be explained in the next chapter.



REFLECTION

Wattles rejects the diet wars of his day between vegetarians, meat eaters, and raw-food advocates. His answer is to eat the plain staple foods of your region, the grains, vegetables, meats, and fruits ordinary families eat, chosen by taste. Nature and custom, he believes, have already settled the question under God's guidance. There is wisdom in his dislike of food anxiety; constantly worrying about the perfect menu can spoil eating and health. Some of his reasoning, however, is dated. His generalizations about "savages," Arctic peoples, and various nations reflect the attitudes and limited knowledge of 1910, and his

claims that you never need to think about a varied diet, or can live well on beans alone, are not sound nutrition. Allergies, illnesses, and medical diets are real. Take his calm, practical spirit, and ask a professional about specifics.

PRACTICE

At your next meal, choose one simple, familiar food you genuinely enjoy. Eat it without judging it as "good" or "bad." Afterward, write one word about how the meal felt.

KEY THOUGHT

you cannot think health so long as you are in continual doubt and uncertainty as to whether you are getting the right bills of fare.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XI

How to Eat

IT IS a settled fact that man naturally chews his food. The few faddists who maintain that we should bolt our nourishment, after the manner of the dog and others of the lower animals, can no longer get a hearing; we know that we should chew our food. And if it is natural that we should chew our food, the more thoroughly we chew it the more completely natural the process must be. If you will chew every mouthful to a liquid, you need not be in the least concerned as to what you shall eat, for you can get sufficient nourishment out of any ordinary food.

Whether or not this chewing shall be an irksome and laborious task or a most enjoyable process, depends upon the mental attitude in which you come to the table.

If your mind and attitude are on other things, or if you are anxious or worried about business or domestic affairs, you will find it almost impossible to eat without bolting more or less of your food. You must learn to live so scientifically that you will have no business or domestic cares to worry about; this you can do, and you can also learn to give your undivided attention to the act of eating while at the table.

When you eat, do so with an eye single to the purpose of getting all the enjoyment you can from that meal; dismiss everything else from your mind, and do not let anything take your attention from the food

and its taste until your meal is finished. Be cheerfully confident, for if you follow these instructions you may KNOW that the food you eat is exactly the right food, and that it will "agree" with you to perfection.

Sit down to the table with confident cheerfulness, and take a moderate portion of the food; take whatever thing looks most desirable to you. Do not select some food because you think it will be good for you; select that which will taste good to you. If you are to get well and stay well, you must drop the idea of doing things because they are good for your health, and do things because you want to do them. Select the food you want most; gratefully give thanks to God that you have learned how to eat it in such a way that digestion shall be perfect; and take a moderate mouthful of it.

Do not fix your attention on the act of chewing; fix it on the TASTE of the food; and taste and enjoy it until it is reduced to a liquid state and passes down your throat by involuntary swallowing. No matter how long it takes, do not think of the time. Think of the taste. Do not allow your eyes to wander over the table, speculating as to what you shall eat next; do not worry for fear there is not enough, and that you will not get your share of everything. Do not anticipate the taste of the next thing; keep your mind centered on the taste of what you have in your mouth. And that is all of it.

Scientific and healthful eating is a delightful process after you have learned how to do it, and after you have overcome the bad old habit of gobbling down your food unchewed. It is best not to have too much conversation going on while eating; be cheerful, but not talkative; do the talking afterward.

In most cases, some use of the will is required to form the habit of correct eating. The bolting habit is an unnatural one, and is without doubt mostly the result of fear. Fear that we will be robbed of our food; fear that we will not get our share of the good things; fear that we will lose precious time—these are the causes of haste. Then there is anticipation of the dainties that are to come for dessert, and the

consequent desire to get at them as quickly as possible; and there is mental abstraction, or thinking of other matters while eating. All these must be overcome.

When you find that your mind is wandering, call a halt; think for a moment of the food, and of how good it tastes; of the perfect digestion and assimilation that are going to follow the meal, and begin again. Begin again and again, though you must do so twenty times in the course of a single meal; and again and again, though you must do so every meal for weeks and months. It is perfectly certain that you CAN form the "Fletcher habit" if you persevere; and when you have formed it, you will experience a healthful pleasure you have never known.

This is a vital point, and I must not leave it until I have thoroughly impressed it upon your mind. Given the right materials, perfectly prepared, the Principle of Health will positively build you a perfectly healthy body; and you cannot prepare the materials *perfectly* in any other way that the one I am describing. If you are to have perfect health, you MUST eat in just this way; you can, and the doing of it is only a matter of a little perseverance. What use for you to talk of mental control unless you will govern yourself in so simple a matter as ceasing to bolt your food? What use to talk of concentration unless you can keep your mind on the act of eating for so short a space as fifteen or twenty minutes, especially with all the pleasures of taste to help you? Go on, and conquer. In a few weeks, or months, as the case may be, you will find the habit of scientific eating becoming fixed; and soon you will be in so splendid a condition, mentally and physically, that nothing would induce you to return to the bad old way.

We have seen that if man will think only thoughts of perfect health, his internal functions will be performed in a healthy manner; and we have seen that in order to think thoughts of health, man must perform the voluntary functions in a healthy manner. The most important of the voluntary functions is that of eating; and we see, so far, no especial difficulty in eating in a perfectly healthy way. I will here summarize the

instructions as to when to eat, what to eat, and how to eat, with the reasons therefor:—

NEVER eat until you have an EARNED hunger, no matter how long you go without food. This is based on the fact that whenever food is needed in the system, if there is power to digest it, the sub-conscious mind announces the need by the sensation of hunger. Learn to distinguish between genuine hunger and the gnawing and craving sensations caused by unnatural appetite. Hunger is never a disagreeable feeling, accompanied by weakness, faintness, or gnawing feelings at the stomach; it is a pleasant, anticipatory desire for food, and is felt mostly in the mouth and throat. It does not come at certain hours or at stated intervals; it only comes when the sub-conscious mind is ready to receive, digest, and assimilate food.

Eat whatever foods you want, making your selection from the staples in general use in the zone in which you live. The Supreme Intelligence has guided man to the selection of these foods, and they are the right ones for all. I am referring, of course, to the foods which are taken to satisfy hunger, not to those which have been contrived merely to gratify appetite or perverted taste. The instinct which has guided the masses of men to make use of the great staples of food to satisfy their hunger is a divine one. God has made no mistake; if you eat these foods you will not go wrong.

Eat your food with cheerful confidence, and get all the pleasure that is to be had from the taste of every mouthful. Chew each morsel to a liquid, keeping your attention fixed on the enjoyment of the process. This is the only way to eat in a perfectly complete and successful manner; and when anything is done in a completely successful manner, the general result cannot be a failure. In the attainment of health, the law is the same as in the attainment of riches; if you make each act a success in itself, the sum of all your acts must be a success. When you eat in the mental attitude I have described, and in the manner I have described, nothing can be added to the process; it is done in a perfect manner, and

it is successfully done. And if eating is successfully done, digestion, assimilation, and the building of a healthy body are successfully begun. We next take up the question of the quantity of food required.

✦

REFLECTION

This chapter is the heart of Wattles' food advice and the part most readers will find useful. Come to the table cheerful, take a moderate portion of what looks good, and give your full attention to the taste of each mouthful, chewing until the food is almost liquid. Do not rush, plan the next bite, or think about business. He traces fast eating to fear: fear of missing out, of losing time, of not getting a share. He credits this approach to Horace Fletcher, whose "Fletcher habit" of thorough chewing was popular at the time. Today we would recognize much of this as mindful eating. His promise that this method guarantees "perfect" digestion goes too far, and chewing every bite to liquid is not necessary for everyone. But slowing down, tasting, and eating without distraction are habits worth trying.

PRACTICE

At one meal today, put your phone away and take the first five bites slowly, setting your fork down between them. Focus only on taste and texture. Notice whether you feel satisfied sooner than usual.

KEY THOUGHT

Think of the taste.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XII

Hunger and Appetites

IT IS very easy to find the correct answer to the question, How much shall I eat? You are never to eat until you have an earned hunger, and you are to stop eating the instant you BEGIN to feel that your hunger is abating. Never gorge yourself; never eat to repletion. When you *begin* to feel that your hunger is satisfied, know that you have enough; for until you have enough, you will continue to feel the sensation of hunger. If you eat as directed in the last chapter, it is probable that you will begin to feel satisfied before you have taken half your usual amount; but stop there, all the same. No matter how delightfully attractive the dessert, or how tempting the pie or pudding, do not eat a mouthful of it if you find that your hunger has been in the least degree assuaged by the other foods you have taken.

Whatever you eat after your hunger begins to abate is taken to gratify taste and appetite, not hunger and is not called for by nature at all. It is therefore excess; mere debauchery, and it cannot fail to work mischief.

This is a point you will need to watch with nice discrimination, for the habit of eating purely for sensual gratification is very deeply rooted with most of us. The usual "dessert" of sweet and tempting foods is prepared solely with a view to inducing people to eat after hunger has been satisfied; and all the effects are evil. It is not that pie and cake are

unwholesome foods; they are usually perfectly wholesome if eaten to satisfy hunger, and NOT to gratify appetite. If you want pie, cake, pastry or puddings, it is better to begin your meal with them, finishing with the plainer and less tasty foods. You will find, however, that if you eat as directed in the preceding chapters, the plainest food will soon come to taste like kingly fare to you; for your sense of taste, like all your other senses, will become so acute with the general improvement in your condition that you will find new delights in common things. No glutton ever enjoyed a meal like the man who eats for hunger only, who gets the most out of every mouthful, and who stops on the instant that he feels the edge taken from his hunger. The first intimation that hunger is abating is the signal from the sub-conscious mind that it is time to quit.

The average person who takes up this plan of living will be greatly surprised to learn how little food is really required to keep the body in perfect condition. The amount depends upon the work; upon how much muscular exercise is taken, and upon the extent to which the person is exposed to cold. The woodchopper who goes into the forest in the winter time and swings his axe all day can eat two full meals; but the brain worker who sits all day on a chair, in a warm room, does not need one third and often not one tenth as much. Most woodchoppers eat two or three times as much, and most brain workers from three to ten times as much as nature calls for; and the elimination of this vast amount of surplus rubbish from their systems is a tax on vital power which in time depletes their energy and leaves them an easy prey to so-called disease. Get all possible enjoyment out of the taste of your food, but never eat anything merely because it tastes good; and on the instant that you feel that your hunger is less keen, stop eating.

If you will consider for a moment, you will see that there is positively no other way for you to settle these various food questions than by adopting the plan here laid down for you. As to the proper time to eat, there is no other way to decide than to say that you should eat whenever

you have an EARNED HUNGER. It is a self-evident proposition that that is the right time to eat, and that any other is a wrong time to eat. As to what to eat, the Eternal Wisdom has decided that the masses of men shall eat the staple products of the zones in which they live. The staple foods of your particular zone are the right foods for you; and the Eternal Wisdom, working in and through the minds of the masses of men, has taught them how best to prepare these foods by cooking and otherwise. And as to how to eat, you know that you must chew your food; and if it must be chewed, then reason tells us that the more thorough and perfect the operation the better.

I repeat that success in anything is attained by making each separate act a success in itself. If you make each action, however small and unimportant, a thoroughly successful action, your day's work as a whole cannot result in failure. If you make the actions of each day successful, the sum total of your life cannot be failure. A great success is the result of doing a large number of little things, and doing each one in a perfectly successful way. If every thought is a healthy thought, and if every action of your life is performed in a healthy way, you must soon attain to perfect health. It is impossible to devise a way in which you can perform the act of eating more successfully, and in a manner more in accord with the laws of life, than by chewing every mouthful to a liquid, enjoying the taste fully, and keeping a cheerful confidence the while. Nothing can be added to make the process more successful; while if anything be subtracted, the process will not be a completely healthy one.

In the matter of how much to eat, you will also see that there could be no other guide so natural, so safe, and so reliable as the one I have prescribed—to stop eating on the instant you feel that your hunger begins to abate. The sub-conscious mind may be trusted with implicit reliance to inform us when food is needed; and it may be trusted as implicitly to inform us when the need has been supplied. If ALL food is eaten for hunger, and NO food is taken merely to gratify taste, you will never eat too much; and if you eat whenever you have an EARNED

hunger, you will always eat enough. By reading carefully the summing up in the following chapter, you will see that the requirements for eating in a perfectly healthy way are really very few and simple.

The matter of drinking in a natural way may be dismissed here with a very few words. If you wish to be exactly and rigidly scientific, drink nothing but water; drink only when you are thirsty; drink whenever you are thirsty, and stop as soon as you feel that your thirst begins to abate. But if you are living rightly in regard to eating, it will not be necessary to practice asceticism or great self-denial in the matter of drinking. You can take an occasional cup of weak coffee without harm; you can, to a reasonable extent, follow the customs of those around you. Do not get the soda fountain habit; do not drink merely to tickle your palate with sweet liquids; be sure that you take a drink of water whenever you feel thirst. Never be too lazy, too indifferent, or too busy to get a drink of water when you feel the least thirst; if you obey this rule, you will have little inclination to take strange and unnatural drinks. Drink only to satisfy thirst; drink whenever you feel thirst; and stop drinking as soon as you feel thirst abating. That is the perfectly healthy way to supply the body with the necessary fluid material for its internal processes.



REFLECTION

Wattles turns to how much to eat. His guide is simple: stop the moment you notice your hunger beginning to fade. Eating past that point, he says, serves only appetite. He suggests that if you want dessert, you eat it first rather than after you are full, and he promises that plain food tastes wonderful to someone who eats only when hungry. He also covers drinking: water when thirsty, an occasional weak coffee, and no habit of sweet drinks. Noticing fullness and stopping before you are stuffed is sound, gentle advice for many people. His figures, such as office workers needing a tenth of what they eat, are guesses, not

measurements. People with a history of restrictive eating should be careful with any rule about eating less, and should work with a doctor or dietitian instead.

PRACTICE

At your next meal, pause halfway through. Put down your fork, take three breaths, and ask yourself whether you are still hungry or simply enjoying the taste. Decide from there, without guilt either way.

KEY THOUGHT

The first intimation that hunger is abating is the signal from the sub-conscious mind that it is time to quit.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XIII

In a Nutshell

THERE IS a Cosmic Life which permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe, being in and through all things. This Life is not merely a vibration, or form of energy; it is a Living Substance. All things are made from it; it is All, and in all.

This Substance thinks, and it assumes the form of that which it thinks about. The thought of a form, in this substance, creates the form; the thought of a motion institutes the motion. The visible universe, with all its forms and motions, exists because it is in the thought of Original Substance.

Man is a form of Original Substance, and can think original thoughts; and within himself, man's thoughts have controlling or formative power. The thought of a condition produces that condition; the thought of a motion institutes that motion. So long as man thinks of the conditions and motions of disease, so long will the conditions and motions of disease exist within him. If man will think only of perfect health, the Principle of Health within him will maintain normal conditions.

To be well, man must form a conception of perfect health, and hold thoughts harmonious with that conception as regards himself and all things. He must think only of healthy conditions and functioning; he

must not permit a thought of unhealthy or abnormal conditions or functioning to find lodgment in his mind at any time.

In order to think only of healthy conditions and functioning, man must perform the voluntary acts of life in a perfectly healthy way. He cannot think perfect health so long as he knows that he is living in a wrong or unhealthy way; or even so long as he has doubts as to whether or not he is living in a healthy way. Man cannot think thoughts of perfect health while his voluntary functions are performed in the manner of one who is sick. The voluntary functions of life are eating, drinking, breathing, and sleeping. When man thinks only of healthy conditions and functioning, and performs these externals in a perfectly healthy manner, he must have perfect health.

In eating, man must learn to be guided by his hunger. He must distinguish between hunger and appetite, and between hunger and the cravings of habit; he must NEVER eat unless he feels an EARNED HUNGER. He must learn that genuine hunger is never present after natural sleep, and that the demand for an early morning meal is purely a matter of habit and appetite; and he must not begin his day by eating in violation of natural law. He must wait until he has an Earned Hunger, which, in most cases, will make his first meal come at about the noon hour. No matter what his condition, vocation, or circumstances, he must make it his rule not to eat until he has an EARNED HUNGER; and he may remember that it is far better to fast for several hours after he has become hungry than to eat before he begins to feel hunger. It will not hurt you to go hungry for a few hours, even though you are working hard; but it will hurt you to fill your stomach when you are not hungry, whether you are working or not. If you never eat until you have an Earned Hunger, you may be certain that in so far as the time of eating is concerned, you are proceeding in a perfectly healthy way. This is a self-evident proposition.

As to what he shall eat, man must be guided by that Intelligence which has arranged that the people of any given portion of the earth's

surface must live on the staple products of the zone which they inhabit. Have faith in God, and ignore "food science" of every kind. Do not pay the slightest attention to the controversies as to the relative merits of cooked and raw foods; of vegetables and meats; or as to your need for carbohydrates and proteins. Eat only when you have an earned hunger, and then take the common foods of the masses of the people in the zone in which you live, and have perfect confidence that the results will be good. They will be. Do not seek for luxuries, or for things imported or fixed up to tempt the taste; stick to the plain solids; and when these do not "taste good," fast until they do. Do not seek for "light" foods; for easily digestible, or "healthy" foods; eat what the farmers and workingmen eat. Then you will be functioning in a perfectly healthy manner, so far as what to eat is concerned. I repeat, if you have no hunger or taste for the plain foods, do not eat at all; wait until hunger comes. Go without eating until the plainest food tastes good to you; and then begin your meal with what you like best.

In deciding how to eat, man must be guided by reason. We can see that the abnormal states of hurry and worry produced by wrong thinking about business and similar things have led us to form the habit of eating too fast, and chewing too little. Reason tells us that food should be chewed, and that the more thoroughly it is chewed the better it is prepared for the chemistry of digestion. Furthermore, we can see that the man who eats slowly and chews his food to a liquid, keeping his mind on the process and giving it his undivided attention, will enjoy more of the pleasure of taste than he who bolts his food with his mind on something else. To eat in a perfectly healthy manner, man must concentrate his attention on the act, with cheerful enjoyment and confidence; he must taste his food, and he must reduce each mouthful to a liquid before swallowing it. The foregoing instructions, if followed, make the function of eating completely perfect; nothing can be added as to what, when, and how.

In the matter of how much to eat, man must be guided by the same inward intelligence, or Principle of Health, which tells him when food is wanted. He must stop eating in the moment that he feels hunger abating; he must not eat beyond this point to gratify taste. If he ceases to eat in the instant that the inward demand for food ceases, he will never overeat; and the function of supplying the body with food will be performed in a perfectly healthy manner.

The matter of eating naturally is a very simple one; there is nothing in all the foregoing that cannot be easily practiced by any one. This method, put in practice, will infallibly result in perfect digestion and assimilation; and all anxiety and careful thought concerning the matter can at once be dropped from the mind. Whenever you have an earned hunger, eat with thankfulness what is set before you, chewing each mouthful to a liquid, and stopping when you feel the edge taken from your hunger.

The importance of the mental attitude is sufficient to justify an additional word. While you are eating, as at all other times, think only of healthy conditions and normal functioning. Enjoy what you eat; if you carry on a conversation at the table, talk of the goodness of the food, and of the pleasure it is giving you. Never mention that you dislike this or that; speak only of those things which you like. Never discuss the wholesomeness or unwholesomeness of foods; never mention or think of unwholesomeness at all. If there is anything on the table for which you do not care, pass it by in silence, or with a word of commendation; never criticise or object to anything. Eat your food with gladness and with singleness of heart, praising God and giving thanks. Let your watchword be perseverance; whenever you fall into the old way of hasty eating, or of wrong thought and speech, bring yourself up short and begin again.

It is of the most vital importance to you that you should be a self-controlling and self-directing person; and you can never hope to become so unless you can master yourself in so simple and fundamental a matter

as the manner and method of your eating. If you cannot control yourself in this, you cannot control yourself in anything that will be worth while. On the other hand, if you carry out the foregoing instructions, you may rest in the assurance that in so far as right thinking and right eating are concerned you are living in a perfectly scientific way; and you may also be assured that if you practice what is prescribed in the following chapters you will quickly build your body into a condition of perfect health.

REFLECTION

This chapter restates the whole book in compact form. One living Substance fills everything; thought shapes conditions; the reader must hold a conception of perfect health and never let a thought of illness settle in the mind. Then come the eating rules again: wait for earned hunger, usually skip breakfast, eat local staple foods, chew thoroughly, stop when hunger fades. Wattles adds an appealing note about the table itself: talk of the goodness of the food, do not criticize what is served, and eat with thanks. That habit of gratitude and pleasant conversation can make meals happier for everyone. His advice to "fast until" plain food tastes good and to "ignore food science" should not be followed literally. It reflects his era's enthusiasm for fasting, not current medical knowledge, and may be harmful for many readers.

PRACTICE

At your next shared meal, say one specific thing you appreciate about the food or the person who made it. If you eat alone, say it quietly to yourself before the first bite.

KEY THOUGHT

Eat your food with gladness and with singleness of heart, praising God and giving thanks.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XIV

Breathing

THE FUNCTION of breathing is a vital one, and it immediately concerns the continuance of life. We can live many hours without sleeping, and many days without eating or drinking, but only a few minutes without breathing. The act of breathing is involuntary, but the manner of it, and the provision of the proper conditions for its healthy performance, falls within the scope of volition. Man will continue to breathe involuntarily, but he can voluntarily determine what he shall breathe, and how deeply and thoroughly he shall breathe; and he can, of his own volition, keep the physical mechanism in condition for the perfect performance of the function.

It is essential, if you wish to breathe in a perfectly healthy way, that the physical machinery used in the act should be kept in good condition. You must keep your spine moderately straight, and the muscles of your chest must be flexible and free in action. You cannot breathe in the right way if your shoulders are greatly stooped forward and your chest hollow and rigid. Sitting or standing at work in a slightly stooping position tends to produce hollow chest; so does lifting heavy weights—or light weights.

The tendency of work, of almost all kinds, is to pull the shoulders forward, curve the spine, and flatten the chest; and if the chest is greatly

flattened, full and deep breathing becomes impossible, and perfect health is out of the question.

Various gymnastic exercises have been devised to counteract the effect of stooping while at work; such as hanging by the hands from a swing or trapeze bar, or sitting on a chair with the feet under some heavy article of furniture and bending backward until the head touches the floor, and so on. All these are good enough in their way, but very few people will follow them long enough and regularly enough to accomplish any real gain in physique. The taking of "health exercises" of any kind is burdensome and unnecessary; there is a more natural, simpler, and much better way.

This better way is to keep yourself straight, and to breathe deeply. Let your mental conception of yourself be that you are a perfectly straight person, and whenever the matter comes to your mind, be sure that you instantly expand your chest, throw back your shoulders, and "straighten up." Whenever you do this, slowly draw in your breath until you fill your lungs to their utmost capacity; "crowd in" all the air you possibly can; and while holding it for an instant in the lungs, throw your shoulders still further back, and stretch your chest; at the same time try to pull your spine forward between the shoulders. Then let the air go easily.

This is the one great exercise for keeping the chest full, flexible, and in good condition. Straighten up; fill your lungs FULL; stretch your chest and straighten your spine, and exhale easily. And this exercise you must repeat, in season and out of season, at all times and in all places, until you form a habit of doing it; you can easily do so. Whenever you step out of doors into the fresh, pure air, BREATHE. When you are at work, and think of yourself and your position, BREATHE. When you are in company, and are reminded of the matter, BREATHE. When you are awake in the night, BREATHE. No matter where you are or what you are doing, whenever the idea comes to your mind, straighten up and BREATHE. If you walk to and from your work, take the exercise all the

way; it will soon become a delight to you; you will keep it up, not for the sake of health, but as a matter of pleasure.

Do not consider this a "health exercise"; *never take health exercises, or do gymnastics to make you well. To do so is to recognize sickness as a present fact or as a possibility, which is precisely what you must not do*. The people who are always taking exercises for their health are always thinking about being sick. It ought to be a matter of pride with you to keep your spine straight and strong; as much so as it is to keep your face clean. Keep your spine straight, and your chest full and flexible for the same reason that you keep your hands clean and your nails manicured; because it is slovenly to do otherwise. Do it without a thought of sickness, present or possible. You must either be crooked and unsightly, or you must be straight; and if you are straight your breathing will take care of itself. You will find the matter of health exercises referred to again in a future chapter.

It is essential, however, that you should breathe AIR. It appears to be the intention of nature that the lungs should receive air containing its regular percentage of oxygen, and not greatly contaminated by other gases, or by filth of any kind. Do not allow yourself to think that you are compelled to live or work where the air is not fit to breathe. If your house cannot be properly ventilated, move; and if you are employed where the air is bad, get another job; you can, by practicing the methods given in the preceding volume of this series—"THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH." If no one would consent to work in bad air, employers would speedily see to it that all work rooms were properly ventilated. The worst air is that from which the oxygen has been exhausted by breathing; as that of churches and theaters where crowds of people congregate, and the outlet and supply of air are poor. Next to this is air containing other gases than oxygen and hydrogen—sewer gas, and the effluvium from decaying things. Air that is heavily charged with dust or particles of organic matter may be endured better than any of

these. Small particles of organic matter other than food are generally thrown off from the lungs; but gases go into the blood.

I speak advisedly when I say "other than food." Air is largely a food. It is the most thoroughly alive thing we take into the body. Every breath carries in millions of microbes, many of which are assimilated. The odors from earth, grass, tree, flower, plant, and from cooking foods are foods in themselves; they are minute particles of the substances from which they come, and are often so attenuated that they pass directly from the lungs into the blood, and are assimilated without digestion. And the atmosphere is permeated with the One Original Substance, which is life itself. Consciously recognize this whenever you think of your breathing, and think that you are breathing in life; you really are, and conscious recognition helps the process. See to it that you do not breathe air containing poisonous gases, and that you do not rebreathe the air which has been used by yourself or others.

That is all there is to the matter of breathing correctly. Keep your spine straight and your chest flexible, and breathe pure air, recognizing with thankfulness the fact that you breathe in the Eternal Life. That is not difficult; and beyond these things give little thought to your breathing except to thank God that you have learned how to do it perfectly.



REFLECTION

Wattles' advice on breathing is short and largely friendly. Keep your spine straight and your chest open, since work tends to pull the shoulders forward. Whenever you remember, straighten up, take a full slow breath, stretch the chest, and let the air go easily. Make it a pleasant habit, not a "health exercise," and do it outdoors, at work, and on walks. He also stresses clean air: avoid stuffy rooms and fumes, and see breathing as taking in life itself. Good posture and fresh air are reasonable goals. Some of his claims, such as that scents are

absorbed as food, are not accurate, and his advice to simply move house or change jobs if the air is bad ignores how hard that can be. People with lung or heart conditions should ask a doctor about breathing exercises.

PRACTICE

Set three reminders today. Each time one goes off, stand or sit tall, roll your shoulders back, breathe in slowly through your nose, pause briefly, and breathe out easily. Notice how your body feels afterward.

KEY THOUGHT

Whenever you step out of doors
into the fresh, pure air, BREATHE.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XV

Sleep

VITAL POWER is renewed in sleep. Every living thing sleeps; men, animals, reptiles, fish, and insects sleep, and even plants have regular periods of slumber. And this is because it is in sleep that we come into such contact with the Principle of Life in nature that our own lives may be renewed. It is in sleep that the brain of man is recharged with vital energy, and the Principle of Health within him is given new strength. It is of the first importance, then, that we should sleep in a natural, normal, and perfectly healthy manner.

Studying sleep, we note that the breathing is much deeper, and more forcible and rhythmic than in the waking state. Much more air is inspired when asleep than when awake, and this tells us that the Principle of Health requires large quantities of some element in the atmosphere for the process of renewal. If you would surround sleep with natural conditions, then, the first step is to see that you have an unlimited supply of fresh and pure air to breathe. Physicians have found that sleeping in the pure air of out-of-doors is very efficacious in the treatment of pulmonary troubles; and, taken in connection with the Way of Living and Thinking prescribed in this book, you will find that it is just as efficacious in curing every other sort of trouble. Do not take any half-way measures in this matter of securing pure air while you sleep.

Ventilate your bedroom thoroughly; so thoroughly that it will be practically the same as sleeping out of doors. Have a door or window open wide; have one open on each side of the room, if possible. If you cannot have a good draught of air across the room, pull the head of your bed close to the open window, so that the air from without may come fully into your face. No matter how cold or unpleasant the weather, have a window open, and open wide; and try to get a circulation of pure air through the room. Pile on the bedclothes, if necessary, to keep you warm; but have an unlimited supply of fresh air from out of doors. This is the first great requisite for healthy sleep.

The brain and nerve centers cannot be thoroughly vitalized if you sleep in "dead" or stagnant air; you must have the living atmosphere, vital with nature's Principle of Life. I repeat, do not make any compromise in this matter; ventilate your sleeping room completely, and see that there is a circulation of outdoor air through it while you sleep. You are not sleeping in a perfectly healthy way if you shut the doors and windows of your sleeping room, whether in winter or summer. Have fresh air. If you are where there is no fresh air, move. If your bedroom cannot be ventilated, get into another house.

Next in importance is the mental attitude in which you go to sleep. It is well to sleep intelligently, purposefully, knowing what you do it for. Lie down thinking that sleep is an infallible vitalizer, and go to sleep with a confident faith that your strength is to be renewed; that you will awake full of vitality and health. Put purpose into your sleep as you do into your eating; give the matter your attention for a few minutes, as you go to rest. Do not seek your couch with a discouraged or depressed feeling; go there joyously, to be made whole. Do not forget the exercise of gratitude in going to sleep; before you close your eyes, give thanks to God for having shown you the way to perfect health, and go to sleep with this grateful thought uppermost in your mind. A bedtime prayer of thanksgiving is a mighty good thing; it puts the Principle of Health

within you into communication with its source, from which it is to receive new power while you are in the silence of unconsciousness.

You may see that the requirements for perfectly healthy sleep are not difficult. First, to see that you breathe pure air from out of doors while you sleep; and, second, to put the Within into touch with the Living Substance by a few minutes of grateful meditation as you go to bed. Observe these requirements, go to sleep in a thankful and confident frame of mind, and all will be well. If you have insomnia, do not let it worry you. While you lie awake, form your conception of health; meditate with thankfulness on the abundant life which is yours, breathe, and feel perfectly confident that you will sleep in due time; and you will. Insomnia, like every other ailment, must give way before the Principle of Health aroused to full constructive activity by the course of thought and action herein described.

The reader will now comprehend that it is not at all burdensome or disagreeable to perform the voluntary functions of life in a perfectly healthy way. The perfectly healthy way is the easiest, simplest, most natural, and most pleasant way. The cultivation of health is not a work of art, difficulty, or strenuous labor. You have only to lay aside artificial observances of every kind, and eat, drink, breathe, and sleep in the most natural and delightful way; and if you do this, thinking health and only health, you will certainly be well.



REFLECTION

Wattles sees sleep as the time when life renews us. He asks for two things. First, plenty of fresh air: open the windows wide, in any weather, and pile on blankets if needed. Second, the right state of mind: go to bed expecting to be restored, and end the day with a few minutes of thankful meditation or prayer. For sleeplessness he suggests lying quietly, breathing, and trusting that sleep will come. The calm, grateful bedtime ritual is close to what sleep experts

recommend today, and a well-ventilated room helps many people. Wide-open windows in all weather may not suit everyone, especially in very cold, noisy, polluted, or unsafe places. Ongoing insomnia can have medical or emotional causes, and a doctor can help.

PRACTICE

Tonight, spend the last five minutes before sleep away from screens. Lie down, take a few slow breaths, and name three things from the day you are thankful for. Then let your thoughts rest.

KEY THOUGHT

Vital power is renewed in sleep.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XVI

Supplementary Instructions

IN FORMING a conception of health, it is necessary to think of the manner in which you would live and work if you were perfectly well and very strong; to imagine yourself doing things in the way of a perfectly well and very strong person, until you have a fairly good conception of what you would be if you were well. Then take a mental and physical attitude in harmony with this conception; and do not depart from this attitude. You must unify yourself in thought with the thing you desire; and whatever state or condition you unify with yourself in thought will soon become unified with you in body. The scientific way is to sever relations with everything you do not want, and to enter into relations with everything you do want. Form a conception of perfect health, and relate yourself to this conception in word, act, and attitude.

Guard your speech; make every word harmonize with the conception of perfect health. Never complain; never say things like these: "I did not sleep well last night;" "I have a pain in my side;" "I do not feel at all well to-day," and so on. Say "I am looking forward to a good night's sleep to-night;" "I can see that I progress rapidly," and things of similar meaning. In so far as everything which is connected with disease is concerned, your way is to forget it; and in so far as everything which is connected with

health is concerned, your way is to unify yourself with it in thought and speech.

This is the whole thing in a nutshell: *make yourself one with Health in thought, word, and action; and do not connect yourself with sickness either by thought, word, or action*.

Do not read "Doctor Books" or medical literature, or the literature of those whose theories conflict with those herein set forth; to do so will certainly undermine your faith in the Way of Living upon which you have entered, and cause you to again come into mental relations with disease. This book really gives you all that is required; nothing essential has been omitted, and practically all the superfluous has been eliminated. The Science of Being Well is an exact science, like arithmetic; nothing can be added to the fundamental principles, and if anything be taken from them, a failure will result. If you follow strictly the way of living prescribed in this book, you will be well; and you certainly CAN follow this way, both in thought and action.

Relate not only yourself, but so far as possible all others, in your thoughts, to perfect health. Do not sympathize with people when they complain, or even when they are sick and suffering. Turn their thoughts into a constructive channel if you can; do all you can for their relief, but do it with the health thought in your mind. Do not let people tell their woes and catalogue their symptoms to you; turn the conversation to some other subject, or excuse yourself and go. Better be considered an unfeeling person than to have the disease thought forced upon you. When you are in company of people whose conversational stock-in-trade is sickness and kindred matters, ignore what they say and fall to offering a mental prayer of gratitude for your perfect health; and if that does not enable you to shut out their thoughts, say good-by and leave them. No matter what they think or say; politeness does not require you to permit yourself to be poisoned by diseased or perverted thought. When we have a few more hundreds of thousands of enlightened thinkers who will not stay where people complain and talk sickness, the world will advance

rapidly toward health. When you let people talk to you of sickness, you assist them to increase and multiply sickness.

What shall I do when I am in pain? Can one be in actual physical suffering and still think only thoughts of *health*?

Yes. Do not resist pain; recognize that it is a good thing. Pain is caused by an effort of the Principle of Health to overcome some unnatural condition; this you must know and feel. When you have a pain, think that a process of healing is going on in the affected part, and mentally assist and co-operate with it. Put yourself in full mental harmony with the power which is causing the pain; assist it; help it along. Do not hesitate, when necessary, to use hot fomentations and similar means to further the good work which is going on. If the pain is severe, lie down and give your mind to the work of quietly and easily co-operating with the force which is at work for your good. This is the time to exercise gratitude and faith; be thankful for the power of health which is causing the pain, and be certain that the pain will cease as soon as the good work is done. Fix your thoughts, with confidence, on the Principle of Health which is making such conditions within you that pain will soon be unnecessary. You will be surprised to find how easily you can conquer pain; and after you have lived for a time in this Scientific Way, pains and aches will be things unknown to you.

What shall I do when I am too weak for my work? Shall I drive myself beyond my strength, trusting in God to support me? Shall I go on, like the runner, expecting a "second wind"?

No; better not. When you begin to live in this Way, you will probably not be of normal strength; and you will gradually pass from a low physical condition to a higher one. If you relate yourself mentally with health and strength, and perform the voluntary functions of life in a perfectly healthy manner, your strength will increase from day to day; but for a time you may have days when your strength is insufficient for the work you would like to do. At such times rest, and exercise gratitude. Recognize the fact that your strength is growing rapidly, and

feel a deep thankfulness to the Living One from whom it comes. Spend an hour of weakness in thanksgiving and rest, with full faith that great strength is at hand; and then get up and go on again. While you rest do not think of your present weakness; *think of the strength that is coming*.

Never, at any time, allow yourself to think that you are giving way to weakness; when you rest, as when you go to sleep, fix your mind on the Principle of Health which is building you into complete strength.

What shall I do about that great bugaboo which scares millions of people to death every year—Constipation?

Do nothing. Read Horace Fletcher on "The A B Z of Our Own Nutrition," and get the full force of his explanation of the fact that when you live on this scientific plan you need not, and indeed cannot, have an evacuation of the bowels every day; and that an operation in from once in three days to once in two weeks is quite sufficient for perfect health. The gross feeders who eat from three to ten times as much as can be utilized in their systems have a great amount of waste to eliminate; but if you live in the manner we have described it will be otherwise with you.

If you eat only when you have an EARNED HUNGER, and chew every mouthful to a liquid, and if you stop eating the instant you BEGIN to be conscious of an abatement of your hunger, you will so perfectly prepare your food for digestion and assimilation that practically all of it will be taken up by the absorbents; and there will be little—almost nothing—remaining in the bowels to be excreted. If you are able to entirely banish from your memory all that you have read in "doctor books" and patent medicine advertisements concerning constipation, you need give the matter no further thought at all. The Principle of Health will take care of it.

But if your mind has been filled with fear-thought in regard to constipation, it may be well in the beginning for you to occasionally flush the colon with warm water. There is not the least need of doing it, except to make the process of your mental emancipation from fear a

little easier; it may be worth while for that. And as soon as you see that you are making good progress, and that you have cut down your quantity of food, and are really eating in the Scientific Way, dismiss constipation from your mind forever; you have nothing more to do with it. Put your trust in that Principle within you which has the power to give you perfect health; relate It by your reverent gratitude to the Principle of Life which is All Power, and go on your way rejoicing.

What about exercise?

Every one is the better for a little all-round use of the muscles every day; and the best way to get this is to do it by engaging in some form of play or amusement. Get your exercise in the natural way; as recreation, not as a forced stunt for health's sake alone. Ride a horse or a bicycle; play tennis or tenpins, or toss a ball. Have some avocation like gardening in which you can spend an hour every day with pleasure and profit; there are a thousand ways in which you can get exercise enough to keep your body supple and your circulation good, and yet not fall into the rut of "exercising for your health." Exercise for fun or profit; exercise because you are too healthy to sit still, and not because you wish to become healthy, or to remain so.

Are long continued fasts necessary?

Seldom, if ever. The Principle of Health does not often require twenty, thirty, or forty days to get ready for action; under normal conditions, hunger will come in much less time. In most long fasts, the reason hunger does not come sooner is because it has been inhibited by the patient himself. He begins the fast with the FEAR if not actually with the hope that it will be many days before hunger comes; the literature he has read on the subject has prepared him to expect a long fast, and he is grimly determined to go to a finish, let the time be as long as it will. And the sub-conscious mind, under the influence of powerful and positive suggestion, suspends hunger.

When, for any reason, nature takes away your hunger, go cheerfully on with your usual work, and do not eat until she gives it back. No

matter if it is two, three, ten days, or longer; you may be perfectly sure that when it is time for you to eat you will be hungry; and if you are cheerfully confident and keep your faith in health, you will suffer from no weakness or discomfort caused by abstinence. When you are not hungry, you will feel stronger, happier, and more comfortable if you do not eat than you will if you do eat; no matter how long the fast. And if you live in the scientific way described in this book, you will never have to take long fasts; you will seldom miss a meal, and you will enjoy your meals more than ever before in your life. Get an earned hunger before you eat; and whenever you get an earned hunger, eat.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles closes with practical questions. Speak only in hopeful terms about your health; do not read medical books; avoid listening to others' complaints. Rest when weak instead of forcing yourself. Get exercise through play, gardening, or sport rather than chores done "for health." On pain, constipation, and fasting he gives advice that needs care. He says pain is always healing and should not be resisted, that bowel movements every few days or weeks are fine, and that you can go many days without food if hunger does not come. These claims can be dangerous. Severe, sudden, or lasting pain, digestive changes, and loss of appetite can signal serious illness and should be checked by a doctor. His advice not to sympathize with the sick is also hard; listening kindly is part of caring for others.

PRACTICE

Choose one form of movement you genuinely enjoy, such as dancing, walking with a friend, gardening, or a ball game. Schedule fifteen minutes of it this week, purely for fun.

KEY THOUGHT

Exercise for fun or profit; exercise because you are too healthy to sit still, and not because you wish to become healthy, or to remain so.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XVII

A Summary of the Science of Being Well

HEALTH IS perfectly natural functioning, normal living. There is a Principle of Life in the universe; it is the Living Substance, from which all things are made. This Living Substance permeates, penetrates, and fills the interspaces of the universe. In its invisible state it is in and through all forms; and yet all forms are made of it. To illustrate: Suppose that a very fine and highly diffusible aqueous vapor should permeate and penetrate a block of ice. The ice is formed from living water, and is living water in form; while the vapor is also living water, unformed, permeating a form made from itself. This illustration will explain how Living Substance permeates all forms made from It; all life comes from It; it is all the life there is.

This Universal Substance is a thinking substance, and takes the form of its thought. The thought of a form, held by it, creates the form; and the thought of a motion causes the motion. It cannot help thinking, and so is forever creating; and it must move on toward fuller and more complete expression of itself. This means toward more complete life and more perfect functioning; and that means toward perfect health.

The power of the living substance must always be exerted toward perfect health; it is a force in all things making for perfect functioning.

> *All things are permeated by a power which makes for health.*

Man can relate himself to this power, and ally himself with it; he can also separate himself from it in his thoughts.

Man is a form of this Living Substance, and has within him a Principle of Health. This Principle of Health, when in full constructive activity, causes all the involuntary functions of man's body to be perfectly performed.

> *Man is a thinking substance, permeating a visible body, and the processes of his body are controlled by his thought.*

When man thinks only thoughts of perfect health, the internal processes of his body will be those of perfect health. Man's first step toward perfect health must be to form a conception of himself as perfectly healthy, and as doing all things in the way and manner of a perfectly healthy person. Having formed this conception, he must relate himself to it in all his thoughts, and sever all thought relations with disease and weakness.

If he does this, and thinks his thoughts of health with positive FAITH, man will cause the Principle of Health within him to become constructively active, and to heal all his diseases. He can receive additional power from the universal Principle of Life by faith, and he can acquire faith by looking to this Principle of Life with reverent gratitude for the health it gives him. If man will consciously accept the health which is being continually given to him by the Living Substance, and if he will be duly grateful therefor, he will develop faith.

Man cannot think only thoughts of perfect health unless he performs the voluntary functions of life in a perfectly healthy manner. These

voluntary functions are eating, drinking, breathing, and sleeping. If man thinks only thoughts of health, has faith in health, and eats, drinks, breathes, and sleeps in a perfectly healthy way, he must have perfect health.

Health is the result of thinking and acting in a Certain Way; and if a sick man begins to think and act in this Way, the Principle of Health within him will come into constructive activity and heal all his diseases. This Principle of Health is the same in all, and is related to the Life Principle of the universe; it is able to heal every disease, and will come into activity whenever man thinks and acts in accordance with the Science of Being Well. Therefore, every man can attain to perfect health.

✦

REFLECTION

The final chapter repeats the system in a few pages. A living, thinking Substance fills all things and always pushes toward health, like vapor filling a block of ice made of the same water. People are part of it, and their thoughts guide their bodies. Form a conception of yourself as healthy, hold it with faith and gratitude, live the voluntary functions well, and, Wattles concludes, "every man can attain to perfect health." The hope in that sentence is moving, and his stress on faith, gratitude, and simple daily habits can enrich anyone's life. But it is a promise no book can keep. Some illnesses cannot be cured, and many need medical treatment. Not reaching perfect health is never a personal failure. Read this summary as a statement of Wattles' faith, and let it encourage, not replace, your care.

PRACTICE

Write a short note to yourself listing two ideas from this book you want to keep, such as slow eating or bedtime gratitude, and one you will set aside. Put the note somewhere you will see it.

KEY THOUGHT

Health is perfectly natural functioning, normal living.

MY OWN NOTES

The Science of Being Great

1910

About This Work

THE SCIENCE of Being Great appeared in 1910 from Elizabeth Towne in Holyoke, Massachusetts, the publisher of most of Wattles' books and of The Nautilus magazine he wrote for. It is the third of his "Science" books. In the text he calls The Science of Getting Rich "the first volume of this series," and after books on money and on health he now turns to character and influence.

The book is built around what Wattles calls the "Principle of Power," a creative force he believes lives in every person because every person is made of the one intelligent Substance he calls God. From there he lays out a sequence of steps: preparation (setting aside fear, greed, and the wish to rule others), the right point of view, consecration (obeying the best within you), identification (knowing yourself one with God), idealization (holding a clear picture of who you want to become), and realization (living that picture now, in small daily acts). The goal is not fame. His measure of greatness is service, borrowed from the words "He that will be great among you let him serve."

Readers today will find much that is practical: think for yourself, act calmly instead of in a hurry, treat everyone as an equal, stop meddling in other people's lives, and do ordinary things with care. Several points deserve a careful reading, though. Wattles writes as if right thinking guarantees wisdom, health, wealth, and recognition. No book can promise that; outcomes depend on effort, health, circumstance, and plain luck, and hardship is never proof of a wrong attitude. When he

calls the world "perfect," he includes child labor and exploitation. Most readers will want to keep his hope while still calling injustice what it is. His picture of evolution, his talk of "savages" and the "ape man," his partial trust in phrenology, and his ranking of peoples and stages of civilization reflect the science and attitudes of his time and should be read as history. His socialist sympathies show in his praise of Eugene V. Debs.

Finally, "greatness" here never means being better than others. Wattles insists you are "a god among gods" and must meet everyone as an equal. If you are struggling with anxiety, debt, or family strain, his calm can be a help, but please also seek practical and professional support.

CHAPTER

I

Any Person May Become Great

THERE IS a Principle of Power in every person. By the intelligent use and direction of this principle, man can develop his own mental faculties. Man has an inherent power by which he may grow in whatsoever direction he pleases, and there does not appear to be any limit to the possibilities of his growth. No man has yet become so great in any faculty but that it is possible for some one else to become greater. The possibility is in the Original Substance from which man is made. Genius is Omniscience flowing into man. Genius is more than talent. Talent may merely be one faculty developed out of proportion to other faculties, but genius is the union of man and God in the acts of the soul. Great men are always greater than their deeds. They are in connection with a reserve power that is without limit. We do not know where the boundary of the mental powers of man is; we do not even know that there is a boundary.

The power of conscious growth is not given to the lower animals; it is man's alone and may be developed and increased by him. The lower animals can, to a great extent, be trained and developed by man; but man can train and develop himself. He alone has this power, and he has it to an apparently unlimited extent.

The purpose of life for man is growth, just as the purpose of life for trees and plants is growth. Trees and plants grow automatically and along fixed lines; man can grow as he will. Trees and plants can only develop certain possibilities and characteristics; man can develop any power which is or has been shown by any person, anywhere. Nothing that is possible in spirit is impossible in flesh and blood. Nothing that man can think is impossible in action. Nothing that man can imagine is impossible of realization.

Man is formed for growth, and he is under the necessity of growing.

It is essential to his happiness that he should continuously advance.

Life without progress becomes unendurable, and the person who ceases from growth must either become imbecile or insane. The greater and more harmonious and well-rounded his growth, the happier man will be.

There is no possibility in any man that is not in every man; but if they proceed naturally, no two men will grow into the same thing, or be alike. Every man comes into the world with a predisposition to grow along certain lines, and growth is easier for him along those lines than in any other way. This is a wise provision, for it gives endless variety. It is as if a gardener should throw all his bulbs into one basket; to the superficial observer they would look alike, but growth reveals a tremendous difference. So of men and women; they are like the basket of bulbs. One may be a rose and add brightness and color to some dark corner of the world; one may be a lily and teach a lesson of love and purity to every eye that sees; one may be a climbing vine and hide the rugged outlines of some dark rock; one may be a great oak among whose boughs the birds shall nest and sing, and beneath whose shade the flocks shall rest at noon, but every one will be something worth while, something rare, something perfect.

There are undreamed of possibilities in the common lives all around us; in a large sense, there are no "common" people. In times of national stress and peril the cracker-box loafer of the corner store and the village

drunkard become heroes and statesmen through the quickening of the Principle of Power within them. There is a genius in every man and woman, waiting to be brought forth. Every village has its great man or woman; some one to whom all go for advice in time of trouble; some one who is instinctively recognized as being great in wisdom and insight. To such a one the minds of the whole community turn in times of local crisis; he is tacitly recognized as being great. He does small things in a great way. He could do great things as well if he did but undertake them; so can any man; so can you. The Principle of Power gives us just what we ask of it; if we only undertake little things, it only gives us power for little things; but if we try to do great things in a great way it gives us all the power there is.

But beware of undertaking great things in a small way; of that we shall speak farther on.

There are two mental attitudes a man may take. One makes him like a football. It has resilience and reacts strongly when force is applied to it, but it originates nothing; it never acts of itself. There is no power within it. Men of this type are controlled by circumstances and environment; their destinies are decided by things external to themselves. The Principle of Power within them is never really active at all. They never speak or act from within. The other attitude makes man like a flowing spring. Power comes out from the center of him. He has within him a well of water springing up into everlasting life. He radiates force; he is felt by his environment. The Principle of Power in him is in constant action. He is self-active. "He hath life in himself."

No greater good can come to any man or woman than to become self-active. All the experiences of life are designed by Providence to force men and women into self-activity; to compel them to cease being creatures of circumstances and master their environment. In his lowest stage, man is the child of chance and circumstance and the slave of fear. His acts are all reactions resulting from the impingement upon him of forces in his environment. He acts only as he is acted upon; he originates

nothing. But the lowest savage has within him a Principle of Power sufficient to master all that he fears; and if he learns this and becomes self-active, he becomes as one of the gods.

The awakening of the Principle of Power in man is the real conversion; the passing from death to life. It is when the dead hear the voice of the Son of Man and come forth and live. It is the resurrection and the life. When it is awakened, man becomes a son of the Highest and all power is given to him in heaven and on earth.

Nothing was ever in any man that is not in you; no man ever had more spiritual or mental power than you can attain, or did greater things than you can accomplish. You can become what you want to be.



REFLECTION

Wattles opens with his central claim: every person carries a "Principle of Power," a capacity for conscious growth that, as far as anyone knows, has no fixed limit. Plants grow along set lines, he says, but people can choose the direction of their growth. He compares us to a basket of bulbs that look alike until they bloom: each grows into something different and worthwhile. He also describes two attitudes, the football that only reacts when kicked and the spring that flows from within. The hopeful core here is that there are no truly "common" people. Today we might call this a growth mindset joined to a sense of calling. Take it as encouragement to start, not as a promise that any one goal is guaranteed, and notice that his idea of greatness begins with small things done well.

PRACTICE

Write down one situation this week where you usually just react, like the football. Decide in advance one thing you will do there on your own initiative instead. Afterward, note in a sentence how acting from within felt different.

KEY THOUGHT

There is a genius in every man and woman, waiting to be brought forth.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

II

Heredity and Opportunity

YOU ARE not barred from attaining greatness by heredity. No matter who or what your ancestors may have been or how unlearned or lowly their station, the upward way is open for you. There is no such thing as inheriting a fixed mental position; no matter how small the mental capital we receive from our parents, it may be increased; no man is born incapable of growth.

Heredity counts for something. We are born with subconscious mental tendencies; as, for instance, a tendency to melancholy, or cowardice, or to ill-temper; but all these subconscious tendencies may be overcome. When the real man awakens and comes forth he can throw them off very easily. Nothing of this kind need keep you down; if you have inherited undesirable mental tendencies, you can eliminate them and put desirable tendencies in their places. An inherited mental trait is a habit of thought of your father or mother impressed upon your subconscious mind; you can substitute the opposite impression by forming the opposite habit of thought. You can substitute a habit of cheerfulness for a tendency to despondency; you can overcome cowardice or ill-temper.

Heredity may count for something, too, in an inherited conformation of the skull. There is something in phrenology, if not so

much as its exponents claim for it; it is true that the different faculties are localized in the brain, and that the power of a faculty depends upon the number of active brain cells in its area. A faculty whose brain area is large is likely to act with more power than one whose cranial section is small; hence persons with certain conformations of the skull show talent as musicians, orators, mechanics, and so on. It has been argued from this that a man's cranial formation must, to a great extent, decide his station in life, but this is an error. It has been found that a small brain section, with many fine and active cells, gives as powerful expression to faculty as a larger brain with coarser cells; and it has been found that by turning the Principle of Power into any section of the brain, with the will and purpose to develop a particular talent, the brain cells may be multiplied indefinitely. Any faculty, power, or talent you possess, no matter how small or rudimentary, may be increased; you can multiply the brain cells in this particular area until it acts as powerfully as you wish. It is true that you can act most easily through those faculties that are now most largely developed; you can do, with the least effort, the things which "come naturally"; but it is also true that if you will make the necessary effort you can develop any talent. You can do what you desire to do and become what you want to be. When you fix upon some ideal and proceed as hereinafter directed, all the power of your being is turned into the faculties required in the realization of that ideal; more blood and nerve force go to the corresponding sections of the brain, and the cells are quickened, increased, and multiplied in number. The proper use of the mind of man will build a brain capable of doing what the mind wants to do.

The brain does not make the man; the man makes the brain.

Your place in life is not fixed by heredity.

Nor are you condemned to the lower levels by circumstances or lack of opportunity. The Principle of Power in man is sufficient for all the requirements of his soul. No possible combination of circumstances can keep him down, if he makes his personal attitude right and determines to

rise. The power which formed man and purposed him for growth also controls the circumstances of society, industry, and government; and this power is never divided against itself. The power which is in you is in the things around you, and when you begin to move forward, the things will arrange themselves for your advantage, as described in later chapters of this book. Man was formed for growth, and all things external were designed to promote his growth. No sooner does a man awaken his soul and enter on the advancing way than he finds that not only is God for him, but nature, society, and his fellow men are for him also; and all things work together for his good if he obeys the law. Poverty is no bar to greatness, for poverty can always be removed. Martin Luther, as a child, sang in the streets for bread. Linnaeus the naturalist, had only forty dollars with which to educate himself; he mended his own shoes and often had to beg meals from his friends. Hugh Miller, apprenticed to a stone mason, began to study geology in a quarry. George Stephenson, inventor of the locomotive engine, and one of the greatest of civil engineers, was a coal miner, working in a mine, when he awakened and began to think. James Watt was a sickly child, and was not strong enough to be sent to school. Abraham Lincoln was a poor boy. In each of these cases we see a Principle of Power in the man which lifts him above all opposition and adversity.

There is a Principle of Power in you; if you use it and apply it in a certain way you can overcome all heredity, and master all circumstances and conditions and become a great and powerful personality.



REFLECTION

Here Wattles argues that neither family background nor poverty locks anyone into a fixed place. Inherited moods, he says, are habits of thought passed down, and new habits can replace them. He lists people who rose from hard beginnings, such as Lincoln and George Stephenson. Some of his support

comes from phrenology, the old belief that skull shape reveals talent, which science has since abandoned, though his conclusion that practice can change the brain sounds surprisingly modern. His claim that "poverty can always be removed" is more hopeful than realistic; many people face barriers that effort alone cannot clear, and that is not their fault. The lasting message is worth keeping: your starting point does not define your worth or your whole future, and growth remains possible at any stage.

PRACTICE

Name one trait you feel you "inherited," such as worry or a short temper. Choose its opposite and one tiny daily action that expresses it. Practice that action each day for a week and notice any change.

KEY THOUGHT

The brain does not make the man; the man makes the brain.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

III

The Source of Power

MAN'S BRAIN, body, mind, faculties, and talents are the mere instruments he uses in demonstrating greatness; in themselves they do not make him great. A man may have a large brain and a good mind, strong faculties, and brilliant talents, and yet he is not a great man unless he uses all these in a great way. That quality which enables man to use his abilities in a great way makes him great; and to that quality we give the name of wisdom. Wisdom is the essential basis of greatness.

Wisdom is the power to perceive the best ends to aim at and the best means for reaching those ends. It is the power to perceive the right thing to do. The man who is wise enough to know the right thing to do, who is good enough to wish to do only the right thing, and who is able and strong enough to do the right thing is a truly great man. He will instantly become marked as a personality of power in any community and men will delight to do him honor.

Wisdom is dependent upon knowledge. Where there is complete ignorance there can be no wisdom, no knowledge of the right thing to do. Man's knowledge is comparatively limited and so his wisdom must be small, unless he can connect his mind with a knowledge greater than his own and draw from it, by inspiration, the wisdom that his own limitations deny him. This he can do; this is what the really great men

and women have done. Man's knowledge is limited and uncertain; therefore he cannot have wisdom in himself.

Only God knows all truth; therefore only God can have real wisdom or know the right thing to do at all times, and man can receive wisdom from God. I proceed to give an illustration: Abraham Lincoln had limited education; but he had the power to perceive truth. In Lincoln we see pre-eminently apparent the fact that real wisdom consists in knowing the right thing to do at all times and under all circumstances; in having the will to do the right thing, and in having talent and ability enough to be competent and able to do the right thing. Back in the days of the abolition agitation, and during the compromise period, when all other men were more or less confused as to what was right or as to what ought to be done, Lincoln was never uncertain. He saw through the superficial arguments of the pro-slavery men; he saw, also, the impracticability and fanaticism of the abolitionists; he saw the right ends to aim at and he saw the best means to attain those ends. It was because men recognized that he perceived truth and knew the right thing to do that they made him president. Any man who develops the power to perceive truth, and who can show that he always knows the right thing to do and that he can be trusted to do the right thing, will be honored and advanced; the whole world is looking eagerly for such men.

When Lincoln became president he was surrounded by a multitude of so-called able advisers, hardly any two of whom were agreed. At times they were all opposed to his policies; at times almost the whole North was opposed to what he proposed to do. But he saw the truth when others were misled by appearances; his judgment was seldom or never wrong. He was at once the ablest statesman and the best soldier of the period. Where did he, a comparatively unlearned man, get this wisdom? It was not due to some peculiar formation of his skull or to some fineness of texture of his brain. It was not due to some physical characteristic. It was not even a quality of mind due to superior reasoning power. Knowledge of truth is not often reached by the

processes of reason. It was due to a spiritual insight. He perceived truth, but where did he perceive it and whence did the perception come? We see something similar in Washington, whose faith and courage, due to his perception of truth, held the colonies together during the long and often apparently hopeless struggle of the Revolution. We see something of the same thing in the phenomenal genius of Napoleon, who always knew, in military matters, the best means to adopt. We see that the greatness of Napoleon was in nature rather than in Napoleon, and we discover back of Washington and Lincoln something greater than either Washington or Lincoln. We see the same thing in all great men and women. They perceive truth; but truth cannot be perceived until it exists; and there can be no truth until there is a mind to perceive it. Truth does not exist apart from mind. Washington and Lincoln were in touch and communication with a mind which knew all knowledge and contained all truth. So of all who manifest wisdom.

Wisdom is obtained by reading the mind of God.

✦

REFLECTION

Talent and intelligence, Wattles says, are only tools. What makes someone great is wisdom: seeing the right goals, the right means, and having the will to act on them. Because human knowledge is limited, he believes real wisdom must come by inspiration from a greater Mind. His main example is Abraham Lincoln, a man with little schooling who, in Wattles' telling, saw clearly when others were confused. Historians would describe Lincoln with more nuance, but the point stands: good judgment is more than cleverness. Whether you think of wisdom as divine insight, deep reflection, or conscience, the chapter invites you to value knowing the right thing to do above being impressive.

That is a quiet but demanding standard, and one open to anyone, whatever their education.

PRACTICE

Think of a decision in front of you. Write three lines: the best goal you can see, the best means to reach it, and what would make you willing to act. Then sit quietly for five minutes and see whether anything becomes clearer.

KEY THOUGHT

Wisdom is obtained by reading the mind of God.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

IV

The Mind of God

THERE IS a Cosmic Intelligence which is in all things and through all things. This is the one real substance. From it all things proceed. It is Intelligent Substance or Mind Stuff. It is God. Where there is no substance there can be no intelligence; for where there is no substance there is nothing. Where there is thought there must be a substance which thinks. Thought cannot be function, for function is motion, and it is inconceivable that mere motion should think. Thought cannot be vibration, for vibration is motion, and that motion should be intelligent is not thinkable. Motion is nothing but the moving of substance; if there be intelligence shown it must be in the substance and not in the motion. Thought cannot be the result of motions in the brain; if thought is in the brain it must be in the brain's substance and not in the motions which brain substance makes.

But thought is not in the brain substance, for brain substance, without life, is quite unintelligent and dead. Thought is in the life-principle which animates the brain; in the spirit substance, which is the real man. The brain does not think, the man thinks and expresses his thought through the brain.

There is a spirit substance which thinks. Just as the spirit substance of man permeates his body, and thinks and knows in the body, so the

Original Spirit Substance, God, permeates all nature and thinks and knows in nature. Nature is as intelligent as man, and knows more than man; nature knows all things. The All-Mind has been in touch with all things from the beginning; and it contains all knowledge. Man's experience covers a few things, and these things man knows; but God's experience covers all the things that have happened since the creation, from the wreck of a planet or the passing of a comet to the fall of a sparrow. All that is and all that has been are present in the Intelligence which is wrapped about us and enfolds us and presses upon us from every side.

All the encyclopedias men have written are but trivial affairs compared to the vast knowledge held by the mind in which men live, move, and have their being.

The truths men perceive by inspiration are thoughts held in this mind. If they were not thoughts men could not perceive them, for they would have no existence; and they could not exist as thoughts unless there is a mind for them to exist in; and a mind can be nothing else than a substance which thinks.

Man is thinking substance, a portion of the Cosmic Substance; but man is limited, while the Cosmic Intelligence from which he sprang, which Jesus calls the Father, is unlimited. All intelligence, power, and force come from the Father. Jesus recognized this and stated it very plainly. Over and over again he ascribed all his wisdom and power to his unity with the Father, and to his perceiving the thoughts of God. "My Father and I are one." This was the foundation of his knowledge and power. He showed the people the necessity of becoming spiritually awakened; of hearing his voice and becoming like him. He compared the unthinking man who is the prey and sport of circumstances to the dead man in a tomb, and besought him to hear and come forth. "God is spirit," he said; "be born again, become spiritually awake, and you may see his kingdom. Hear my voice; see what I am and what I do, and come forth and live. The words I speak are spirit and life; accept them and they

will cause a well of water to spring up within you. Then you will have life within yourself."

"I do what I see the Father do," he said, meaning that he read the thoughts of God. "The Father showeth all things to the son." "If any man has the will to do the will of God, he shall know truth." "My teaching is not my own, but his that sent me." "You shall know the truth and the truth shall make you free." "The spirit shall guide you into all truth."

We are immersed in mind and that mind contains all knowledge and all truth. It is seeking to give us this knowledge, for our Father delights to give good gifts to his children. The prophets and seers and great men and women, past and present, were made great by what they received from God, not by what they were taught by men. This limitless reservoir of wisdom and power is open to you; you can draw upon it as you will, according to your needs. You can make yourself what you desire to be; you can do what you wish to do; you can have what you want. To accomplish this you must learn to become one with the Father so that you may perceive truth; so that you may have wisdom and know the right ends to seek and the right means to use to attain those ends, and so that you may secure power and ability to use the means. In closing this chapter resolve that you will now lay aside all else and concentrate upon the attainment of conscious unity with God.

"Oh, when I am safe in my sylvan home,
I tread on the pride of Greece and Rome;
And when I am stretched beneath the pines,
Where the evening star so holy shines,
I laugh at the lore and pride of man,
At the Sophist schools and the learned clan;
For what are they all in their high conceit,
When man in the bush with God may meet?"

REFLECTION

Wattles lays out the philosophy behind the book. There is one thinking Substance, which he calls God, present in all things and holding all knowledge. Thought, he argues, cannot be mere motion in the brain; it belongs to spirit. Human beings are part of this Substance but limited, so we must learn to draw on the greater Mind, as he believes Jesus did when he said that he and the Father were one. This is a form of monism, the view that all reality is one, and it differs from many traditional Christian teachings, so readers of faith may want to weigh it against their own beliefs. Even so, the chapter offers something many people seek today: a sense that we are not alone with our questions and that insight can come in stillness.

PRACTICE

Spend ten minutes outdoors or by a window without your phone. Hold one honest question in mind and simply wait. Write down whatever thought or feeling arrives, without judging it, and return to it tomorrow.

KEY THOUGHT

We are immersed in mind and that mind contains all knowledge and all truth.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

V

Preparation

"Draw nigh to God and He will draw nigh to you."

IF YOU become like God you can read his thoughts; and if you do not you will find the inspirational perception of truth impossible. You can never become a great man or woman until you have overcome anxiety, worry, and fear. It is impossible for an anxious person, a worried one, or a fearful one to perceive truth; all things are distorted and thrown out of their proper relations by such mental states, and those who are in them cannot read the thoughts of God.

If you are poor, or if you are anxious about business or financial matters, you are recommended to study carefully the first volume of this series, "The Science of Getting Rich." That will present to you a solution for your problems of this nature, no matter how large or how complicated they may seem to be. There is not the least cause for worry about financial affairs; every person who wills to do so may rise above want, have all he needs, and become rich. The same source upon which you propose to draw for mental unfoldment and spiritual power is at your service for the supply of all your material wants. Study this truth

until it is fixed in your thoughts and until anxiety is banished from your mind; enter the Certain Way, which leads to material riches.

Again, if you are anxious or worried about your health, realize it is possible for you to attain perfect health so that you may have strength sufficient for all that you wish to do and more. That Intelligence which stands ready to give you wealth and mental and spiritual power will rejoice to give you health also. Perfect health is yours for the asking, if you will only obey the simple laws of life and live aright. Conquer ill-health and cast out fear.

But it is not enough to rise above financial and physical anxiety and worry; you must rise above moral evil-doing as well. Sound your inner consciousness now for the motives which actuate you and make sure they are right. You must cast out lust, and cease to be ruled by appetite, and you must begin to govern appetite. You must eat only to satisfy hunger, never for gluttonous pleasure, and in all things you must make the flesh obey the spirit.

You must lay aside greed; have no unworthy motive in your desire to become rich and powerful. It is legitimate and right to desire riches, if you want them for the sake of the soul, but not if you desire them for the lusts of the flesh.

Cast out pride and vanity; have no thought of trying to rule over others or of outdoing them. This is a vital point; there is no temptation so insidious as the selfish desire to rule over others. Nothing so appeals to the average man or woman as to sit in the uppermost places at feasts, to be respectfully saluted in the market place, and to be called Rabbi, Master. To exercise some sort of control over others is the secret motive of every selfish person. The struggle for power over others is the battle of the competitive world, and you must rise above that world and its motives and aspirations and seek only for life. Cast out envy; you can have all that you want, and you need not envy any man what he has. Above all things, see to it that you do not hold malice or enmity toward any one; to do so cuts you off from the mind whose treasures you seek to

make your own. “He that loveth not his brother, loveth not God.” Lay aside all narrow personal ambition and determine to seek the highest good and to be swayed by no unworthy selfishness.

Go over all the foregoing and set these moral temptations out of your heart one by one; determine to keep them out. Then resolve that you will not only abandon all evil thought but that you will forsake all deeds, habits, and courses of action which do not commend themselves to your noblest ideals. This is supremely important; make this resolution with all the power of your soul, and you are ready for the next step toward greatness, which you will find explained in the following chapter.

✦

REFLECTION

Before anyone can perceive truth, Wattles says, they must clear out anxiety, worry, and fear, along with greed, pride, envy, and malice. He singles out the wish to rule over others as the most dangerous temptation of all. For money worries he points readers to The Science of Getting Rich, and he says perfect health is available to those who live rightly. Those promises go too far: anxiety about money or health is often a sensible response to real problems, and it may call for a budget, a doctor, or a counselor rather than willpower alone. The moral heart of the chapter is still strong. Honest motives, freedom from envy, and no wish to dominate anyone are a fine starting point for any kind of personal growth.

PRACTICE

List the motives behind one goal you are pursuing. Circle any that involve outdoing or controlling someone. Rewrite the goal so it rests only on growth or service. If worry feels overwhelming, consider talking to someone you trust or a professional.

KEY THOUGHT

You can never become a great man or woman until you have overcome anxiety, worry, and fear.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VI

The Social Point of View

"Without faith it is impossible to please God," and without faith it is impossible for you to become great. The distinguishing characteristic of all really great men and women is an unwavering faith. We see this in Lincoln during the dark days of the war; we see it in Washington at Valley Forge; we see it in Livingstone, the crippled missionary, threading the mazes of the dark continent, his soul aflame with the determination to let in the light upon the accursed slave trade, which his soul abhorred; we see it in Luther, and in Frances Willard, in every man and woman who has attained a place on the muster roll of the great ones of the world.

Faith—not a faith in one's self or in one's own powers but faith in principle; in the Something Great which upholds right, and which may be relied upon to give us the victory in due time. Without this faith it is not possible for any one to rise to real greatness. The man who has no faith in principle will always be a small man. Whether you have this faith or not depends upon your point of view. You must learn to see the world as being produced by evolution; as a something which is evolving and becoming, not as a finished work. Millions of years ago God worked with very low and crude forms of life; low and crude, yet each perfect after its kind. Higher and more complex organisms, animal and vegetable, appeared through the successive ages; the earth passed

through stage after stage in its unfoldment, each stage perfect in itself, and to be succeeded by a higher one. What I wish you to note is that the so-called "lower organisms" are as perfect after their kind as the higher ones; that the world in the Eocene period was perfect for that period; it was perfect, but God's work was not finished. This is true of the world to-day. Physically, socially, and industrially it is all good, and it is all perfect. It is not complete anywhere or in any part, but so far as the handiwork of God has gone it is perfect.

THIS MUST BE YOUR POINT OF VIEW: THAT THE WORLD AND ALL IT CONTAINS IS PERFECT, THOUGH NOT COMPLETED.

"All's right with the world." That is the great fact. There is nothing wrong with anything; there is nothing wrong with anybody. All the facts of life you must contemplate from this standpoint. There is nothing wrong with nature. Nature is a great advancing presence, working beneficently for the happiness of all. All things in Nature are good; she has no evil. She is not complete, for creation is still unfinished, but she is going on to give to man even more bountifully than she has given to him in the past. Nature is a partial expression of God, and God is love. She is perfect but not complete.

So of human society and government. What though there are trusts and combinations of capital and strikes and lockouts and so on. All these things are part of the forward movement; they are incidental to the evolutionary process of completing society. When it is complete there will be no more of these inharmonies; but it cannot be completed without them. J. P. Morgan is as necessary to the coming social order as the strange animals of the age of reptiles were to the life of the succeeding period, and just as these animals were perfect after their kind, so Morgan is perfect after his kind. Behold it is all very good. See society, government, and industry as being perfect now, and as advancing rapidly toward being complete; then you will understand that there is nothing to fear, no cause for anxiety, nothing to worry about. Never complain of

any of these things. They are perfect; this is the very best possible world for the stage of development man has reached.

This will sound like rank folly to many, perhaps to most people. "What!" they will say, "are not child labor and the exploitation of men and women in filthy and unsanitary factories evil things? Are not saloons evil? Do you mean to say that we shall accept all these and call them good?"

Child labor and similar things are no more evil than the way of living and the habits and practices of the cave dweller were evil. His ways were those of the savage stage of man's growth, and for that stage they were perfect. Our industrial practices are those of the savage stage of industrial development, and they are also perfect. Nothing better is possible until we cease to be mental savages in industry and business, and become men and women. This can only come about by the rise of the whole race to a higher viewpoint. And this can only come about by the rise of such individuals here and there as are ready for the higher viewpoint. The cure for all these inharmonies lies not with the masters or employers but with the workers themselves. Whenever they reach a higher viewpoint, whenever they shall desire to do so, they can establish complete brotherhood and harmony in industry; they have the numbers and the power. They are getting now what they desire. Whenever they desire more in the way of a higher, purer, more harmonious life, they will receive more. True, they want more now, but they only want more of the things that make for animal enjoyment, and so industry remains in the savage, brutal, animal stage; when the workers begin to rise to the mental plane of living and ask for more of the things that make for the life of the mind and soul, industry will at once be raised above the plane of savagery and brutality. But it is perfect now upon its plane; behold, it is all very good.

So of saloons and dens of vice. If a majority of the people desire these things, it is right and necessary that they should have them. When a majority desire a world without such discords, they will create such a

world. So long as men and women are on the plane of bestial thought, so long the social order will be in part disorder, and will show bestial manifestations. The people make society what it is, and as the people rise above the bestial thought, society will rise above the beastly in its manifestations. But a society which thinks in a bestial way must have saloons and dives; it is perfect after its kind, as the world was in the Eocene period, and very good.

All this does not prevent you from working for better things. You can work to complete an unfinished society, instead of to renovate a decaying one; and you can work with a better heart and a more hopeful spirit. It will make an immense difference with your faith and spirit whether you look upon civilization as a good thing which is becoming better or as a bad and evil thing which is decaying. One viewpoint gives you an advancing and expanding mind and the other gives you a descending and decreasing mind. One viewpoint will make you grow greater and the other will inevitably cause you to grow smaller. One will enable you to work for the eternal things; to do large works in a great way toward the completing of all that is incomplete and inharmonious; and the other will make you a mere patchwork reformer, working almost without hope to save a few lost souls from what you will grow to consider a lost and doomed world. So you see it makes a vast difference to you, this matter of the social viewpoint. "All's right with the world. Nothing can possibly be wrong but my personal attitude, and I will make that right. I will see the facts of nature and all the events, circumstances, and conditions of society, politics, government, and industry from the highest viewpoint. It is all perfect, though incomplete. It is all the handiwork of God; behold, it is all very good."

REFLECTION

Wattles asks readers to see the world as unfinished rather than broken: "perfect, though not completed," like Earth in an earlier geological age. He pushes this so far that he calls child labor and exploitation "perfect" for the present stage of development, and he says the cure lies with the workers themselves. Modern readers will rightly object. Calling injustice a natural phase can excuse harm, and suffering people are not to blame for the systems they live under. Yet his deeper purpose is psychological. He wants reformers to work from hope instead of despair, building a better society rather than mourning a doomed one. You can keep that hopeful energy while still naming wrongs clearly. Some phrases here, such as "dark continent" and "savage," belong to his era.

PRACTICE

Pick one social problem you care about. Write one sentence describing it as a loss and one describing it as unfinished work. Then choose a small, hopeful action, such as donating, volunteering, or learning more, and do it this week.

KEY THOUGHT

It will make an immense difference with your faith and spirit whether you look upon civilization as a good thing which is becoming better or as a bad and evil thing which is decaying.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VII

The Individual Point of View

IMPORTANT as the matter of your point of view for the facts of social life is, it is of less moment than your viewpoint for your fellow men, for your acquaintances, friends, relatives, your immediate family, and, most of all, yourself. You must learn not to look upon the world as a lost and decaying thing but as a something perfect and glorious which is going on to a most beautiful completeness; and you must learn to see men and women not as lost and accursed things, but as perfect beings advancing to become complete. There are no "bad" or "evil" people. An engine which is on the rails pulling a heavy train is perfect after its kind, and it is good. The power of steam which drives it is good. Let a broken rail throw the engine into the ditch, and it does not become bad or evil by being so displaced; it is a perfectly good engine, but off the track. The power of steam which drives it into the ditch and wrecks it is not evil, but a perfectly good power. So that which is misplaced or applied in an incomplete or partial way is not evil. There are no evil people; there are perfectly good people who are off the track, but they do not need condemnation or punishment; they only need to get upon the rails again.

That which is undeveloped or incomplete often appears to us as evil because of the way we have trained ourselves to think. The root of a bulb

which shall produce a white lily is an unsightly thing; one might look upon it with disgust. But how foolish we should be to condemn the bulb for its appearance when we know the lily is within it. The root is perfect after its kind; it is a perfect but incomplete lily, and so we must learn to look upon every man and woman, no matter how unlovely in outward manifestation; they are perfect in their stage of being and they are becoming complete. Behold, it is all very good.

Once we come into a comprehension of this fact and arrive at this point of view, we lose all desire to find fault with people, to judge them, criticise them, or condemn them. We no longer work as those who are saving lost souls, but as those who are among the angels, working out the completion of a glorious heaven. We are born of the spirit and we see the kingdom of God. We no longer see men as trees walking, but our vision is complete. We have nothing but good words to say. It is all good; a great and glorious humanity coming to completeness. And in our association with men this puts us into an expansive and enlarging attitude of mind; we see them as great beings and we begin to deal with them and their affairs in a great way. But if we fall to the other point of view and see a lost and degenerate race we shrink into the contracting mind; and our dealings with men and their affairs will be in a small and contracted way. Remember to hold steadily to this point of view; if you do you cannot fail to begin at once to deal with your acquaintances and neighbors and with your own family as a great personality deals with men. This same viewpoint must be the one from which you regard yourself. You must always see yourself as a great advancing soul. Learn to say: "There is THAT in me of which I am made, which knows no imperfection, weakness, or sickness. The world is incomplete, *but God in my own consciousness is both perfect and complete.* Nothing can be wrong but my own personal attitude, and my own personal attitude can be wrong only when I disobey THAT which is within. I am a perfect manifestation of God so far as I have gone, and I will press on to be complete. I will trust and not be afraid." When you are able to say this

understandingly you will have lost all fear and you will be far advanced upon the road to the development of a great and powerful personality.

✦

REFLECTION

The same viewpoint now turns toward people. Wattles insists there are no evil people, only good ones "off the track," like a sound locomotive thrown into a ditch by a broken rail. A lily bulb looks ugly, but the flower is already inside. Seeing others this way, he says, ends our urge to judge and condemn, and it lets us deal with everyone generously. He applies the same view to ourselves: we are growing souls, not failures. This is a kind and freeing idea. It does not mean excusing harm or staying close to someone who hurts you; you can believe in a person's potential and still keep firm boundaries. What it offers is release from constant fault-finding, which often wears down the one doing the judging most of all.

PRACTICE

Choose someone who irritates you. Write down three good qualities they have, however small. The next time you meet, let one of those qualities guide how you speak to them, while still keeping any boundaries you need.

KEY THOUGHT

There are no evil people; there are perfectly good people who are off the track, but they do not need condemnation or punishment; they only need to get upon the rails again.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VIII

Consecration

HAVING ATTAINED to the viewpoint which puts you into the right relations with the world and with your fellow men, the next step is consecration; and consecration in its true sense simply means obedience to the soul. You have that within you which is ever impelling you toward the upward and advancing way; and that impelling something is the divine Principle of Power; you must obey it without question. No one will deny the statement that if you are to be great, the greatness must be a manifestation of something within; nor can you question that this something must be the very greatest and highest that is within. It is not the mind, or the intellect, or the reason. You cannot be great if you go no farther back for principle than to your reasoning power. Reason knows neither principle nor morality. Your reason is like a lawyer in that it will argue for either side. The intellect of a thief will plan robbery and murder as readily as the intellect of a saint will plan a great philanthropy. Intellect helps us to see the best means and manner of doing the right thing, but intellect never shows us the right thing. Intellect and reason serve the selfish man for his selfish ends as readily as they serve the unselfish man for his unselfish ends. Use intellect and reason without regard to principle, and you may become known as a very able person, but you will never become known as a person whose

life shows the power of real greatness. There is too much training of the intellect and reasoning powers and too little training in obedience to the soul. This is the only thing that can be wrong with your personal attitude—when it fails to be one of obedience to the Principle of Power.

By going back to your own center you can always find the pure idea of right for every relationship. To be great and to have power it is only necessary to conform your life to the pure idea as you find it in the GREAT WITHIN. Every compromise on this point is made at the expense of a loss of power. This you *must* remember.

There are many ideas in your mind which you have outgrown, and which, from force of habit, you still permit to dictate the actions of your life. Cease all this; abandon everything you have outgrown. There are many ignoble customs, social and other, which you still follow, although you know they tend to dwarf and belittle you and keep you acting in a small way. Rise above all this. I do not say that you should absolutely disregard conventionalities, or the commonly accepted standards of right and wrong. You cannot do this; but you can deliver your soul from most of the narrow restrictions which bind the majority of your fellow men. Do not give your time and strength to the support of obsolete institutions, religious or otherwise; do not be bound by creeds in which you do not believe. Be free. You have perhaps formed some sensual habits of mind or body; abandon them. You still indulge in distrustful fears that things will go wrong, or that people will betray you, or mistreat you; get above all of them. You still act selfishly in many ways and on many occasions; cease to do so. Abandon all these, and in place of them put the best actions you can form a conception of in your mind. If you desire to advance, and you are not doing so, remember that it can be only because your thought is better than your practice. You must do as well as you think.

Let your thoughts be ruled by principle, and then live up to your thoughts.

Let your attitude in business, in politics, in neighborhood affairs, and in your own home be the expression of the best thoughts you can think. Let your manner toward all men and women, great and small, and especially to your own family circle, always be the most kindly, gracious, and courteous you can picture in your imagination. Remember your viewpoint; you are a god in the company of gods and must conduct yourself accordingly.

The steps to complete consecration are few and simple. You cannot be ruled from below if you are to be great; you must rule from above. Therefore you cannot be governed by physical impulses; you must bring your body into subjection to the mind; but your mind, without principle, may lead you into selfishness and immoral ways; you must put the mind into subjection to the soul, and your soul is limited by the boundaries of your knowledge; you must put it into subjection to that Oversoul which needeth no searching of the understanding but before whose eye all things are spread. That constitutes consecration. Say: "I surrender my body to be ruled by my mind; I surrender my mind to be governed by my soul, and I surrender my soul to the guidance of God." Make this consecration complete and thorough, and you have taken the second great step in the way of greatness and power.



REFLECTION

For Wattles, consecration simply means obeying your soul, the deepest sense of right within you. Reason alone cannot guide us, he notes, because like a lawyer it will argue for either side. So he asks readers to drop outgrown habits, empty customs, and beliefs they no longer hold, and to replace them with the best actions they can imagine. He gives a simple chain of command: body ruled by mind, mind by soul, soul by God. The most practical line in the chapter is that if you are not advancing, your thought is better than your practice. Most of us

know more about living well than we actually do. The invitation is to close that gap, beginning with kindness and courtesy at home, where it is often hardest.

PRACTICE

Write down one thing you know you should be doing but are not, such as a phone call, an apology, or a healthier habit. Do the smallest version of it today. Tonight, note whether your actions matched your best thoughts.

KEY THOUGHT

Let your thoughts be ruled by principle,
and then live up to your thoughts.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

IX

Identification

HAVING RECOGNIZED God as the advancing presence in nature, society, and your fellow men, and harmonized yourself with all these, and having consecrated yourself to that within you which impels toward the greatest and the highest, the next step is to become aware of and recognize fully the fact that the Principle of Power within you is God Himself. You must consciously identify yourself with the Highest. This is not some false or untrue position to be assumed; it is a fact to be recognized. You are already one with God; you want to become consciously aware of it.

There is one substance, the source of all things, and this substance has within itself the power which creates all things; all power is inherent in it. This substance is conscious and thinks; it works with perfect understanding and intelligence. You know that this is so, because you know that substance exists and that consciousness exists; and that it must be substance which is conscious. Man is conscious and thinks; man is substance. He must be substance, else he is nothing and does not exist at all. If man is substance and thinks, and is conscious, then he is Conscious Substance. It is not conceivable that there should be more than one Conscious Substance; so man is the original substance, the source of all life and power embodied in a physical form. Man cannot be

something different from God. Intelligence is one and the same everywhere, and must be everywhere an attribute of the same substance. There cannot be one kind of intelligence in God and another kind of intelligence in man; intelligence can only be in intelligent substance, and Intelligent Substance is God. Man is of one stuff with God, and so all the talents, powers, and possibilities that are in God are in man; not in a few exceptional men but in every man. "All power is given to man, in heaven and on earth." "Is it not written, ye are gods?" The Principle of Power in man is man himself, and man himself is God. But while man is original substance, and has within him all power and possibilities, his consciousness is limited. He does not know all there is to know, and so he is liable to error and mistake. To save himself from these he must unite his mind to That outside him which does know all; he must become consciously one with God. There is a Mind surrounding him on every side, closer than breathing, nearer than hands and feet, and in this mind is the memory of all that has ever happened, from the greatest convulsions of nature in prehistoric days to the fall of a sparrow in this present time; and all that is in existence now as well. Held in this Mind is the great purpose which is behind all nature, and so it knows what is going to be. Man is surrounded by a Mind which knows all there is to know, past, present, and to come. Everything that men have said or done or written is present there. Man is of one identical stuff with this Mind; he proceeded from it; and he can so identify himself with it that he may know what it knows. "My Father is greater than I," said Jesus, "I come from him." "I and my Father are one. He showeth the son all things." "The spirit shall guide you into all truth."

Your identification of yourself with the Infinite must be accomplished by conscious recognition on your part. Recognizing it as a fact, that there is only God, and that all intelligence is in the one substance, you must affirm somewhat after this wise: "There is only one and that one is everywhere. I surrender myself to conscious unity with the highest. Not I, but the Father. I will to be one with the Supreme and

to lead the divine life. I am one with infinite consciousness; there is but one mind, and I am that mind. I that speak unto you am he."

If you have been thorough in the work as outlined in the preceding chapters; if you have attained to the true viewpoint, and if your consecration is complete, you will not find conscious identification hard to attain; and once it is attained, the power you seek is yours, for you have made yourself one with all the power there is.

✦

REFLECTION

This chapter takes the boldest step. If everything is made of one conscious Substance, Wattles reasons, then human intelligence and God's intelligence are the same in kind, and the power within you is God. The task is not to become one with God but to realize you already are. He offers an affirmation of surrender and unity. This view goes beyond mainstream Christian theology, and many believers will see real differences, so it is fair to read it as Wattles' personal philosophy. For readers of any background, there is still something steadying here: the sense of belonging to something larger than your worries. Note too that he follows identification with humility, not pride. Being one with the whole means everyone else is part of it as well.

PRACTICE

Sit quietly for five minutes. Breathe slowly and, in your own words, name the larger reality you belong to, whether God, nature, or humanity. Notice how your current worry looks when held against that larger background.

KEY THOUGHT

You are already one with God; you want to become consciously aware of it.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

X

Idealization

YOU ARE a thinking center in original substance, and the thoughts of original substance have creative power; whatever is formed in its thought and held as a thought-form must come into existence as a visible and so-called material form, and a thought-form held in thinking substance is a reality; it is a real thing, whether it has yet become visible to mortal eye or not. This is a fact that you should impress upon your understanding—that a thought held in thinking substance is a real thing; a form, and has actual existence, although it is not visible to you. You internally take the form in which you think of yourself; and you surround yourself with the invisible forms of those things with which you associate in your thoughts.

If you desire a thing, picture it clearly and hold the picture steadily in mind until it becomes a definite thought-form; and if your practices are not such as to separate you from God, the thing you want will come to you in material form. It must do so in obedience to the law by which the universe was created.

Make no thought-form of yourself in connection with disease or sickness, but form a conception of health. Make a thought-form of yourself as strong and hearty and perfectly well; impress this thought-form on creative intelligence, and if your practices are not in violation of

the laws by which the physical body is built, your thought-form will become manifest in your flesh. This also is certain; it comes by obedience to law.

Make a thought-form of yourself as you desire to be, and set your ideal as near to perfection as your imagination is capable of forming the conception. Let me illustrate: If a young law student wishes to become great, let him picture himself (while attending to the viewpoint, consecration, and identification, as previously directed) as a great lawyer, pleading his case with matchless eloquence and power before the judge and jury; as having an unlimited command of truth, of knowledge, and of wisdom. Let him picture himself as the great lawyer in every possible situation and contingency; while he is still only the student in all circumstances, let him never forget or fail to be the great lawyer in his thought-form of himself. As the thought-form grows more definite and habitual in his mind, the creative energies, both within and without, are set at work. He begins to manifest the form from within; and all the essentials without, which go into the picture, begin to be impelled toward him. He makes himself into the image and God works with him; nothing can prevent him from becoming what he wishes to be.

In the same general way the musical student pictures himself as performing perfect harmonies, and as delighting vast audiences; the actor forms the highest conception he is capable of in regard to his art, and applies this conception to himself. The farmer and the mechanic do exactly the same thing. Fix upon your ideal of what you wish to make of yourself; consider well and be sure that you make the right choice; that is, the one which will be the most satisfactory to you in a general way. Do not pay too much attention to the advice or suggestions of those around you; do not believe that any one can know, better than yourself, what is right for you. Listen to what others have to say, but always form your own conclusions. DO NOT LET OTHER PEOPLE DECIDE WHAT YOU ARE TO BE. BE WHAT YOU FEEL THAT YOU WANT TO BE.

Do not be misled by a false notion of obligation or duty. You can owe no possible obligation or duty to others which should prevent you from making the most of yourself. Be true to yourself, and you cannot then be false to any man. When you have fully decided what thing you want to be, form the highest conception of that thing that you are capable of imagining, and make that conception a thought-form. Hold that thought-form as a fact, as the real truth about yourself, and believe in it.

Close your ears to all adverse suggestions. Never mind if people call you a fool and a dreamer. Dream on. Remember that Bonaparte, the half-starved lieutenant, always saw himself as the general of armies and the master of France, and he became in outward realization what he held himself to be in mind. So likewise will you. Attend carefully to all that has been said in the preceding chapters, and act as directed in the following ones, and you will become what you want to be.

REFLECTION

Wattles teaches that thoughts held steadily in the creative Substance take real form, so you should picture yourself as you want to be, at the highest level you can imagine. A law student should see himself as a great lawyer; a musician, a farmer, or a mechanic should do the same. He urges readers to choose their own path and not let others decide it. Clear vision does help: it focuses attention and motivates practice. But a picture held in mind does not guarantee results, and his claim that the wanted thing "must" come should be read as his belief, not a law. Choosing for yourself is wise, though listening to people who love you still has value. Treat the vision as a compass, not a contract.

PRACTICE

Write a short paragraph describing yourself five years from now at your best in one area of life. Read it each morning for a week. Then add one concrete step you could take toward it this month.

KEY THOUGHT

DO NOT LET OTHER PEOPLE DECIDE WHAT YOU ARE TO BE.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XI

Realization

IF YOU were to stop with the close of the last chapter, however, you would never become great; you would be indeed a mere dreamer of dreams, a castle-builder. Too many do stop there; they do not understand the necessity for present action in realizing the vision and bringing the thought-form into manifestation. Two things are necessary. First, the making of the thought-form, and, second, the actual appropriation to yourself of all that goes into and around the thought-form. We have discussed the first, now we will proceed to give directions for the second. When you have made your thought-form, you are already, in your interior, what you want to be; next you must become externally what you want to be. You are already great within, but you are not yet doing the great things without. You cannot begin, on the instant, to do the great things; you cannot be before the world the great actor, or lawyer, or musician, or personality you know yourself to be; no one will intrust great things to you as yet for you have not made yourself known. But you can always begin to do small things in a great way.

Here lies the whole secret. You can begin to be great to-day in your own home, in your store or office, on the street, everywhere; you can begin to make yourself known as great, and you can do this by doing everything you do in a great way. You must put the whole power of your

great soul into every act, however small and commonplace, and so reveal to your family, your friends, and neighbors what you really are. Do not brag or boast of yourself; do not go about telling people what a great personage you are; simply live in a great way. No one will believe you if you tell him you are a great man, but no one can doubt your greatness if you show it in your actions. In your domestic circle be so just, so generous, so courteous, and kindly that your family, your wife, husband, children, brothers, and sisters shall know that you are a great and noble soul. In all your relations with men be great, just, generous, courteous, and kindly. The great are never otherwise. This for your attitude.

Next, and most important, you must have absolute faith in your own perceptions of truth. Never act in haste or hurry; be deliberate in everything; wait until you feel that you know the true way. And when you do feel that you know the true way, be guided by your own faith though all the world shall disagree with you. If you do not believe what God tells you in little things, you will never draw upon his wisdom and knowledge in larger things. When you feel deeply that a certain act is the right act, do it and have perfect faith that the consequences will be good. When you are deeply impressed that a certain thing is true, no matter what the appearances to the contrary may be, accept that thing as true and act accordingly. The one way to develop a perception of truth in large things is to trust absolutely to your present perception of truth in small things. Remember that you are seeking to develop this very power or faculty—the perception of truth; you are learning to read the thoughts of God. Nothing is great and nothing is small in the sight of Omnipotence; he holds the sun in its place, but he also notes a sparrow's fall, and numbers the hairs of your head. God is as much interested in the little matters of everyday life as he is in the affairs of nations. You can perceive truth about family and neighborhood affairs as well as about matters of statecraft. And the way to begin is to have perfect faith in the truth in these small matters, as it is revealed to you from day to day.

When you feel deeply impelled to take a course which seems contrary to all reason and worldly judgment, take that course. Listen to the suggestions and advice of others, but always do what you feel deeply in the within to be the true thing to do. Rely with absolute faith, at all times, on your own perception of truth; but be sure that you listen to God—that you do not act in haste, fear, or anxiety.

Rely upon your perception of truth in all the facts and circumstances of life. If you deeply feel that a certain man will be in a certain place on a certain day, go there with perfect faith to meet him; he will be there, no matter how unlikely it may seem. If you feel sure that certain people are making certain combinations, or doing certain things, act in the faith that they are doing those things. If you feel sure of the truth of any circumstance or happening, near or distant, past, present, or to come, trust in your perception. You may make occasional mistakes at first because of your imperfect understanding of the within; but you will soon be guided almost invariably right. Soon your family and friends will begin to defer, more and more, to your judgment and to be guided by you. Soon your neighbors and townsmen will be coming to you for counsel and advice; soon you will be recognized as one who is great in small things, and you will be called upon more and more to take charge of larger things. All that is necessary is to be guided absolutely, in all things, by your inner light, your perception of truth. Obey your soul, have perfect faith in yourself. Never think of yourself with doubt or distrust, or as one who makes mistakes. "If I judge, my judgment is just, for I seek not honor from men, but from the Father only."

REFLECTION

A vision alone makes you a dreamer, Wattles warns. The next step is to act, and since no one will hand you great tasks yet, you start by doing small things in a great way: with full attention, fairness, generosity, and kindness at home and at

work. He also asks readers to trust their own inner perception of truth, even against appearances or advice. That part needs balance. Intuition can be valuable, but it can also be wrong, and he admits early mistakes will happen. For important decisions about money, health, or safety, test your inner sense against facts and trusted counsel. The lasting gift of the chapter is its focus on everyday conduct, because character is shown in ordinary moments long before any big opportunity arrives.

PRACTICE

Choose one routine task today, such as washing dishes, answering an email, or helping a coworker. Do it as carefully and generously as you possibly can. Afterward, write one sentence about what "doing it in a great way" meant in practice.

KEY THOUGHT

But you can always begin to do small things in a great way.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XII

Hurry and Habit

NO DOUBT you have many problems, domestic, social, physical, and financial, which seem to you to be pressing for instant solution. You have debts which must be paid, or other obligations which must be met; you are unhappily or inharmoniously placed, and feel that something must be done at once. Do not get into a hurry and act from superficial impulses. You can trust God for the solution of all your personal riddles. There is no hurry. There is only God, and all is well with the world.

There is an invincible power in you, and the same power is in the things you want. It is bringing them to you and bringing you to them. This is a thought that you must grasp, and hold continuously—that the same intelligence which is in you is in the things you desire. They are impelled toward you as strongly and decidedly as your desire impels you toward them. The tendency, therefore, of a steadily held thought must be to bring the things you desire to you and to group them around you. So long as you hold your thought and your faith right all must go well. *Nothing can be wrong but your own personal attitude, and that will not be wrong if you trust and are not afraid.* Hurry is a manifestation of fear; he who fears not has plenty of time. If you act with perfect faith in your own perceptions of truth, you will never be too late or too early; and

nothing will go wrong. If things appear to be going wrong, do not get disturbed in mind; it is only in appearance. Nothing can go wrong in this world but yourself; and you can go wrong only by getting into the wrong mental attitude. Whenever you find yourself getting excited, worried, or into the mental attitude of hurry, sit down and think it over; play a game of some kind, or take a vacation. Go on a trip, and all will be right when you return. So surely as you find yourself in the mental attitude of haste, just so surely may you know that you are out of the mental attitude of greatness. Hurry and fear will instantly cut your connection with the universal mind; you will get no power, no wisdom, and no information until you are calm. And to fall into the attitude of hurry will check the action of the Principle of Power within you. Fear turns strength to weakness.

Remember that poise and power are inseparably associated. The calm and balanced mind is the strong and great mind; the hurried and agitated mind is the weak one. Whenever you fall into the mental state of hurry you may know that you have lost the right viewpoint; you are beginning to look upon the world, or some part of it, as going wrong. At such times read Chapter Six of this book; consider the fact that this world is perfect, now, with all that it contains. Nothing is going wrong; nothing can be wrong; be poised, be calm, be cheerful; have faith in God.

Next, as to habit. It is probable that your greatest difficulty will be to overcome your old habitual ways of thought, and to form new habits. The world is ruled by habit. Kings, tyrants, masters, and plutocrats hold their positions solely because the people have come to habitually accept them. Things are as they are only because people have formed the habit of accepting them as they are. When the people change their habitual thought about governmental, social, and industrial institutions, they will change the institutions. Habit rules us all.

You have formed, perhaps, the habit of thinking of yourself as a common person, as one of a limited ability, or as being more or less of a failure. Whatever you habitually think yourself to be, that you are. You

must form, now, a greater and better habit; you must form a conception of yourself as a being of limitless power, and habitually think that you are that being. It is the habitual, not the periodical thought that decides your destiny. It will avail you nothing to sit apart for a few moments several times a day to affirm that you are great, if during all the balance of the day, while you are about your regular vocation, you think of yourself as not great. No amount of praying or affirmation will make you great if you still habitually regard yourself as being small.

The use of prayer and affirmation is to change your habit of thought. Any act, mental or physical, often repeated, becomes a habit. The purpose of mental exercises is to repeat certain thoughts over and over until the thinking of those thoughts becomes constant and habitual. The thoughts we continually repeat become convictions. What you must do is to repeat the new thought of yourself until it is the only way in which you think of yourself. Habitual thought, and not environment or circumstance, has made you what you are. Every person has some central idea or thought-form of himself, and by this idea he classifies and arranges all his facts and external relationships. You are classifying your facts either according to the idea that you are a great and strong personality, or according to the idea that you are limited, common, or weak. If the latter is the case you must change your central idea. Get a new mental picture of yourself. Do not try to become great by repeating mere strings of words or superficial formulæ; but repeat over and over the THOUGHT of your own power and ability until you classify external facts, and decide your place everywhere by this idea. In another chapter will be found an illustrative mental exercise and further directions on this point.

REFLECTION

Wattles treats hurry as a form of fear. When we rush, he says, we lose poise and the clear thinking that comes with it, so the remedy is to stop, rest, or even take a break until calm returns. He then turns to habit: what you habitually think about yourself shapes your life far more than a few minutes of affirmation each day. Both ideas hold up well. Calm decisions are usually better ones, and lasting change comes from repeated patterns of thought and action. One caution: he tells readers with debts and pressing problems that "there is no hurry." Calm is wise, but bills, legal deadlines, and health concerns still need timely, practical attention. Seeking advice early is part of acting with poise, not a lack of faith.

PRACTICE

When you next feel rushed, pause for ten slow breaths before acting. Then write one sentence about yourself that you want to become a habit, and repeat it whenever you notice an old, limiting self-description.

KEY THOUGHT

Hurry is a manifestation of fear;
he who fears not has plenty of time.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XIII

Thought

GREATNESS is attained only by the thinking of great thoughts. No man can become great in outward personality until he is great internally; and no man can be great internally until he THINKS. No amount of education, reading, or study can make you great without thought; but thought can make you great with very little study. There are altogether too many people who are trying to make something of themselves by reading books without thinking; all such will fail. You are not mentally developed by what you read, but by what you think about what you read.

Thinking is the hardest and most exhausting of all labor; and hence many people shrink from it. God has so formed us that we are continuously impelled to thought; we must either think or engage in some activity to escape thought. The headlong, continuous chase for pleasure in which most people spend all their leisure time is only an effort to escape thought. If they are alone, or if they have nothing amusing to take their attention, as a novel to read or a show to see, they must think; and to escape from thinking they resort to novels, shows, and all the endless devices of the purveyors of amusement. Most people spend the greater part of their leisure time running away from thought,

hence they are where they are. We never move forward until we begin to think.

Read less and think more. Read about great things and think about great questions and issues. We have at the present time few really great figures in the political life of our country; our politicians are a petty lot. There is no Lincoln, no Webster, no Clay, Calhoun, or Jackson. Why? Because our present statesmen deal only with sordid and petty issues—questions of dollars and cents, of expediency and party success, of material prosperity without regard to ethical right. Thinking along these lines does not call forth great souls. The statesmen of Lincoln's time and previous times dealt with questions of eternal truth; of human rights and justice. Men thought upon great themes; they thought great thoughts, and they became great men.

Thinking, not mere knowledge or information, makes personality. Thinking is growth; you cannot think without growing. Every thought engenders another thought. Write one idea and others will follow until you have written a page. You cannot fathom your own mind; it has neither bottom nor boundaries. Your first thoughts may be crude; but as you go on thinking you will use more and more of yourself; you will quicken new brain cells into activity and you will develop new faculties. Heredity, environment, circumstances,—all things must give way before you if you practice sustained and continuous thought. But, on the other hand, if you neglect to think for yourself and only use other people's thought, you will never know what you are capable of; and you will end by being incapable of anything.

There can be no real greatness without original thought. All that a man does outwardly is the expression and completion of his inward thinking. No action is possible without thought, and no great action is possible until a great thought has preceded it. Action is the second form of thought, and personality is the materialization of thought. Environment is the result of thought; things group themselves or arrange themselves around you according to your thought. There is, as

Emerson says, some central idea or conception of yourself by which all the facts of your life are arranged and classified. Change this central idea and you change the arrangement or classification of all the facts and circumstances of your life. You are what you are because you think as you do; you are where you are because you think as you do.

You see then the immense importance of thinking about the great essentials set forth in the preceding chapters. You must not accept them in any superficial way; you must think about them until they are a part of your central idea. Go back to the matter of the point of view and consider, in all its bearings, the tremendous thought that you live in a perfect world among perfect people, and that nothing can possibly be wrong with you but your own personal attitude. Think about all this until you fully realize all that it means to you. Consider that this is God's world and that it is the best of all possible worlds; that He has brought it thus far toward completion by the processes of organic, social, and industrial evolution, and that it is going on to greater completeness and harmony. Consider that there is one great, perfect, intelligent Principle of Life and Power, causing all the changing phenomena of the cosmos. Think about all this until you see that it is true, and until you comprehend how you should live and act as a citizen of such a perfect whole.

Next, think of the wonderful truth that this great Intelligence is in you; it is your own intelligence. It is an Inner Light impelling you toward the right thing and the best thing, the greatest act, and the highest happiness. It is a Principle of Power in you, giving you all the ability and genius there is. It will infallibly guide you to the best if you will submit to it and walk in the light. Consider what is meant by your consecration of yourself when you say: "I will obey my soul." This is a sentence of tremendous meaning; it must revolutionize the attitude and behavior of the average person.

Then think of your identification with this Great Supreme; that all its knowledge is yours, and all its wisdom is yours, for the asking. You are a

god if you think like a god. If you think like a god you cannot fail to act like a god. Divine thoughts will surely externalize themselves in a divine life. Thoughts of power will end in a life of power. Great thoughts will manifest in a great personality. Think well of all this, and then you are ready to act.

REFLECTION

Greatness, Wattles says, comes only from thinking great thoughts, and real thinking is hard work. He believes many people chase entertainment mainly to avoid it. Reading without reflection achieves little; what matters is what you think about what you read. He contrasts the statesmen of Lincoln's day, who wrestled with justice and human rights, with the politicians of his own time, who debated mostly money and party advantage. In an age of endless feeds and quick takes, this chapter feels especially current. The practical lesson is to read less and reflect more, and to give your attention to questions that matter. He then asks readers to think deeply about his earlier steps until they become part of their central idea of themselves.

PRACTICE

Take one idea from something you read this week. Set a timer for fifteen minutes and write about it without stopping: do you agree, why, and what would change if you acted on it? Keep the page.

KEY THOUGHT

You are not mentally developed by what you read,
but by what you think about what you read.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XIV

Action at Home

DO NOT merely think that you are going to become great; think *that you are great now.* Do not think that you will begin to act in a great way at some future time; begin now. Do not think that you will act in a great way when you reach a different environment; act in a great way where you are now. Do not think that you will begin to act in a great way when you begin to deal with great things; begin to deal in a great way with small things. Do not think that you will begin to be great when you get among more intelligent people, or among people who understand you better; begin now to deal in a great way with the people around you.

If you are not in an environment where there is scope for your best powers and talents you can move in due time; but meanwhile you can be great where you are. Lincoln was as great when he was a backwoods lawyer as when he was President; as a backwoods lawyer he did common things in a great way, and that made him President. Had he waited until he reached Washington to begin to be great, he would have remained unknown. You are not made great by the location in which you happen to be, nor by the things with which you may surround yourself. You are not made great by what you receive from others, and you can never manifest greatness so long as you depend on others. You will manifest greatness only when you begin to stand alone. Dismiss all thought of

reliance on externals, whether things, books, or people. As Emerson said, "Shakespeare will never be made by the study of Shakespeare." Shakespeare will be made by the thinking of Shakespearean thoughts.

Never mind how the people around you, including those of your own household, may treat you. That has nothing at all to do with your being great; that is, it cannot hinder you from being great. People may neglect you and be unthankful and unkind in their attitude toward you; does that prevent you from being great in your manner and attitude toward them? "Your Father," said Jesus, "is kind to the unthankful and the evil." Would God be great if he should go away and sulk because people were unthankful and did not appreciate him? Treat the unthankful and the evil in a great and perfectly kind way, just as God does.

Do not talk about your greatness; you are really, in essential nature, no greater than those around you. You may have entered upon a way of living and thinking which they have not yet found, but they are perfect on their own plane of thought and action. You are entitled to no special honor or consideration for your greatness. You are a god, but you are among gods. You will fall into the boastful attitude if you see other people's shortcomings and failures and compare them with your own virtues and successes; and if you fall into the boastful attitude of mind, you will cease to be great, and become small. Think of yourself as a perfect being among perfect beings, and meet every person as an equal, not as either a superior or an inferior. Give yourself no airs; great people never do. Ask no honors and seek for no recognition; honors and recognition will come fast enough if you are entitled to them.

Begin at home. It is a great person who can always be poised, assured, calm, and perfectly kind and considerate at home. If your manner and attitude in your own family are always the best you can think, you will soon become the one on whom all the others will rely. You will be a tower of strength and a support in time of trouble. You will be loved and appreciated. At the same time do not make the mistake of throwing

yourself away in the service of others. The great person respects himself; he serves and helps, but he is never slavishly servile. You cannot help your family by being a slave to them, or by doing for them those things which by right they should do for themselves. You do a person an injury when you wait on him too much. The selfish and exacting are a great deal better off if their exactions are denied. The ideal world is not one where there are a lot of people being waited on by other people; it is a world where everybody waits on himself. Meet all demands, selfish and otherwise, with perfect kindness and consideration; but do not allow yourself to be made a slave to the whims, caprices, exactions, or slavish desires of any member of your family. To do so is not great, and it works an injury to the other party.

Do not become uneasy over the failures or mistakes of any member of your family, and feel that you must interfere. Do not be disturbed if others seem to be going wrong, and feel that you must step in and set them right. Remember that every person is perfect on his own plane; you cannot improve on the work of God. Do not meddle with the personal habits and practices of others, though they are your nearest and dearest; these things are none of your business. Nothing can be wrong but your own personal attitude; make that right and you will know that all else is right. You are a truly great soul when you can live with those who do things which you do not do, and yet refrain from either criticism or interference. Do the things which are right for you to do, and believe that every member of your family is doing the things which are right for him. Nothing is wrong with anybody or anything; behold, it is all very good. Do not be enslaved by any one else, but be just as careful that you do not enslave any one else to your own notions of what is right.

Think, and think deeply and continuously; be perfect in your kindness and consideration; let your attitude be that of a god among gods, and not that of a god among inferior beings. This is the way to be great in your own home.

REFLECTION

Greatness starts where you are, Wattles says, and especially at home. Do not wait for a better setting or more appreciative people; be calm, kind, and considerate now. He warns against boasting and against comparing your progress with others' failings, insisting that everyone be met as an equal. He also cautions against two traps: becoming a servant to every demand and meddling in family members' habits. Respecting others' choices and refusing to be exploited are healthy boundaries. One balance is needed: not interfering does not mean ignoring danger. If someone at home is at risk or being harmed, stepping in or seeking help is right. Within ordinary family life, though, his picture of quiet, steady kindness without control is a demanding and worthwhile ideal.

PRACTICE

For one evening at home, notice every urge to correct or criticize someone. Let each one pass and say something kind or helpful instead. Afterward, write down one request you could politely decline next time without feeling guilty.

KEY THOUGHT

meet every person as an equal, not as either a superior or an inferior.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XV

Action Abroad

THE RULES which apply to your action at home must apply to your action everywhere. Never forget for an instant that this is a perfect world, and that you are a god among gods. You are as great as the greatest, but all are your equals.

Rely absolutely on your perception of truth. Trust to the inner light rather than to reason, but be sure that your perception comes from the inner light; act in poise and calmness; be still and attend on God. Your identification of yourself with the All-Mind will give you all the knowledge you need for guidance in any contingency which may arise in your own life or in the lives of others. It is only necessary that you should be supremely calm, and rely upon the eternal wisdom which is within you. If you act in poise and faith, your judgment will always be right, and you will always know exactly what to do. Do not hurry or worry; remember Lincoln in the dark days of the war. James Freeman Clarke relates that after the battle of Fredericksburg, Lincoln alone furnished a supply of faith and hope for the nation. Hundreds of leading men, from all parts of the country, went sadly into his room and came out cheerful and hopeful. They had stood face to face with the Highest, and had seen God in this lank, ungainly, patient man, although they knew it not.

Have perfect faith in yourself and in your own ability to cope with any combination of circumstances that may arise. Do not be disturbed if you are alone; if you need friends they will be brought to you at the right time. Do not be disturbed if you feel that you are ignorant; the information that you need will be furnished you when it is time for you to have it. That which is in you impelling you forward is in the things and people you need, impelling them toward you. If there is a particular man you need to know, he will be introduced to you; if there is a particular book you need to read it will be placed in your hands at the right time. All the knowledge you need will come to you from both external and internal sources. Your information and your talents will always be equal to the requirements of the occasion. Remember that Jesus told his disciples not to worry as to what they should say when brought before the judges; he knew that the power in them would be sufficient for the needs of the hour. As soon as you awaken and begin to use your faculties in a great way you will apply power to the development of your brain; new cells will be created and dormant cells quickened into activity, and your brain will be qualified as a perfect instrument for your mind.

Do not try to do great things until you are ready to go about them in a great way. If you undertake to deal with great matters in a small way—that is, from a low viewpoint or with incomplete consecration and wavering faith and courage—you will fail. Do not be in a hurry to get to the great things. Doing great things will not make you great, but becoming great will certainly lead you to the doing of great things. Begin to be great where you are and in the things you do every day. Do not be in haste to be found out or recognized as a great personality. Do not be disappointed if men do not nominate you for office within a month after you begin to practice what you read in this book. Great people never seek for recognition or applause; they are not great because they want to be paid for being so. Greatness is reward enough for itself;

the joy of being something and of knowing that you are advancing is the greatest of all joys possible to man.

If you begin in your own family, as described in the preceding chapter, and then assume the same mental attitude with your neighbors, friends, and those you meet in business, you will soon find that people are beginning to depend on you. Your advice will be sought, and a constantly increasing number of people will look to you for strength and inspiration, and rely upon your judgment. Here, as in the home, you must avoid meddling with other people's affairs. Help all who come to you, but do not go about officiously endeavoring to set other people right. Mind your own business. It is no part of your mission in life to correct people's morals, habits, or practices. Lead a great life, doing all things with a great spirit and in a great way; give to him that asketh of thee as freely as ye have received, but do not force your help or your opinions upon any man. If your neighbor wishes to smoke or drink, it is his business; it is none of yours until he consults you about it. If you lead a great life and do no preaching, you will save a thousand times as many souls as one who leads a small life and preaches continuously.

If you hold the right viewpoint of the world, others will find it out and be impressed by it through your daily conversation and practice. Do not try to convert others to your point of view, except by holding it and living accordingly. if your consecration is perfect you do not need to tell any one; it will speedily become apparent to all that you are guided by a higher principle than the average man or woman. If your identification with God is complete, you do not need to explain the fact to others; it will become self-evident. To become known as a great personality, you have nothing to do but to live. Do not imagine that you must go charging about the world like Don Quixote, tilting at windmills, and overturning things in general, in order to demonstrate that you are somebody. Do not go hunting for big things to do. Live a great life where you are, and in the daily work you have to do, and greater works will surely find you out. Big things will come to you, asking to be done.

Be so impressed with the value of a man that you treat even a beggar or the tramp with the most distinguished consideration. All is God. Every man and woman is perfect. Let your manner be that of a god addressing other gods. Do not save all your consideration for the poor; the millionaire is as good as the tramp. This is a perfectly good world, and there is not a person or thing in it but is exactly right; be sure that you keep this in mind in dealing with things and men.

Form your mental vision of yourself with care. Make the thought-form of yourself as you wish to be, and hold this with the faith that it is being realized, and with the purpose to realize it completely. Do every common act as a god should do it; speak every word as a god should speak it; meet men and women of both low and high estate as a god meets other divine beings. Begin thus and continue thus, and your unfoldment in ability and power will be great and rapid.

✦

REFLECTION

The same rules carry into public life. Wattles asks readers to act calmly, trust their inner guidance, and believe that the people, books, and information they need will arrive in time. He points again to Lincoln, who in the darkest days of the Civil War steadied the hopes of others. He warns against rushing toward big projects before you are ready, against seeking applause, and against preaching at people or meddling in their lives. Influence, he says, comes from living well and helping those who ask. His belief that help will simply be "brought to you" is an article of faith; in practice it also helps to reach out, ask, and network. His insistence on respect for everyone, rich or poor, remains a fine standard.

PRACTICE

Today, treat every person you deal with, from a cashier to a manager, with the same unhurried courtesy. Then reach out to one person who might help with a current goal, and simply ask for a short conversation.

KEY THOUGHT

You are as great as the greatest, but all are your equals.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XVI

Some Further Explanations

WE GO back here to the matter of the point of view, for, besides being vitally important, it is the one which is likely to give the student the most trouble. We have been trained, partly by mistaken religious teachers, to look upon the world as being like a wrecked ship, storm-driven upon a rocky coast; utter destruction is inevitable at the end, and the most that can be done is to rescue, perhaps, a few of the crew. This view teaches us to consider the world as essentially bad and growing worse; and to believe that existing discords and inharmonies must continue and intensify until the end. It robs us of hope for society, government, and humanity, and gives us a decreasing outlook and contracting mind.

This is all wrong. The world is not wrecked. It is like a magnificent steamer with the engines in place and the machinery in perfect order. The bunkers are full of coal, and the ship is amply provisioned for the cruise; there is no lack of any good thing. Every provision Omniscience could devise has been made for the safety, comfort, and happiness of the crew; the steamer is out on the high seas tacking hither and thither because no one has yet learned the right course to steer. We are learning to steer, and in due time will come grandly into the harbor of perfect harmony.

The world is good, and growing better. Existing discords and inharmonies are but the rollings of the ship incidental to our own imperfect steering; they will all be removed in due time. This view gives us an increasing outlook and an expanding mind; it enables us to think largely of society and of ourselves, and to do things in a great way.

Furthermore, we see that nothing can be wrong with such a world or with any part of it, including our own affairs. If it is all moving on toward completion, then it is not going wrong; and as our own personal affairs are a part of the whole, they are not going wrong. You and all that you are concerned with are moving on toward completeness. Nothing can check this forward movement but yourself; and you can only check it by assuming a mental attitude which is at cross purposes with the mind of God. You have nothing to keep right but yourself; if you keep yourself right, nothing can possibly go wrong with you, and you can have nothing to fear. No business or other disaster can come upon you if your personal attitude is right, for you are a part of that which is increasing and advancing, and you must increase and advance with it.

Moreover your thought-form will be mostly shaped according to your viewpoint of the cosmos. If you see the world as a lost and ruined thing you will see yourself as a part of it, and as partaking of its sins and weaknesses. If your outlook for the world as a whole is hopeless, your outlook for yourself cannot be hopeful. If you see the world as declining toward its end, you cannot see yourself as advancing. Unless you think well of all the works of God you cannot really think well of yourself, and unless you think well of yourself you can never become great.

I repeat that your place in life, including your material environment, is determined by the thought-form you habitually hold of yourself. When you make a thought-form of yourself you can hardly fail to form in your mind a corresponding environment. If you think of yourself as an incapable, inefficient person, you will think of yourself with poor or cheap surroundings. Unless you think well of yourself you will be sure to picture yourself in a more or less poverty stricken environment. These

thoughts, habitually held, become invisible forms in the surrounding mind-stuff, and are with you continually. In due time, by the regular action of the eternal creative energy, the invisible thought-forms are produced in material stuff, and you are surrounded by your own thoughts made into material things.

See nature as a great living and advancing presence, and see human society in exactly the same way. It is all one, coming from one source, and it is all good. You yourself are made of the same stuff as God. All the constituents of God are parts of yourself; every power that God has is a constituent of man. You can move forward as you see God doing. You have within yourself the source of every power.



REFLECTION

Wattles returns to the point of view, which he expects readers to find hardest. Some teachers, he says, picture the world as a wrecked ship from which only a few can be saved. He offers a different picture: a sound, well-stocked steamer whose crew is still learning to steer. The world is good and growing better, and our own lives are part of that forward movement. He adds that your habitual image of yourself shapes your surroundings. His hopeful outlook can lift a discouraged mind. But his claim that no disaster can reach someone whose attitude is right is not true to life. Good people suffer losses, illnesses, and setbacks they did nothing to cause. Hope is a strength; self-blame for misfortune is not.

PRACTICE

Write two short descriptions of your life right now: one as a "wrecked ship" and one as a "ship learning to steer." Read both. Choose one small course correction suggested by the second, and make it this week.

KEY THOUGHT

The world is good, and growing better.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XVII

More About Thought

I GIVE place here to some further consideration of thought. You will never become great until your own thoughts make you great, and therefore it is of the first importance that you should THINK. You will never do great things in the external world until you think great things in the internal world; and you will never think great things until you think about *truth;* about the verities. To think great things you must be absolutely sincere; and to be sincere you must know that your intentions are right. Insincere or false thinking is never great, however logical and brilliant it may be.

The first and most important step is to seek the truth about human relations; to know what you ought to be to other men, and what they ought to be to you. This brings you back to the search for a right viewpoint. You should study organic and social evolution. Read Darwin and Walter Thomas Mills, and when you read, THINK; think the whole matter over until you see the world of things and men in the right way. THINK about what God is doing until you can SEE what he is doing.

Your next step is to think yourself into the right personal attitude. Your viewpoint tells you what the right attitude is, and obedience to the soul puts you into it. It is only by making a complete consecration of yourself to the highest that is within you that you can attain to sincere

thinking. So long as you know you are selfish in your aims, or dishonest or crooked in any way in your intentions or practices, your thinking will be false and your thoughts will have no power. THINK about the way you are doing things; about all your intentions, purposes, and practices, until you know that they are right.

The fact of his own complete unity with God is one that no person can grasp without deep and sustained thinking. Any one can accept the proposition in a superficial way, but to feel and realize a vital comprehension of it is another matter. It is easy to think of going outside of yourself to meet God, but it is not so easy to think of going inside yourself to meet God. But God is there, and in the holy of holies of your own soul you may meet him face to face. It is a tremendous thing, this fact that all you need is already within you; that you do not have to consider how to get the power to do what you want to do or to make yourself what you want to be. You have only to consider how to use the power you have in the right way. And there is nothing to do but to begin. Use your perception of truth; you can see some truth to-day; live fully up to that and you will see more truth to-morrow.

To rid yourself of the old false ideas you will have to think a great deal about the value of men—the greatness and worth of a human soul. You must cease from looking at human mistakes and look at successes; cease from seeing faults and see virtues. You can no longer look upon men and women as lost and ruined beings who are descending into hell; you must come to regard them as shining souls who are ascending toward heaven. It will require some exercise of will power to do this, but this is the legitimate use of the will—to decide what you will think about and how you will think. The function of the will is to direct thought. Think about the good side of men; the lovely, attractive part, and exert your will in refusing to think of anything else in connection with them.

I know of no one who has attained to so much on this one point as Eugene V. Debs, twice the Socialist candidate for president of the United States. Mr. Debs reverences humanity. No appeal for help is ever made

to him in vain. No one receives from him an unkind or censorious word. You cannot come into his presence without being made sensible of his deep and kindly personal interest in you. No one, whether millionaire, grimy workingman, or toil worn woman, meets him without receiving the radiant warmth of a brotherly affection that is sincere and true. No ragged child speaks to him on the street without receiving instant and tender recognition. Debs loves men. This has made him the leading figure in a great movement, the beloved hero of a million hearts, and will give him a deathless name. It is a great thing to love men so and it is only achieved by thought. Nothing can make you great but thought.

"We may divide thinkers into those who think for themselves and those who think through others. The latter are the rule and the former the exception. The first are original thinkers in a double sense, and egotists in the noblest meaning of the word." — Schopenhauer.

"The key to every man is his thought. Sturdy and defiant though he look he has a helm which he obeys, which is the idea after which all his facts are classified. He can only be reformed by showing him a new idea which commands his own." — Emerson.

"All truly wise thoughts have been thought already thousands of times; but to make them really ours we must think them over again honestly till they take root in our personal expression." — Goethe.

"All that a man is outwardly is but the expression and completion of his inward thought. To work effectively he must think clearly. To act nobly he must think nobly." — Channing.

"Great men are they who see that spirituality is stronger than any material force; that thoughts rule the world." — Emerson.

"Some people study all their lives, and at their death they have learned everything except to think." — Domergue.

"It is the habitual thought that frames itself into our life. It affects us even more than our intimate social relations do. Our confidential friends have not so much to do in shaping our lives as the thoughts have which we harbor." — J. W. Teal.

"When God lets loose a great thinker on this planet, then all things are at risk. There is not a piece of science but its flank may be turned to-morrow; nor any literary reputation or the so-called eternal names of fame that may not be refused and condemned." — Emerson.

Think! *Think!!* THINK!!!

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles deepens his call to think. Great thinking, he says, requires sincerity, which means your intentions must be honest. He recommends studying evolution and society, naming Darwin and Walter Thomas Mills, a socialist writer of his day. Above all, he asks readers to think about the worth of every human being: to look at people's virtues rather than their faults, using the will to choose what to dwell on. His example is Eugene V. Debs, the Socialist candidate for president, whom he admired for his warm respect toward everyone. Readers need not share his politics to value that example. The chapter's lasting idea is that attention is a choice, and choosing to see the good in people can be trained over time.

PRACTICE

At the end of each day this week, write down one good thing you noticed in someone, especially someone you usually overlook or find difficult. On Sunday, read the list and notice how your view of those people has shifted.

KEY THOUGHT

The function of the will is to direct thought.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XVIII

Jesus' Idea of Greatness

IN THE twenty-third chapter of Matthew Jesus makes a very plain distinction between true and false greatness; and also points out the one great danger to all who wish to become great—the most insidious of temptations which all must avoid and fight unceasingly who desire to really climb in the world. Speaking to the multitude and to his disciples he bids them beware of adopting the principle of the Pharisees. He points out that while the Pharisees are just and righteous men, honorable judges, true lawgivers and upright in their dealings with men, they "love the uppermost seats at feasts and greetings in the market place, and to be called Master, Master"; and in comparison with this principle, he says: "He that will be great among you let him serve."

The average person's idea of a great man, rather than of one who serves, is of one who succeeds in getting himself served. He gets himself in a position to command men; to exercise power over them, making them obey his will. The exercise of dominion over other people, to most persons, is a great thing. Nothing seems to be sweeter to the selfish soul than this. You will always find every selfish and undeveloped person trying to domineer over others, to exercise control over other men. Savage men were no sooner placed upon the earth than they began to enslave one another. For ages the struggle in war, diplomacy, politics,

and government has been aimed at the securing of control over other men. Kings and princes have drenched the soil of the earth in blood and tears in the effort to extend their dominions and their power,—to rule more people.

The struggle of the business world to-day is the same as that on the battle-fields of Europe a century ago so far as the ruling principle is concerned. Robert G. Ingersoll could not understand why men like Rockefeller and Carnegie seek for more money and make themselves slaves to the business struggle when they already have more than they can possibly use. He thought it a kind of madness and illustrated it as follows: "Suppose a man had fifty thousand pairs of pants, seventy-five thousand vests, one hundred thousand coats, and one hundred and fifty thousand neckties, what would you think of him if he arose in the morning before light and worked until after it was dark every day, rain or shine, in all kinds of weather, merely to get another necktie?"

But it is not a good simile. The possession of neckties gives a man no power over other men, while the possession of dollars does. Rockefeller, Carnegie, and their kind are not after dollars but power. It is the principle of the Pharisee; it is the struggle for the high place. It develops able men, cunning men, resourceful men, but not great men.

I want you to contrast these two ideas of greatness sharply in your minds. "He that will be great among you let him serve." Let me stand before the average American audience and ask the name of the greatest American and the majority will think of Abraham Lincoln; and is this not because in Lincoln above all the other men who have served us in public life we recognize the spirit of service? Not servility, but service. Lincoln was a great man because he knew how to be a great servant. Napoleon, able, cold, selfish, seeking the high places, was a brilliant man. Lincoln was great, Napoleon was not.

The very moment you begin to advance and are recognized as one who is doing things in a great way you will find yourself in danger. The temptation to patronize, advise, or take upon yourself the direction of

other people's affairs is sometimes almost irresistible. Avoid, however, the opposite danger of falling into servility, or of completely throwing yourself away in the service of others. To do this has been the ideal of a great many people. The completely self-sacrificing life has been thought to be the Christ-like life, because, as I think, of a complete misconception of the character and teachings of Jesus. I have explained this misconception in a little book which I hope you may all sometime read.[1] Thousands of people imitating Jesus, as they suppose, have belittled themselves and given up all else to go about doing good; practicing an altruism that is really as morbid and as far from great as the rankest selfishness. The finer instincts which respond to the cry of trouble or distress are not by any means all of you; they are not necessarily the best part of you. There are other things you must do besides helping the unfortunate, although it is true that a large part of the life and activities of every great person must be given to helping other people. As you begin to advance they will come to you. Do not turn them away. But do not make the fatal error of supposing that the life of complete self-abnegation is the way of greatness.

To make another point here, let me refer to the fact that Swedenborg's classification of fundamental motives is exactly the same as that of Jesus. He divides all men into two groups: those who live in pure love, and those who live in what he calls the love of ruling for the love of self. It will be seen that this is exactly the same as the lust for place and power of the Pharisees. Swedenborg saw this selfish love of power as the cause of all sin. It was the only evil desire of the human heart, from which all other evil desires sprang.

Over against this he places pure love. He does not say love of God or love of man, but merely love. Nearly all religionists make more of love and service to God than they do of love and service to man. But it is a fact that love to God is not sufficient to save a man from the lust for power, for some of the most ardent lovers of the Deity have been the

worst of tyrants. Lovers of God are often tyrants, and lovers of men are often meddlesome and officious.

[1] *A New Christ.*

✦

REFLECTION

Drawing on the twenty-third chapter of Matthew, Wattles contrasts two ideas of greatness. One seeks the best seats, titles, and power over others; the other serves. He argues that the great business magnates of his day were chasing power rather than money, and he sets Lincoln, a servant of the public, against Napoleon, brilliant but cold. Then he adds an important balance: service is not servility. He criticizes a self-sacrificing ideal that gives away everything and calls it morbid, a theme he says he develops in his little book A New Christ. Today we might say healthy generosity needs self-respect and limits. The chapter offers a clear test: are you trying to be served, or trying to serve well?

PRACTICE

Look at one role you hold, such as parent, manager, friend, or volunteer. Write one way you could serve better in it, and one way you might be giving so much that you are wearing yourself out. Adjust one of them.

KEY THOUGHT

Not servility, but service.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XIX

A View of Evolution

BUT HOW shall we avoid throwing ourselves into altruistic work if we are surrounded by poverty, ignorance, suffering, and every appearance of misery as very many people are? Those who live where the withered hand of want is thrust upon them from every side appealingly for aid must find it hard to refrain from continuous giving. Again, there are social and other irregularities, injustices done to the weak, which fire generous souls with an almost irresistible desire to set things right. We want to start a crusade; we feel that the wrongs will never be righted until we give ourselves wholly to the task. In all this we must fall back upon the point of view. We must remember that this is not a bad world but a good world in the process of becoming.

Beyond all doubt there was a time when there was no life upon this earth. The testimony of geology to the fact that the globe was once a ball of burning gas and molten rock, clothed about with boiling vapors, is indisputable. And we do not know how life could have existed under such conditions; that seems impossible. Geology tells us that later on a crust formed, the globe cooled and hardened, the vapors condensed and became mist or fell in rain. The cooled surface crumbled into soil; moisture accumulated, ponds and seas were gathered together, and at

last somewhere in the water or on the land appeared something that was alive.

It is reasonable to suppose that this first life was in single-celled organisms, but behind these cells was the insistent urge of Spirit, the Great One Life seeking expression. And soon organisms having too much life to express themselves with one cell had two cells and then many, and still more life was poured into them. Multiple-celled organisms were formed; plants, trees, vertebrates, and mammals, many of them with strange shapes, but all were perfect after their kind as everything is that God makes. No doubt there were crude and almost monstrous forms of both animal and plant life; but everything filled its purpose in its day and it was all very good. Then another day came, the great day of the evolutionary process, a day when the morning stars sang together and the sons of God shouted for joy to behold the beginning of the end, for man, the object aimed at from the beginning, had appeared upon the scene.

An ape-like being, little different from the beasts around him in appearance but infinitely different in his capacity for growth and thought. Art and beauty, architecture and song, poetry and music, all these were unrealized possibilities in that ape man's soul. And for his time and kind he was very good.

"It is God that worketh in you to will and to do of his good pleasure," says St. Paul. From the day the first man appeared God began to work IN men, putting more and more of himself into each succeeding generation, urging them on to larger achievements and to better conditions, social, governmental, and domestic. Those who looking back into ancient history see the awful conditions which existed, the barbarities, idolatries, and sufferings, and reading about God in connection with these things are disposed to feel that he was cruel and unjust to man, should pause to think. From the ape man to the coming Christ man the race has had to rise. And it could only be accomplished by the successive unfoldments of the various powers and possibilities

latent in the human brain. Naturally the cruder and more animal-like part of man came to its full development first; for ages men were brutal; their governments were brutal, their religions were brutal, their domestic institutions were brutal, and what appears to be an immense amount of suffering resulted from this brutality. But God never delighted in suffering, and in every age he has given men a message, telling them how to avoid it. And all the while the urge of life, insistent, powerful, compelling, made the race keep moving forward; a little less brutality in each age and a little more spirituality in each age. And God kept on working in man.

In every age there have been some individuals who were in advance of the mass and who heard and understood God better than their fellows. Upon these the inspiring hand of Spirit was laid and they were compelled to become interpreters. These were the prophets and seers, sometimes the priests and kings, and oftener still they were martyrs driven to the stake, the block, or the cross. It is to these who have heard God, spoken his word, and demonstrated his truth in their lives that all progress is really due.

Again, considering for a moment the presence of what is called evil in the world, we see that that which appears to us to be evil is only undeveloped; and that the undeveloped is perfectly good in its own stage and place. Because all things are necessary to man's complete unfoldment, all things in human life are the work of God. The graft rings in our cities, the red-light districts and their unfortunate inmates, these he consciously and voluntarily produced. Their part in the plan of unfoldment must be played. And when their part has been played he will sweep them off the stage as he did the strange and poisonous monsters which filled the swamps of the past ages.

In concluding this vision of evolution we might ask why it was all done, what is it for? This question should be easy for the thoughtful mind to answer. God desired to express himself, to live in form, and not only that, but to live in a form through which he could express himself

on the highest moral and spiritual plane. God wanted to evolve a form in which he could live as a god and manifest himself as a god. This was the aim of the evolutionary force. The ages of warfare, bloodshed, suffering, injustice, and cruelty were tempered in many ways with love and justice as time advanced. And this was developing the brain of man to a point where it should be capable of giving full expression to the love and justice of God. The end is not yet; God aims not at the perfection of a few choice specimens for exhibition, like the large berries at the top of the box, but at the glorification of the race. The time will come when the Kingdom of God shall be established on earth; the time foreseen by the dreamer of the Isle of Patmos, when there shall be no more crying, neither shall there be any more pain, for the former things are all passed away, and there shall be no night there.



REFLECTION

To answer people overwhelmed by the suffering around them, Wattles sketches the history of life as God's gradual self-expression: from a molten earth to single cells, to an "ape-like being," and onward toward a coming "Christ man." Every stage, he says, was good for its time, and history's brutality slowly gives way to love and justice. This is a faith-filled reading of evolution typical of his era. Its language about the "race," "ape man," and earlier peoples as brutal reflects ideas of progress that modern science and history have left behind. His claim that God deliberately produced corruption and prostitution will also trouble many readers. What can still speak today is his hope that humanity is, on the whole, slowly learning to be kinder.

PRACTICE

Think of one way life is kinder or fairer now than a century ago, and one way it still falls short. Write both down. Then note one small action you could take to help the second move forward.

KEY THOUGHT

We must remember that this is not a bad world but a good world in the process of becoming.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XX

Serving God

I HAVE brought you thus far through the two preceding chapters with a view to finally settling the question of duty. This is one that puzzles and perplexes very many people who are earnest and sincere, and gives them a great deal of difficulty in its solution. When they start out to make something of themselves and to practice the science of being great, they find themselves necessarily compelled to rearrange many of their relationships. There are friends who perhaps must be alienated, there are relatives who misunderstand and who feel that they are in some way being slighted; the really great man is often considered selfish by a large circle of people who are connected with him and who feel that he might bestow upon them more benefits than he does. The question at the outset is: Is it my duty to make the most of myself regardless of everything else? Or shall I wait until I can do so without any friction or without causing loss to any one? This is the question of duty to self vs. duty to others.

One's duty to the world has been thoroughly discussed in the preceding pages and I give some consideration now to the idea of duty to God. An immense number of people have a great deal of uncertainty, not to say anxiety, as to what they ought to do for God. The amount of work and service that is done for him in these United States in the way of

church work and so on is enormous. An immense amount of human energy is expended in what is called serving God. I propose to consider briefly what serving God is and how a man may serve God best, and I think I shall be able to make plain that the conventional idea as to what constitutes service to God is all wrong.

When Moses went down into Egypt to bring out the Hebrews from bondage, his demand upon Pharaoh, in the name of the Deity, was, "Let the people go that they may serve me." He led them out into the wilderness and there instituted a new form of worship which has led many people to suppose that worship constitutes the service of God, although later God himself distinctly declared that he cared nothing for ceremonies, burned offerings, or oblation, and the teaching of Jesus, if rightly understood, would do away with organized temple worship altogether. God does not lack anything that men may do for him with their hands or bodies or voices. Saint Paul points out that man can do nothing for God, for God does not need anything.

The view of evolution which we have taken shows God seeking expression through man. Through all the successive ages in which his spirit has urged man up the height, God has gone on seeking expression. Every generation of men is more Godlike than the preceding generation. Every generation of men demands more in the way of fine homes, pleasant surroundings, congenial work, rest, travel, and opportunity for study than the preceding generation.

I have heard some shortsighted economists argue that the working people of to-day ought surely to be fully contented because their condition is so much better than that of the workingman two hundred years ago who slept in a windowless hut on a floor covered with rushes in company with his pigs. If that man had all that he was able to use for the living of all the life he knew how to live, he was perfectly content, and if he had lack he was not contented. The man of to-day has a comfortable home and very many things, indeed, that were unknown a short period back in the past, and if he has all that he can use for the living of all the

life he can imagine, he will be content. But he is not content. God has lifted the race so far that any common man can picture a better and more desirable life than he is able to live under existing conditions. And so long as this is true, so long as a man can think and clearly picture to himself a more desirable life, he will be discontented with the life he has to live, and rightly so. That discontent is the Spirit of God urging men on to more desirable conditions. It is God who seeks expression in the race. "He worketh in us to will and to do."

The only service you can render God is to give expression to what he is trying to give the world, through you. The only service you can render God is to make the very most of yourself in order that God may live in you to the utmost of your possibilities. In a former work of this series[1] I refer to the little boy at the piano, the music in whose soul could not find expression through his untrained hands. This is a good illustration of the way the Spirit of God is over, about, around, and in all of us, seeking to do great things with us, so soon as we will train our hands and feet, our minds, brains, and bodies to do his service.

Your first duty to God, to yourself, and to the world is to make yourself as great a personality, in every way, as you possibly can. And that, it seems to me, disposes of the question of duty.

There are one or two other things which might be disposed of in closing this chapter. I have written of opportunity in a preceding chapter. I have said, in a general way, that it is within the power of every man to become great, just as in "The Science of Getting Rich" I declared that it is within the power of every man to become rich. But these sweeping generalizations need qualifying. There are men who have such materialistic minds that they are absolutely incapable of comprehending the philosophy set forth in these books. There is a great mass of men and women who have lived and worked until they are practically incapable of thought along these lines; and they cannot receive the message. Something may be done for them by demonstration, that is, by living the life before them. But that is the only way they can be aroused. The

world needs demonstration more than it needs teaching. For this mass of people our duty is to become as great in personality as possible in order that they may see and desire to do likewise. It is our duty to make ourselves great for their sakes, so that we may help prepare the world that the next generation shall have better conditions for thought.

One other point. I am frequently written to by people who wish to make something of themselves and to move out into the world, but who are hampered by home ties, having others more or less dependent upon them, whom they fear would suffer if left alone. In general I advise such people to move out fearlessly, and to make the most of themselves. If there is a loss at home it will be only temporary and apparent, for in a little while, if you follow the leading of Spirit, you will be able to take better care of your dependents than you have ever done before.

[1] *The Science of Getting Rich.*

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles settles the question of duty. God needs nothing from us, he argues, so serving God does not mainly mean rituals or church work; it means letting God express himself through a fully developed life. Even discontent can be holy, he says, because it is the urge toward a better life. He also admits his promises need qualifying: some people, worn down by life, cannot take in his teaching, and he hopes example will help them. His advice to leave dependents behind and "move out fearlessly," trusting things will work out, should be weighed carefully. Real responsibilities to children, elderly parents, or sick relatives matter, and growth can usually be planned in ways that keep them safe.

PRACTICE

Write one sentence about what "making the most of yourself" would mean for you. Then list the people who depend on you, and note one way you could pursue that growth while still caring for them well.

KEY THOUGHT

The only service you can render God is to make the very most of yourself in order that God may live in you to the utmost of your possibilities.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XXI

A Mental Exercise

THE PURPOSE of mental exercises must not be misunderstood. There is no virtue in charms or formulated strings of words; there is no short cut to development by repeating prayers or incantations. A mental exercise is an exercise, not in repeating words, but in the thinking of certain thoughts. The phrases that we repeatedly hear become convictions, as Goethe says; and the thoughts that we repeatedly think become habitual, and make us what we are. The purpose in taking a mental exercise is that you may think certain thoughts repeatedly until you form a habit of thinking them; then they will be your thoughts all the time. Taken in the right way and with an understanding of their purpose, mental exercises are of great value; but taken as most people take them they are worse than useless.

The thoughts embodied in the following exercise are the ones you want to think. You should take the exercise once or twice daily, but you should think the thoughts continuously. That is, do not think them twice a day for a stated time and then forget them until it is time to take the exercise again. The exercise is to impress you with the material for continuous thought.

Take a time when you can have from twenty minutes to half an hour secure from interruption, and proceed first to make yourself physically

comfortable. Lie at ease in a Morris chair, or on a couch, or in bed; it is best to lie flat on your back. If you have no other time, take the exercise on going to bed at night and before rising in the morning.

First let your attention travel over your body from the crown of your head to the soles of your feet, relaxing every muscle as you go. Relax completely. And next, get physical and other ills off your mind. Let the attention pass down the spinal cord and out over the nerves to the extremities, and as you do so think:—

"My nerves are in perfect order all over my body. They obey my will, and I have great nerve force." Next, bring your attention to the lungs and think:—

"I am breathing deeply and quietly, and the air goes into every cell of my lungs, which are in perfect condition. My blood is purified and made clean." Next, to the heart:—

"My heart is beating strongly and steadily, and my circulation is perfect, even to the extremities." Next, to the digestive system:—

"My stomach and bowels perform their work perfectly. My food is digested and assimilated and my body rebuilt and nourished. My liver, kidneys, and bladder each perform their several functions without pain or strain; I am perfectly well. My body is resting, my mind is quiet, and my soul is at peace.

"I have no anxiety about financial or other matters. God, who is within me, is also in all things I want, impelling them toward me; all that I want is already given to me. I have no anxiety about my health, for I am perfectly well. I have no worry or fear whatever.

"I rise above all temptation to moral evil. I cast out all greed, selfishness, and narrow personal ambition; I do not hold envy, malice, or enmity toward any living soul. I will follow no course of action which is not in accord with my highest ideals. I am right and I will do right."

Viewpoint

All is right with the world. It is perfect and advancing to completion. I will contemplate the facts of social, political, and industrial life only from this high viewpoint. Behold, it is all very good. I will see all human beings, all my acquaintances, friends, neighbors, and the members of my own household in the same way. They are all good. Nothing is wrong with the universe; nothing can be wrong but my own personal attitude, and henceforth I keep that right. My whole trust is in God.

Consecration

I will obey my soul and be true to that within me which is highest. I will search within for the pure idea of right in all things, and when I find it I will express it in my outward life. I will abandon everything I have outgrown for the best I can think. I will have the highest thoughts concerning all my relationships, and my manner and action shall express these thoughts. I surrender my body to be ruled by my mind; I yield my mind to the dominion of my soul, and I give my soul to the guidance of God.

Identification

There is but one substance and source, and of that I am made and with it I am one. It is my Father; I proceeded forth and came from it. My Father and I are one, and my Father is greater than I, and I do His will. I surrender myself to conscious unity with Pure Spirit; there is but one and that one is everywhere. I am one with the Eternal Consciousness.

Idealization

Form a mental picture of yourself as you want to be, and at the greatest height your imagination can picture. Dwell upon this for some little time, holding the thought: "This is what I really am; it is a picture

of my own soul. I am this now in soul, and I am becoming this in outward manifestation."

Realization

I appropriate to myself the power to become what I want to be, and to do what I want to do. I exercise creative energy; all the power there is is mine. I will arise and go forth with power and perfect confidence; I will do mighty works in the strength of the Lord, my God. I will trust and not fear, for God is with me.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles closes the teaching with a guided exercise. He stresses that it is not a magic formula; the point is to think certain thoughts so often that they become habits. Lying comfortably, you relax the body from head to toe, then move through statements about nerves, lungs, heart, and digestion, followed by thoughts of freedom from anxiety and moral temptation, and finally short meditations on viewpoint, consecration, identification, idealization, and realization. The relaxation part resembles a modern body scan and can be calming. The health statements, however, are affirmations, not medicine. Saying "I am perfectly well" will not fix a real symptom, so keep any treatment you need. Used as a way to settle the mind and rehearse your values, the exercise can be a gentle daily practice.

PRACTICE

Tonight in bed, spend ten minutes relaxing each part of your body from head to feet. Then repeat, slowly, one sentence from the chapter that fits you. If any physical symptom worries you, make a note to ask a doctor.

KEY THOUGHT

A mental exercise is an exercise, not in repeating words, but in the thinking of certain thoughts.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

XXII

A Summary of the Science of Being Great

ALL MEN are made of the one intelligent substance, and therefore all contain the same essential powers and possibilities. Greatness is equally inherent in all, and may be manifested by all. Every person may become great. Every constituent of God is a constituent of man.

Man may overcome both heredity and circumstances by exercising the inherent creative power of the soul. If he is to become great, the soul must act, and must rule the mind and the body. Man's knowledge is limited, and he falls into error through ignorance; to avoid this he must connect his soul with Universal Spirit.

Universal Spirit is the intelligent substance from which all things come; it is in and through all things. All things are known to this universal mind, and man can so unite himself with it as to enter into all knowledge.

To do this man must cast out of himself everything which separates him from God. He must will to live the divine life, and he must rise above all moral temptations; he must forsake every course of action that is not in accord with his highest ideals.

He must reach the right viewpoint, recognizing that God is all, in all, and that there is nothing wrong. He must see that nature, society,

government, and industry are perfect in their present stage, and advancing toward completion; and that all men and women everywhere are good and perfect. He must know that all is right with the world, and unite with God for the completion of the perfect work. It is only as man sees God as the Great Advancing Presence in all, and good in all, that he can rise to real greatness.

He must consecrate himself to the service of the highest that is within himself, obeying the voice of the soul. There is an Inner Light in every man which continuously impels him toward the highest, and he must be guided by this light if he would become great.

He must recognize the fact that he is one with the Father, and consciously affirm this unity for himself and for all others. He must know himself to be a god among gods, and act accordingly. He must have absolute faith in his own perceptions of truth, and begin at home to act upon these perceptions. As he sees the true and right course in small things, he must take that course. He must cease to act unthinkingly, and begin to think; and he must be sincere in his thought.

He must form a mental conception of himself at the highest, and hold this conception until it is his habitual thought-form of himself. This thought-form he must keep continuously in view. He must outwardly realize and express that thought-form in his actions. He must do everything that he does in a great way. In dealing with his family, his neighbors, acquaintances, and friends, he must make every act an expression of his ideal.

The man who reaches the right viewpoint and makes full consecration, and who fully idealizes himself as great, and who makes every act, however trivial, an expression of the ideal, has already attained to greatness. Everything he does will be done in a great way. He will make himself known, and will be recognized as a personality of power. He will receive knowledge by inspiration, and will know all that he needs to know. He will receive all the material wealth he forms in his thoughts, and will not lack for any good thing. He will be given ability to deal with

any combination of circumstances which may arise, and his growth and progress will be continuous and rapid. Great works will seek him out, and all men will delight to do him honor.

Because of its peculiar value to the student of the Science of Being Great, I close this book by giving a portion of Emerson's essay on the "Oversoul." This great essay is fundamental, showing the foundation principles of monism and the science of greatness. I recommend the student to study it most carefully in connection with this book.

What is the universal sense of want and ignorance, but the fine innuendo by which the great soul makes its enormous claim? Why do men feel that the natural history of man has never been written, but always he is leaving behind what you have said of him, and it becomes old, and books of metaphysics worthless? The philosophy of six thousand years has not searched the chambers and magazines of the soul. In its experiments there has always remained, in the last analysis, a residuum it could not resolve. Man is a stream whose source is hidden. Always our being is descending into us from we know not whence. The most exact calculator has no prescience that somewhat incalculable may not balk the very next moment. I am constrained every moment to acknowledge a higher origin for events than the will I call mine.

As with events, so it is with thoughts. When I watch that flowing river, which, out of regions I see not, pours for a season its streams into me,—I see that I am a pensioner,—not a cause, but a surprised spectator of this ethereal water; that I desire and look up, and put myself in the attitude for reception, but from some alien energy the visions come.

The Supreme Critic on all the errors of the past and present, and the only prophet of that which must be, is that great nature in which we rest, as the earth lies in the soft arms of the atmosphere; that Unity, that Oversoul, with which every man's particular being is contained and made one with all other; that common heart, of which all sincere conversation is the worship, to which all right action is submission; that overpowering reality which confutes our tricks and talents, and constrains every one to pass for what he is, and to speak from his character and not from his tongue; and which evermore tends and aims to pass into our thought and hand, and become wisdom, and virtue, and power, and beauty. We live in succession, in division, in parts, in particles. Meantime within man is the soul of the whole; the wise silence; the universal beauty, to which every part and particle is equally related; the eternal One. And this deep power in which we exist, and whose beatitude is all accessible to us, is not only self-sufficing and perfect in every hour, but the act of seeing, and the thing seen, the seer and the spectacle, the subject and the object, are one. We see the world piece by piece, as the sun, the moon, the animal, the tree; but the whole, of which these are the shining parts, is the soul. It is only by the vision of that Wisdom, that the horoscope of the ages can be read, and it is only by falling back on our better thoughts, by yielding to the spirit of prophecy which is innate in every man, that we know what it saith. Every man's words, who speaks from that life, must sound vain to those who do not dwell in the same thought on their own part. I dare not speak for it. My words do not carry its august sense; they fall short and cold. Only itself can inspire whom it will, and behold! their speech shall

be lyrical and sweet, and universal as the rising of the wind. Yet I desire, even by profane words, if sacred I may not use, to indicate the heaven of this deity, and to report what hints I have collected of the transcendent simplicity and energy of the Highest Law.

If we consider what happens in conversation, in reveries, in remorse, in times of passion, in surprises, in the instruction of dreams wherein often we see ourselves in masquerade,—the droll disguises only magnifying and enhancing a real element, and forcing it on our distinct notice,—we shall catch many hints that will broaden and lighten into knowledge of the secret of nature. All goes to show that the soul in man is not an organ, but animates and exercises all the organs; is not a function, like the power of memory, of calculation, of comparison,—but uses these as hands and feet; is not a faculty, but a light; is not the intellect or the will, but the master of the intellect and the will;—is the vast background of our being, in which they lie,—an immensity not possessed and that cannot be possessed. From within or from behind, a light shines through us upon things, and makes us aware that we are nothing, but the light is all. A man is the facade of a temple wherein all wisdom and all good abide. What we commonly call man, the eating, drinking, planting, counting man, does not, as we know him, represent himself, but misrepresents himself. Him we do not respect, but the soul, whose organ he is, would he let it appear through his action, would make our knees bend. When it breathes through his intellect, it is genius; when it flows through his affection it is love. * * *

After its own law and not by arithmetic is the rate of its progress to be computed. The soul's advances are not made by gradation, such as can be represented by motion in a straight line; but rather by ascension of state, such as can be represented by metamorphosis,—from the egg to the worm, from the worm to the fly. The growths of genius are of a certain total character, that does not advance the elect individual first over John, then Adam, then Richard, and give to each the pain of discovered inferiority, but by every throe of growth the man expands there where he works, passing, at each pulsation, classes, populations of men. With each divine impulse the mind rends the thin rinds of the visible and finite, and comes out into eternity, and inspires and expires its air. It converses with truths that have always been spoken in the world, and becomes conscious of a closer sympathy with Zeno and Arrian, than with persons in the house.

This is the law of moral and of mental gain. The simple rise as by specific levity, not into a particular virtue, but into the region of all the virtues. They are in the spirit which contains them all. The soul is superior to all the particulars of merit. The soul requires purity, but purity is not it; requires justice, but justice is not that; requires beneficence, but is somewhat better: so that there is a kind of descent and accommodation felt when we leave speaking of moral nature, to urge a virtue which it enjoins. For, to the soul in her pure action, all the virtues are natural, and not painfully acquired. Speak to his heart, and the man becomes suddenly virtuous.

Within the same sentiment is the germ of intellectual growth, which obeys the same law. Those who are capable of humility,

of justice, of love, of aspiration, are already on a platform that commands the sciences and arts, speech and poetry, action and grace. For whoso dwells in this mortal beatitude, does already anticipate those special powers which men prize so highly; just as love does justice to all the gifts of the object beloved. The lover has no talent, no skill, which passes for quite nothing with his enamored maiden, however little she may possess of related faculty. And the heart which abandons itself to the Supreme Mind finds itself related to all its works and will travel a royal road to particular knowledge and powers. For, in ascending to this primary and aboriginal sentiment, we have come from our remote station on the circumference instantaneously to the center of the world, where, as in the closet of God, we see causes, and anticipate the universe, which is but a slow effect.

✦

REFLECTION

The summary gathers the whole method in a few pages. Everyone is made of the same intelligent Substance, so greatness is possible for all. To realize it, a person must rise above wrong motives, see the world as good and advancing, obey the highest within, know themselves one with God, hold a clear picture of their best self, and express it in every act, beginning at home. Wattles then promises inspiration, recognition, and "all the material wealth he forms in his thoughts." Those last promises are his hopes, not guarantees; life rarely works so neatly. The book ends with a long passage from Emerson's essay "The Over-Soul," which Wattles saw as the root of his monism. The steps themselves, however, remain a useful checklist for anyone.

PRACTICE

Read the summary slowly and mark the one step you practice least. Write it on a card and keep it where you will see it daily. After a month, review what changed and choose the next step.

KEY THOUGHT

He must do everything that he does in a great way.

MY OWN NOTES

How to Get What You Want

FIVE CHAPTERS

About This Work

How to Get What You Want is one of the shortest pieces in this collection, and one of the most direct. It speaks of itself as a set of "lessons," and its closing pages mention "wealth-culture," which places it close to the practical teaching Wattles was writing around the time of The Science of Getting Rich. The text printed here comes from a later reprint rather than from a first edition. The chapter titles are editorial: they were added to help the reader find their way and are not necessarily Wattles' own wording.

The argument is simple. Success, Wattles says, is getting what you want, and its cause lies inside the person, not in the neighborhood or the circumstances. He names that inner cause "Power-Consciousness," the settled knowledge that you can do a thing and know how to do it. He then gives a method: use what you already have as fully as you can, do today's work so well that you have energy left over, keep a clear picture of where you are going, and put real care into every relationship, at work and at home. His image of the peanut stand that grows into a department store sums it up.

Much of this still holds up well. Doing your present job thoroughly, choosing work that fits your strengths, treating customers as people and being kind at home are sound habits. Some of it needs a careful reading. Wattles writes that it is "mathematically certain" you can succeed. No book can promise that. Effort and clear aims help, but results also depend on health, money, timing, other people and plain luck. When

things do not work out, that is not proof that you lacked faith or did something wrong.

His claim that the cause of success is "always in the person" can also sound harsh to anyone facing poverty, illness or unfair treatment. Read it as encouragement to act where you can, not as a judgment on people who struggle. The language is of its time, too: it assumes a male reader with a wife, and it uses blunt words for dishonest work. The repeated affirmations can be a helpful tool. If low confidence or persistent doubt runs deeper, though, talking with a counselor or therapist may help more than any exercise.

CHAPTER

I

The Definition of Success

GETTING WHAT you want is success; and success is an effect, coming from the application of a cause. Success is essentially the same in all cases; the difference is in the things the successful people want, but not in the success. Success is essentially the same, whether it results in the attainment of health, wealth, development or position; success is attainment, without regard to the things attained. And it is a law in nature that like causes always produce like effects; therefore, since success is the same in all cases, the cause of success must be the same in all cases.

The cause of success is always in the person who succeeds; you will see that this must be true, because if the cause of success were in nature, outside the person, then all persons similarly situated would succeed. The cause of success is not in the environment of the individual, because if it were, all persons within a given radius would be successful, and success would be wholly a matter of neighborhood; and we see that people whose environments are practically the same, and who live in the same neighborhood show us all degrees of success and failure; therefore, we know that the cause of success must be in the individual, and nowhere else.

It is, therefore, mathematically certain that you can succeed if you will find out the cause of success, and develop it to sufficient strength, and apply it properly to your work; for the application of a sufficient cause can not fail to produce a given effect. If there is a failure anywhere, of any kind, it is because the cause was either not sufficient or was not properly applied. The cause of success is some power within you; you have the power to develop any power to a limitless extent; for there is no end to mental growth; you can increase the strength of this power indefinitely, and so you can make it strong enough to do what you want to do, and to get what you want to get; when it is strong enough you can learn how to apply it to the work, and therefore, you can certainly succeed. All you have to learn is what is the cause of success, and how it must be applied.

The development of the special faculties to be used in your work is essential. We do not expect any one to succeed as a musician without developing the musical faculty; and it would be absurd to expect a machinist to succeed without developing the mechanical faculty, a clergyman to succeed without developing spiritual understanding and the use of words, or a banker to succeed without developing the faculty of finance. And in choosing a business, you should choose the one which will call for the use of your strongest faculties. If you have good mechanical ability, and are not spiritually minded and have no command of language, do not try to preach; and if you have the taste and talent to combine colors and fabrics into beautiful creation in millinery and dress, do not learn typewriting or stenography; get into a business which will use your strongest faculties, and develop these faculties all you can; and even this is not enough to insure success.

There are people with fine musical talent who fail as musicians; with good mechanical ability who fail as carpenters, blacksmiths and machinists; with deep spirituality and fluent use of language who fail as clergymen; with keen and logical minds who fail as lawyers, and so on; the special faculties used in your work are the tools you use, but success

does not depend alone on having good tools; it depends more on the power which uses and applies the tools. Be sure that your tools are the best and kept in the best condition; you can cultivate any faculty to any desired extent.

The application of the musical faculty causes success in music; that of the mechanical faculty causes success in mechanical pursuits; that of the financial faculty causes success in banking, and so on; and the something which applies these faculties, or causes them to be applied is the cause of success. The faculties are tools; the user of the tools is you, yourself; that in you which can cause you to use the tools in the right way, at the right time and in the right place is the cause of success. What is this something in the person which causes him to use his faculties successfully?

What it is and how to develop it will be fully explained in the next section; but before taking that up you should read this section over several times, so as to fix upon your mind the impregnable logic of the statement that you can succeed. You can; and if you study the foregoing argument well, you will be convinced that you can; and to become convinced that you can succeed is the first requisite to success.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles begins by defining success as simply getting what you want, whatever that is: health, money, growth or a position. Because success is the same kind of result every time, he reasons that it must have one cause, and that this cause lives inside the person. He points out that neighbors in the same circumstances get very different results. Talents matter, and he urges readers to choose work that uses their strongest abilities, but talents are only tools. What counts is the "something" that uses them well. Today this reads as a call to take ownership of the part you can control. It works best alongside an honest admission that circumstances still shape outcomes, sometimes heavily, and that a setback is not a verdict on your worth.

PRACTICE

Write down your three strongest abilities, and ask a friend to name theirs for you too. Then look at your current work or main project and note one concrete way it could use those strengths more fully this week.

KEY THOUGHT

to become convinced that you can
succeed is the first requisite to success.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

II

The Something Which Those Who Succeed Possess

THE FACULTIES of the human mind are the tools with which success is attained, and the right application of these tools to your work or business will do it successfully and get what you want. A few people succeed because they use their faculties successfully, and the majority, who have equally good faculties, fail because they use them unsuccessfully. There is something in the man who succeeds which enables him to use his faculties successfully, and this something must be cultivated by all who succeed; the question is, What is it?

It is hard to find a word which shall express it, and not be misleading. This something is Poise; and poise is peace and power combined; but it is more than poise, for poise is a condition, and this something is an action as well as a condition. This Something is Faith; but it is more than faith, as faith is commonly understood: As commonly understood, faith consists in the action of believing things which cannot be proved; and the Something which causes success is more than that. It is Conscious Power in Action. It is ACTIVE POWER-CONSCIOUSNESS.

Power-Consciousness is what you feel when you know that you can do a thing; and you know HOW to do the thing. If I can cause you to KNOW that you can succeed, and to know that you know HOW to

succeed, I have placed success within your grasp; for if you know that you can do a thing and know that you know how to do it, it is impossible that you should fail to do it, if you really try. When you are in full Power-Consciousness, you will approach the task in an absolutely successful frame of mind. Every thought will be a successful thought, every action a successful action; and if every thought and action is successful, the sum-total of all your actions cannot be failure.

What I have to do in these lessons, then, is to teach you how to create Power-Consciousness in yourself, so that you will know that you can do what you want to do and then to teach you how to do what you want to do. Read again the preceding section; it proves by unanswerable logic that you CAN succeed. It shows that all that is in any mind is in your mind; the difference, if any, being in development. It is a fact in nature that the undeveloped is always capable of development; we see then that the cause of success is in you, and is capable of full development. Having read this you must believe that it is possible for you to succeed; but it is not enough for you to believe that you can; you must know that you can; and the sub-conscious mind must know it as well as the objective mind. People have a way of saying, "he can who thinks he can"; but this is not true. It is not even true that he can who knows he can, if only the objective mind is spoken of; for the sub-conscious mind will often completely set aside and overcome what is positively known by the objective mind. It is a true statement, however, that he can whose sub-conscious mind knows that he can; and it is especially true if his objective mind has been trained to do the work. People fail because they think, objectively, that they can do things, but do not know, sub-consciously, that they can do them. It is more than likely that your sub-conscious mind is even now impressed with doubts of your ability to succeed; and these must be removed, or it will withhold its power when you need it most.

The sub-conscious mind is the source from which power comes in the action of any faculty; and a doubt will cause this power to be withheld,

and the action will be weak; therefore, your first step must be to impress your sub-conscious mind with the fact that you CAN. This must be done by repeated suggestions. Practice the following mental exercise several times a day, and especially just before going to sleep; think quietly about the sub-conscious mentality, which permeates your whole body as water permeates a sponge; as you think of this mind, try to feel it; you will soon be able to become conscious of it. Hold this consciousness, and say with deep, earnest feeling: "I CAN succeed! All that is possible to any one is possible to me. I AM successful. I do succeed, for I am full of the Power of Success." This is the simple truth. Realize that it is true, and repeat it over and over until your mentality is saturated through and through with the knowledge that YOU CAN DO WHAT YOU WANT TO DO. You can; other people have, and you can do more than any one has ever done, for no one has ever yet used all the power that is capable of being used. It is within your power to make a greater success in your business than any one has ever made before you.

Practice the above autosuggestion for a month with persistence, and you will begin to KNOW that you have within you that which CAN do what you want to do; and then you will be ready for the next section which will tell you how to proceed in doing what you want to do. But remember that it is absolutely essential that you should first impress upon the sub-conscious mind the knowledge that you CAN.



REFLECTION

Here Wattles names the inner cause of success. It is more than calm and more than ordinary belief: it is "Power-Consciousness," the felt knowledge that you can do something and know how to do it. He argues that the deeper, sub-conscious mind must be convinced, not just the thinking mind, because hidden doubt holds back effort just when it is needed. His method is repetition. Several times a day, and especially before sleep, quietly affirm that you can succeed. In

modern terms this is close to building self-efficacy through rehearsal and self-talk. It can steady nerves before a hard task. It works best when it is paired with real skill-building, so that confidence rests on something you actually practice.

PRACTICE

Choose one task you have been avoiding. Before bed for seven nights, take a slow breath and say quietly, "I can do this, and I am learning how." Each morning, take one small step on the task.

KEY THOUGHT

Power-Consciousness is what you feel when you know that you can do a thing; and you know HOW to do the thing.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

III

The Right Way to Get What You Want

HAVING FILLED your mentality, conscious and sub-conscious, with the faith that you CAN get what you want, the next question is one of the methods. You know that you can do it if you proceed in the right way; but which is the right way?

This much is certain; to get more, you must make constructive use of what you have. You cannot use what you have not; therefore, your problem is how to make the most constructive use of what you already have. Do not waste any time considering how you would use certain things if you had them; consider, simply, how to use what you have. It is also certain that you will progress more rapidly if you make the most perfect use of what you have. In fact, the degree of rapidity with which you attain what you want will depend upon the perfection with which you use what you have. Many people are at a standstill, or find things coming their way very slowly because they are making only partial use of present means, power and opportunities.

You may see this point more plainly by considering an analogy in nature. In the process of evolution, the squirrels developed their leaping power to its fullest extent; then a continuous effort to advance brought forth the flying squirrel, which has a membrane uniting the legs in such a

way as to form a parachute and enable the animal to sail some distance beyond an ordinary leap. A little extension of the parachute jump of the flying squirrel produced the bat, which has membranous wings and can fly; and continuous flight produced the bird with feathered wings. The transition from one plane to another was accomplished simply by perfecting and extending functions. If the squirrels had not kept leaping further and further, there would have been no flying squirrel, and no power of flight. Making constructive use of the leaping power produced flight. If you are only jumping half as far as you can, you will never fly.

In nature, we see that life advances from one plane to another by perfecting function on the lower plane. Whenever an organism contains more life than it can express by functioning perfectly on its own plane, it begins to perform the functions of the next higher, or larger plane. The first squirrel which began to develop the parachute membrane must have been a very perfect leaper. This is the fundamental principle of evolution, and of all attainment.

In accordance with this principle, then, you can advance only by more than filling your present place. You must do, perfectly, all that you can do now; and it is the law that by doing perfectly all that you can do now you will become able to do later things which you cannot do now. The doing to perfection of one thing invariably provides us with the equipment for doing the next larger thing, because it is a principle inherent in nature that life continuously advances. Every person who does one thing perfect is instantly presented with an opportunity to begin doing the next larger thing. This is the universal law of all life, and is unfailing. First, do perfectly all that you can do now; keep on doing it perfectly until the doing of it becomes so easy that you have surplus power left after doing it; then by this surplus power you will get a hold on the work of a higher plane, and begin to extend your correspondence with environment.

Get into a business which will use your strongest faculties, even if you must commence at the bottom; then develop those faculties to the

utmost. Cultivate power-consciousness, so that you can apply your faculties successfully, and apply them in doing perfectly everything you can do now, where you are now. Do not wait for a change of environment; it may never come. Your only way of reaching a better environment is by making constructive use of your present environment. Only the most complete use of your present environment will place you in a more desirable one.

If you wish to extend your present business, remember that you can only do it by doing in the most perfect manner the business you already have. When you put life enough into your business to more than fill it, the surplus will get you more business. Do not reach out after more until you have life to spare after doing perfectly all that you have to do now. It is of no advantage to have more work or more business than you have life to do perfectly; if that is the case, increase your vital power first. And remember, it is the perfection with which you do what you have to do now that extends your field and brings you in touch with a larger environment.

Bear in mind that the motive force which gets you what you want is life; and that what you want, in the last analysis, is only an opportunity to live more; and that, therefore, you can get what you want only through the operation of that universal law by which all life advances continuously into fuller expression. That law is that whenever an organism has more life than can find expression by functioning perfectly on a given plane, its surplus life lifts it to the next higher plane. When you put enough of yourself into your present work to do it perfectly, your surplus power will extend your work into a larger field. It is also essential that you should have in mind what you want, so that your surplus power may be turned in the right direction.

Form a clear conception of what you seek to accomplish, but do not let what you seek to accomplish interfere with doing perfectly what you have to do now. Your concept of what you want is a guide to your energies, and an inspiration to cause you to apply them to the utmost to

your present work. Live for the future now. Suppose that your desire is to have a department store, and you have only capital enough to start a peanut stand. Do not try to start a department store today, on a peanut stand capital; but start the peanut stand in the full faith and confidence that you will be able to develop it into a department store. Look upon the peanut stand merely as the beginning of the department store, and make it grow; you can.

Get more business by using constructively the business you have now; get more friends by using constructively the friends you already have; get a better position by using constructively the one you now have; get more domestic happiness by the constructive use of the love that already exists in your home.

✦

REFLECTION

The method, Wattles says, is to make full and "constructive" use of what you already have instead of daydreaming about what you would do with more. He uses an image from evolution: the squirrel that leaps as far as it can comes before the flying squirrel. Life moves up a level when it more than fills its present one. So do your present work so well that you have energy to spare, and that surplus will carry you into larger work. Keep a clear picture of your goal, but do not let it pull attention from today. His peanut stand, treated as the first department of a future store, captures the idea. It is a patient, practical message about compounding small efforts, and it applies to friendships and family as much as to business.

PRACTICE

Pick one area: job, business, friendship or home. List what you already have there: skills, contacts, time, goodwill. Choose one of these resources and use it more fully today, for example by finishing a task completely or reaching out to a contact.

KEY THOUGHT

If you are only jumping half as far as you can, you will never fly.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

IV

Having the Best of Everything

YOU CAN obtain what you want only by applying your faculties to your work and your environment; you become able to apply your faculties successfully by acquiring Power-Consciousness; and you go forward by a concentration on today's work, and by doing perfectly everything that can be done at the present time. You can get what you want in the future only by concentrating all your energies upon the constructive use of whatever you are in relation with today. An indifferent or half-hearted use of the elements in today's environment will be fatal to tomorrow's attainment.

Do not desire for today what is beyond your ability to get today; but be sure you get today the very best that can be had. Never take less than the very best that can be had at the present time; but do not waste energy by desiring what cannot be had at the present time. If you always have the best that can be had, you will continue to have better and better things, because it is a fundamental principle in the universe that life shall continually advance into more life, and into the use of more and better things; this is the principle which causes evolution. But if you are satisfied with less than the best that can be had, you will cease to move forward.

Every transaction and relation of today whether it be business, domestic or social, must be made a stepping stone to what you want in the future; and to accomplish this you must put into each more than enough life to fill it. There must be surplus power in everything you do. It is this surplus power which causes advancement and gets you what you want; where there is no surplus power there is no advancement and no attainment. It is the surplus of life above and beyond the functions of present environment which causes evolution; and evolution is advancing into more life, or getting what you want.

Suppose, for instance, you are in trade or a profession, and wish to increase your business; it will not do, when you sell goods or service to make the matter a merely perfunctory transaction, taking the customer's money, giving him good value, and letting him go away feeling that you had no interest in the matter beyond giving him a fair deal and profiting thereby. Unless he feels that you have a personal interest in him and his needs, and that you are honestly desirous to increase his welfare, you have made a failure and are losing ground. When you can make every customer feel that you are really trying to advance his interests as well as your own, your business will grow. It is not necessary to give premiums, or heavier weights or better values than others give to accomplish this; it is done by putting life and interest into every transaction, however small.

If you desire to change your avocation, make your present business a stepping-stone to the one you want. As long as you are in your present business, fill it with life; the surplus will tend toward what you want. Take a live interest in every man, woman and child you meet in either a business or social way, and sincerely desire the best for them; they will soon begin to feel that your advancement is a matter of interest to them and they will unite their thoughts for your good. This will form a battery of power in your favor and will open ways of advancement for you.

If you are an employee and desire promotion, put life into everything you do; put in more than enough life and interest to fill each piece of work. But do not be servile; never be a flunkey; and above all things avoid the intellectual prostitution which is the vice of our times in many trades and most professions. I mean by this the being a mere hired apologist for and defender of immorality, graft, dishonesty, or vice in any form. The intellectual prostitute may rise in the service, but he is a lost soul. Respect yourself; be absolutely just to all; put LIFE into every act and thought and fix Power-Conscious thought upon the fact that you are entitled to promotion; it will come as soon as you can more than fill your present place in every day. If it does not come from your present employer it will come from another; it is the law that whosoever more than fills his present place must be advanced. But for this law there could be no evolution, and no progress; but mark well what follows.

It is not enough that you should merely put surplus life into your business relations. You will not advance far if you are a good business man or employee, but a bad husband, an unjust father, or, an untrustworthy friend. Your failure in these respects will make you incapable of using your success for the advancement of life, and so you will not come under the operation of the constructive law. Many a man who fulfills the law in business is prevented from progressing because he is unkind to his wife, or deficient in some other relation of life. To come under the operation of the evolutionary force you must more than fill EVERY present relation. A telegraph operator desired to get away from the key, and get onto a small farm; and he began to move in that direction by being "good" to his wife. He "courted" her, without any reference to his desire; and from being half indifferent she became interested and eager to help; soon they had a little piece of ground in the edge of the town, and she raised poultry and superintended a garden while he "pounded the key"; now they have a farm and he has obtained his desire. You can secure the co-operation, not only of your wife but of

all the people around you by putting life and interest into all your relations with them.

Put into every relation, business, domestic or social, more than enough life to fill that relation; have faith, which is Power-Consciousness; know what you want in the future, but have today the very best that can be obtained today; never be satisfied at any time with less than the best that can be had at that time, but never waste energy in desiring what is not to be had now; use all things for the advancement of life for yourself and for all with whom you are related in any way. Follow out these principles of action and you cannot fail to get what you want; for the universe is so constructed that all things must work together for your good.

✦

REFLECTION

This chapter widens the method. Do not wish for what you cannot have today, Wattles says, but never settle for less than the best that is actually available now. Put more than enough life into every transaction and relationship. A customer should leave feeling you care about their welfare, not just their money. An employee should give full effort without becoming servile, and should refuse to defend dishonesty for pay. Most striking, he insists that success at work cannot make up for unkindness at home. His story of the telegraph operator who courts his wife and builds a farm with her shows this. The language assumes a male reader, but the point is universal: lasting progress needs integrity and warmth in every part of life.

PRACTICE

Think of one relationship you have been treating as routine, such as a partner, a colleague or a regular customer. Today, do one small thing that shows real interest in their good, with no request attached. Notice how the exchange feels.

KEY THOUGHT

To come under the operation of the evolutionary force you must more than fill EVERY present relation.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

V

Concluding Thoughts

WEALTH-CULTURE CONSISTS in making constructive use of the people and things in your environment.

First, get a clear mental picture of what you want. If your present business or profession is not the one most suitable to your talents and tastes, decide upon the one which is most suitable; and determine to get into that business or profession, and to achieve the very greatest success in it. Get a clear idea of what you want to do, and get a mental concept of the utmost success in that business or profession; and determine that you will attain to that. Give a great deal of time to forming this concept or mental picture; the more clear and definite it is, the easier will be your work. The man who is not quite sure what he wants to build will put up a wobbling and shaky structure.

Know what you want, and keep the picture of it in the background of your mind night and day; let it be like a picture on the wall of your room, always in your consciousness, night and day. And then begin to move toward it. Remember that if you have not the fully developed talent now, you can develop it as you go along; you can surely do what you want to do.

It is quite likely that at present you cannot do the thing you want to do because you are not in the right environment, and have not the

necessary capital; but this does not hinder you from beginning to move toward the right environment, and from beginning to acquire capital. Remember that you move forward only by doing what you can in your present environment. Suppose that you have only capital enough to operate a newsstand, and your great desire is to own a department store; do not get the idea that there is some magical method by which you can successfully operate a department store on a newsstand capital. There is, however, a mental science method by which you can so operate a newsstand as to certainly cause it to grow into a department store. Consider that your newsstand is one department of the store you are going to have; fix your mind on the department store, and begin to assimilate the rest of it. You will get it, if you make every act and thought constructive.

To make every act and thought constructive, every one must convey the idea of increase. Steadily hold in mind the thought of advancement for yourself; know that you are advancing toward what you want, and act and speak in this faith. Then every word and act will convey the idea of advancement and increase to others, and they will be drawn to you. Always remember that what all people are seeking for is increase.

First, study over the facts in regard to the great abundance until you know that there is wealth for you, and that you do not have to take this wealth from any one else. Avoid the competitive spirit. You can readily see that if there is limitless abundance there is enough for you, without robbing any one else. Then, knowing that it is the purpose of nature that you should have what you want, reflect upon the fact that you can get it only by acting. Consider that you can act only upon your present environment; and do not try to act now upon environment of the future. Then remember that in acting upon your present environment, you must make every act a success in itself; and that in doing this you must hold the purpose to get what you want. You can hold this purpose only as you get a clear mental picture of what you want; be sure that you have that. Also, remember that your actions will not have dynamic

moving power unless you have an unwavering faith that you get what you want.

Form a clear mental picture of what you want; hold the purpose to get it; do everything perfectly, not in a servile spirit, but because you are a master mind; keep unwavering faith in your ultimate attainment of your goal, and you cannot fail to move forward.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles closes by gathering the threads into a short program. Get a clear mental picture of what you want and keep it in view "night and day." Begin from where you are, because a newsstand cannot be run as a department store, though it can be grown toward one. Let every act and word carry a sense of increase, so that others feel advanced by dealing with you. Remember that abundance does not require taking from anyone, and give up the competitive spirit. Finally, act with steady faith. His promise that you "cannot fail" should be read as encouragement, not a guarantee. Still, the combination he describes, a clear aim, present action and generosity toward others, is a sound way to work toward almost any goal.

PRACTICE

Write one paragraph describing, in concrete detail, what you want to be doing three years from now. Below it, write the single action you can take this week in your present situation that moves you toward it. Put the page where you will see it.

KEY THOUGHT

Wealth-culture consists in making constructive use of the people and things in your environment.

MY OWN NOTES

Making the Man Who Can

1909 · NINE CHAPTERS

About This Work

MAKING THE Man Who Can was first published in 1909, and it was later reissued under the title How to Promote Yourself. The text in this edition has been restored from a later re-edition. Like several of Wattles' works, it reads as a course of lessons: the first chapter speaks of "this series of lessons" and refers back to "former articles" and to his books. It belongs to the same productive period as The Science of Getting Rich, and the two books share many ideas.

The book moves in three stages. It opens with Wattles' New Thought view that all is one living, intelligent Spirit, and that power comes from unity with it. It then turns practical. A successful person is "self-directing" rather than driven by circumstance. Strong desire shows a real capacity. You advance by "more than filling your present place." Finally, it sets out his "Law of Opulence": nature holds enough for everyone, so competition rests on a mistaken belief in scarcity, and real success means giving others more in life-value than you take from them in cash value. These chapters also show his Christian socialist outlook, with sharp words about wage labor and hope for a fairer system, alongside his belief that inner change must come first.

Several cautions apply. Wattles writes that success becomes "a certainty, and failure rendered impossible," and that dollars will move toward the person of faith. No book can promise wealth. Effort, generosity and clear aims matter, but so do circumstances, health, timing

and luck. His claims about unlimited resources and food supply are also those of a hopeful age and are not reliable facts today.

The last chapter, "Talk That Builds," needs special care. It says that only the ignorant, lazy or incompetent are poor, and it dismisses relief work and campaigns against child labor. Many people are poor because of illness, disability, discrimination, low wages, debt or bad luck. Poverty is not a personal failing, and no one should be blamed for it. The chapter's useful point is narrower: how we talk about our lives can shape our hope and our choices. It also contains terms that are now considered outdated or offensive. Read it as a historical document. If money worries or low mood weigh on you, a financial counselor, a doctor or a therapist can offer real help.

CHAPTER

I

The Powerful Life—Whence Comes the Power?

THAT THERE is a successful, powerful life; that it may be lived here; that it may be lived by anyone, we are obliged to concede; and having conceded this we cannot fail to wish to live this life, for rightly lived, it means health, wealth, power, happiness and all round success in life. Those who read this series of lessons are going to learn how to live it, and they need first to understand a little as to what the power is and whence it comes.

We are just passing from the physical, animal or material stage of development to the mental and spiritual stage. We are ceasing to be physical men and women and becoming mental and spiritual men and women. To make this change is sometimes a matter of considerable difficulty. The majority of people are not as yet making it at all. They are still entirely material in their beliefs and thought. They do not see the world of Spirit; they put their faith in houses and lands and money and so on, and because they believe in these things they are subject to them. The only powerful life of which they conceive is a life of physical power.

New Thought people, they whose spiritual eyes are becoming opened; who begin to see the inner and finer world penetrating the false appearances of the world of matter; who begin to see Spirit as the cause

of matter and of what is called natural phenomena, these are they to whom Jesus referred in speaking to Nicodemus; they have been born of the Spirit and they begin to see the Kingdom of God. They get glimpses of a powerful life which may be lived in the flesh and here on earth; occasionally they enter upon it and live it for a time, but their great difficulty is lack of understanding as to what the power is and how the life must be lived. This we are going to find out.

The first step is to learn the great truth about the universe which is that all is one. All things are forms of one Substance; that Substance is conscious and intelligent; it is Spirit. In former articles and in my books I have referred to this Original Substance under various names, as the supreme, the Thinking Stuff, God, All-Mind and so on; but here I shall use the one word, Spirit. Substance is Spirit; everything is Spirit; there isn't anything but Spirit.

Before you can fully believe this great truth you will have to learn to disbelieve much of what your senses tell you, and it is easy to do this when you understand how unreliable the senses are. The physical man depends upon the senses for everything. To him seeing is believing, and he accepts as real the appearances around him; but in reality he is grossly deceived; he lives in an unreal world, his whole universe is a deception, and not what it seems to him at all.

This man must believe that he lives on a flat world under a solid blue arch; the sun and moon travel over him and his earth is stationary and the stars are small points of life. These are the appearances of the physical world as given us by the senses, yet no civilized person now really believes in them; we know that the earth is round, that the sky is not solid, that the stars are very much larger than the earth, and that the earth goes round the sun. No well informed person believes what he sees as to these things; he looks through appearances to the reality.

Take another illustration. Nothing appears more real than color and one can hardly doubt that the objects around us are really of the hue they appear; that the grass is green and the robin's breast is red and so on.

But there is no color except in consciousness. When an object appears to us to be of a given color, as red, it is not really so. The "red" object reflects or refuses to absorb and receive the red in the ray of light which strikes it and throws it back to the eye; we see the color it rejects and not the color it is. Where there is no eye to receive the reflection, color has no existence. So it does not do to believe appearances to be true; we must look through them and see the only reality and the only reality of all things is Spirit.

The first step to be taken by those who would lead the Powerful Life is to cease to be misled by appearances, and to perceive truth; to cease to believe in what seems to be and to have faith in what is. They must get to the heart of things, and instead of trying to reason from appearances to realities they must believe realities and disregard appearances.

Spirit is Substance and all Substance is Spirit. There cannot be two Substances. The moment we admit that there are two Substances as Spirit and matter we are absolutely lost. If matter is distinct from Spirit then it has powers and potentialities of its own and may affect us for good or ill. So, if we believe this, we shall become more and more tied down to matter which we can see and have less and less faith in Spirit which we cannot see or can only feel; and the Powerful Life will become impossible to us. We must see that Spirit is Substance and that it is the only Substance. Nothing exists but Spirit.

Next we must come to understand that Spirit is life, and that it is all the life there is. Nothing lives but Spirit. Every thought of man, every volition of any animal, every unfoldment of leaf or blossom is Spirit, acting in the thing that moves. Spirit lives in the grass and flowers and trees; in flesh and insect; in animals and men. There is *no* life but the life of Spirit. "He giveth life to all." "In Him we live and move and have our being." Nothing has individual life or life of its own. It is all the life of Spirit.

Again, all power is Spirit. Every movement in nature or art from the flutter of a leaf to the rushing of the giant current through the dynamo

formed by man is Spirit. And in it all and through it all Spirit is working intelligently to some great purpose or purposes of His own.

That there is intelligence through the power of nature is shown for one thing among many by continuity. Everything works under the same laws, yesterday, today and forever. But suppose one day the water pipes ran water and the next day gasoline; one day you weighed one hundred and ten pounds and the next day half a ton, the laws of gravity and chemistry working in contrary fashion; then you might suspect that there were two forces in nature or that the one force was an unintelligent one.

If you want to live the Powerful Life of Samson, Napoleon, or of the evangelist,—and you do, you are reaching out for more power. This is what we are all seeking. Whether we want merely to become rich or whether we wish to excel in society or to rear our children well or become benefactors of humanity, the only thing we require is power and ability to lead the Powerful life.

At the close of this first chapter I bring you to this fact, which if you can grasp it fully, will give you the foundation on which you must stand in leading the life, and if you go on with the succeeding lessons will certainly enable you to lead it.

We live and move and have our being in the limitless ocean of intelligent Spirit from whom we draw our life and power, physical, mental and spiritual. All power is in this Spirit. And we may learn to so unify ourselves with Spirit that more and more power shall be ours, in fact we may have all the power that He can trust us with, and it is only then, a matter of making ourselves trustworthy.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles opens with his spiritual foundation. Humanity, he says, is moving from a purely material stage toward a mental and spiritual one. The senses mislead

us, as they once suggested a flat earth and a moving sun, so we must look past appearances to what is real. For him that reality is one Substance, conscious and intelligent, which he calls Spirit. All life and all power are Spirit at work. The more we unite ourselves with it, and become trustworthy, the more power we can draw on. Readers today need not share his metaphysics to take something from it: the idea that strength grows from a sense of connection to something larger than yourself, and from character more than from things.

PRACTICE

Spend five quiet minutes outdoors or by a window. Notice one ordinary living thing, such as a plant, a bird or a tree. Reflect on the life in it, and then on the life in you. Write one sentence about what that connection means to you.

KEY THOUGHT

it is only then, a matter of making ourselves trustworthy.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

II

The Business Attitude

LIKE CAUSES, under like conditions, produce like effects; business success is an effect, and cannot be an exception to the law of cause and effect. The cause of success is the person who succeeds; something in him has been applied to his work, and has produced a certain result. What is it in an individual which produces the result of success? It is not physical strength, although physical strength may be a great aid; all strong people do not succeed, however, and those who do have the ability to so apply their physical strength as to make it assist in producing the result of success. It is not intellectual ability, for all intellectually able people do not succeed; those who do have the power to so direct their intellectual ability as to make it assist in the achievement of success.

The potency which makes the successful person, therefore, is the power to so apply physical and mental ability as to produce results. This power must be an attitude of the individual himself. It is not a special gift to a few, nor is it a rudimentary faculty which each may develop; it is a position to be assumed. If his abilities and energies are to be directed, it is the person himself who must direct them; and if he directs them he is the potency which causes success.

Every human being has the inherent power to direct his own abilities and energies; and everyone is conscious of having this power. It is because a person has it that he is capable of growth and progress. To make a successful person, it is necessary to make one who knows what things result in success, and who will direct his energies to do those things; and the first essential to this is that he should assume the attitude of self-direction.

Every man is either self-directing or directed by the suggestions which come from his environment. The individual who can is always a self-directing one; the one who is directed by suggestion is the one who cannot. The individual who is directed by suggestion has a "horoscope"; his destiny is decided by heredity and environment; the self-directing person does not allow his thoughts to be dictated by heredity, environment or the stars; he thinks what he wants to think, and if his horoscope does not suit him he makes a better one.

Business success depends upon business policy; business policy can only be formulated by thought; therefore, whether a person succeeds or fails depends upon the way he thinks.

The directed man only thinks the thoughts which are suggested by his environment; and so he can only do what those around him think he can do.

The self-directing man thinks what he wants to think, and can therefore do what he wants to do.

To become the man who can, the first step is to take the attitude of self-direction.

Receive and consider every suggestion which comes from your environment, but do not act on the suggestion; act on your own conclusions about the suggestion.

Digest and assimilate suggestions as you digest and assimilate food; make them a part of your own thought before you use them, and learn to reject any that are indigestible.

REFLECTION

This short chapter makes one central claim: the successful person is self-directing. Strength and intelligence help, but what produces results is the power to direct your own abilities, and Wattles says this is not a rare gift but "a position to be assumed." People who are directed by suggestion think only what their surroundings tell them, so they can do only what others expect of them. The self-directing person listens to every suggestion, weighs it, and then acts on their own conclusions. His image is digestion: take in ideas, make them your own, and reject what does not agree with you. In an age of constant advice and online opinion, this is a timely habit of independent thinking.

PRACTICE

Next time someone gives you advice, or you read a strong opinion online, pause before acting on it. Write down the suggestion, then your own conclusion about it, and act only on the second.

KEY THOUGHT

Receive and consider every suggestion which comes from your environment, but do not act on the suggestion; act on your own conclusions about the suggestion.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

III

What You Desire

SUCCESS IS becoming what you want to be, and is obtained by applying your energies to your work; and you will apply your energies in exact proportion to the intensity of your desire, and to your faith in your ability to become what you want to be.

The intensity of your desire will depend on the clearness with which you picture to yourself what you want to be.

Vague and indefinite longings will never call out your best effort. Form a mental picture of what you want to be, and of all that you want in person, property and environment; dwell upon it until it is clear and definite to you, and hold it until it arouses intense desire.

Think about this picture until you are always conscious of it, no matter what you may be doing, so that it is always in the background of your consciousness.

But even though you have strong desire you will not put forth your best effort without confidence; you will have to think you can before you can. And you cannot think you can unless you feel that you can; and so you need to have demonstrated to you the fact that you cannot feel that you can unless you have within you the power that can.

In other words, if you strongly desire to do a thing, it is certain proof that you have the power to do it.

Desire is the result of feeling, and the feeling which results in desire is a faculty seeking expression.

The desire to sing or play music is the musical faculty seeking expression, and if there were no faculty, or power, there could be no desire. We cannot desire things which do not harmonize with the forces within, for a thing which does not harmonize with the forces within is repulsive to us. Things only harmonize with those of the same essential nature; therefore, if you desire a thing it is because that thing is essentially and potentially within you.

What is within you essentially must be within you potentially. When we see a generous and sympathetic person we desire to be like him because the sight arouses generosity and sympathy within us; and the power to be, seeking expression, causes the desire to be.

When we hear a great oration or a beautiful song, we desire to execute a similar performance because the faculties of oratory or music respond to the stimulus and seek expression.

Desire is a power seeking expression. You cannot desire what is not potentially within you; and therefore, you can be what you want to be. The fact that you want to be is proof that you can be.

First, form a clear conception of what you want to be in person, property and environment; and then understand that in so far as your desires are not contrary to Eternal Justice it is absolutely certain that you can be what you want to be.



REFLECTION

Wattles argues that desire is a capacity trying to express itself. You long to sing because there is music in you; you admire a generous person because generosity stirs within you. So, he concludes, a strong desire is itself evidence that you can achieve it. He advises forming a clear, detailed picture of what you want to be, holding it until it becomes intense desire, and keeping it always in

the background of your mind. This is an encouraging idea, especially for people who doubt their own wishes. It is wise, though, to treat it as a hopeful starting point rather than proof: desire points toward potential, but skill, time, support and circumstances still decide how far it can grow.

PRACTICE

Write down one thing you have long wanted to do or become. Beneath it, list the qualities in you that this desire reveals, such as curiosity, care or a love of beauty. Choose one small way to express that quality this week.

KEY THOUGHT

Desire is a power seeking expression.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

IV

Becoming What You Want to Be

SUCCESS IS a progressive evolution of the faculties of the successful individual. To understand this, remember that success is becoming what you want to be; becoming what you want to be consists in satisfying your desires, and desire is the effort of a faculty to come into action. Each gain in money or position that a man may make enables him to bring into use a new faculty, or to make fuller use of an old one; this satisfies desire, and is success.

The man who can use the most of his faculties is the man who can; and because he is a person who can, he is a successful one.

Success, then, being an evolution of the successful human being, must follow the evolutionary principle of action; and the basic fact in evolution is that each lower plane contains all the potentialities required to perform the functions of the higher plane.

On ascending to a higher plane, new faculties are brought into use; but we also see the continued use of the faculties which were active on the lower plane; and it is the complete development of these faculties, or their fullest possible use which makes ascension to a higher plane possible.

Evolution never reaches the higher plane from imperfectly developed specimens on the lower plane, but always from the most perfectly developed.

In other words, it is the evolutionary principle that those organisms which function most perfectly on the lower plane are nearest to the higher plane; and the way to approach the higher plane is by perfecting function on the lower plane.

More than this is necessary, however, for if no organism ever did more than to function perfectly on its own plane there would be no evolution.

Evolution begins when organisms begin to add to the necessary functions of the plane on which they are living; calling into use faculties which can be perfected only on a higher plane.

Your present work may not be the work you want to do; but unless you can do your present work perfectly you are not ready for the work you want to do. And even when you can do your present work perfectly, if that is all that you can do you are not ready for anything else.

It is only when you can do your present work perfectly, *and do some other work besides*, that you are ready to advance.

Evolution is brought about by developing the faculties which are to be used on a higher plane; and this is done by first doing perfectly the work of the lower plane and then adding to it, so as to bring other faculties into use, or to so develop those already in use that they become too large to find expression on the lower plane.

To rise, you must not only fill your present place, but you must more than fill it: it is that part of you which projects beyond the boundaries of your present place which gets hold on the higher place. The evolutionary principle of success is that you should more than fill your present place; and you can succeed in no other way.

REFLECTION

Here Wattles applies his idea of evolution to personal growth. Life rises to a higher level only from the most fully developed forms on the level below. So doing your present work perfectly is necessary but not enough. You are ready to advance when you can do your present work well and also do something more, using abilities that point toward the next stage. The part of you that "projects beyond the boundaries" of your present place is what takes hold of a higher one. The biology is simplified, but the advice is practical: master your current role, then stretch beyond it by learning and taking on work that prepares you for the role you want.

PRACTICE

Name one skill your next desired role would require that your current one does not. This week, spend thirty minutes practicing or learning it, through a course, a book or a small side task at work.

KEY THOUGHT

To rise, you must not only fill your present place, but you must more than fill it

---

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

V

Promoting Yourself

THE SUCCESSFUL life is the advancing life; and the advancing life is lived by obedience to the evolutionary principle. The evolutionary principle is that advancement which comes by more than filling your present place; and this is true whether you are an employee, or are in business for yourself.

However, a mere purposeless doing of more work than is required will not advance you; it will probably only tend to keep you where you are. If you are an employee and have no ambition to more than fill your present place, it will be to your employer's interest to keep you in your present place; and he will probably do so. You must know what you want to be, and you must more than fill your present place for the purpose of becoming what you want to be.

Do not do extra work with the idea that by so doing you may curry favor with your employer; that will put you in a servile attitude, and out of the attitude of self-direction.

Do not do it in the hope that those above you will see your good service and promote you; they may find it more profitable to keep you where you are.

Do what you do with the purpose of promoting your self.

You are more than filling your place in order to develop your faculties for filling a larger place; if your employer does not offer you one when you are ready for it, offer yourself to another employer.

There are always places for the Advancing Man.

Keep your mind fixed on what you want to be, and more than fill your present place; your mental attitude will make you quick to see every opportunity for bettering your condition, and you will be competent to take advantage of opportunities when they come.

Do not wait for an opportunity to be all that you want to be; be all that you can today, and when an opportunity to be more is offered to you, take it.

There is no such thing as lack of opportunities for the man who is living the advancing life, and who has an advancing mind. Everything that touches your life is an opportunity, if you discover its proper use.

Every circumstance, every seeming misfortune, every person you meet, every dog that barks at you, or wags its tail as you pass—all have some element of usefulness to you if you will find it. Study them all, for they are your opportunities. Most men fail by waiting for some particular kind of opportunity, instead of being ready to seize every opportunity.

Steadily hold the picture of all that you want to attain in person, property and environment; live the advancing life within, by more than filling your present place; live the accumulative life without, by acquiring everything you meet which belongs in your picture, and you cannot fail.

The stars in their courses will fight for you; your success will be made by the evolutionary principle, the creative power of the universe.

REFLECTION

Wattles tells employees to do more than their job requires, but for the right reason. Extra work done to win favor makes you servile, and you cannot count on a boss to notice, since it may pay them to keep you where you are. Instead, more than fill your place in order to develop yourself, keep your goal clearly in mind, and if your employer does not offer you a larger place when you are ready, offer yourself elsewhere. He also urges seeing every person and circumstance as a possible opportunity. This is a self-respecting view of career growth. It also fits a modern world where people often change employers and take charge of their own development.

PRACTICE

Write down what you want your next role to be. Then list two things you are doing now that build toward it, and one you could add. Set a date to review whether your current workplace can offer that next step.

KEY THOUGHT

Do what you do with the purpose of promoting your self.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VI

The Advancing Thought

IF YOU are in business for yourself, the evolutionary principle of success is the same as if you were working for another. You must keep in mind what you want to become, and more than fill your present place each day.

That does not mean that you are to try to do part of tomorrow's work today. You have nothing to do with tomorrow's work, except to be ready for it when it comes; but you must do all that is necessary for today's business, and something for increase. In every transaction you must keep the advancing mind; you must put the expanding thought into everything you do, and communicate it to every person with whom you have dealings.

If you sell a pound of sugar, do it with the thought that the purchaser's trade is valuable because he will soon be able to buy in barrel lots; if a child buys a penny's worth of candy, put into the sale the thought that he will one day buy a five pound box; and in each case see that the customer gets the thought.

Put into every sale the thought of advance for the customer as well as for yourself; soon they will all feel that they are getting bargains in everything. And they will be right.

If you thus put the advancing thought into every transaction, your customers will get it in regard to their own affairs; and they will begin to be more successful and will mentally connect their success with you.

This will strongly attract them to you; the best bargain you can give another person is to communicate to him the advancing thought in regard to his own affairs. No "premium" or "rebate" is equal to it.

When you send a person away feeling that he is advancing, and becoming a more valuable customer, you give him the strongest possible inducement to visit you again.

If you communicate the advancing thought to your customers, they will begin to make successes because of it; and intuitively connecting their successes with you, will come to you for more power. You will build them up, and they, in turn, will build you up.

The man who can give the advancing thought to all who deal with him cannot fail; he has exactly what he is seeking.

This principle holds good whether you are a merchant, an artist, a professional man, actor, singer no matter what. You can more than fill your present place; so that your customers, patrons or audiences will know that they are getting a bargain.

It is not the quantity or quality of the goods that makes the bargain; it is the feeling of advancement, or increase.

> *The basic element of success in business is, therefore, to hold the thought and the mental attitude of advancement; and to more than fill your present place.*

And you more than fill your place by so doing your work that those who deal with you are conscious of being advanced by you.

By study and application of the evolutionary principle, success is made a certainty, and failure rendered impossible.

REFLECTION

For anyone who serves customers, clients or audiences, Wattles' principle is to share "the advancing thought." Do today's work fully and add something for growth, and in every exchange communicate a sense of increase to the other person. Treat the child buying a penny's worth of candy as a future customer for a whole box. When people leave feeling that they are moving forward, they connect that feeling with you and return. A real bargain, he says, is not about quantity or price but about the sense of being advanced. Modern readers will recognize the value of service that leaves people encouraged. His claim that failure becomes "impossible" is hope rather than a guarantee.

PRACTICE

In your next three interactions with a customer, client or colleague, add one sentence that points to their progress or future, such as noting how far a project has come. Afterward, jot down how each person responded.

KEY THOUGHT

It is not the quantity or quality of the goods that makes the bargain; it is the feeling of advancement, or increase.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VII

The Law of Opulence

"Except a man be born again he cannot see the kingdom of God."

IN LIVING the new life the first essential is to abandon the idea of competition and of a limited supply. Too many people who consider themselves practitioners of the new thought never entirely succeed in doing this.

Competition in business originates in the idea of a limited supply. It grows out of the supposition that because there is not enough to go round, people must compete with each other for what there is.

Many people who have a partial grasp of the new thought still suppose that it is necessary that some should be poor in order that others may have enough, and believe that wealth is possible only to those who have superior ability, or the power to attract to themselves a larger portion from the limited supply.

These people try to apply the new thought principles on the competitive plane, and they do so with a fair degree of success; they try to develop a superior attracting power; they inject new motives and new energy into competitive business methods; they assert, "I am success," all the while believing that they can succeed only because ninety-five per cent of all others fail.

The majority of these competitive new thought people do achieve a great measure of success because their faith gives them just the energy, push and optimism which are necessary in competitive business. The confidence born of their belief makes a majority of their actions successful actions; their partial application of new thought ideas makes them exceptionally able competitors, and they attribute their success to thought-power and to affirmation when it is almost purely competitive.

This so-called new thought is really only the highest and most fully perfected form of the old thought. It only sees Caesar's kingdom after all; it has no conception of the kingdom of God.

All the final results show that these new thought people are only a part of Caesar's kingdom. Their fortunes fluctuate. They meet with losses and their business suffers from panics. Their prosperity is checkered by periods of adversity. Their sense of safety is mere self-confidence; deep in the subconscious they always carry the germ of secret fear.

No one can ever be wholly free from fear who recognizes any limitation in the supply, for if there is not enough to go round, we know that our turn to go without may come at any time.

The lapses and failures of new thought people are traceable directly to the idea of a limited supply; to the idea that success and the attainment of wealth are possible only to a part of us.

Is there any truth in this idea that competition is necessary? Let us see. The things that are essential to life and advancement, mental and physical, may be roughly grouped under five headings, and these are: Food, clothing, shelter, education and amusement. For three of these, food, clothing and shelter, we look to the world of nature for supply. These three with their paraphernalia and extensions in the way of luxuries, decorations, art and beauty, constitute what we call wealth. Is there any limitation to the supply of these?

Take into consideration, first, the question of food supply. In the USA we have not yet begun to sound the possibilities of intensive

agriculture, making four blades of grass grow where one grew before.

It is a fact capable of mathematical demonstration that the single state of Texas, if all its resources were organized for the production of food, would produce enough to feed the whole present population of the globe, and feed them well.

Our food products range from wheat in the Dakotas to rice in Carolina; from northern fruits in Michigan to oranges in California and Florida. This country, intensely cultivated, would feed the inhabitants of ten worlds like this. There is no lack in the food supply.

When we pray to our Father, "Give us our daily bread," we should never forget to add a thanksgiving that He answered that prayer when He laid the foundation of the world.

Remember, too, that the work of men like Burbank has just begun; the food supply is capable of infinite development. There is, therefore, no need for men to compete with each other in order to get enough to eat.

As to the second essential, clothing, we find the same to be true. The United States can produce cotton for the world, but it is not necessary to dress the world in anything so cheap as cotton fabrics. We have sheep ranges to supply the woolen goods for all, and fields in which to raise the flax for fine linen; there are great wastes of land, now barren, where we might grow enough mulberry trees to feed the silk worms necessary to clothe the world in silks; we even have the deserts on which to raise ostriches for fine plumage. We have resources sufficient to clothe every man, woman and child in raiment finer than that of Solomon in all his glory. And there are undreamed of possibilities in the despised weeds by the wayside; some will presently develop into the raw material for fabrics more beautiful than the world has ever seen. The supply of clothing is inexhaustible. No need to compete with another here; no need for one to go in sackcloth that another may wear purple and fine linen; there is purple and fine linen for all.

Taking up the question of shelter we find the same conditions prevailing. There are great banks of clay waiting to be made into bricks and tile; there are vast ledges of building stone unquarried as yet; we have learned that brick may be made of sand and lime, and that cement is excellent building material. It is an indisputable fact that a mansion finer than Vanderbilt's might be erected for every family in America, and when all were finished we should hardly have made a scratch on the surface of our supply of building material. No need for some to live in hovels in order that others may be delicately housed!

And the supply for interior furnishings—for furniture, carpets, books, musical instruments, pictures, statuary, everything to delight the eye and mind of man is just as unlimited.

Truly, there is no scarcity of things; nor is there any lack of work that ought to be done. There is no necessity in nature for competition, either for things or for jobs. There is enough useful and beautiful work waiting to be done to keep us all busy all our lives.

And it may be well to point out here that there is no lack in the supply of finished products because labor is not productive enough to keep pace with the demand. Modern machinery has solved the problem of production. The producing power of labor has been multiplied by six hundred in a little more than a generation. In making nails, for instance, one man does the work which required a thousand men one hundred years ago; and the same is approximately true in all lines of industry; and the end of the increase in producing power is not yet. There is nothing in which further improvement is not possible. Six hours' work a day, by all of us, would produce all that we could use, including every known luxury.

With such abundance in the whole, we do not need to compete for a part; we do not need to take thought for tomorrow; we do not need to experience panics or reverses.

We need only to seek for the kingdom of God, and His righteous relations toward each other, and all these things shall be added unto us.

And what is the kingdom of God?

> *"Whereunto shall I liken the kingdom of God? It is like leaven, which a woman took and hid in three measures of meal, until the whole was leavened."*

The kingdom of God is in nature like the leaven in the meal—in all and through all. It includes all nature, for God is the cause of nature; and when nature is perfectly natural, there is the kingdom of God in all its fullness.

If God be the Mind of nature, then there can be no more perfect expression of God than in the naturalness of nature.

The kingdom of God includes all life, for God is the Life itself; and when life is lived in a perfectly natural way, there is the kingdom of God in all its fullness; for there can be no more perfect expression of God than the living of life in a natural way.

And this brings us to the question, how may life be lived in the natural way? The living of life consists in continually advancing into more life. Drop a seed in the center of a field; the life in the seed at once becomes active; it ceases to merely exist, and begins to live. Soon it produces a plant, and a seed head, in which there are thirty, sixty or a hundred seeds, each containing as much life as the first seed contained.

These fall into the ground, and in their turn begin to live; and in time there are a million seeds in the field, each containing as much life as the first seed contained.

The life of the first seed, by the mere act of living, has increased a million fold.

> *The living of life consists in continuously increasing life; there is no other way to live.*

This necessity of life for increase is the cause of what we know as evolution.

There is no such thing as evolution in the mineral world. Minerals do not advance or progress. Lead does not evolve into tin, tin into iron, iron into silver, silver into gold, and so on.

Evolution is found only in the organic forms of life, and is caused by the natural necessity of life to find fuller and fuller expression.

Life on this earth began no doubt, in a single cell; but a single cell could not give sufficient expression to life, and so it formed a double celled organism; then organisms of many cells; then vertebrates; then mammals, and finally, man.

All this because of the inherent necessity of life to advance forever into more complete expression.

And evolution did not cease with the formation of man; physical evolution ceased, and mental and spiritual evolution began.

Man, from the beginning, has been developing more ability to live. Each generation is capable of living more than the preceding generation. The race is continually advancing into more life, and so we see that the living of life means to live more.

The action of consciousness continually expands consciousness. The primal necessity of mind is to know more, and feel more, and enjoy more; and this necessity of mind is the cause of social evolution, and of all progress.

If we take conscious life—as we must—to be the highest expression of God, or of the Mind of nature, then the purpose of all things must be to further the development of conscious life; and if man is the highest form of conscious life—and he is—then the purpose of all things must be to further the development of man.

And if the development of man consists in the increase of his capacity for life, then the purpose of all things in nature must be to further the continuous advancement of man into more and more of life.

Life finds expression by the use of things.

The measure of a person's life is not the things he possesses, but the number of things he is able to use rightly; and to have fullness of life is to have all the things we are capable of using rightly. The purpose of the Mind of nature being the continuous advancement of man into more life, it must also be the intention of that Mind that every human being shall have the unrestricted use of all the things that he is capable of using and enjoying rightly; or that "his own shall come to him."

The purpose of God is that all should have life, and have it more abundantly.

God is the Mind of nature, and God is in all, and through all; therefore, the mind, or intelligence of God is in all and through all, like the leaven in the meal.

The desire for advancement is a fundamental fact in the action of mind; therefore, the desire for advancement is in all, and through all.

All things desire the advancement of every man.

If an individual desires any good thing in order to live his life more fully, that thing desires him also, for all life is one—the mind of nature is in and through all things.

The mind of things responds to the mind of man, when man desires advancement. All things work together for good to those who desire only advancement.

The greatest of all facts to us is the fact that there is a Mind in nature which desires us to have all the things we are capable of using, and willing to use, in the direction of fuller life, and that this Mind is in the things themselves, tending to bring them toward us; and that if we take the right course, recognizing this Mind and working with it, all things must come to us.

But this Mind is the Mind of the Whole, not of a part; and if we lose sight of the Whole and enter into competition with our fellows for a part we lose all.

For competition of a part is virtually a denial and rejection of the Whole. He who recognizes and accepts the whole cannot compete for a part. It is the idea of competition for a limited supply which prevents us from seeing and accepting the Abundance which is ours. We still keep up the foolish struggle of Caesar's kingdom, because we cannot see the kingdom of God, which is all around us and within us. "If my kingdom were of this world, then would my servants fight," said Jesus. We do not get fully out of the ideas of the kingdoms of this world; we still do more or less fighting.

But how are we to avoid competition, when the whole business world is proceeding on the method of competing for a limited supply? How can we get work without competing for jobs? Can we succeed in a competitive world without competing? Shall we withdraw from the world, and form communistic societies? Certainly not. To try that is to fail. A communistic society is a body of people who do not compete with each other, but who do compete with everybody else.

No community can be complete unto itself without greatly limiting its members in the means of life; and to do this is to defeat the end aimed at.

And if it is not complete in itself, satisfying all its wants, it must compete with the outside world for what is lacking, and this is what we seek to avoid. No separation of a part from the Whole in any way, will solve the problem. The community scheme is inconvenient, unnatural and impracticable.

Shall we establish socialism and the co-operative commonwealth? We cannot do it, because socialism and the co-operative commonwealth can never be established; it must establish itself, and it may take it a long time yet to do so. We cannot do away with competition by legislative enactment of any kind so long as the majority of men believe in the

limited supply; so we must keep right on in business under the present system, and yet cease to compete.

Can we do it? Yes. But how?

✦

REFLECTION

This long chapter attacks the idea of scarcity. Many New Thought followers, Wattles says, use positive thinking only to compete better, and so they still live with hidden fear. He surveys food, clothing, shelter and labor and argues that nature and modern machinery could supply plenty for all, so competition is unnecessary. Life naturally increases, like a seed becoming a million seeds, and a Mind in nature wants everyone to have what they can rightly use. He rejects both withdrawing into separate communes and trying to impose socialism by law. His figures reflect the optimism of his time and should not be taken as facts. The core attitude, creating value rather than fighting over a fixed share, remains useful.

PRACTICE

Think of a situation where you feel in competition with someone. Write down one way you could create new value there instead, by helping, cooperating or offering something different, rather than trying to win a bigger share of what already exists.

KEY THOUGHT

The living of life consists in continuously increasing life; there is no other way to live.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VIII

Man and Money

"I am come that they might have life; and that they might have it more abundantly."

GOD, THE Mind of nature, produces the Abundance of nature with the purpose of providing for the development of man; not just of some men, but of mankind. The purpose of nature is the continuous advancement of life; and as man is the embodiment of God and the highest form of life, the purpose of nature must be the continuous advancement of every man into more abundant life.

That which seeks the advancement of every man cannot take anything from any one; therefore to be one with the Mind of nature is to seek the advancement of all at the expense of none; to seek to get for all what one desires to get for one's self.

This must lift one entirely out of the competitive thought. "What I want for myself, I want for all;" that is the declaration of independence aimed at the competitive system.

"Our" Father, give "us,"—that is the prayer of the advancing life.

This declaration and prayer are in unison with the Mind of nature; the man who so declares and so prays is mentally one with all that lives, God, nature and man; and this is the At-one-ment.

To be mentally one with the Mind of things makes you able to register your thoughts on that Mind, and your desires as well.

When you desire a thing, and your mind and the Mind of things are one, that thing will desire you, and will move toward you. If you desire dollars, and your mind is one with the Mind that pervades dollars and all things else, dollars will be permeated with the desire to come to you, and they will move toward you, impelled by the Eternal Power which makes for more abundant life.

To obtain what you want, you only need to establish your own at-one-ment with the Mind of things, and they will be drawn toward you.

But the primal purpose of the Mind of things is the continuous advancement of ALL into more abundant life; therefore, nothing will be taken away from anyone else and given to you unless you give to that person more in the way of life than you take away.

It will be plainly seen that the Divine Mind cannot be brought into action in the field of purely competitive business. God cannot be divided against Himself. He cannot be made to take from one and give to another. He will not decrease one man's opportunity to advance in life in order to increase another man's opportunity to advance in life. He is no respecter of persons, and has no favorites. He is equally in all, equally for all, and at the service of all alike.

To make the at-one-ment, you must see that your business gives to all who deal with you a full equivalent in life for the money value of what you take from them.

I say in life; that does not necessarily mean in money value. Here is what many critics of the profit system fail to understand: that a thing of small value to one man may be of inestimable value to another who can use it for the advancement of life. A box of matches would be worth more to an Eskimo than a combine harvester.

The value of a thing to an individual is determined by the plane of life on which he stands: what is of no value on one plane, or in one stage of his development, is indispensable on another plane, or in another

stage. The life-giving power of any article may be out of all proportion to its monetary value. This book is not worth a dollar in so far as the cash value of the paper and ink are concerned, but one sentence in it may be worth thousands of dollars to any reader. You may sell an article for more than it cost you, making a profit; but the purchaser may put it to such use that it will be worth hundreds of times its cost to him, and in that case profit is no robbery. See that your business meets this fundamental requirement; that is the first step.

When you have done this you are one with that Intelligence in nature which is working for more life for all; you are "working together with Him," as St. Paul says; you and your Father are one. The aim of your work is that all may have life, and have it more abundantly. What you seek for yourself you are seeking for all, and the mental principle in everything that you need begins to gravitate toward you. If you need dollars, the Mind of things, IN the dollars is conscious of the need; and you can affirm with truth "Dollars want me." Dollars will begin to move toward you, and they will come, invariably, from those who need what you can give in exchange. The Divine Mind will attend to the transference of that which is needed for the advancement of life to the place where need exists.

This will apply not only to all that you need to keep your business going, but to all that you are capable of using to enter into fuller life yourself.

No good thing will be withheld from you.

Your unity with the Evolutionary Power, with the Purpose of nature, will be such that you will receive all that nature has to give. Because you will do always the will of God, all things are yours, and you need to compete with no one.

But you must bear in mind that your wants are impressed on the Divine Mind *only by your faith.* A doubt cuts the connection. Anxiety and fear cut the connection.

Exactly as you are in the matter of impressing your own subconscious mind, so you are in the matter of impressing the Mind of things.

Your affirmations fall flat unless they are made with the dynamic power of absolute faith.

The Mind of things will not act positively for doubt and hesitancy.

"What things soever ye desire when ye pray, believe that ye receive them and ye shall have them."

We cannot walk and work with God and distrust Him at the same time. If you feel distrust, you impress the Mind of things with distrust of you, and things will move away from you rather than toward you.

The requirements for non-competitive success are very simple:

First, desire for everybody what you desire for yourself, and be sure to take nothing from anybody without giving a full equivalent in life; and the more you give the better for you.

Then move out in the absolute faith that all you need for the fullest life you are capable of living will come to you.

Pray with unfaltering faith to the Father that it shall come to you, and thank Him in every prayer, from a heart full of gratitude that it DOES come to you.

Everything that comes to you then will mean more life to someone else.

Each gain you make will add to the wealth of someone else.

What you get for yourself—life—you get for all.

Your success adds to the life, health, wealth and happiness of all.

But someone says: Wherein does this differ from competition, after all? Are you not still competing with those in the same line of business? No!

What you gain will not come from the limited supply for which others are struggling, but from the Whole.

Let me illustrate: It may be said that there is only a limited supply of money in the country; not enough to supply the needs of all. Suppose a large number of people enter this Way of Life, and dollars begin to move

toward them all, there will not be enough to go around. That is true, but the thought of need impressed upon the Mind of things would react upon the minds of men; new currency laws would be passed; the bullion would begin to move toward the mints; and the printing presses to turn out bank notes if they were necessary to the advancement of life.

The Mind of things reaches beyond the coined cash, into the gold and silver lying in the hearts of the hills; and it will all begin to move forward when it is called for by the prayer of faith. The Mind of things can call in resources from the ends of the earth in order to meet demand.

And the same is true of everything else. Not only the mints, but the mills will start whenever a sufficient number of people have entered the way of the Advancing life.

If it be urged that the wage system prevents the workers from living full lives, the answer is that whenever the workers begin to live full lives, if the wage system stands in the way of their advancement it will be changed. Their demand for more life will be all that is required to change it.

Life cannot be advanced by changing systems, but systems may be changed by the advance of life.

There is plenty of work to be done in the erection of useful and beautiful things; all that is needed is a demand for those things by those whose sole purpose is to use them to give more life to all.

As the number of such people increases, the prosperity of all will increase, and a constantly increasing proportion of all classes will come into the Truth, abandoning competition and the way of the limited supply, until the kingdom will be established on earth as it is in Heaven.

> *"And God shall wipe away all tears from their eyes; and there shall be no more crying, neither shall there be any more pain: and there shall be no night there."*

REFLECTION

Wattles explains how to succeed without competing. Want for everyone what you want for yourself, and make sure your work gives each person more in "life," or real usefulness, than the money you take. A thing of small price may hold great value for the one who uses it well, and then profit is fair. When you live this way, he says, your mind is at one with the Mind in things, and what you need moves toward you through faith and grateful prayer. Systems such as wages will change as people demand more life. His promise that money will come "invariably" is not something anyone can guarantee, but the ethic of giving full value and wishing others well is worth keeping.

PRACTICE

Look at one thing you sell, make or provide at work. Write down how it actually improves the life of the person who receives it. Then name one change that would make it more useful to them without raising its price.

KEY THOUGHT

Life cannot be advanced by changing systems, but systems may be changed by the advance of life.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

IX

Talk That Builds

DO NOT talk about poverty. It adds nothing to the wealth and happiness of the world to disseminate the information that you have always been poor, and have had a mighty hard struggle to get along. Poverty is no more a thing to boast of than ignorance is a thing to boast of. The old saying that it is no disgrace to be poor is only a half truth; in the true sense it is really a disgrace to be poor. Nobody is poor, or having a hard struggle but (a) the ignorant, (b) the lazy, and (c) the incompetent.

This sounds harsh, and you are ready to go "up in the air" about it; you want to tell me that the tenement dwellers and wage-slaves have no chance, and so on.

But wait a little. The wage slaves really own the world; they have created it all, and they could take possession of it tomorrow if they would. They can begin, at any time, to use the factories to make things for themselves, instead of turning wealth out for their masters.

But they do not do it because they are (a) too ignorant to know that this is their world; (b) too intellectually lazy to THINK, and so discover that this is their world; and (c) incompetent, because they do not THINK.

Intellectual laziness is what keeps the masses down; those who work hard and willingly in other ways shrink from the effort of sustained and consecutive thinking; and because they let other people do their thinking for them, they are slaves.

The masses will be wage-slaves as long as the nickel and dime theaters are crowded and the public libraries deserted.

I tell you this because I want to make plain to you the futility of talking about poverty. Talking about poverty and adverse conditions will only lead people to run to the cheap shows, and to try in other ways to drown their miseries in temporary pleasures.

The more you talk, and think about your hard times, the more you will be inclined to seek some mental narcotic to dull the keen edge of your suffering; and the longer you will suffer.

No surer way to keep the masses poor can be devised than to continually write and talk about their poverty.

Talk about the good time coming.

The good time IS coming, and the rapidity of its coming is in exact proportion to the number of people who think about it and talk about it.

Instead of going about showing horrible pictures of the condition of those who live in the tenements, go about showing *beautiful* pictures of the conditions of those who will live in the *coming* city.

If you can inspire *one* person to go to work for the *coming* city, you have done more good than you can by sending *ten* people out with salves and plasters to relieve existing distress.

Instead of crusading against child labor and bad factory conditions, tell the working people what splendid conditions they will have when they wake up and begin to operate the industries for themselves.

The masses are not in bondage to anything but ignorance and intellectual laziness; they can have what they will if they will begin to THINK.

And the way to make them think is to talk WEALTH.

That is the philosophy for the mass.

And the same applies to you as an individual.

If the mass is not ready or willing to rise, you do not have to stay down with it; you can rise above it.

But you can never rise above it if you keep talking about yourself as being down with it.

If you keep talking of yourself as one of those who have hard times in getting along, you will continue to be one of those who have hard times in getting along.

Do not tell how poor your parents were, and what terrible times you had when you were a child. To talk of those things is to go back into those conditions, mentally; and to go back into those conditions mentally is to invite them physically.

Talk about the happy times you had in your youth, and forget all the unhappy times.

Do not tell how hard you used to work, and how little you got for it. If you worked hard for nothing, you were a chump; and you should not advertise yourself as a chump.

Tell of the good work you have done, and of the good wages you got for it; then you are advertising yourself as a competent person, who can earn good wages.

Do not, like Uriah Heep, tell how 'amble you are, and boast of living in a 'amble abode; declare yourself to be as good as the best, and describe the elegant home you are in the process of getting and furnishing. Don't apologize for your clothes, tell how few you have, or say you "have nothing fit to wear"; tell of the fine clothes you are making arrangements to get.

Don't talk poverty in any way; don't refer to it as existing. TALK WEALTH.

✦

REFLECTION

This final chapter urges readers not to dwell on poverty in conversation, but to talk about growth and good things coming. Wattles believes that how we speak about ourselves shapes how we think and act. Along the way he says that only the ignorant, lazy and incompetent are poor, and he dismisses relief work and reform campaigns. That view is unfair and mistaken. Poverty often comes from illness, low pay, discrimination or bad luck, and the people who fought child labor did vital work. The narrower point can still help: replaying old hardships can keep you stuck, while describing your strengths and plans can build hope. If hard memories are heavy, talking with a counselor is a strength, not a failure.

PRACTICE

For one day, notice how you describe your money or work to others. Each time you catch yourself retelling an old struggle, add one sentence about a skill you have or a step you are taking now.

KEY THOUGHT

Tell of the good work you have done,
and of the good wages you got for it

MY OWN NOTES

The New Science of Living and Healing

NINE CHAPTERS

About This Work

THE NEW Science of Living and Healing is Wattles' short manifesto on the body. It reads like a run of magazine pieces, and the text itself speaks of "this series of articles." After his death it was reissued in 1924 under the title Health Through New Thought and Fasting. That reissue added a commentary by Elizabeth Towne, his longtime publisher. This edition gives Wattles' own text only and leaves out the 1924 commentary.

His argument begins with Edward Hooker Dewey, the "no-breakfast doctor." The claim is that our strength does not come from food. It is renewed in sleep, and food is only building material. From there Wattles draws a whole way of life: eat only when truly hungry, skip breakfast, eat far less, sleep in moving fresh air, and do not feed the seriously sick. Later chapters turn inward. The mind directs the body's "vital power," fear shuts that power off, and will power grows in silent prayer. The book ends with speculation about life, the soul, and immortality. It sits close to The Science of Being Well and shows the New Thought conviction that spirit comes first and matter second.

Please read it as history, not as medical advice. Much of its science is simply wrong by today's knowledge. Food does supply the body's energy. Germs cause infectious disease whether or not a person overeats. Colds do not come from the dinner table. Tuberculosis is a treatable infection. Fasting, skipping meals, or sharply cutting food can be dangerous, especially for people with diabetes, during pregnancy or

breastfeeding, for anyone with a past or present eating disorder, for people on medication, and for children, older adults, and anyone who is ill. Sick people often need fluids and nourishment. Do not stop treatment or keep a doctor away because of anything written here. Illness is never the patient's fault, and nothing in these pages promises healing. Wattles also makes a passing joke at women's expense that belongs to his time.

What can still help is the quieter part of the book. Notice whether you eat from hunger or from habit. Take sleep seriously. See how fear and worry affect the body. And treat life as something received with gratitude. Before you change how you eat, fast, or care for a sick person, talk with a qualified doctor.

CHAPTER

I

The Source of Work-Power

Life passes through us, we do not possess it. — Amiel

It is probable that the late Edward Hooker Dewey, M. D., of Meadville, Pa., widely known as "the no-breakfast doctor," influenced more people in the direction of the simplification of life than any other writer, living or dead. His books, "The New Science of Health," and "The No-Breakfast Plan," have been read by many thousands of people and have indirectly influenced many thousands more; his theories are working a revolution, and yet scarcely one in ten of his followers comprehends the really revolutionary character of his thought, or the tremendous importance of his great physiological discovery.

In brief, as set forth in his last book, that discovery is this: That the strength—the work-power—of the human organism is not drawn from the food consumed, but is renewed in sleep. The storage battery of muscle energy and thought energy is not charged and recharged at the dining table, but in the bedroom. Food is to the human body what the soil is to a plant—merely raw material; tissue elements, to be built into the organism, but not in any sense a source of life.

The interesting points about this theory are:

First, that it is capable of mathematical demonstration, and is therefore true beyond controversy;

Second, that it absolutely overthrows current theories of the source of life and strength, driving the materialistic physiologist from the field by proving that life energy is not the product of functional action, and that most muscle workers would be healthier, stronger and longer lived on one-half, and most brain workers on one-tenth of the quantity of food they now consume. It gives good ground also for the argument that mind is not produced by the body, but that mind produces the body; that the brain does not produce thought, but that thought produces the brain; that there is no chemistry by which a piece of bread can become mind or thought;

Third, it proves that most of the conclusions of the pseudo-science of medicine have been based on false premises, and are erroneous; and that most of the sick are greatly hindered in recovery by feeding, dosing and other interference.

It gives us, also, a solid foundation upon which we may base a really scientific investigation of the problems of the origin of life, and of the immortality of the soul; but that is beyond the scope of this article.

Let us now "make good" on our first proposition: That we do not get our strength from food. The brain is a storage battery of vital energy, which is charged in some unknown manner, and from some unknown source, during sleep. The stomach is a machine which is run by brain power, and the digestion of food is a tax on strength, and not a source of strength.

Now, as to the mathematics. A laborer will consume a beefsteak and a couple of potatoes, and will shovel twenty tons of earth to a height of five feet; was there sufficient potential energy in the food to perform the work? A Japanese soldier, carrying a heavy load, can march and fight all day and only consume a handful of rice; and he can do this for an indefinite period without loss of weight or strength. Can any one seriously claim that the enormous amount of energy he displays was

potentially in the few ounces of rice consumed per diem? No machine which science has been able to devise can extract one five-hundredth part as much energy from a pound of beef as the human body must draw from it if the old physiology is true; but it is not true. It is mathematically impossible. A man will eat a few slices of pork, and will "run down," catch and overpower two or three full-grown hogs, by the sheer excess of his physical power over theirs. Is the potential energy of a pound of dead pork greater than the kinetic energy of three *live* three hundred pound hogs?

Consider, next, the numerous cases of protracted fasts which have been recorded since Dr. Dewey's books were published. Leonard Thress, of Philadelphia, fifty-six days, and Miss Estella Kuenzel, forty-two days, *with a steady gain in strength from the first day,* are among the cases recorded by the doctor himself; and some hundreds of others, perfectly authenticated, prove that a person can go from twenty to sixty days without food and can often do so without appreciable loss of strength. I believe it is the accepted *dictum* of the old physiology that a man will starve to death in ten days. This has been proved to be a mistake, and it is evident that most of the people who have perished of hunger in that limited time died because they thought they *had* to, and that, properly educated, they might have lived from twenty to sixty days longer. In death by starvation the brain and nervous system, which are the power plant, lose no weight; the other tissues disappear until the skeleton condition is reached, and death comes because the brain can get no more raw material with which to repair the heart, lungs, stomach, liver, etc. The organism grows weak and perishes from lack of raw material to replace the daily waste of its vital parts; it dies when the viscera are so attenuated as to be unable to perform their functions, but it dies not for lack of vital energy, but because the vital energy has no material to use in keeping up the organism. Set a plant in gravel, and it will die—not for lack of energy, but for lack of material.

Consider for a moment this claim that the body works with energy generated by its own digestive system. The digestion of food is certainly work, and it certainly takes power; those who remember the feeling of lethargy after a too hearty meal will not be disposed to deny that a very considerable amount of energy is required to operate the stomach. The old physiology claims that the heart, brain, liver, kidneys, etc., are machines which are operated by power which is ultimately traced to the action of the stomach; and that the stomach, in turn, is operated by power which is generated by the action of the heart, brain, liver, kidneys, etc. Here is a mechanical impossibility—the stomach generating power to operate the other machines and being in turn operated by power supplied by the other machines. That the body should perform its great amount of external work by means of energy generated by its own *internal* work is impossible; the claim that it does so is an absurdity. The functional actions of the viscera do not generate energy; they absorb energy. It uses up power to spade up the earth in the garden; and the heart and stomach cannot generate power to operate themselves, with a sufficient surplus to spade up the garden also. It is, I repeat, an absurd denial of all known chemical and mechanical principles to assert that the body works by means of energy generated by its own functional action. As well claim that a man can lift himself by his boot straps.

Power is stored in the brain during sleep, and is probably transmitted to the muscles and organs over the nerves in a manner similar to the transmission of electrical energy over a trolley wire; and there is no evidence that this power comes from our food at all. Food does not "strengthen" us; there is no such thing as a "strengthening" food. We need food to furnish the tissue elements, not to supply power; and every mouthful we eat in excess of the actual need weakens us and tends to shorten our lives. Most people expend more than half of their total life-force in the disposition of unnecessary food; if we only ate from one-tenth to one-half of what we now consume most of us would die of old age, and the average of life in the next generation would probably be

beyond the century mark. This shocks you, doesn't it? Well, it is hard, scientific fact; I am just trying to write it in plain, common sense words.

But, you say, do not we *feel* more strength after eating?

Yea, but not after digesting our food. If strength comes from the assimilation of food it can only be after the food is completely digested; a partially digested mass in the stomach certainly cannot yield any work-power. Now it takes some hours, at least, to complete the process of assimilation; but the accession of strength is always felt *immediately* after swallowing the food. You are tired and weak; you swallow a cup of coffee and a piece of toast, and you rise and go to work refreshed; it has "strengthened" you, you say. But it has not; if you will pause to think you will see that your fresh strength cannot have come from the food, which has not had time to be changed at all; it is coffee and toast in your stomach, and will be, for some time; how can it strengthen you before it is digested? And three or four hours hence, when it *is* digested, you will be as weak as ever. If we get our energy from food, is it before or after we digest it?

You are stronger right after your noon-day meal, but at five p. m., when the food is digested, you are all tired out; and with all your eating you suffer a steady decline in power from the time you emerge from unconsciousness in the morning until you return to it at night. The accession of strength you felt after taking the coffee and toast did not come from the food; it was from the rally nature made, summoning her power to the task of disposing of the food. She drew on the brain for an extra supply of its stored-up energy to perform the work of digestion, and as this power was turned on you felt it throughout the body; but the power came from the brain, and not from the stomach.

We do not live by bread alone; we do not really live by bread at all. Beefsteak and potatoes are not the raw materials from which life and mind are made. The old physiology is controverted by the law of the conservation of energy.

So much for our first proposition; now for the second:

Most muscle workers would be stronger, healthier and longer lived on one-half, and most brain workers on one-tenth of the food they now consume.

Since Dr. Dewey's books were published some hundreds of thousands of people have adopted the no-breakfast plan, going entirely without food until noon; and nearly all of them have found, to their astonishment, that they were stronger, brighter, and had more work-power without the breakfast than with it. And the exceptions are nearly always those who cannot grasp the idea that the possession of strength does not depend on keeping the stomach full. This is the philosophy of the no-breakfast plan: You awake with the brain fully charged with work-power, and your blood contains the tissue elements of the previous days' food; you are, therefore, in the best possible condition for work. Why should you eat? It takes power to run the stomach; why not save the power for your other work? You are not really hungry; there is no such thing as a normal hunger on arising in the morning, in a person who has been sufficiently fed on the previous day. Your morning appetite is a matter of habit; of mental attitude. You eat because you are afraid you will get faint later in the day; or you tickle your palate with sweet foods until you arouse a taste for more; but you never eat breakfast because you are genuinely hungry.

If you do not believe all this, put it to the best possible test; try it on yourself. Get up and go to work without eating; and if you are in anything approaching a normal condition you will find that you are in better condition for mental or physical labor with an empty stomach than with a full one. Mind, though, much depends upon your mental attitude; remember that many people who believe in the old physiology have starved to death in ten days, while others, better taught, have fasted forty days without much discomfort. If you *expect* that because your stomach is empty you will have a fainting fit about ten o'clock, the fainting fit will probably come; you will get just about what you look for. On the other hand, if you put the thought of food resolutely aside,

and go to your work without fear of any disagreeable consequences you will have a forenoon of such mental cheer, and of such physical vigor as you have seldom experienced; but you will not feel so well after your noon meal.

Why? Because you will overeat; you will mistakenly suppose that because you have done without breakfast you must eat enough, and more than enough at noon to make up the deficiency; and during the afternoon so much of your brain's energy will be required at the stomach that you will have very little left for mental or physical work. This ought to convince you that your stomach is a machine which absorbs energy, instead of being a generator for producing it. The object in dispensing with the breakfast is not to increase the quantity consumed at noon but to prevent the waste of energy in the disposition of unnecessary food. If you want to be strong, and full of snap and vigor, drop your breakfast entirely, leave off half your noon meal and two-thirds of your evening one. Eat just enough to maintain your weight; not a mouthful more. If you can hold your weight on one cracker a day, and you eat two crackers, the disposal of the superfluous one will be a waste of your life force; it will weaken you by just the amount of power required to dispose of it, and if you overeat as a matter of habit the surplus will be a source of danger, disease and premature death.

You don't believe it, do you? Well, it won't cost you a cent to prove it.

If you want to have strength for your work, whether mental or physical, get eight hours of sleep every night in a well-ventilated room; eat plain, hearty food, and the smallest quantity which will maintain your weight. If it takes power to run the stomach it is foolish to keep it in operation more than is actually necessary. "For this cause many are weak and sickly among you, and many sleep." said St. Paul, writing to the Corinthians about overeating at the Lord's supper. Wise St. Paul!

Most of the dietary conclusions of the pseudo-science of medicine are based on false premises, and are therefore erroneous; and the

recovery of most of the sick is greatly hindered by feeding, dosing, and other interference.

Most physicians accept the theory that we can add to the strength of a sick man by inducing him to swallow food; when the fact is that every mouthful is a tax on his strength, and decreases his power of resistance. It takes power to run the stomach. In every case of severe sickness Nature takes away the appetite, because there is no power to spare for the digestive process; she wishes to conserve her energy for combat with the disease. In severe sickness Nature's way is to suspend digestion and let the brain live on the tissues of the body, which can be spared. That is why a sick man loses in weight. If you feed him, and he still loses, it is proof positive that the food is not assimilated; if it *were* assimilated there could be no loss in weight. And if you continue to feed under such conditions you may be absolutely certain that you are loading up his system with waste matter which must be eliminated at a fearful cost in vital power. You may lay it down as a general law which is amply proven in practice, that in the absence of appetite the patient who is fed will lose weight and strength more rapidly than the one who is not fed. When the desire for food is absent, and the tongue is heavily coated, it should be interpreted to mean: "Busy; nothing wanted within." It is homicidal folly to feed under such conditions; the food decays in the alimentary canal, and generates poisons which are dangerous to life. No matter what the books say, it is foolish to feed the sick man whose breath tells in unmistakable language that his digestive tract is already filled with rotting filth. The sick horse will not eat; and it is to be hoped that sick men, women and children will some day be allowed by their physicians and friends to exercise horse sense. Nature would have the severely sick man sleep much, and not eat at all; *we* try to induce him to eat all he can, and we wake him every few minutes to force into his protesting stomach some nauseous or poisonous compound of drugs. Nine-tenths of our interference with the sick has no scientific justification, and is injurious to them. Put the sick man into a well-ventilated room; make him as

comfortable as possible; shut out the neighbors, the family, the preacher —everybody but the nurse, and possibly the doctor; in most cases leave the doctor out, too. It would be a great deal better if two-thirds of the doctors had to resort to some other means of making a living; the other third could easily take care of all the cases where they are really needed. Give nature a chance with your sick one; and if he dies you may at least feel sure that you did not help to kill him.

The stomach is a machine which uses up power, and it is operated by power supplied from the brain, which is charged during sleep. Remember this physiological fact, and regulate your life accordingly; get sleep enough, and get it under favorable conditions, and eat less.

| Sleep, that knits up the ravelled sleeve of care,
| The death of each day's life; | Balm of hurt
minds, great nature's second course, | Chief
nourisher in life's feast. — Shakespeare, "Macbeth"

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles builds on Edward Hooker Dewey, the "no-breakfast doctor." His claim is that our strength is not drawn from food but renewed in sleep, so food is only raw material, the way soil is for a plant. From this he concludes that most people should eat far less, skip breakfast, and stop feeding sick people who have lost their appetite. He calls all this mathematically proven. Modern physiology does not support him: the energy in food is measured and real, and long fasts can be dangerous. His remark that starving people died because they "thought they had to" is wrong and unkind. A gentler lesson still holds. Notice whether you eat from hunger or from habit, value good sleep, and avoid stuffing yourself. Take the rest as history, and ask a doctor before changing how you eat.

PRACTICE

For three days, pause before each meal or snack and rate your real hunger from 1 to 10. Write down the number and what made you reach for food. Don't change your diet. Just watch the pattern with curiosity.

KEY THOUGHT

Food is to the human body what the soil is to a plant—merely raw material

---

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

II

Sleep

He giveth His beloved sleep. — Ps. 127:2.

IN THE preceding chapter we considered some of the arguments for the new physiology, which holds that vital energy is renewed in sleep, and is not generated by the digestion of food. Man is not, as we have been taught to suppose, an engine whose power comes from the combustion of fuel, or food. If he were, he would never need rest or sleep; supplied with food he could keep on eating and working indefinitely, as an engine can work indefinitely if it is supplied with coal; whereas no matter how much or how often he eats, we know that he must have frequent lapses into the silence and unconsciousness of sleep in order to recharge his brain with that mysterious energy by which he lives and works.

We find by observation that the fact that vital power is received in sleep is universal with all forms of life. Men, animals, reptiles, fish and insects sleep; and plants sleep also. You will notice that I speak of vital power as being received, not generated; if the law of the conservation of energy holds good as applied to the energy displayed by the human body, then the energy of man is received from some source outside himself; for it is a mechanical impossibility for the organism to generate within itself the power to maintain itself, renew itself, and perform

external work also. The human body cannot be regarded as being anything but a machine; and since it is found to be impossible for a machine to operate itself, and to do additional work with power generated by its own operation, I am compelled to accept the hypothesis that there is an inflow of life, which is received by all living organisms during sleep. Let me write this again, and call your attention to it for it is the greatest and most important scientific fact that has been given to the world in a century.

There is an inflow of vital power, which is received by all living organisms during sleep.

I do not know where this inflow of life comes from; I do not know whether it results from some combination of other forces or is a force which is eternally self-existent. I am simply stating the facts as I observe them, and giving the inevitable deductions from them; if the facts disprove the theories you have been holding, you will have to readjust your theories to fit the facts. It is a fact that the human body cannot possibly manufacture its own vital power and at the same time be manufactured by its own vital power; and it is a fact that it receives its vital power in sleep; and necessarily, from some source outside itself. Life comes to us from somewhere; we do not make it; we receive it. I do not say that it is received only in sleep; I do not know but that there are conditions under which we may receive it when awake. Neither do I say that we always receive it directly from the unknown source; there may be individuals who can become so charged with it as to be able to communicate it to others; I do say, however, that no individual has power to create it in himself; he can only give what he has received, so that ultimately we all receive from the unknown source.

Now, as to the importance of all this. Hold up your finger, and examine it carefully. What made it? It is made of different chemical elements taken from the food you have eaten; but what combined those elements and built them into a finger? Life! You slept, and your brain was charged with power; that power was applied to the stomach and

bowels and digested your food; it took the separate elements and emptied them into the blood; your heart, which beats by brain power, forced them along through the arteries until they came to the finger; and vital energy from the brain built them into bone, muscle, nerve and connective tissue. Life built the finger; and nothing but life can make another like it. All the science in the world cannot duplicate it; we may make something which looks very much the same, but it will not be like your finger at all. Be careful, therefore, about the gentleman who tells you that he has a "remedy" which will renew your finger or fix it up all right if there is anything the matter with it. Nothing can repair or renew the finger but the force which created it—vital power. Nothing can make a finger, nothing can mend a broken or injured finger, and nothing can cure a sick finger but life. There is no remedy, and no known force that can unite a broken bone save life only; and there is no remedy and no force that can make a heart beat save life only. Nothing ever made a heart beat but life; all the other powers in the world cannot send a single pulse-throb through the arteries of a dead body. No medicine ever made your heart beat, and none ever will; nothing ever made a heart beat but vital power. The force which operates your heart is stored in your brain during sleep. The only manner in which a medicine could make your heart beat would be by causing the vital power to flow from your brain to your heart. I do not say that medicine can or cannot do this; I will touch upon this point again.

What is true of the heart is necessarily true of every other organ of the body; they are all operated by brain-power, and cannot be operated by any other power. We hear certain medicines spoken of as having power to move the bowels; but a little study must convince us that the only power on earth which can move the bowels is that which is stored in the brain. If a medicine causes the bowels to move it must do so by causing the brain to move them; you understand that I do not say that it is impossible for medicine to do this; I simply say that it is impossible that it should be done in any other way. The vital power which is stored in

the brain during sleep is the only power capable of producing functional action in any part of the body. Your heart, stomach, liver, kidneys and bowels are not separate and independent machines, operated by different and extraneous powers; they are all parts of one machine, which is run by brain-power; and the brain is charged in sleep.

Now, if there is defective action, or congestion, or inflammation, or pain in any part of the body, the only possible way to effect a cure is by directing the brain-power to the affected part. If a medicine can do this it is of value, provided its benefit be not neutralized by reactionary or other effects. Local applications produce their curative effect in this manner; a mustard plaster cannot increase functional action in the organs over which it is applied, but it is possible that by it a chemical effect upon the tissues may cause the brain to turn its power in that direction, and so increase functional action. This is the only theory of medical action which is in accord with the facts; and we must apply it also in explaining the effects of exercise and massage. Neither exercise nor massage can build up a weak part; but either may cause the brain to build it up, by directing its power to it. Mental healing is accomplished in exactly the same way; it is done by consciously and intelligently directing the brain-power by concentration of mind; and it is by far the most scientific and effective method of healing, when not complicated by speculative absurdities which befuddle the mind and prevent direct and positive action.

Now, again, perhaps you do not see the importance of all this. Go back over this chapter, and the preceding one; examine the facts and study the logic of the deductions. You will hardly fail to become convinced that your body is a machine which is operated by power which is stored in your brain during sleep; and that no other agency can heal it, build it up, or keep it well but this brain-power. If you are sick or weak you know now where your cure is to be found; and you are ready to begin to act intelligently.

First, if the power which is to heal you is to be stored in your brain during sleep, you had better study sleep, and learn how to surround yourself with favorable conditions for the charging of your storage battery with power; sleep intelligently, and with a purpose, so as to get the best results. There are laws which govern the process of charging the brain with vital force; some of them are known; enough to enable you to set to work with a reasonable certainty of getting good results.

Second, having learned how to charge your brain with vital power you must learn how to conserve the power; how to keep yourself from throwing it away, and expending it uselessly; and this is more important, perhaps, than you imagine. Most people waste at least half their vital power.

Third, you will need to learn how to turn this force to the part where it is most needed; and this involves the consideration of all medicines, treatments, exercises, and mental processes.

What we need above all else is to be scientific in our methods of arriving at conclusions. We must avoid speculation, and fanciful theories based on the supposed need for retaining old medical or religious dogmas, and stick to the facts and to the deductions which are the inevitable corollary of the facts. If the facts do not accord with the teaching of the doctor and the physiological authorities, we will have to disbelieve the doctor and the authorities, and accept the facts; and if the facts disagree with the dogmas of the preacher we will have to ask the preacher to revise his dogmas; we must keep to the facts. And here, again, are some of the facts, and some of the things which the facts prove:

In death by starvation the brain loses no weight, but is nourished at the expense of the other tissues of the body. Death does not come so long as there are other tissues available for the brain to feed upon. This proves that the brain, not the stomach is the alpha—the center of vital power.

The structure of the body goes to prove that the brain is the power-plant; the afferent nerves carrying sensation in, and the efferent ones carrying power out. It is an absurdity to suppose that muscular power is generated by the muscles themselves; it is far more reasonable to assume that power is transmitted to them over the nerves in a manner similar to the transmission of power over an electric wire.

The strength of the body is not drawn from food; because

(*a*) It would be impossible to extract the amount of energy displayed by the body from the quantity of food consumed;

(*b*) Work-power does not increase in proportion to the quantity of food digested;

(*c*) If work-power came from food we would not be obliged to sleep for the purpose of renewing our strength; and

(*d*) The digestion of food is work in itself, and requires the expenditure of power; it cannot, therefore, be done with power drawn in the ultimate from its own processes. Work cannot do itself with power furnished by itself. It is a manifest impossibility that the body should work with energy manufactured by its own internal processes, which are themselves a part of its work, and consume its power.

Lastly, we see that every living thing goes regularly to sleep, and wakes with renewed energy.

From all this we deduce:

That the external work of the human organism is done, and its internal processes carried on by means of a vital energy which is accumulated in the brain during sleep.

That this vital energy is the only power by which the body may be healed, repaired, renewed or maintained.

Were I to adopt a pet idea as so many people do, and fondle it in my embraces to the exclusion of all others, it would be, that the great want which mankind labors under at this present period is sleep. The world should recline its vast head on the

first convenient pillow and take an age-long nap. It has gone distracted through a morbid activity, and while preternaturally wide awake, is nevertheless tormented by visions that seem real to it now, but would assume their true aspect and character were all things once set right by an interval of soul repose. — Hawthorne, "Mosses from an Old Manse"

The mind grows wiser by watching, but her sister, the body, of coarser materials, needs the support of repose. — Scott, "Talisman"

✦

REFLECTION

Here Wattles makes sleep the center of life. In sleep, he says, every living thing receives an "inflow of vital power" from a source outside itself. We do not make life; we receive it. Only that life can build a finger, mend a bone, or make a heart beat. In his view medicine, massage, and mental healing work only by sending this power to the right place. Today's science confirms that sleep matters a great deal for health, mood, and healing. It does not confirm his theory of a brain "battery," and medicines do work in ways he denies, so never drop a treatment because of this chapter. What lasts is the spiritual idea behind it: life is a gift we receive each night. That thought can make rest feel less like lost time and more like an act of trust.

PRACTICE

Tonight, choose a regular bedtime and put screens away thirty minutes before it. In the morning, write one line about how rested you feel. Repeat for a week and look at what changed.

KEY THOUGHT

Life comes to us from somewhere;
we do not make it; we receive it.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

III

How to Use Sleep

HAVING SETTLED that the brain is charged with vital power during sleep, the next important thing is to study the process, and see if we may arrive at any conclusion as to the laws which govern it. In observing the phenomena of sleep, the most noticeable thing is the change in the manner of breathing. The sleeping person breathes deeply, strongly and with a more rhythmic movement than the waking one; a much larger quantity of air is taken into the system in a given time during sleep than when awake. Very few persons breathe audibly when awake, while frequently the deep, strong breathing of a sleeping person can be heard throughout a house of ordinary size. Since deep and rhythmic breathing is universal during sleep, I conclude that it is an essential part of the process of charging the brain with vital power, and that a large quantity of air is necessary to the operation. I notice an apparent connection between air and vital power, as shown by other phenomena. When I am about to undertake a heavy lift, or to perform some feat of strength, I instinctively fill my lungs with air, as if by so doing I could add to my muscular power; and if I exercise violently nature compels me to breathe with great force and rapidity, evidently needing an increased quantity of air because of the strenuous exertion. There appears, I say, to be a direct connection between air and energy.

But I find that deep breathing is not all; I cannot renew the energy of the brain by deep breathing without sleep; I must go into the silence and become unconscious. And I do not know *what* it is in the air that is essential to life. It is not oxygen alone, for if you put me in an atmosphere of undiluted oxygen I will die. I must have air.

It is essential, too, that the air be pure. When I sleep in a room with no ventilation I rise in the morning unrefreshed; the battery has been very imperfectly charged. It is therefore necessary to have air which is in motion; since motion is essential to the purity of air. It will not answer the purpose to set a spool of thread under the window and put the bed's head back in the corner, out of the "draft." The draft is just what I want to get into. The object of ventilation is to produce motion in the air, so that we can breathe air which moves. It is not enough to raise the sash well up, if that is the only opening, for the air in the center of the room, or in the corner where the bed's head stands may be absolutely motionless and stagnant and remain so throughout the night.

There is not the slightest reason for the universal fear of drafts; a draft is air in motion, and motion does not impart any evil quality to air; on the contrary, moving air is far more likely to be pure than that which is stagnant. The chemical processes by which air purifies itself depends on motion. There is no reason to suppose that cold air is dangerous; that is, if it is not so cold as to actually freeze one. The night air is not less salubrious than day air. Night air is air with the light out of it, and taking the light out of air does not make it noxious. There is no evidence to support the idea that damp air is harmful; damp air is air with a little water in it, and water is not a poison.

If you lack vitality of power and wish to proceed scientifically in charging your brain with it, you must first disabuse your mind of the notion that pure air, in any place or under any condition or in any quantity is harmful; and you must come to understand the fact that the first great necessity of life is a plentiful supply of absolutely pure air during sleep.

So, attend first to the ventilation of your sleeping room. If there is only one room in the house that can be ventilated sleep in that room no matter how inconvenient it may be otherwise. Begin by providing for a current of air across the room. Open a door or window on each side; wide open. Do not be afraid of burglars; better be carried off by a burglar than by the undertaker. When you have arranged for a current of air through the room, pull your bed out so that your head will be right in the middle of the stream. If you are not quite free from the old fear of moving air, you had better do this gradually, bringing the bed out a foot or two at a time; otherwise you may scare yourself to death with your fears of the dreadful "draft!"

Now understand that no matter what your disease may be, there is only one power which can cure you. You may have consumption, typhoid fever, appendicitis, cancer, liver complaint, a broken leg or a sore toe; but the only power which can make you whole is your own vital energy. The life that is in you is all the life there is; and you must accumulate enough of it to overcome the diseased or morbid condition. And you get it in sleep, and fresh, pure, *moving* air is absolutely necessary to the process. Do not close the window because it is damp; breathe the pure air, water and all. Do not close the window because it is cold; pile on bed clothes or make a fire. Do not "air" your bedroom during the day and close it at night; better reverse the process. Sleep the year round with your head in a running stream of pure air, fresh from out-of-doors.

There are certain other things which are pretty well established. In a vast majority of cases eight hours is about the right length of time to pass in sleep every day. More than eight hours is too much. It is generally better to sleep six hours than ten. Don't ask me why, because I do not know.

And a condition of absolute physical and mental relaxation and passivity is demanded for the best results. It is a mistake to eat before going to bed. The digestion of food is work, and if you wish to gain

strength you should not work while you are sleeping. I know, if you are mentally excited or disturbed you can often become unconscious more speedily after eating; that is because the stomach is robbing the brain of power, but unconsciousness while the brain works is not genuine sleep, and the charging process is very imperfect under such conditions; and you will lack power the next day. And you cannot make up the loss by eating more; the more you eat the weaker you will be. What you lose in sleep cannot be recovered at the table. There are better ways of curing insomnia than by overworking the stomach. Never mind what anybody tells you about the necessity for stuffing; go to bed with your stomach empty. The digestion of food is work, and you cannot have a natural, effective sleep while you are at work.

So far, you will please notice, I have written on physical energy or work power; not of will power. Will power, or spiritual control is also acquired in the silence, but with this difference—we do not become unconscious. We will talk about that in a subsequent chapter, but I want to call attention here to the fact that certain thought conditions are essential to perfect sleep. A brain whose power is being drawn upon for thought cannot sleep. You cannot sleep and dream at the same time; the more you dream the less perfect is the renewal of your vital power. I do not wish you "pleasant dreams" or any other kind; I hope you may sleep.

Absolute quietude of mind; the cessation of all physical and mental activity, the relaxation which comes only with perfect trust in God, is a necessary condition for "restful" sleep; but while this is true, there is an element of positive thought which may enter in, possibly with advantage. It is a demonstrable fact, as I will show you later, that the brain power may be directed to or withheld from any part of the body by thought; and there is pretty good evidence that the character of the last thought on going to sleep may influence the course of the brain current during the night. Those who indulge in lascivious waking dreams are apt to have lascivious sleeping dreams; and to become unduly stimulated in the sexual system by an abnormal turning of power in that

direction. I am quite sure that it is possible to turn the vital energy toward any weak or defective organ, on going to sleep; but I am not so confident as to the wisdom of this, for it seems to me that sleep is for the gathering of force, and not for its expenditure in healing, or any other activities. I would be careful about setting the mind at work to heal myself or others during sleep; the best time to think your healing thoughts is when you are awake. Suppose, when you lie down tonight you try a formula like the following:

"I have opened my windows, and the pure air, filled with vital power, comes streaming in; the One Great Life is seeking to find me, and to fill me with Itself. I relax, and open my soul as I have opened my windows; I shall be filled with Life while I sleep; and it will give me power to overcome every ill, and all weakness. Flow in, oh, Life, and give me strength; and I will use it, by the guidance of Thy love, to do Thy will. Amen."

The first wealth is health. — Emerson

Oh, thou that pinest in the imprisonment of the Actual, and criest bitterly to the God for a kingdom wherein to rule and create, know this of a truth, the thing thou seekest is already with thee, here or nowhere, couldst thou only see! — Thomas Carlyle

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles gets practical. Sleep comes with deep, rhythmic breathing, so he concludes that fresh, moving air is vital to it. Open the windows wide on both sides, put your head right in the draft, and stop fearing night air, damp air, or cold. About eight hours is right, the stomach should be empty at bedtime, and the mind should rest in quiet trust. He ends with a short evening prayer. Some

of this is sensible: a ventilated room, regular hours, and a calm mind before sleep all help. Some is not. Very cold rooms can be risky for babies, older people, and the sick, and his claim that only your own vital energy can cure cancer or appendicitis must never delay real treatment. His prayer of opening the soul is still a lovely way to end a day.

PRACTICE

Write your own short evening sentence of trust or gratitude, using Wattles' prayer as a model if it suits you. Read it slowly before sleep for seven nights, and notice whether your evenings feel different.

KEY THOUGHT

I relax, and open my soul as I have opened my windows

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

IV

Scientific Living and Healing

NOT MANY things are harder to overcome than the persistent auto-suggestion that life is of material origin, and that vital power comes from food. It takes a great deal of argument to make the average man (especially if he is a woman) understand that his strength is renewed in sleep, and that he grows weaker, not stronger by eating. Possibly not many of our readers are firmly grounded in this faith as yet; I shall have to argue it a little further for you, even at the risk of repeating myself.

Let me call your attention, first, to the fact that loss of appetite nearly always accompanies severe sickness. Now, if strength comes from food, why does nature "go back on us" just when we need strength most? Why does she not make the sick man ravenous with hunger, as she does the woodchopper? The latter needs food in large quantities to replace the tissues destroyed by his strenuous toil; he has digestive power, and hunger is given to him. Why should not hunger be given to the sick man, so that he can generate vital power from the food, build up his strength and get well?

The appetite is taken away in severe sickness because nature needs all her power for the work of restoring normal conditions, and there is none to spare for the labor of digestion. The digestion of food is work, and hard work; the sick man's brain has not the power for it. So nature says,

"Keep out; we are busy inside; when we are ready for food we will let you know." Sick horses never eat; but sick people—or at least their friends and physicians—seldom have horse sense. When the appetite is taken away it is considered a sign that nature requires "light" foods; or that the earth should be ransacked for tempting dainties to create an appetite; whereas, nature simply wants to be let alone. Food given when the tongue is coated and the appetite gone is seldom digested; it decomposes, and the condition within the stomach of the unfortunate one becomes something horrible to think about; a putrid, poisonous mass, the dreadful odor of which can often be distinguished throughout a large apartment.

The person who fasts loses weight, but the loss all falls upon those tissues which can best be spared; and even in death by starvation, the brain and nervous system lose no weight at all. That is, the brain *eats up* the other tissues; and death does not come until the skeleton condition is reached, and there is nothing more for the brain to absorb. The brain must be sustained; when there is no other food it draws its nourishment from the body itself. The sick man loses in weight by just this process; and it is the intention of nature that he should do so. I am not speaking of the sick man who *has* hunger, you understand, but of the severely sick one who has none. Nature desires his brain to live on its stored-up resources for a few days; she wants to economize power. And if you feed him he generally keeps right on losing weight; and the more you feed the faster he loses which is proof positive that he does not assimilate food. If he did, how could he lose weight? He lies still, and is not destroying any tissue; if he assimilated food he could not fail to gain in weight. And, I repeat, the patient who is fed generally loses weight and strength faster than the one who eats nothing at all; proving that the disposition of the food is a tax on his energy. It would be as logical, and as scientific, to set the sick man chopping wood as to feed him; working his stomach is as bad for him as working his arms would be.

Even when the sickness is chronic, and there is some appetite, the greatest care should be used not to overeat. Where little or no exercise is taken, the amount of food required is very small indeed, and there is nothing to gain and everything to lose by eating more than is readily assimilated. Very, very many invalids are kept weak and low because their brain power is wasted by overeating; sick or well, if you are eating more than is required to maintain your body you are robbing yourself of vital power, and charging your system with deadly poison besides.

In case of severe sickness, do not offer the patient food nor mention it in his presence; put him in a cool, airy room and make him as comfortable as possible; give him a chance to sleep; do not let him be talked to, or fussed over; keep out the neighbors, the doctor and the preacher; and if the disease is curable, he will get well. The scientific use (or non-use, as the case may be) of air, water, food, exercise, sleep and thought will cure any disease that is curable at all.

Be sure you do not mention food until the sick one asks for it with well-developed hunger. Do not fear that he will suddenly starve to death, and drop off all in a minute when your back is turned. He will starve faster if you feed him than if you do not. Trust nature; when she is ready for food she will let you know.

If the sickness is not severe, and there is little appetite, bear in mind that the way to conserve brain power is to eat no more than is actually demanded, and that a sick person, who exercises little needs very little indeed. One egg makes a pretty fair day's ration for the average sick person—even for one who is "up and around"; and if most of the sick who are trying to eat all they can, and racking their brains and those of their friends to think of "something they can eat," would cut their day's food down to one egg, or its equivalent in weight and value, they would surprise themselves and their doctors by an immediate gain in weight and strength. Save your brain power, and get strong and well.

Let us now give a little thought to the phenomena we see in the class of diseases called catarrhal—coughs, colds, hayfevers, etc. In many cases

an enormous quantity of matter is expectorated or discharged; and the question I wish to press upon you is, Where does it all come from? Clearly, nothing can come out of the body through the mouth, which has not been put into it; and as things are generally put into the body through the mouth, is it not apparent that what is blown out of the head must have gotten into the body by way of the stomach? Is it not an unavoidable conclusion that catarrhal discharges are taken from the food consumed; that they are simply food matter gone wrong? If there is a discharge from the body we know that one of two things must be true; either the tissues are breaking up and coming away, or the discharge comes from the dining tables.

This is the process of "taking cold." A pound of food is needed in the system, and we eat, say, two pounds. Digestion being good, the whole quantity is taken into the blood. Nature has use for only one pound, and she uses that, repairing bone, muscle and nerve. The other pound she has no use for, but it has been forced upon her, and she must dispose of it. She may deposit a little of it on the body in the form of fat, and eliminate more through the kidneys, lungs and skin; but there will still be some ounces left to decay in the blood—for food matter will decay in the blood. So there is a little rotten matter—sewage—left in the blood as the result of that meal. At the next meal the process is repeated; and at the next, and the next. The quantity of decaying waste in the blood gets greater, until at last the arterial flow is like a stream into which the sewage of a city is emptied, foul and thick with decaying refuse, which all comes from the dining table.

At last the stream gets so thick that nature must call a halt; she cannot carry on the processes of bodily renewal with that foul blood; it must be purified. So there is a chill; a congestion in some part of the mucous membrane, and the impurities begin to be strained off. When you take cold you cough up and blow out the surplus food you have been eating; it would kill you if you did not get rid of it. The cold is an effort of nature to save your body from dissolution. It is not caused by drafts or

exposure; it is caused by overeating. If you do not overeat you may sit in drafts, or sleep in them, or expose yourself as you please, and you will not take cold. You "catch" cold at the table; you cannot get one anywhere else. That is where we get catarrh, which is a chronic cold. A year of scientific living will cure the worst case of catarrh that ever happened, climate or no climate. And this is the way the new physiology accounts for catarrh, and catarrhal diseases. You may easily avoid these ills if you only realize that you do not have to stuff yourself with large quantities of food in order to generate vital power. Your life is more than meat. It is not drawn from material things, and food does not contribute to life or strength in any way. You need food only to supply the spirit with material from which to construct a body, and the quantity required is very, very much less than most of you have believed.

Let us talk a little now about "germ" diseases. The people of the city of Chicago have dug great tunnels out under the lake a mile or so, to get pure water. They want to get far away from the water of the river, which is thick with rotting sewage, like the blood of a glutton. There are plenty of disease germs in the river, but none out in the lake; disease germs cannot live and propagate in water which does not contain sewage; and it is also a fact that they cannot propagate in blood which does not contain sewage. If your blood is like the pure water of Lake Michigan no disease germ can live in it; but if it is like the Chicago river it will be a breeding ground for any organism that may be introduced into it. This is bed-rock, scientific fact. If your blood is pure you are immune to germ diseases; you cannot have typhoid, la grippe, smallpox or diphtheria, nor can you catch cold. Disease germs can only propagate in impure blood, and blood is made impure by overeating, and by not breathing enough.

How much more sensible and scientific to purify the stream than to try to neutralize the germs by loathsome counter-poisons!

Let me close this chapter outlining a sane regime of living. We do not need food on arising in the morning. We have slept, and the brain is fully charged with power; there is no demand for food, for there has been no

destruction of tissues. No one is really hungry in the morning; the appetite for breakfast is a forced and unnatural one. Most people do not eat breakfast because they are hungry, but for fear of collapse later in the day; they think to store up energy in the stomach against a future need. Drop off the breakfast altogether, and as soon as you get your mind adjusted to the plan you will find that no matter whether your work is mental or physical you can do more of it "on an empty stomach" and do it better. At noon, eat a moderate meal of any plain hearty food that your taste may call for; and eat a very light supper between six and seven o'clock. If you are a brain worker, make your dinner very light also; by "light" I mean small in quantity, not of chaffy materials. Do not bother your head about carbohydrates and nitrogens; eat what you like best. The invalid and the brain worker need exactly the same foods that the woodchopper needs, but not nearly so much. Your taste is the safest guide as to what you shall eat; let it be beans, potatoes, sauerkraut, hog and hominy—anything that will stay on a Christian stomach, if you desire it, but not too much! And above all things, *never* eat when you are not hungry.

Life is an energy which is stored in the brain during sleep. If we understand that material food plays no part in the generation of this energy, and govern our appetites accordingly, we shall have perfect health. If we live according to the simple law of life no material thing can harm us. We are spiritual beings; we get our life in the Great Silence, out of which we came. We shall live after we cease to eat, for we do not live by eating now; our physical bodies are kept up by a mysterious power which comes to us while we are unconscious. God is Spirit; and He giveth life to all.

It is notorious that a single successful effort of moral volition, such as saying "No" to some habitual temptation, or performing some courageous act, will launch a man on a higher level of energy for days and weeks, will give him a new

range of power. The emotions and excitements due to usual situations are the usual inciters of the will. But these act discontinuously; and in the intervals the shallower levels of life tend to close in and shut us off. Accordingly the best knowers of the human soul have invented the thing known as methodical, ascetic discipline to keep the deeper levels constantly in reach. Beginning with easy tasks, passing to harder ones, and exercising day by day, it is, I believe, admitted that disciples of asceticism can reach very high levels of freedom and power of will. Ignatius Loyola's spiritual exercises must have produced this result in innumerable devotees. But the most venerable ascetic system, and the one whose results have the most voluminous, experimental corroboration is undoubtedly the Yoga system in Hindustan.
— William James, "Energies of Men"

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles comes back to his central claim and spells out what follows from it. Sick people lose their appetite because nature needs all its strength for healing, so they should not be fed until real hunger returns. Colds, he says, are the body throwing off surplus food, and germs can live only in "impure" blood made by overeating. He ends with a plan: no breakfast, a moderate midday meal, a light supper, and never eating without hunger. Much of this is now known to be false. Germs cause infection in healthy people too, vaccines and medicine save lives, and sick people often need fluids and nourishment. Keeping the doctor away can be dangerous. His aside about women is a prejudice of his era. What survives is a simple reminder to listen to the body's real signals, together with his conviction that we are more than our meals.

PRACTICE

Over one ordinary day, notice each time you eat for reasons other than hunger: boredom, stress, habit, politeness. Write each moment down without judging it. If you are ill, follow your doctor's advice on food and fluids.

KEY THOUGHT

We are spiritual beings; we get our life in the Great Silence, out of which we came.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

V

Mind Cures

IN THE second chapter I asserted that nothing can repair, restore, heal or renew the body or any part of it but vital powers—the energy which is stored in the brain during sleep. Nothing but brain power, conducted to it over the "motor" nerves, can make a heart beat; and nothing but brain power can "strengthen" a weak heart. Nothing but brain power can cause a liver to secrete bile; and a "torpid" liver is one to which the brain power is imperfectly conducted or applied. Nothing but brain power can cause a movement of the bowels; the only power which can cure constipation is that which is stored in the brain during sleep. This is pretty hard for you to believe, if you have been taking medicines to "strengthen" your heart, "act" on your liver, and "move" your bowels; but it is a demonstrable scientific fact nevertheless. How much medicine will it take to make a dead man's heart beat, his liver act or his bowels move? Can medicine move heart, liver or bowels when the brain is not charged with life? The most that can be said of medicine is that it (or the belief in it,) causes the brain power to be applied to certain parts or organs. You must understand that your liver like every other organ of your body is built and planned to be operated by brain power; it cannot be operated by medicine, or by anything else, any more than an electric motor can be made to run by turning a steam jet against it. The electric

motor is only built to be run by one kind of power; and the same is true of the liver. There is not the slightest evidence that there is any "remedy" which can "act" on the liver, or cause the liver to act; and this is true of all the viscera.

How, then, do we get effects from medicine? Let me show you. Suppose I begin to write here a detailed description of things good to eat —fried chicken, lemon pie, strawberries and cream—yum, yum! You read a little way, and you notice an increased flow of saliva into your mouth; it "makes your mouth water." How can the thought of strawberries and cream cause the saliva to flow? Only by causing the brain power to be turned on; nothing but brain power can cause the salivary glands to act. Tickle the inside of the mouth with a straw and the saliva will flow; why? Because the afferent nerves carry the irritation to the brain and cause the power to be turned on. The power is turned on to the whole digestive system by the thought of eating; and it is withheld by anxiety, or the fear of indigestion; but that is another story, which I will tell you a little farther on.

Suppose, instead of strawberries and cream, I tell you of something horrible and disgusting,—say a dead cat. Pretty soon you begin to be nauseated; and you may even vomit. How can the thought of a dead cat cause vomiting? Only by causing the brain power to be turned on to the stomach with that intention; and that is the only way an emetic can produce its effect. Nothing but the brain can cause vomiting; an emetic introduced into a dead man's stomach lies inert and powerless. Some emetics act through belief only; others, perhaps, irritate the sensory nerves of the stomach in such a way as to cause the power to be turned on; but it is always the brain which really empties the stomach.

Of course there are medicines which act directly on the parts with which they come in contact—corrosive chemicals which affect the lining membranes of the alimentary canal. These ought never to be taken, and the ignorance which prescribes them is homicidal. Irritation of the sensory nerves, in any part of the body, causes the power to be turned on

in that direction. That, as I have mentioned in a previous chapter, explains the action of all "strengthening," "soothing," "healing" and other applications. A mustard plaster has no power to increase action in the parts beneath it; but its irritation causes the brain to act. Liniments, etc., cannot overcome morbid conditions; but by reflex action or by the patient's faith, they may cause the direction of an increased amount of brain power to the affected part. And there is not the slightest evidence that medicines do or can "act" except as described above.

What I say of medicine applies also to massage and exercise. Massage may shake and work loose the obstructions to the circulation in a congested tissue; and it may cause the brain power to be turned on. It cannot increase "local action" because, strictly speaking, there is no local action; all action is from the brain. Shaking and pounding a torpid liver, loosens the morbid matter in the ducts and channels and draws power from the brain to move the matter on; but it does not cause the liver to act, for the liver never acts; the brain acts through it. This ought to be understood in applying massage: That there are two things to accomplish, the thorough loosening of the tissues and opening of the channels, and the turning on of power of the brain. Massage cannot "build up" a weak or defective part; only brain power can do that.

This is also true of exercise. Exercise does not strengthen weak parts; the brain does that. Exercise does not make big muscles; the brain does *that* also! Don't fly off the handle, you physical culture enthusiast; let me explain. How do you build up a weak part by exercise? Flex and relax the biceps muscles vigorously for a few moments; the quantity of blood flowing to it is greatly increased, and the blood carries the food; the muscle is fed more just in proportion as it is used more, and it grows larger and thicker. The benefit of exercise is that it turns the brain power to the part you wish to build up; and with brain power goes an increased blood supply, which carries the nourishment. So it is the brain which makes the big muscles, you see. Exercise really tears a part down, and the brain restores it. And let me give you a gentle hint right here. If the

above is true—and it surely is—*all* exercise is not beneficial to a sick man, but only those movements which direct the power to the afflicted part. If your back is weak and you take arm and leg exercises, you are drawing power away from the part you wish to help; that is the reason why "physical culture courses" under the guidance of pugilists and ex-champion wrestlers are as apt to do the sick harm as to do them good. For a weak back, take ten minutes night and morning of exercise which uses the muscles in the weak place; and do not neutralize the effect by going through other movements which draw the power to other parts of the body. Remember that ten minutes twice a day is worth more than two hours at irregular intervals; what you want to do is to regularly, systematically and continuously demand of the brain that a little more power and nourishment be sent to the weak part. *That* is the way to exercise scientifically for curative effect. Ask, and keep on asking, and ye shall receive.

That is you will receive if you put your mind into the demand. And now we are at the *crux of* this whole healing business. Neither medicine, massage nor exercise can produce effect if opposed by the mind of the patient. I hope you will read and consider carefully what follows. It is the most important of all, so far.

Let a person be laid on his back on a bed, accurately balanced so that the head and foot may swing up and down; now let him be asked to perform severe mental labor, and the bed's head will tip down, because of an increased flow of blood to his head. Let him go through a series of leg exercises and the foot of the bed will tip down, because of the increased flow of blood to the legs, and mark! Let him *think* out the leg exercises, without moving a muscle, and the foot will go down, showing that it is the *intention* to move which sends the blood to the legs; and if the intention is formed in the mind, the power goes whether the movement is really executed or not. It is the *thought* of exercise, and not really the exercise which sends the blood to the muscle; and if the thought be withheld the exercise accomplishes next to nothing as a

building process. That is why exercise which is taken under compulsion, which is a drag and a task, does no good. That is why mere muscular toil and drudgery rarely make strong men and women, but generally make weaker ones. Work or exercise to be beneficial must be done freely, joyously and confidently; if it be mechanical and automatic it is useless expenditure of power, and tears down instead of building up.

And if the positive thought of action can send power and nourishment to the muscles of the legs, it necessarily follows that the same must be true of all parts and organs of the body. The firm, steady concentration of thought upon the "torpid" liver with the positive will and purpose to make it "go" will certainly cause action where action is possible at all. This is true of all cases of arrested action, unless there is some mechanical obstruction which requires massage, manipulation or surgery. If there is a part of the machine which isn't working, turn on the power by steady, concentrated, purposeful *thought;* understand that you possess at all times the power to control and direct your own vital power. And if there is a thought that turns on the power, so there must be thoughts that shut it off; and this we find by experiment to be true also. Fear or anxiety instantly arrests action. If you think of your liver with fear you shut off the power from it; if you think of your stomach with anxiety you deprive it of energy; if you think with fear or anxiety of the bowels you paralyze them. In most cases of constipation the cause is entirely in a habit of mind or thought which withholds power from the bowels. All cases of indigestion are greatly aggravated by anxious thought about the digestibility of foods. When you begin to worry about what you shall eat you begin to have dyspepsia. Don't think about the values of digestibility of different foods; eat what tastes good to you, but only eat from one-fifth to one-sixteenth of what your friends would like to have you eat. That is all that is necessary to cure stomach trouble. We hear it said of melancholy people that they have the blues because their livers are bad; that is generally the reverse of the truth; their livers are bad because they have the blues.

Remember that the calm, confident, purposeful thought of faith sends the life power flowing out; and the fear thought locks it in. And can we cultivate power to think the thoughts of faith and cheer, and avoid those of anxiety, fear and discouragement? Yes, and that will be the subject for a subsequent chapter of this series.

Every man has experienced how feelings which end in themselves and do not express themselves in action, leave the heart debilitated. We get feeble and sickly in character when we feel keenly, and cannot do the thing we feel. — Robertson

The flighty purpose never is o'ertook, Unless the deed go with it; from this moment The very firstlings of my heart shall be The firstlings of my hands. | No boasting like a fool; | This deed I'll do before the purpose cool. — Shakespeare, "Macbeth"

✦

REFLECTION

This chapter shows how Wattles sees the mind working on the body. Thinking about strawberries makes the mouth water, and a disgusting image can bring on nausea. To him this proves that the brain, steered by thought, drives every organ. Medicine works only by turning that power on, and exercise helps only when done with intention and joy. Fear and worry shut the power off, so anxious people get indigestion and their "livers are bad because they have the blues." Modern research does take the mind-body link seriously: stress affects digestion, placebo effects are real, and exercise you enjoy is easier to keep up. But thoughts do not replace medicine, and nobody is sick because they thought wrongly. His advice to eat a tiny fraction of normal amounts is unsafe. Keep the hopeful core: calm confidence helps, and fear rarely does.

PRACTICE

On your next walk or workout, give it your full, cheerful attention instead of treating it as a chore. Afterward, write one sentence about how it felt. If a symptom worries you, note it down and take it to a doctor.

KEY THOUGHT

the calm, confident, purposeful thought of faith sends the life power flowing out; and the fear thought locks it in.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VI

Nature and Development of Will Power

"Burnt offerings for sin thou wouldst not. . . . Lo, I come to do thy will, Oh, God!" — Heb. x: 8-9.

IN HUMAN life I seem to see three different forms of manifestations of energy, which for convenience's sake I am going in this article to call physical, mental, and spiritual. Physical energy is what we have been treating of in this series of articles; proving that it is not drawn from food, but is received in sleep. It is the life force of the organism, the work power of the body. Mental energy is thought power. I do not know what the difference between physical work power and thought power may be; I do not know whether there is a difference or not; but I know that there are individuals who have a great deal of physical power and apparently very little thought power; and there are others who have a great deal of thought power and very little vital energy; and so I will consider them as separate forms of force. We will, therefore, adopt this hypothesis; that you display three forms of energy; first, the physical power, which carries on the work of the material body, and second, the power which runs your think-machine. I do not know what your think-machine is, or where it is; I do not know whether you think with your

brain or not; I am inclined to think that you do not; but anyway, I know that you have a thinker, because you think; and I know that it takes power to operate your thinker, because thought is a force itself, and cannot be produced without the expenditure of force. So I know that you have a thinker and that it takes power to run it; and I am assuming that this power is different from physical energy, although I do not know that it is; but it makes my point a little clearer to speak of physical energy and thought power as if they were different things.

Now, this thinker of yours is absolutely indifferent to moral considerations. It knows nothing, and cares nothing about good and evil. There is no connection between thought power and goodness. Bad people often have much thought power, and many excellent souls have very little. A devil may be a very keen and acute thinker, and a saint may be almost destitute of reasoning power. Your thinking machine works in the direction in which you set it running. If you start it planning to execute a noble deed of charity, it will go on and arrange all the details, and if you put it at work on a plan to rob a bank, it will work on the details of that plan just as readily. I think you will agree with me, however, that you have, at least in a rudimentary way, the power to control and direct your think-machine. You tell it to think about this, and it does; or to cease thinking about this, and to consider that, and it obeys you. So you see here are the three forms of power I have mentioned—first, physical power; second, thought power, and third, the power to control and direct the thought.

Now, it is this power to control and direct the think-machine that we wish to develop. The trouble is that there are too many other forces operating it. Some one, or some thing, starts it running on the fear thought or the thought of despondency and discouragement, and it runs away from us; we want to master it completely, so that it will only work on the thoughts of hope and faith and love and health; how to do it is the question; how to develop this power of control. For it is not a thing to be acquired, but one to be developed; we have it within.

Did your thinking-machine ever run away with you along the line of self pity? First, it says, you are not appreciated; you are not understood; those around you do not realize how fine your nature is, and how delicate your sensibilities are! They are all blind, callous, selfish; they do not love you as they ought, they do not see, or seem to care how they make you suffer! Ah well, they will be sorry, when it is too late! And then your imagination runs on and you see yourself sick, dying, dead—and your weeping friends stricken with awful remorse, standing around your coffin and wishing they had treated you better—did your thinker ever get started on that line? And when it reached a certain point did not something else seem to rise up within you and say: "Nonsense! You know better than all this! Stop it, and think sense!" It was as if the engine ran away while the engineer slept, and he suddenly awakened and assumed control. This engineer is always within you. You have always faith and hope and love at the center of your being. You do not have to acquire them from without, but to arouse them within. The engineer is there, but he is like one in a tomb, asleep; he must hear the voice and come forth. That is salvation. "You who were dead in trespasses and sins hath he quickened," said St. Paul, who was very scientific. To be dead in trespasses and sins is simply to have lost control of your thinker. The engineer is in a dead sleep, and the sin thought and the fear thought and the disease thought are running the engine. The force works undirected. How shall we waken the engineer, and get him "quickened" so he will stay awake? How shall we vitalize this third principle, and get the power of control over our own internal forces? This is the supreme question. We know how to charge the battery of vital power in sleep; how shall we energize the soul?

Let me point you to the connection between silence and physical power. When you want vital energy you have to quit reaching, snatching, and grabbing for it, and just lie and shut your eyes and let it come. To charge the brain with power you must get still; stop the busy hand, close the eye, suspend the action of the senses; and life comes in.

Cease all activities, and couple on to the one Eternal Life as to a dynamo, and get charged. That is the process. Why not try it in charging the will? Suspend all other work and make connection with the Eternal Will, and receive spiritual power as we receive physical energy; why not?

I wonder if any of our readers were ever in an old-fashioned Quaker meeting, where the congregation sat in silence for an hour? If you were, you know something of how it feels to be in an atmosphere surcharged with spiritual power. For a hundred devout men and women to sit together in perfect silence for an hour, with their thoughts withdrawn from earthly things and their souls open toward God—it is no wonder that the early Quakers were spiritual giants and giantesses. It is a great pity that the friends of the present day have fallen in line with the practices of their competitors and fill every moment of their meetings with gibble, gabble, gobble,—words, words, words! The marked spiritual power which once distinguished the Quakers came to them in their silent meetings, and they have lost it with the discontinuance of the practice. The silent meeting was scientific; it was in line with the law of transmission of life, and to that law you must individually conform if you are to have energy of soul.

So, this is the method. Go into your closet and shut the door. Get by yourself in the quietest place you can find, and where you may be free from interruption for a little while. And sit down; relax the body; rest. And now, stop thinking. You have not gone apart to meditate, or to think about God, or about anything else. Stop thinking; silence; be still. And when you are still begin to pray. Now this is a wordless prayer, and a prayer without thought. You are not to pray with the thinking-machine but with the will. You are not to think thoughts and tell them to God; nor are you to ask Him to think thoughts and tell them to you. You are not seeking God's thoughts but His energy. You do not wish to hitch your thinker to His thinker, but to unite your will to His will. You will readily see that if there is a purpose in the universe, there must also be a will behind the purpose, and this will must be the source of all will

power. Get rid of the notion that there is any connection or similarity between stubbornness and will power. Will power is power to control and direct your own thought. It is spiritual energy and comes by connection with the universal will, in like manner as physical energy comes by connection with One Life.

What manner of prayer, then, will connect your will with the will of God? Only this, and no other:

> *"I will do Thy will, Oh, God!"*

That is all the prayer you need. "Not every man that sayeth unto me Lord, Lord, but he that willeth to do the will of my Father shall enter the Kingdom." To will to do the will of God is the sum of all religion. It is the highest possible assertion of self-hood. It comprehends all possible good effort, and shuts off all evil. It suspends all activity but God's and holds the soul in silence before Him. It is the greatest assertion of will power of which man is capable. Angels can do no more. And that within you which wills to do the will of God is the power which can direct and control your thought. Exercise it; call it into activity. Sit in the silence and hold your soul on the will to do the will of God. When you cannot or do not wish to concentrate longer, arise and go out. Do this every day or twice a day; and whenever your thinker gets beyond your control for an instant, will to do the will of God. You will find yourself in the way of power and life; you will draw spiritual power from God in the silence by day as you draw vital energy from Him in the silence of night.

"For I do not my own will, but the will of Him that sent me."

"Not my will, but thine."

"I do always His will."

That, beloved, is the way to get will power; and will power is the spiritual ability to control and direct yourself in thought and deed,

internal and external.

And now, here are the conclusions: Never eat unless you are hungry. If you are a hard worker or a young person, eat two moderate meals a day. If a brain worker, an invalid or an old person, eat only one meal and not much at that.

Sleep in pure air.

Think good thoughts.

And acquire power to do all these things by willing to do the will of God.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles separates three powers in us: the body's energy, the "think-machine," and the will that steers our thinking. The thinker is morally neutral; it will plan a kindness or a robbery just as readily. His vivid example is self-pity running away with us until an inner "engineer" wakes and says, "Stop it, and think sense!" He believes the will is strengthened the way the body is, through silence. Sit still, stop thinking, and pray without words: "I will do Thy will, Oh, God!" Even readers outside his faith can recognize the value of quiet practice and of choosing where attention goes. His closing rule that invalids and older people should eat only one small meal a day is not safe; ask a doctor. If low mood or self-pity weighs on you for a long time, a counselor can help.

PRACTICE

Sit quietly for five minutes each day this week. When your thoughts drift into worry or self-pity, notice it gently and return to stillness, or to a short phrase of your own about choosing the good.

KEY THOUGHT

Will power is power to control and direct your own thought.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VII

The Living One

AT THE risk of being guilty of wearisome repetition, I must here restate some of the things which have gone before. I want you to have them fresh in your mind, so that you will fully grasp the arguments which follow, for the point is one which is rather difficult to state. Life is a force, a form of energy, as truly as heat and electricity are forms of energy. That which performs work is force, or energy. There is no distinction to be made between the life of the body and its work-power. Life *is* work-power. The work-power of the body is not drawn from the food consumed; this we have proved by the following facts:

1. The anatomical structure of the body, which proves that the brain, not the stomach, is the power-plant of the organism.

1. The phenomena of sleep prove that the brain is charged with work-power during the period of sleep.

1. It is a mechanical impossibility that the enormous amount of work-power displayed by the body should be in the food consumed. A handful of rice cannot possibly furnish power to carry two hundred pounds over twenty miles of rocky ground.

1. People can fast, if properly instructed, from twenty to sixty days without material loss of strength. This would be impossible if the work-power were drawn from the daily food.

1. In death by starvation the brain loses no weight. Nature preserves the power-plant intact until the last.

1. The accession of strength felt after eating must come from the brain. It cannot come from the food, which is still an undigested mass in the stomach.

1. In severe sickness Nature always takes away the appetite; proving that the digestion of food is work; a tax on strength, and not a source of strength.

1. All the other phenomena of life point us irresistibly to the conclusion that food is merely raw material, to be used in building up the body; and that it is used by an energy which is stored up in the brain during sleep.

Now, as a form of energy, life presents one peculiar characteristic; it seems to be an exception to the law of the correlation of forces. Heat, light, and electricity are convertible, each into the others; but none of them, so far as we know, is convertible into life. Every living thing came from a germ, which contained part of a preceding life, and contained it as life, and not as something else to be converted into life. Life only comes from life; we cannot originate, generate or create it as we do electricity, by changing or combining other forces. It does not appear, so far as our observation goes, that there was ever any new life, or that life has ever come into existence where there was none before. We, with all our wisdom, skill and science, can only watch life reproduce itself; we cannot originate it.

It is the work-power of the life in the seed germ which produces the organism. It is the function of life to produce organisms. The life in the seed produces the plant; the plant does not produce the life. Life is not a result of organization, but is the cause of it. Living organisms are not machines which generate life; they are machines which are built and operated by life. Life is not the result of functional action, because it is the cause of functional action; it cannot be at once the effect and the cause. The external work of the body, as I have shown in a preceding chapter, cannot possibly be performed by power which is generated by its internal work; for the power which does both the internal and the external work is one and the same. There is no difference between the power which does muscular work and that which operates the heart, liver and stomach. It is all one, and comes from one source. It is, therefore, an absurdity to say that the work-power of the body is the result of the performance of its internal digestive or other functions.

Life is the cause of all function, including the digestion of food, and cannot be the result of that which it causes. We are therefore driven to the conclusion that the body receives its power from some external source. It certainly expends energy, we have seen that it does not and cannot generate this energy; it must, occasionally, be charged anew. And when we witness the phenomena of sleep we conclude that we are witnessing the vitalizing process; the sleeping organism is being charged with power.

But where does the power come from? Oxygen, as we have seen, is necessary to the charging process, but oxygen is not life. It is a chemical element indispensable to functional action, and to the operations of vital power, but it is not life. Nor does it appear that there is any possible combination or recombination of the elements of the atmosphere with those of the body which can produce life. For if life be drawn by chemical processes from atmospheric air, it can only be done by internal functional processes, and we have seen that it is a mechanical impossibility that life should be the result of functional action. It is as

impossible that the body should manufacture life out of air as that it should manufacture it out of food. All the arguments which I have used in the one case will apply in the other. If vital power cannot be received by the body in the form of potential energy in food, and converted into life by functional action, then it cannot be received in the form of electrical or other energy from the atmosphere, and converted into work-power by functional action. It must, therefore, be received directly as vital power, for the body is not a generator or transformer of energy. When the body receives life it must receive life; it cannot receive something else which is to be converted into life, for this would make life to be its own creator, the effect becoming its own cause.

Therefore, life is not drawn from the atmosphere, for the atmosphere is a compound of dead gases. It is not drawn from the earth, for the earth is dead mineral, vegetable and animal matter. There are forms of potential and kinetic energy in both earth and air—heat and electricity, for instance—but as I have shown you, these are not life, and it is not mechanically possible for the body to convert them into life. If there is life in the air it must be there as life, and not as something else; and it must *be in* the air, *not of* the air. If there is vital power in the earth, it must be there as life, and not as some other form of force; it must be a force; separate and distinct from all other forces, and not an inherent property of matter. For, if life were inherent in all matter, death and disintegration would be impossible. The body without the spirit would not be dead, but just as much alive as ever. We cannot escape the conclusion that vital power, or life, is seen by us only in the bodies of living organisms; whatever forces we see in dead matter are not alive, nor capable of being alive; for we receive life, not something else. If vital power is present in our material environment it is there as a living force —a living presence, a life,—not as a dead material force, which we must convert into life in order to live.

There is one other supposition which we must consider briefly here, which is that life comes from the sun. This idea probably originated

from observing the phenomena of the seasons; the forthputting of life in the spring, when the sun's rays penetrate air and soil, creating the right chemical conditions for the building of organisms by life. There is no evidence, however, that the life of the springtime comes from the sun. A certain amount of heat is necessary to the constructive processes of vital power, but heat in excess is destructive to all the work of life. Life does not come from fire, or work in fire, or with fire; and the sun, so far as we know, is pure fire. It is unthinkable that there should be life on, or in the sun. And, so far as the facts go, life only comes from life. If there are no germs of life in the sun, then reasoning from the facts of life as I see them, I cannot accept the theory that life comes from a body where there is no life.

Whence, then, does life come? I do not know. I can only say with Swedenborg that there appears to be an inflow of life into the world, which is received by all living things according to their forms; or I can say with St. Paul that there is a Living One, in whom we live and move, and whose offspring we are. But this I know by all the laws of force, that we must get our life from a living force which surrounds us. There is no escaping this conclusion. It is mechanically impossible that we should generate life, or that we should convert some other force into it; we receive it as life, and we receive it *from* life.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles repeats his eight "proofs" that food does not give us strength, then asks where life comes from. Life, he argues, comes only from life. It cannot be made from heat, electricity, air, soil, or sunlight. Life is not produced by the body's machinery; it builds and runs that machinery. So it must reach us from a living source around us. He gives two answers, Swedenborg's "inflow of life" and St. Paul's Living One "in whom we live and move." His physics would not satisfy a scientist today, and the origin of life is still an open research question. As a

spiritual reflection, though, the chapter has real force. It invites wonder that we are alive at all, and a humble sense that we live from something greater than ourselves. Readers of any belief can share that wonder.

PRACTICE

Spend ten minutes outside watching something alive: a tree, a bird, a garden. Then write three sentences about what you noticed and what it feels like to be part of the same living world.

KEY THOUGHT

Life is not a result of organization, but is the cause of it.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VIII

New Light on Immortality

FINALLY, IN the light of all the foregoing, what about the immortality of the individual? Well, the new physiology gives us, for the first time, a really scientific basis for the hope of a continued existence. You must remember that if the old physiology is true, immortality is simply impossible. If you get your vital power from food, then your soul comes from the beef trust; and when you cease to eat, that will be the end of you for time and eternity. The theory that the soul draws its vital power from God, while the body gets energy from corned beef and cabbage, is improvable; all the evidence goes to show that there are not two kinds of life, one of the body and one of the soul, but that there is only one life. The life of the soul and the life of the body are one, and come from the same source; therefore, if the old physiology is true, the death of the body is the end of all.

To prove individual immortality we must demonstrate two things to be true:

First, that there is a spiritual organism which the ego, or individual intelligence can inhabit after the dissolution of the physical body; and

Second, that the ego can and will keep the spiritual organism so in harmony with the constructive principle of nature that it, in turn, shall not be dissolved.

It is unthinkable that life should continue individualized without an organism. There must be a separate organism for every individual life; and when the life can no longer preserve its organism against the attacks of nature's destructive principle, then it must cease to be an individual life, and be merged into that Universal from whence it came. What evidence have we that there are spiritual bodies?

1. We have the testimony of clairvoyants and other psychics who claim to see them. Take this evidence for what it is worth to you. Personally, I believe some of it.

1. We are able to demonstrate mathematically that personality is not the result of functioning of the physical body. Mind is not produced by the physical body, for mind controls the physical body. Mind is not the result of functional action, for mind can and does control functional action. There is no organ of the body whose action is not controllable by mind, properly applied. To have mind control the machinery which produces it would be to make the effect become its own cause. If mind were the result of functional action, it could not cause or control functional action. There is no more evidence that the brain thinks than there is that the heart thinks, or that the liver thinks; the most we can say is that the brain appears to be the organ through which the ego applies thought to the physical body. It does not appear to be at all impossible that there is a spiritual organism, formed of finer material, in and through the physical body, permeating it as ether permeates the atmospheric air; and that this spiritual body may continue to exist after the dissolution of the physical body.

But its continued existence must depend upon its power and willingness to co-operate with the constructive principle in nature. Look where we will, we see two principles in operation; all about us are the phenomena of construction and destruction, integration and disintegration,

combination and dissolution, growth and decay, life and death. In our own bodies construction and destruction are continuous; and the length of physical life depends upon our living, so that the process of construction shall equal or exceed that of destruction. In the very nature of things, it is not possible that there should be any such thing as essential, inherent and intrinsic immortality for any living organism. Every living thing, whether spiritual or physical, must be subject to the same fundamental laws; and each must receive its vital energy from the same source. You know that you are not necessarily and inherently immortal, in so far as your physical body is concerned. You may have a long and merry life, or a short and miserable one, just as you choose. If you eat and drink and sleep and think in a constructive way, you will live a good while—I cannot undertake to say how long. You may achieve physical immortality, for all I can prove to the contrary, although I do not believe you can; and I do not know why you should want to unless you are afraid to pass out, and try the other plane. On the other hand, if you eat and drink so as to turn your constructive force into the destructive channel; if you do not give the constructive principle an opportunity by sleeping under proper conditions, or if you think destructively, you can commit physical suicide in a very little while, or you can prolong the process over a number of years, but it will be suicide all the same.

Permit me now to point out that the same must be true of your spiritual body. I believe that you have a spiritual body, for the reasons given above, and because I see phenomena in your life which I cannot possibly account for on any other hypothesis than that there is a personality which uses your brain but which is not produced by your brain. All that, however, is another story, and I shall not go into it now. But you will note now that it can be no more a necessity that your spiritual body shall live forever than it is that your physical body shall live forever. You are endowed with the power to commit physical suicide, and it necessarily follows that you must also have the power to

commit spiritual suicide. The spiritual bodies of those who persist in thinking the destructive thought and living in the destructive way must eventually be dissolved into their original elements, and the life principle be merged into that Universal life from whence it came. They who persist in violation of the law must eventually vanish from the universe; the "soul that sinneth, it shall die."

Immortality is a privilege, but not a necessity. Conscious individual existence on either the physical or spiritual planes can be long continued only by working in harmony with the constructive principle; by intelligent and continuous co-operation with God. And this is the great, stern fact that underlies the New Physiology: That the individual cannot create or renew his own life, or vital power of soul or body; he must, therefore, so harmonize himself with the source of life as to receive from it, or he will inevitably perish.

| How wonderful is Death! | Death and
his brother, Sleep. — Percy Bysshe Shelley

Everything in nature contains all the powers of nature.
Everything is made of one hidden stuff. — Emerson

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles turns to the soul. If life came from food, he says, death would end everything. Because life comes from a higher source, a spiritual body may outlast the physical one. He then gives the idea a stern twist: no one is immortal by nature. Lives that work with the "constructive principle," in harmony with God, can go on, and persistent destructive living ends in a kind of spiritual dissolution. This is his personal speculation, partly resting on psychics' testimony, and religious traditions answer these questions in many ways. His use of the word "suicide" for unhealthy habits is rhetoric, not judgment on anyone's

suffering. If thoughts of death or self-harm trouble you, please reach out to a crisis line or a professional. The hopeful part is clear: daily choices that build up life matter.

PRACTICE

List three daily habits that feel life-building to you and one that drains you. Without blaming yourself, choose one small life-building step to take tomorrow, and notice how it feels.

KEY THOUGHT

Immortality is a privilege, but not a necessity.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

IX

Suffering in Sickness

MY ATTENTION has lately been called to the case of an old lady—seventy-six years old—who is suffering from a severe attack of asthma, complicated with la grippe. Her sufferings are distressing to witness. She coughs almost continuously, especially during the night, and expectorates vast quantities of mucous; there is much retching and straining in the desperate efforts nature is making to eliminate this filth from the overburdened system.

Now this old lady belongs to that vast army of excellent women whose greatest pleasure is to feed their families, their visitors and themselves. It is not an exaggeration to say that most of her life has been spent in cooking, in eating and in thinking of eating, and in planning and preparing for meals. When she was younger, an active and hard working housewife, she ate heartily, and with some reason, because of her physical activities; but for some years now she has done very little work, and she has gone on eating, just the same. I do not know that she has eaten less than during her years of active life. She thinks and talks continuously of eating, and of things good to eat; she frequently munches apples, etc., between meals; she "lunches" at all hours, and often at bed time. And for some years she has suffered intensely with rheumatism, asthma, and frequently recurring attacks of the grippe.

It is impossible to make her believe that all her sufferings are caused by the terrible struggle her physical organism is compelled to make to rid itself of the filth with which she is continually gorging it; but such is actually the case. And the same is true of nearly all old people who suffer from the so-called infirmities of age. It has been said that when a man "retires" nature usually retires him permanently in a very short time; but the fact is that he usually destroys himself by continuing to eat as if he were still at work. Professor Metchnikoff discovered that old age is caused by a germ which originates in putrefying matter in the intestinal tract; and he hit on the marvelously scientific scheme of drinking sour milk to kill the bad germs, as the sour milk germ is an enemy to the old-age germ. And by the way, what has become of the professor's great "discovery" that drinking plenty of sour milk would make us all immortal in body? Like most of the medical discoveries it seems to have fallen flat. It is about time for some other great "scientist" to come out with an elixir of life. Instead of trying to find a counter-poison for the old age bug why did not Metchnikoff simply advise people to eat less, so as to have no putrefying filth in the intestines? This was the plan followed by Lewis Cornaro, the feeble Italian, who lived to pass the century mark, often subsisting a whole day on half an egg, or a single bunch of grapes. And Cornaro, a broken down wreck in middle life, recovered his health and lived and died without suffering. There is no reason in nature why there should be aches and pains and physical miseries attendant upon old age; it ought to be a period of physical rest and wholesomeness, and mental cheer and joy; and the reason why it is not is generally to be told in one word—overeating! The old lady mentioned above is very cross and crabbed; hating everybody, and disliked by most of those around her, she leads a loveless and wretched life; her vital power is so fully expended in eliminating the filth she continually shovels into her stomach that she has no strength to expend in loving people. And even in her misery, her whole thought is of something to eat. It is the first thing on awakening in the morning, and

it is referred to hourly during the day. "Isn't there something I can eat? Get me a little of this, or that" and so on. The poor thing eats enough to supply the needs of a hard-working man, and lingers on in excruciating torments while her enfeebled system tries to rid itself of the poisonous accumulating filth.

Another neighbor of mine, also an aged woman, passed out the other day. This was a similar case. She, also, was "a great sufferer." For weeks before she died her continuous groans and screams were heard by the neighbors; she ate three or four meals during the day, and was also fed at four o'clock in the morning. She was a heavy woman; she could have lived through the entire period of her sickness without food and had she done so she would have lost less in weight, for her system would have been spared the dreadful labor of eliminating unused food; and not only would she have lost less flesh but she would have had a painless illness, and an easy death. Most of the agonies of all kinds of sickness are due to feeding.

Five years ago I was asked to advise a young man who was in the last stage of tuberculosis, with the end very near at hand. Surrounded by loving friends, who, unable to think of any other way to show their sympathy, were continually forcing food upon him, he was coughing his life away, and suffering severely in the struggle of his feeble body to eliminate the filth. I said to him: "My boy, if you want to spend your remaining days in peace and comfort, do not eat except when you are decidedly and unmistakably hungry," and I gave his family a lecture on the difference between selfish and unselfish love. That young man never ate another mouthful of food. In a few days his coughing and expectorating ceased; he slept well, and was free from pain; he became bright and cheerful, and *four weeks* later, he fell asleep, like a little child. In my last illness, may I be delivered from the love that feeds!

And that is about all, dearly beloved. Most of the suffering in sickness is caused by feeding the sick. Oh, I know! You don't believe any such stuff! But you try it, and see. When you are sick, stop eating. Do

not think about eating; do not talk about eating; ask your friends to kindly refrain from talking about eating; and wait until you are sure you are hungry; and then wait a few hours to make sure you are sure; and then eat enough to satisfy your hunger, and *then* wait again. And if you are getting along in years, and especially if you have quit work, remember that it takes only a very little raw material to maintain the body of an old person who does not work. Find out the least quantity of food upon which you can live and keep up your weight, and live on that. If you can live on one bunch of grapes, or half an egg a day, and be well and free from aches and pains, and also be bright and happy, is not that better than to eat forty bunches of grapes or a couple of dozen eggs, and be a wretched, suffering invalid, a burden to yourself and a trial to your friends?

And, by the way, this applies as well to you who are *not* growing old; find out the smallest quantity of food upon which you can live and work without losing weight; and live on it!

REFLECTION

The last chapter tells three stories: an elderly woman with asthma who still eats heavily, a neighbor who died in pain while being fed, and a dying young man with tuberculosis who stopped eating and passed away peacefully. Wattles concludes that most suffering in sickness comes from feeding the sick, and that older people should live on tiny amounts. Read this with great care. Older adults are at real risk of malnutrition, and tuberculosis is an infection that can now be cured. His harsh portrait of the old woman blames her for her illness, and illness is never anyone's fault. One point does echo modern end-of-life care: dying people often lose their appetite, and forcing food may not comfort them. Decide such things with doctors and palliative teams. His deeper point, about love that truly serves the other person, remains worth keeping.

PRACTICE

If you care for someone who is ill or elderly, ask their care team what nourishment they need. Then ask the person what would comfort them most today, and listen closely to the answer.

KEY THOUGHT

the difference between selfish and unselfish love

MY OWN NOTES

What Is Truth?

THE NAUTILUS · 1909 · SEVEN CHAPTERS

About This Work

WHAT IS Truth? was published as a series in The Nautilus, Elizabeth Towne's New Thought magazine, between April and September 1909. Each installment begins with a short line of topics, kept here as it appeared, and each ends by summing up what has been "demonstrated" so far. Read together, the pieces form a small, step-by-step treatise.

This is Wattles at his most philosophical. Most of his books give practical instructions. Here he tries to lay the foundation beneath them by asking what is real behind appearances. He works through a series of "realities" in order: time, space, substance, consciousness and motion. He argues that there is one conscious Substance, that all force is the pressure of that Substance moved by will, and that the will behind everything is God, seeking happiness in and through all beings. The final installment draws the practical conclusion: health and abundance are the will of God for every person, and we receive them by recognizing and uniting with that Great Intelligence. These are the same ideas that support The Science of Getting Rich and The Science of Being Well, stated here as reasoning rather than method.

Two cautions are important. First, the science belongs to its time. Wattles relies on the "luminiferous ether," treats gravity as divine "will-pressure," and argues against forces acting across empty space. Physics has since moved on, so the arguments are best read as religious philosophy, not as science.

Second, the last chapter says that a person who recognizes only the health of God "cannot be otherwise than well," and that recognizing disease helps form it. This is a historical belief, not medical advice. Illness is never the patient's fault, and no amount of faith or positive thought is a substitute for medical care. If you are unwell, see a doctor. In the same way, being poor is not a refusal of God's will. Many people face hardship for reasons they cannot control.

Read today, the series rewards patience. It shows a self-taught thinker trying to join faith, reason and the science of his day into one picture of the world. His closing advice, to "pray" and to "work," can be taken in many ways. For some readers it will mean prayer; for others, steady reflection and effort.

CHAPTER

I

Time

A balloon goes up; a stone falls to earth;
why? One force in nature—Gravity.

THE SCIENCE of theology and medicine are necessarily very closely allied, both having to do with the saving of men from the consequences of wrong living; and it follows that in religion and medicine we are always seeking for realities; searching the truth; seeking the ultimate, spiritual and physical facts upon which to base our theories, and from which to proceed in making our demonstrations of health and wholeness. And since our demonstrations must and will be complete or incomplete just in proportion to the completeness of our grasp of the realities, the importance of the search for truth becomes apparent; the very first thing we have to do is to penetrate through all the appearances of life, and ascertain the differences between what is really true and what is only apparently true; for there is often a vast difference between the appearance and the reality. The sun appears to rise and set, and to go around the earth; but it does not. A balloon goes up; and a stone falls to the earth; in appearance there are two forces at work, but in reality there is only one—gravity. The reality behind the going up of the balloon and the coming down of the stone is the same. And to seek for the realities behind the appearances of life; behind its goings up and

comings down, its goings out and comings in,—that is science, and that is what we are going to try to do.

The first of the realities with which we will deal is Time. It is the fashion with some metaphysical writers to assert that there is no time; but the arguments advanced in support of this claim are superficial. Time is not an entity having substance, but it is an existing reality, nevertheless. Time is not an idea; a fiction by which we measure and record the motions of the heavenly bodies; time would go on just the same and at exactly the same rate if the heavenly bodies were motionless. Do not misunderstand me in my use of the word "time." Many people suppose that time began when man began, and must end when man ends as a mortal and physical being, and that the periods before and after the earth life of the human race are to be called eternities; in other words that there can be no time except so long as there is a mortal man to measure it; but this is erroneous. Days, weeks, months and years must have gone on before man came on earth, just as they do now; and if man disappeared from the earth, they would still go on. If the earth ceased to revolve around the sun, and to turn on its axis, the succession of the seasons and of day and night would cease; day would be continuous on one side of the earth, and night upon the other, but hours and minutes would go on just the same, and if the sun, moon, planets, stars and all else were to disappear and be succeeded by black, silent, formless chaos, hours and minutes would go on forever. Clocks do not make time; an hour would have the same duration if there were no clocks. In eternity there must still be time; time is duration in eternity. Eternity is endless time.

Time can never end. If you try to think of a point at which time should end, you can only think of it as a point beyond which there must be still more time. Also, then, time can never have had a beginning; for if you try to think of a point at which time began, you can only think of it as a point beyond which there must have been still more time. Do not say that endless time is unthinkable; you can very easily think endless

time, if you do not try to think of the end of it. You cannot *comprehend* endless time, for that means to contain it in your mind, or to go around it; but you can know what it is, and you can know that it is.

Time is; and we must use it, whether we will or no. And the use we make of present time decides the use we shall be able to make of future time; just as the use we made of past time has fixed our place in present time. The use we make of today decides the use we shall be able to make of tomorrow. To be strong and wise is to be able to use time well; and to use time well is to become continually stronger and wiser. Success, growth and development are only attained by the right use of time; and we are failures today in exact proportion as we have erred in our use of time past To know the right use of the present moment is therefore of immense importance; and to have the will to make the right use of it is more important still. If man can—and will—make the right use of every moment of time, he must certainly become a being of marvellous power and wholeness. Oh, the wasted time! The misspent time! The lost time!

We close this chapter, then, by claiming the demonstration of our first fact; that time is a reality.

REFLECTION

Wattles opens the series by saying that religion and medicine both seek the realities behind appearances. The sun seems to circle the earth but does not. A balloon rising and a stone falling look like two forces but are one. His first reality is time. Against writers who claim time is an illusion, he argues that it is real, endless and without beginning: clocks only measure it and do not make it. The practical point comes at the end. How we use each present moment shapes what we can do in the future, just as past choices placed us where we are. Few readers will need convincing that time is real, but his call to use it wisely is timeless.

PRACTICE

Tonight, look back over your day and mark one hour that was well used and one that drifted. Without judging yourself, choose one small change that would make tomorrow's drifting hour count.

KEY THOUGHT

The use we make of today decides the use we shall be able to make of tomorrow.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

II

Space

Can space have boundaries?

BEAR IN mind that in the first chapter we prove that time is an existent reality; in this chapter we shall try to prove that space also exists. Space is the place where a thing is; and it is also the place where no thing is. Space is the place where the earth is; the earth's diameter being about 7,925 miles, it fills so much space; if the earth were to disappear, the 7,925 miles of space would still exist, but it would then be empty space whereas now it is filled space. The sun, also, fills space, and the distance between the earth and the sun is space; beyond the sun is more space, and beyond the earth still more; and so on. It does not matter whether space is occupied or unoccupied; empty or filled; it is space, all the same. Space is a reality. Distance is a portion of space between two given points. Endless distance would comprise all of space in one direction.

Space has three dimensions: Length, breadth and thickness. It could never have a beginning, and can never have an ending. If all created things, and all substance should disappear, space would still exist; it would be merely blank, empty space, where now is filled space. Also, space can have no boundaries. If you try to think of a boundary to space, what will you think of as lying beyond the boundary? Something solid?

Then that something solid must itself occupy space, while if there is nothing there, that nothing must be unfilled space. So, beyond any boundary that you can set for space, there must be still more space. Space is a reality; beginningless, endless, boundless. Time is a reality; and yet, neither time nor space are substantial things. They possess no power. They do not act, neither can they be acted upon. Time can be used, and space can be occupied; and that is what we do with them; we occupy space and make use of time.

Space is the field in which we must operate, and contain the raw materials which we must use. The claim has been made that space is non-existent to mind or spirit, because it does not require appreciable time for the transference of thought; but the validity of this deduction has not been proved. The distances with which we are able to deal are very limited; it might require a measurable time to send thought to the sun, or to the planet Mars, or for a spirit to travel those distances. Again, the argument is advanced that the moon "acts" on the earth; and that, as a thing cannot act where it is not, there is no space between the moon and the earth; but this is puerile. The moon does not, and cannot act on the earth, because it does not touch the earth; if it affects the earth at all, it must act on something which is between them, and which in turn acts on the earth. And this something which is between the earth and the moon occupies space.

I have spoken of filled space and empty space. I do not know whether empty space exists or not, but it is quite thinkable that it should exist. There may be portions of empty space, surrounded by filled space; or there may be endless extensions of empty space, side by side with endless extensions of filled space; I do not know. I know that there is filled space, and that there may be empty space. But, if there is filled space, what fills it? The answer to this must be in one word—Substance. That which is not substance is not anything, and that which is not anything cannot fill space. Space is filled by substance, and cannot be filled by anything else; but what is substance, and how do we know that it exists? That we leave

for the next chapter, closing this with the claim that we have demonstrated that we live in space, and that life consists in making use of time.

✦

REFLECTION

The second reality is space. Wattles defines it as the place where a thing is, and also the place where no thing is. It has three dimensions and no beginning, end or boundary, since beyond any wall you imagine there must be more space. Like time, space has no power of its own: we occupy it, just as we use time. He rejects the claim that space does not exist for the mind, and he argues that the moon can affect the earth only through something between them. That leads to his next question: what fills space? His reasoning is that of a careful amateur philosopher, and modern physics describes space very differently. The chapter's real role is to lay a foundation step by step.

PRACTICE

Look around the room you are in. Notice the objects and the open space between them. Choose one cluttered corner and clear it, then notice how the cleared space changes the way the room feels and how you use it.

KEY THOUGHT

we occupy space and make use of time.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

III

Substance

Real nature of substance—A curious fact concerning the growth of vegetables—Does substance occupy all of space?—The three great realities.

SUBSTANCE is that which occupies space. In its more compact and rigid forms substance is perceptible by the senses, and is then called matter; but in its finer and more ethereal forms, when it cannot be perceived by the senses, substance is still matter, and is essentially the same. The apparently many substances of nature are in reality only varying forms of one Substance; the differences between them are due to varying degrees of pressure, and to the form and rate of vibration of the atoms which compose them. Ice is a solid substance; water a partially fluid substance; the vapor arising from water verges on the gaseous state; and oxygen and hydrogen are gases. But a piece of ice may be brought back through all these stages, and converted into oxygen and hydrogen, and no change is made in it except that in the fluid state the atoms are less firmly pressed together than in the solid state; and in the gaseous state the bond of cohesion is still weaker, and the atoms circulate or roll around each other more freely than in the fluid state. It is now a well-known fact that nearly all the growth of the vegetable kingdom comes from the atmosphere; trees, plants and flowers are solidified air. The furniture in our homes, and the walls of the houses in which we live are

merely solidified gases; burn them, and they return to their original state, leaving only a handful of ashes as "material" evidence of their existence, and if we learn to treat these ashes with the right agencies, they, too, will vanish into the ethereal realm. The earth itself, so firm and solid under our feet, was indisputably once a ball of flaming gases and vapors, and in the stage before that, must it not have been still more ethereal? It is all solidified atmosphere. Our own bodies are compounds of gases; in the crematory the human form vanishes. All things came out from the ether, and all things are ether, *changed* to more or less solid forms by differences in atomic pressure and cohesion.

All this brings us to the conclusion that the many seemingly different substances—iron, wood, coal, lime, water, etc., are merely different forms of one thing; that there is only one elemental substance, from which all created things are shaped. As we find that solid things are the gaseous atmosphere, solidified by an increased atomic pressure, so we shall no doubt find that the gases are produced from one ether, being brought to the semi fluid state by increased pressure, and at last we must conclude that there is one perfectly fluid substance, of which are made all the things which do appear. This One Substance is the stupendous reality behind all the appearances of the material world.

We will now take up the study of this substance. First, we must get rid of the idea that there is anything else. Substance is all there is. We live, and move, and have our being in substance; we, ourselves, are substance. We must conclude that substance cannot have been created, for that it should have been formed out of nothing is unthinkable. Substance always was; forms have been created, and are being continually created, changed, and modified; but the substance of which those forms are made is the same, yesterday and today and forever. When I speak of forms, I mean the so-called "material" universe; suns, stars, planets, seas, continents, trees, plants, gases, and the bodies of animals and men; all these are varying forms of the One Changeless Substance, which is all, and in all. And as this substance has existed through all of time past, so it

will exist through all of time future, for it is indestructible; we may change its forms, but not one particle of it can we destroy.

Does this substance occupy all of space? Evidently not, for the more nearly we carry its forms to their original state the more fluid they become; we go from solids back to gases, and from gases to ether, and so on; and we conclude that the one substance must be perfectly fluid, and if that be so, its particles cannot be solidly pressed together; there must be space between them, as in all fluids. Furthermore, if substance filled *all* space motion would be impossible; for substance can only move when there is unoccupied space to move into. And as we know that there is motion, so we know that there must be empty space. This is a matter of some importance when we come to the study of consciousness; for if one substance completely filled all space, it must be absolutely solid, with its atoms pressed rigidly against each other; and not only could there be no motion in any part, but there could be no separate consciousness in any part; if consciousness were possible at all in a perfectly solid substance, it could only be the consciousness of the whole. But if there is empty space, there is not only room for motion, but there is room for separate portions of substance, which may be conscious within themselves. If there is empty space, there is room for man, as a separate portion of original substance to move about and to have a consciousness of his own. There may be more than one conscious intelligence, though there is only one substance. We close this chapter with the claim that we have demonstrated the existence of three realities: time, space and a substance which moves in space. The next chapter will be devoted to the consideration of consciousness.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles now argues that everything we see is one Substance in different forms. Ice, water, vapor and gas are the same thing under different pressure. Trees are

largely made from the air, and our bodies are compounds of gases. Behind it all, he says, is one perfectly fluid original Substance that was never created and can never be destroyed. Since it is fluid, it does not fill all space, which leaves room for motion and for separate conscious beings such as ourselves. Some details, like the ether, belong to the science of 1909. The underlying picture, that the many things of the world share one source, is the backbone of all his later teaching.

PRACTICE

Take one everyday object, such as a cup, a chair or an apple, and trace its origins as far back as you can: materials, sunlight, soil, air. Write a few lines about what it means that ordinary things share common roots.

KEY THOUGHT

This One Substance is the stupendous reality behind all the appearances of the material world.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

IV

Consciousness

Explanation of consciousness.—Motion a kind of action.—What effect it has on consciousness—Brain and consciousness. Which the product of the other?—Consciousness in vegetable and mineral kingdoms limited while in man almost complete

THAT CONSCIOUSNESS exists does not need proof; we know, and we know that we know. We are conscious of consciousness; and now we have to consider the source of consciousness. Turning back to the realities we have considered, we find that time cannot be the source of consciousness; we cannot think of time as being conscious, and the same is true of space. We cannot conceive of consciousness as existing in empty space, for there would be nothing there to be conscious; and so we see that only substance can be conscious. Where there is no substance there is nothing, and there can be no consciousness. This is a proposition which you should consider well, until you have mastered it in all its bearings; that there can be no consciousness apart from substance; that empty space cannot be conscious. If consciousness exists —and it does—there is a Conscious Substance.

This point we need to develop very fully, for it is vital. If it is not substance which is conscious, then consciousness must exist in the interstices between the particles of substance, or in empty space; and it is

empty space which is conscious, which is unthinkable. But if consciousness exists in substance, then it is the substance itself which is conscious; for there can be nothing in substance but substance. It becomes clear, too, that consciousness cannot be the result of functional action within an organism. Functional action is merely motion, and motion is a shifting of substance from one place to another. If consciousness were produced by motion, would it not still be the substance which was conscious? Try to reason out how a substance could be made conscious by shifting it from one place to another. If consciousness was produced by the motion, then the substance could not have been conscious before it moved, nor could it remain conscious after it ceased to move. Try to think of a substance as becoming conscious, and endowed with reason, memory and love while making a certain motion, and as losing all these when ceasing to move; try to reason out how motion could come first as a cause, and consciousness follow as a result. Try to conceive of the Original Fluid Substance as beginning, unconsciously, to move; and as producing, unconsciously, all the orderly sequences of forms which appear in nature; and at last, and only at last, becoming fully conscious of it all through the unconscious beginning of a certain motion in the brain of man. Try to think of full consciousness as having been lacking in the universe until certain vibrations were started in the brain of man; you will find all this unthinkable. Consciousness is not the result of motion, but the first cause of motion. It is not motion which is conscious, but substance. The human ego is Conscious Substance.

The next question is whether consciousness is an attribute of substance only in certain forms, or whether it inheres in original fluid substance; and to that we now turn our attention. Is it the brain which is conscious? Those who have kept abreast of the revelations of modern psychology as set forth by William Hanna Thompson and others, know that it is not. The substance of the brain is not conscious; or at least, the substance of the brain is not *the* conscious, thinking, reasoning human

ego. We have learned that the brain is the product, rather than the producer of consciousness; and that the intelligent direction of consciousness in the work of brain-building may produce almost any desired change in the structure and capacity of the brain. Furthermore, there are many evidences which go to show that consciousness is not localized in, or confined to the brain, but extends throughout the body; and that we are conscious, not with our brains alone, but with our entire beings. If this should be proved true, and it is likely to be, we will have to conclude that the "physical" body of man is permeated and pervaded by a conscious substance which is co-extensive with it in every part, and which is the real man. And we must also conclude that this conscious substance is Original Substance, and in a condition approaching its primal state; for it becomes apparent as we go on that complete consciousness can only exist in Original Substance in its primal state. Changes in state and form appear to limit consciousness. The consciousness of the animal creation is limited by their forms, and is little, if any, more than sufficient for the reproduction of those forms; the consciousness of the tree and plant is still more limited, but scientists now generally admit that there is consciousness in the vegetable kingdom; and in the mineral world, consciousness appears as directivity of atoms, and chemical affinity. When we come to man, however, we find a capacity for growth in consciousness which seems to be unlimited; hence we argue that man is Original Substance in its primal state, or at least, that he may attain to the primal state.

Time is; space is. Space is occupied by conscious substance; and there is but one substance, from which are made all the forms of the visible creation. The physical body of man is a form of substance as prepared through the processes of the visible creation; man, himself, is original substance or spirit, inhabiting this physical body. "In the image of God created He them."

It will be seen that while all is God, it is also true that man is man, an independent entity, having a consciousness of his own, and that, while

all is spirit, matter exists, being spirit on a varying plane of atomic pressure; and that while it is true that mind is in all and through all, perfect consciousness exists only in original substance, in pure spirit, or in God; and that the nearest approach to complete consciousness is in man, whose unlimited capacity for growth proves him to be at least, a near approach to original substance; a son of God. We close this chapter with the assertion that time is; that space is, and that space is occupied by a conscious substance which moves. We will next consider the fourth reality: Motion.

✦

REFLECTION

The fourth step is consciousness. Only substance can be conscious, Wattles argues, since empty space holds nothing to be aware. Motion cannot create awareness, so consciousness must come first and cause motion, not the other way around. He believes the brain is shaped by consciousness rather than producing it, and that awareness fills the whole body. Plants and even minerals, he suggests, have some limited awareness, while human consciousness can grow without limit, which makes us "a son of God." Modern science and philosophy remain divided on how mind and brain relate, so readers can take this as one serious religious view among many. It is also an invitation to honor the depth of their own inner life.

PRACTICE

Sit quietly for three minutes and simply notice that you are aware: of sounds, sensations, thoughts. Then write one sentence about what it feels like to be conscious, and one way you would like your awareness to grow.

KEY THOUGHT

Consciousness is not the result of motion, but the first cause of motion.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

V

Motion

Motion defined—Do time and space move?—Time, space, force and attraction compared.—A logical analysis of "attraction" by using empty space as a basis.

I PRESUME no one will deny that motion is a reality; we know that we move, and we know that motion is going on all around us. The immensity of motion is staggering when we come to consider it; the motions of stars, suns, planets and satellites; of rivers, lakes and seas; of wind and clouds; of the circulation of sap and blood; of atomic vibration, and so on. Motion is the cause of light and heat; of sound, tone, color, electricity, magnetism. Differences in the shape and motion of atoms make bodies solid or gaseous, and differentiate the so-called "substances" from each other. It may be seen then that motion plays an all-important part in the work of creation; that motion is the work of creation in progress; and so the study of motion becomes very important indeed. What is motion?

That which moves is neither time nor space; it is not conceivable that either time or space should move. That which moves is substance. Motion, then, is a shifting of substance from place to place; or from one part of space to another part of space. And are there different kinds of motion? In a way, there are; and the difference depends upon the time

used in making the motion, and upon the direction in which the motion is made. That is, there are fast and slow motions; circular and linear motions; and those metaphysicians who contend that time and space do not exist should consider that if there is no time there is no such thing as fast and slow motion; and if there is no space there is no motion at all, for there is no place to move to. No more preposterous absurdity has appeared in modern thought than the denial of the existence of time and space. Motion, then, is the shifting of substance in space and time. And what causes motion?

To this you will be ready to answer "forces"; and after a little consideration you will see that that is no answer at all unless you tell what force is. What is force, and how does it cause substance to move? Force is not time; we cannot think of time as causing motion. Force is not space; we cannot think of space as causing motion. If force is substance and causes motion, then substance moves itself; and if force is not substance, then it is nothing, or empty space, and empty space cannot act on substance so as to cause it to move. It is all very well for scientists to write of atoms as being "electrons" or ultimate units of force; but these electrons are either substance or they are not; and if they are not substance they are nothing but empty space, and in that case there is no substance, no existence, no consciousness, no anything. Either force is substance, or it is something in substance; and if it is something in substance which is not substance, what is it? And how can that which has no substance act on substance so as to cause motion? Force is not motion, for it is the cause of motion and the effect cannot be its own cause. Let me now try to give you a definition of force.

Force is pressure of substance against substance. Try to exert force upon anything in any other way than by pressing substance against it; can you do it? Try to cause a body to move in any other way than by pressing something against it; can you do it? Try to conceive of force as being exerted upon any body without pressing anything against it; try to conceive of force as crossing a complete vacuum where is no substance of

any kind. Force is pressure of substance; that it can be anything else is not thinkable. And this brings us to the consideration of what is loosely spoken of as "attraction." It is stated that all solid bodies "attract" each other, and that every body in the universe attracts every other body; but those who make these assertions do not tell us how the attraction is accomplished. If bodies "attract" each other, then they exert force upon each other; and if they exert force upon each other they must cause pressure upon each other; for how can a body exert force upon another except by causing pressure upon it? If "attraction" is an unsubstantial thing, then it cannot affect substance, or cause motion; if it is an unsubstantial thing, then it is empty space; for where there is no substance there is only empty space. Can you think of an "attraction" crossing an empty space? What would it be like, and how would it get across? Can you think of a "vibration" as crossing an empty space? How would it be transmitted where there was nothing to vibrate? Can you think of a force as crossing an empty space? What would be the shape, size and general appearance of a force apart from substance? By considering all these points we see that what we know as force is simply pressure of substance; or, one portion of substance pressing against another portion of substance; and that force can be nothing else than this. And we see that pressure causes motion, and that motion, in turn, causes pressure; so that force and motion are mutually convertible, each into the other. Also, we see that there is only one force, the pressure of substance; and that all the so-called "forces" of nature are merely different rates and modes of motion, and have their origin in the One Force—pressure of substance. Furthermore, we see that there is no such thing as a universal attraction which bodies exert upon each other, but that there is a universal pressure, impelling all bodies toward each other in a definite and orderly way; and to the study of this universal pressure we will next turn our attention. Time, space, substance and motion exist. Substance is conscious. Motion is caused by pressure of substance

against substance, and the varying forms of substance in the visible creation are caused by differences in motion.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles turns to motion, which is everywhere, from planets to atoms, and which he calls "the work of creation in progress." Motion is substance shifting through space and time, so he finds it absurd to deny that time and space exist. Then he asks what causes motion. Force, he argues, can only be the pressure of substance against substance. Nothing can push across a true emptiness, so "attraction" between distant bodies must really be a universal pressure. Physicists today explain gravity and other forces in quite different terms, so this is best read as part of his philosophical system. The chapter shows his habit of following an argument patiently, testing each idea against what he can clearly think.

PRACTICE

Choose one change you want to see in your life. Ask Wattles' question about it: what force, what steady pressure, would actually move it? Write down one small, regular action that could supply that push.

KEY THOUGHT

Motion, then, is the shifting of substance in space and time.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VI

The Beginning of Motion

Origin of motion—An exposition of force and motion founded on the theory of space being occupied by a fluid conscious substance—Has motion ever a beginning?—Will and will-pressure on motion—Will of god the one compelling power

To understand force and motion, we must go back to a supposititious creation. Conceive, first, of space as being occupied by completely conscious substance in a perfectly fluid state; conscious throughout, alike throughout, and without motion. Now, can you conceive of motion as beginning in any part of this substance without an act of will? Can you think of your conscious self as beginning to act, and as continuing to act in an orderly and consecutive series of motions without an effort of will? If, as we have seen, original substance is completely conscious, then its every motion must be a conscious motion; and we cannot think of conscious motion without will. You are aware that you can consciously originate motion yourself; but you cannot do it without will. You are conscious substance; you can be nothing else as we have seen, and you can move or cease to move by an exertion of your will, and in moving or ceasing to move you cause the body you inhabit to move or cease to move. We see motion beginning and ceasing all around us; and we conclude that every motion had a

beginning; and that the beginning of the series of creative motions which have resulted in the present universe of forms could only have been in an action of the will of Original Conscious Substance.

In the beginning, then, by an act of will, parts of substance were made to press against each other; and this pressure must pack the substance together, making it more dense, more rigid, and less fluid. This pressure, also, must originate the motions we know as light, heat, electricity and magnetism; and this will-pressure, drawing substance together and holding it in coherent masses, is what we call gravity. It is this will-pressure which brings an apple to the earth, and which holds the earth itself in its orbit; which tends to bring all the heavenly bodies together, and which yet holds them apart forever, keeping each in its own place. There is no accounting for "attraction" on other grounds than that it is the Creative Will of Original Substance, pressing itself together into forms. Every phenomenon of force or motion, from the circling sweep of a planet to the vibration of an atom, has its origin in the will of the great Intelligent Substance to which, or to whom, men have given the name of God. The earth is held together solely by the pressure of the will which permeates it; were that will relaxed, the earth would return instantly to its original fluid condition. Try to think of substance as being held together by something else than will; try to think of substance, originally fluid, as being pressed into solid shapes and held in solid shapes, and going on in orderly and consecutive motions without will; and you will find it unthinkable. The earth is a part of Conscious Being, holding itself in form by the exercise of the will which is in all substance; gravity is the will exerted by substance in pressing itself into form; so also is chemical affinity, or the directivity of atoms. All motion originates in will-pressure. Trace back the motion of the wheels to the engine and thence to the coal; and you say that the latent heat-energy of the coal is causing motion. But what lodged the heat-energy in the coal? Was it the will-pressure of gravity, in the distant ages? There is only one force, and that is the will of the Great Intelligence; the eternal creative

pressure, moving substance into the various forms in which it appears to us.

In the beginning was God, Spirit, Conscious Substance, occupying the calm deeps of space. An act of will, and there was sufficient pressure to produce the particles of the luminiferous ether, whose vibrations produce light; and there was light. A further act of will, increasing pressing of substance together, and nebulous clouds appear; and by the Great Will these were pressed into spheres with all the accompanying phenomena of the motions of heat and electricity; and so the creation of forms went, on until the visible universe appeared as it is; formed of one substance, by the Will of God, and maintained and held together by the continued exercise of that Great Will.

The question of motive comes in just here. We cannot conceive of continuous, orderly and systematic action without a motive; and the question must come to our minds, what is the motive of the Great One in His work? With a little reflection, the answer must present itself. He is seeking happiness. We cannot conceive of a conscious being as continuously seeking pain, inharmony or misery. Conscious action can have but one motive, and that motive is ultimate harmony or happiness. The purpose of God in the creation can be nothing else than His own happiness, and since he is All and in All. His happiness can only be attained in the happiness of all. Remember that the purpose of the creation is the happiness of all, including yourself, and that to be unhappy is to oppose the will of the Great Intelligence.

Look now upon the immensity of the visible universe, and contemplate the power of the Creator; see that in all and through all, from the rolling on a planetary system to the rising of the sap in a blade of grass, the one impelling power is the Will of God. And this Great Intelligence is seeking pleasure and happiness in us, and through us. Shall we doubt, then, that He can and will heal our diseases, give us every good thing that we need, and guide us into all truth? In the next chapter, we shall consider man's relation to this Great Intelligence.

REFLECTION

Here the argument reaches God. Imagine space filled with perfectly fluid, fully conscious Substance at rest. Motion could only begin, Wattles says, by an act of will, just as your own movements begin with your will. That will pressed substance together, creating light, heat and the forms of the universe, and it still holds everything in shape. Gravity itself is this "will-pressure." He then asks what motive could guide such a will, and answers: happiness, which for a God who is in all can only mean the happiness of all. This is an old theme, creation as an expression of divine joy, told in the language of 1909 physics. It is a picture of the universe as fundamentally friendly.

PRACTICE

Write down three small things today that brought you real happiness. Next to each, note whether it also brought happiness to someone else. Reflect on Wattles' idea that true happiness is shared.

KEY THOUGHT

The purpose of God in the creation can be nothing else than His own happiness

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VII

Man and His Powers

What makes you man—The conscience of the all-wise—Health the highest good—Abundance secondary-live in constant and conscious contact with the great independent substance and be ideal!

THE UNIVERSE is a Great Being, who is seeking happiness in and through the forms which he creates from his own substance; and of all these forms, man alone has power to enter into intelligent relations with the Creator. To state it in other words, the great intelligence is seeking happiness in you, and you have power to co-operate intelligently with him in the search. That is what makes you man; the power to work with God in the search for happiness. And if this Great One seeks your happiness, it must be your most permanent and perfect happiness; that is, your highest good; for being conscious of all that there is to be conscious of, and knowing all that there is to know, he is all-wise; and we cannot think of the all-wise as seeking anything less than the highest good, or as being satisfied with anything less than the highest good.

As far as your physical body is concerned, the highest good that can come to you is unquestionably perfect health. The notion that there are circumstances under which pain and sickness are better for man than perfect health must take its place among those superstitious beliefs which have been exploded and discredited. Pain and sickness may be

good for man if he takes them rightly, but perfect health is always far better if he takes that rightly; and it is a self-evident proposition that God can find complete delight in man only as man is completely whole. The Great Intelligence, then, seeks perfect health and wholeness in you; and the substance of the Living One, filled with life and power, presses upon you on every side, seeking to impart life and power to you, but you being a portion of that great intelligence, are supreme within your own personality, and so you will have health or not as you receive and recognize this health of God, If you fail to recognize and receive the All-health, and if you recognize disease within yourself, you prevent God from reaching you; and you form within yourself that which you recognize as existing. If you continuously recognize the perfect health of the Intelligent Substance, in which you live and move and are, and of which you are a part, you cannot be otherwise than well.

It is another self-evident truth that man's highest good demands that he should have the use of all the things he is capable of using in order to live all the life he is capable of living. Man's highest good, and his real happiness can be attained only when he has abundance for every physical and mental need. Just as it is true that God cannot fully delight in you if you are physically sick, so it is true that he cannot find happiness through you if you are mentally or physically starved, or lacking the essentials for life, growth and enjoyment. Happiness consists in living fully; and God can live fully in you only when you have everything to live with. So, the desire of the Great One for you must be that you shall have abundance.

But here again you are supreme within yourself. What if God presses abundance upon you, and you persist in recognizing only privation and poverty? If that be the case, you will remain poor in the midst of abundance, as millions of people are doing; and to be poor, or in want is to oppose the will of God, who seeks happiness in all, and for all. We are parts of himself, and what can he do when his will is opposed and his bounty rejected by a part of himself?

The solution of man's problems of health, wealth, and growth can be reached when man unifies himself with God, the Great Intelligent Spirit, Substance, who seeks life and happiness in man; and man can unify himself with God only by constantly recognizing God; by considering and acknowledging God, and by looking to God in prayer. The prayer of faith is really an affirmation; and an affirmation is the recognition of an existing fact. When you live in constant and conscious contact with the great intelligent substance you can have no sickness; and his desire for happiness in you will cause the exertion of that mighty will-pressure to bring to you all the things that make for your highest good. The man who can completely unify himself with the divine substance becomes a center toward which the divine will impels every desirable thing; and that man will not, and cannot, lack for anything.

The universe is a Great Being; an intelligent substance, occupying space and using time. His desire leads Him to create forms from His own substance, and in these forms He seeks happiness. Man has but to unify himself with this Great Being to secure the supply of every need, and the gratification of every desire. Man only needs to learn how to pray and how to work.



REFLECTION

The series ends with its practical point. Wattles says that the universe is a Great Being seeking happiness, and that human beings alone can cooperate with it knowingly. Its desire for us is our highest good, which he names as perfect health and abundance for every need. We receive these by recognizing God through prayer and affirmation. He goes so far as to say that recognizing disease helps form it. That is a historical belief and not medical advice: illness is never the sick person's fault, and medical care remains essential. Faith and a hopeful outlook may support wellbeing, but they cannot replace a doctor. His closing line, that we need to learn "how to pray and how to work," offers balance.

PRACTICE

Write a short statement of what your "highest good" would look like in health, relationships and work. Then list one thing to pray or reflect on and one practical step, such as booking an overdue checkup, to take this week.

KEY THOUGHT

Man only needs to learn how to pray and how to work.

MY OWN NOTES

A New Christ

EIGHT CHAPTERS

About This Work

A New Christ is Wattles' extended study of the life and teaching of Jesus, usually dated to around 1910, shortly before his death. The text calls itself "this series" and later "this little book," and it reads like a set of connected essays: first a portrait of Jesus as a person, then his attitude toward the society of his day, his teachings about human worth and about wealth, the story of the early church, and finally a spiritual method for reaching what Wattles calls "cosmic consciousness."

Two strands of Wattles' thought meet here. One is Christian socialism: the conviction, shared by a number of American reformers of his era, that the Kingdom of God Jesus preached was meant to reshape social and economic life, not only the inner life. The other is New Thought: the belief that one divine Mind lives in everyone and that steady affirmation can bring health, power and abundance. Readers who know *The Science of Getting Rich* will recognize the second half; readers who know his 1905 Cincinnati lecture on Jesus will recognize much of the first.

How to read it today: Wattles writes as an advocate, not as a neutral historian. His readings of Scripture are bold and personal, and many Christians, scholars and socialists would disagree with parts of them. These notes explain his views without endorsing or attacking any faith or political position, so you can test his arguments against your own tradition and reading.

Some passages are very much of their time. In one story Wattles quotes a man using "Huniaks," a slur then aimed at immigrant mine and mill workers from Central and Eastern Europe. Wattles repeats it to condemn the contempt behind it, but the word is offensive. Phrases such as "mongrel multitude," and his sharp picture of the Pharisees, also reflect period language and polemic; modern scholarship paints a far more varied picture of Jewish life in Jesus' time.

The final chapters teach affirmations for health and wealth and claim they can cure "every sickness." Please read these as historical spiritual writing, not as medical or financial advice. Illness and poverty are never a person's fault, no affirmation replaces a doctor, and no book can guarantee wealth.

CHAPTER

I

His Personality

THIS SERIES will not be an attempt to prove something about Christ; it will be an effort to ascertain by scientific study, what He was, how He lived, and what He taught. Too many people have studied Jesus from the standpoint of some preconceived notion of Him or His mission, such an attitude always leads to erroneous conclusions.

The common concept of Christ was given to the church by the priests of the dark ages, at a time when a religious ideal was wanted which should induce men to be content with slavery, and to bow their necks to every kind of wrong and oppression; and this concept was drawn almost wholly from the poetry of Isaiah; the Christ of the churches is the Christ of Isaiah, and our ideas of Him are not drawn at all from an impartial study of the history of His life.

Such passages in the prophecies as; "He is despised and rejected of men; a man of sorrows and acquainted with grief; and we hid, as it were, our faces from him; he is brought as a lamb to the slaughter, and as a sheep before her shearers is dumb, so he opened not his mouth," have been quoted to show His character, and the meekness and humbly submissive spirit with which He endured wrong and injustice; and we have had held up as the ideal man a despised, friendless, poverty-stricken laborer whom the upper classes regarded with scorn because of his lowly

origin and station; who had no friends save fishermen, laborers, outcasts and sinners; who was often shirtless and hungry, and who bore insults and persecutions with meek submission, and walked about in a scornful world with his hands always uplifted in loving benediction.

This character has too long been offered as the Christian ideal; Be meek, Be submissive, Be lamb-like or sheep-like. Bow your head before the persecutor, and offer your back to the shearer. Rejoice when you are fleeced; it is for the glory of God. It is a good religion for the man with the shears.

The Christ who was held up in the old fashioned orthodox pulpit is a weak character. He is not the kind of a man we would nominate for president, and his followers have very little faith in him as an organizer.

No railroad magnate of today would make him foreman of a section; and if it were broadcast over the country tonight that the president of the United States had resigned and that Jesus would be inaugurated tomorrow, 95 percent of the Christians there would draw their money out of the banks for fear Jesus might start a panic.

What we propose to do now is to ascertain by a study of the four gospels in the light of history whether this is the real Christ; and if not, to find what the real Christ was like.

The Real Jesus Christ

In the first place, then, Jesus could not have been despised because He was a carpenter, or the reputed son of a carpenter. Custom required every Jewish Rabbi or teacher to have a trade. We read in the Talmud of Rabbi Johanan, the blacksmith, and of Rabbi Isaac, the shoemaker, learned and highly honored men. Rabbi Jesus, the carpenter, would be spoken of in the same way. St. Paul, a very learned man, was a tent-maker by trade.

At that time, and among that people, Jesus could not have been despised for His birth and station.

And He was popularly supposed to be of royal blood, being saluted as the son of David; His lineage was well known. The people who cried "Hosannah to the son of David" knew that He was an aristocrat of the aristocrats; a prince of the royal house. He was not "lowly" in birth, nor was He supposed to be so. On this point I refer you to Matthew 9:27; Matthew 15:22; Matthew 20:30; Matthew 21:9; Mark 10:47.

He Was Educated

Second, He could not have been despised for His ignorance, for He was a very learned man. Whenever He went into a synagogue He was selected to read the law and teach the congregation, as the one best qualified for that work. Luke says; "There went a fame of Him through all the region round about, and He taught in their synagogues, being glorified of all." In those times of fierce religious disputation, no unlearned man could have held his own in such fashion. He must have been letter-perfect in the books of the Jewish law, for He was always able to rout His adversaries by making apt quotations from their own books. Even His enemies always addressed Him as Master, or Teacher, acknowledging His profound learning. On this point, read Matthew 13:54; Mark 12:24-34; Luke 4:14-15; John 7:19-23; John 10:34.

Jesus Had Plenty

Third, He was not despised for His poverty, for He had many wealthy and influential friends, and knew no lack of anything. Lazarus and his sisters, whose home was always open to Him, were people of consequence; for we are told that "many of the Jews" came to comfort the sisters when Lazarus died.

Luke says that Joanna, the wife of Chuza, the king's steward, and other women "ministered unto him of their substance"; that is, they were supporters of His work.

The king's steward was a high official, and his wife would be a prominent lady.

Joseph of Arimathea, who came to get the body of Jesus, was a well-to-do man. So, probably was Nicodemus.

Jesus healed the sick in the families of rulers and high officials, and they appear to have responded liberally in supplying His financial needs.

True, He held no property and bought no real estate; but He dressed expensively, lived well and never lacked for money. When He was crucified the soldiers cast lots for His clothing because it was too fine to cut up, as they would have done with the garments of an ordinary man; and on the night of His betrayal, when Judas went out, it was supposed by the others that he had gone to give something to the poor. It must have been their custom to give away money, or how could such a supposition have arisen?

In that country and climate, the wants of Jesus and His disciples were few and simple, and they seem to have been fully supplied. He wore fine clothes, had plenty to eat and drink, and had money to give away. Read Luke 8:1-3; Luke 5:33; Luke 23:50; John 11:19; John 12:2; John 19:23.

Jesus Was Not Humble

Fourth, Jesus was not humble, in the commonly accepted meaning of the word. He was a man of the most impressive, commanding and powerful personal appearance. He "spoke as one having authority" and "his word was with power."

Frequently, we are told, great fear and awe fell upon the people at His mighty words and works. In one place they were so frightened that they besought Him to leave; and John tells how certain officers sent to arrest Him in the market place lost their nerve in His commanding presence, and went back, saying "Surely, never man spake like this man."

On the night of His arrest a band of soldiers approached Him in the grove and asked for Jesus of Nazareth; and when He answered "I am he,"

such was His majesty and psychic power that they prostrated themselves; "they went backward," the account says, "and fell to the ground" (John 18:6).

To be like the Christ of the four Gospels, one must be learned, well dressed, well supplied with money, and of noble and commanding appearance, speaking with authority, and having tremendous magnetic power. And now, what was His attitude toward His fellow men?

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles opens by challenging the picture of Jesus he heard from pulpits: a meek, poor, friendless sufferer modeled on Isaiah's "man of sorrows." He argues that this image suited those who wanted people to accept oppression quietly. Reading the Gospels, he finds a different man: a trained teacher (rabbis commonly had trades), hailed as a son of David, supported by well-off friends, dressed well enough that soldiers gambled for his clothing, and carrying such presence that crowds were awed. You don't have to accept every detail of his reading, and many believers rightly cherish Jesus' humility. But his core question is useful: are we holding up an ideal that makes us passive in the face of wrong? Strength and goodness, he suggests, belong together.

PRACTICE

Write down three qualities you were taught a "good person" should have. For each, ask: does this help me act well, or mainly keep me quiet when something is unfair? Keep one as it is, and rephrase one in a stronger, healthier way.

KEY THOUGHT

It is a good religion for the man with the shears.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

II

His Attitude

ONE OF the very best ways to reach an understanding of Jesus is by studying His reasons for taking the title He assumed—the Son of Man. He rarely spoke of Himself in any other way. This term, Son of Man, was common in the Jewish prophecies, and in the current conversation of the times, and it was simply an emphatic way of saying "Man." If you wished to emphasize your fealty to democracy, you might say "I am a son of Thomas Jefferson"; and if you wished to emphasize your fealty to humanity, you would say as Jesus did. "I am a son of man."

The World Jesus Lived In

The Roman empire was a great taxing machine. In its conquered provinces, the people were left, as far as possible, with their own local government and institutions of justice, the function of the Roman officials being to extort tribute, or collect taxes. Every form of extortion and oppression was practiced by the governors, procurators and tax collectors upon those who had property. Open robbery, torture, kidnapping, false accusation and imprisonment might be visited upon the man who had money to tempt the cupidity of the higher powers; and as the oppressed property owners had no way of meeting the

exactions of the government but by exploiting the poor, the condition of the masses was pitiful indeed.

You will readily see that the business, and property-owning class had to get the money to pay their taxes by exploiting the multitude in some way. It is an economic axiom which is indisputable that all taxation of whatever kind, upon whomsoever levied, must at last be wrung from the hard hands of the producers; no one, however, seems to comprehend this fact as little as the producers themselves. They strenuously reject all offers of deliverance, and generally kill those who try to help them.

Jesus received His only real and permanent following from among the middle class, as we shall see, and was crucified by the workers, whom He was trying to deliver from oppression. It was no middle class mob which demanded the liberation of Barabbas and howled for the blood of Christ.

To give you an idea as to how oppressive the Roman taxation was, we may estimate from certain passages in Josephus that the private income of Herod the Great was three and one-half millions of dollars a year. That is vastly less, of course, than the income of our John D. Rockefeller; but our Herods have a much larger, richer, and more populous country to levy taxes on, and they have discovered methods of extortion which lay the crude ways of the monarchs of antiquity very far in the shade. The enormous sums which were collected from the little province of Galilee brought the unhappy workers down to the last extremity of destitution; they could go no lower and live.

The Sects of Jesus' Day

In Judea at this time were several religious sects, which were also, in a way, political parties, scheming for prestige and power, and for influence with Rome. The Pharisees, Sadducees, Essenes, Samaritans, etc., disagreed upon various questions, as the existence or non-existence of angels, the resurrection of the dead, baptism, and so on. The strife

between these parties was desperately acrimonious and bitter, often to the point of open violence. You will notice as you read that they were always ready to "take up stones" to end a dispute; riots were of daily occurrence in the streets of Jerusalem, and only the psychic power and commanding personality of Jesus saved Him from being stoned by these religious mobs. Read Luke 4:28-30; Luke 20:6; John 8:59.

The leaders of these sects were, of course, of the middle, or property-owning class; but the rank and file were the common masses, sunk in the most abject poverty—taxed, beaten, robbed, outraged, slaughtered, with no voice lifted anywhere in their behalf. No one, Jew or Gentile, thought for a moment of demanding justice for the mongrel multitude.

It is said of Jesus that He "had compassion on the multitude, because they fainted, and were amazed, and were like sheep without a shepherd" (Matthew 9:36). They had then, as now, plenty of shepherds to baptize them, to interpret prophecy for them, to instruct them in "spiritual" things; but none to demand a lightening of their burdens—none to cry out, in their behalf, for justice.

The principal care of the shepherds was that the flock should be so doctrinally correct that they would never, never consent to be sheared by the opposing party.

The New Thought of Jesus' Time

Into this maze of oppression, taxation, murder, outrage and theological discussion comes the grand, strong figure of this young prince and scholar, saying; "The Spirit of the Lord is upon me, for he hath anointed me to preach good news to the poor. I am no Pharisee; I am no Sadducee, Essene, or Samaritan; I am a man. I come, not in behalf of Pharisaism or Samaritanism, but in behalf of humanity."

Here was an altogether different religious attitude; He had no "ism" to build up; His only creed was justice, His only doctrine the square deal. No wonder they were "amazed at his doctrine."

No wonder His "word was with power."

No wonder they said, "he speaketh as one having authority." Jesus said of Himself that the father had given Him authority to execute Judgment because He was man (John 5:27). That is the only reason God could possibly have for giving authority to any man; if there is a man anywhere today upon whom the divine sanction rests, it is not because he is a Pharisee, a Methodist, Presbyterian, Republican or Democrat, but because he is a MAN.

And it is further true that amongst all those who claim leadership by virtue of divine authority we may apply this test with certainty—that the man who stands for humanity, first, last and all the time, against all vested interests, religious and economic, is the man who stands as Jesus stood.

The man who stands for humanity against the vested religious interests of his time frequently is called an infidel; and the man who stands for the propertyless against the vested political and economic interests of his time is called a traitor. Jesus was crucified on the charges of infidelity and treason, and He was guilty on both counts.

Let no one be too horrified here to proceed further; for there are no prouder titles when justly held than the terms Infidel and Traitor. It was a grand saying of Wendell Phillips; *"Write upon my grave. Infidel-Traitor; infidel to every church that compromises with wrong; traitor to every government that oppresses the poor."*

The most sinful infidelity is not being unfaithful to some church, but being unfaithful to the truth; and the vilest treason is not turning against some government, but turning against the weak and helpless. This was the attitude which Jesus took; He gave expression to all this when He took the title which made Him the champion of humanity—when He said, "I am the Son of Man."

We will now take up the consideration of His teachings.

REFLECTION

Here Wattles explains why Jesus called himself "the Son of Man": in his reading it simply meant "a man," a way of standing for humanity rather than for any party or sect. He sketches the Roman province as a "taxing machine" that squeezed property owners, who in turn squeezed the poor, while rival religious groups argued about doctrine. Into this, he says, Jesus came with no "ism" to promote, only justice. Wattles admires Wendell Phillips' phrase "Infidel-Traitor" for anyone who refuses to side with oppression. His portrayal of the Pharisees and of the crowds is a period polemic, and historians today would add nuance. The lasting challenge is simple: in our loyalties to churches, parties and causes, do we still put people first?

PRACTICE

List the groups you belong to: faith, party, team, profession. Recall one recent moment when loyalty to a group pulled against fairness to a person. What would "standing for humanity" have looked like then? Write two honest sentences about it.

KEY THOUGHT

He had no "ism" to build up; His only creed
was justice, His only doctrine the square deal.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

III

His Teachings About Man

IF JESUS was a Savior, He came to save mankind, collectively and individually, from sin, from Error; for there is nothing but error to be saved from. That is what He says of Himself, in John 18:37; "To this end was I born, and for this cause came I into the world, that I should *bear witness to the truth.*"

A lost world is a world which has lost the truth about life; and a lost man or woman is simply one who has lost the truth about life; and there is no other way under heaven to save the lost but by telling them the truth about life.

This simple sentence in which He concisely states His mission lets in a flood of light upon His theory of life; He came to save from sin, disease and poverty by telling the truth. Then sin, disease and poverty are untruths; that is, they are wrong ways of living. We will consider first His broader and more generic application of truth, and later, His application of it to the individual.

In the sermon on the mount, He says (Matthew 5:21-22); "Ye have heard that it was said by them of old time, thou shalt not kill; and whosoever shall kill shall be in danger of the judgment; but I say unto you, that whosoever is angry with his brother without a cause shall be in danger of the judgment; and whosoever shall say to his brother Raca,

shall be in danger of the council; but whosoever shall say Thou fool, shall be in danger of hell fire." The phrase, "thou fool," as we understand it now, does not give the meaning of the original at all; it would be better rendered by some such phrase as "you are of no value" or "you are good for nothing."

I can make His meaning clear, I think, by an illustration. I was sitting in a hotel lobby, once, when the news came of a coalmine horror in which a number of poor fellows lost their lives. Two well-dressed men near me were discussing the affair, and one said; "Oh, well, it's only a couple of Huniaks less. A million more are ready to step into their shoes tomorrow; the world hasn't lost anything."

Jesus says whosoever shall speak of a man as that man spoke, is in danger of hell fire. That man, and those who think and speak as he does, are the real murderers of all who die in mine and mill and under rolling wheels; they make the slaughter possible by cheapening the estimate that is put on the value of a human life. Whosoever talks of "cheap" people, and of "lower" classes, and insists that some are especially valuable to God, and that others are their "inferiors," will go to hell, said Jesus; and I think He was right.

A little farther on in His life, we shall see how He proved it, and on what great natural fact He based His assertion. I have given you the exact meaning of the quoted passage, and the only meaning which may legitimately be drawn from it.

Turn now to the 12th chapter of Matthew and read the first eight verses.

The Sabbath

There you find that the disciples were crossing the fields on the Sabbath day, and that they plucked the ears of corn, and ate as they went. This gave great offence to the Pharisees. They were not offended because they took the grain, for, under the Jewish law, the right of the hungry

wayfarer to life transcended the property rights of the owner of the field; none might say the famished man nay, if he chose to pluck and eat. It was not to a theft of grain that the Pharisees objected, but to the fact that the plucking and eating were done on the Sabbath day. The Pharisees believed that the one thing most valuable to God was their church with its institutions and observances. They would not break the Sabbath to feed a hungry man, or to heal a sick man, because they thought the Sabbath was more valuable to God than the man.

And so they complained to Jesus, and He answered them, "Have ye not heard what David did, when he was hungry; he and they that were with him?" and He went on to tell them from their own scriptures, in which, as I have said, He was letter-perfect, how David and his followers went into the temple and took the sacred shew bread and ate it—and God approved. "One standeth here," said Jesus, "greater than the temple."

"The (son of) man is lord of the Sabbath day." That is, God cares more for a hungry man than He does for a holy day or house. In the second chapter of Mark, where the same story is told, He adds, "The Sabbath was made for man, and not man for the Sabbath."

Organizations

Here is brought out and sharply defined the issue between Jesus and His opponents. They were exalting the temple, the worship, the Sabbath, the ceremonial; He exalted the man. They declared that God was working through humanity to build systems and institutions; He declared that God was working through systems and institutions to build humanity. And I, for one, agree with Jesus. I feel no reverence for buildings; even though they are magnificent structures, where the dim light falls through stained glass windows upon the sculptured forms of saints and angels, where robed priests chant in solemn cadence; these things move me little.

But when I stand in a schoolroom and look into the bright faces of a hundred, boys and girls—when I stand in the crowded marketplace, or in a mill or factory where my brothers and sisters toil to supply the needs of the world, and I remember that every soul before me contains possibilities as boundless as the universe itself; when I stand in the presence of this toiling, seeking, loving, suffering, glorious, common humanity, I bare my head and bow in reverence, for here, indeed, I am in the presence of Almighty God. One is here greater than the temple, greater than the Sabbath, greater than the system, greater than the institution, greater than the Church or State.

God has a higher call for man than the keeping of certain days and places holy. This whole earth is a holy place, because it is consecrated by the love of God to fulfill His purpose in unfolding the high destiny of man.

Little Children

In the 18th chapter of Matthew you will read how Jesus took a little child and set him in the midst, of them, and said; "Whosoever shall humble himself as this little child, the same shall be greatest in the kingdom of heaven"; and He went on to assert that whatsoever should offend the child had better be cast into the sea.

You will get a good idea of the prevailing misconception concerning Jesus and His times if you study the pictures you commonly see of the scene where He blessed the little children. He is always shown to us surrounded by prettily dressed women, who are bringing nice clean babies for Him to love and bless; and it looks very easy for one to humble himself as one of those.

But turn back to our description of the condition of the masses in His day, and you will get a different idea. That was a slave child that He set in the midst of them; unwashed, uncombed, covered with vermin

and noisome sores repulsive to every sense; a child of the abyss, in the darkest period of the world's history.

And what could He mean by telling us to humble ourselves as such a child? Is it that we should be childlike in spirit, teachable, credulous? No; there is only one way. Stand beside that child of the gutter, and say; *"Before God he is as good as I. He is entitled to everything that I claim for myself and for my children, and I will not rest until all that I demand for my own is his also."* Then you will have humbled yourself as the little child by acknowledging his equality with you, and then you will begin to be great in the kingdom of heaven.

"Whosoever shall offend one of these little (slaves?) ones, it is better that a millstone shall be hanged about his neck, and he were cast into the sea." Yes, any man, or woman, or railroad system, or financial system, or industrial order or disorder that stands between the poor man's child and life, is under the curse of God. It is better that all the corn crops of a thousand years be lost, than that the least injustice shall be done to one such little child. That is what Jesus taught; and it is not to be wondered at that He was crucified.

✦

REFLECTION

This chapter is about human worth. Wattles reads Jesus' warning against calling someone "fool" as a warning against calling anyone worthless. He tells of overhearing a man dismiss dead miners with an ethnic slur, as if they were easily replaced, and says such contempt is what makes cruelty possible. The Sabbath story shows the same principle: institutions exist for people, not people for institutions. The child Jesus set among the disciples, Wattles insists, was probably a poor, neglected child. To "humble yourself" like that child means to declare that child your equal and to keep working until they have what your own children have. It is a demanding and generous idea of dignity, and it leaves no room for ranking people as "cheap" or "lower."

PRACTICE

Today, notice any phrase you hear or use that ranks people as "cheap," "low," or "less than," whether in conversation, the news or online. Each time, quietly restate it in words that honor the person's worth. Count how often it happens.

KEY THOUGHT

This whole earth is a holy place, because it is consecrated by the love of God to fulfill His purpose in unfolding the high destiny of man.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

IV

His Teachings About Wealth

ONE DAY Jesus was teaching the people, and He said, in substance; "Why are you worried about things to eat, and to wear". Look at the birds; they have not a fraction of your intelligence; they do not know enough to sow, or reap, or gather provision for the future; and yet they have no famine. You, with your great intelligence, surely ought to be able to live with more ease and safety than the lower orders of life; yet the only fear and anxiety are to be found among men. Seek the kind of kingdom your Father wants; a perfectly righteous order of things, and you will have plenty of everything."

This is a rather free translation of Matthew 6:25-34, but it is a very accurate rendering of the meaning of the original; much more accurate than that given by the King James version.

And I wish here to give you a word of caution. I frequently receive letters from people who lay great stress on the interpretation of some particular passage from the New Testament, and even on that of some single word; as if the letter of it was a perfect and infallible guide. Now, remember that Jesus taught and spoke in the Aramaic, a dialect which had entirely supplanted the Hebrew among the Jews of Palestine, and that His sayings, in that language, were held in memory about seventy years before they appeared in the Greek, written in the manuscripts of

the gospels; and that from the Greek they were translated into the English of 500 years ago, in our King James version. Five hundred years ago many words in our language carried meanings which are lost now; and so you will see how foolish it is to pin so much faith on single detached sayings and passages, which may not at all convey the meaning He gave to them. We never can understand him until we study his teachings as a connected whole.

Wealth for All

On the face of things it would look as if He told the truth when He said that there was no need for worry. There is no lack of the things needed, and where there is no lack there is no necessity for worry. This world would produce food, under intensive cultivation, for more than ten times its present population. It would produce the fabrics wherewith to clothe ten times its present population finer than Solomon was arrayed in all his glory. It would furnish building material sufficient to erect a palace larger than the Capitol at Washington for every family now living, and there would be material enough left over to house another generation.

Our Father has provided the raw material for all the things essential to life, and He has provided a thousandfold more than we can use. The race, taken as a whole, is rich; immensely rich; it is only individuals within the race who are poor.

The satisfaction of human needs is a problem of machinery and organization, and the machinery is pretty well perfected; it is now, then, a matter of organization.

Seek the Father's Kingdom, says Jesus, and you solve the bread and butter problem. Does that sound like a rational interpretation of the passage we are speaking of? Turn to the 12th chapter of Luke, and read the parallel passage.

The Kingdom of God

Now, what did He mean by the kingdom of God? Practically all commentators agree, now, that He did not mean a distinct Heaven, which we cannot enter until we die; and they agree, also that He did not mean a church like the one we have now.

If you can conceive of the church as expanded until it filled the whole earth; all the people united in one, and all practicing what the churches preach now, that would be very like a Kingdom of God as Jesus describes it.

He illustrates it by showing that the birds know no anxiety; they live in the Father's kingdom. They all, alike, have access to the Supply. There is no bug trust, and no shrewd bird has, as yet, cornered the worm market. When, instead of going freely to the Great Supply, the birds begin to compete for the limited portions of it, there will begin to be an anxiety among them. There can be no Father's kingdom unless all can have equal access to the Great Supply.

Equality and Democracy

You will find this confirmed in the twenty-third chapter of Matthew, in the first twelve verses. Here He lays the foundation of the kingdom in the fact of the Fatherhood of God, and I will call the attention of the literalists especially to the fact that the sayings were addressed "to the multitude" as well as to His disciples.

He assures them all that God is their Father, and that they are brethren; and that hence, they should not compete for the best place at the feast. If, instead of struggling with each other, you will go lovingly to the feast together, is there not enough for all? Let there be no striving for mastery, or power over one another; just plain equality and democracy, says Jesus, and no one will have to bear a heavy burden anymore.

Suppose the father of a family should see his children gather around a table, where he had provided for them as bountifully as our Father has for us; and suppose that the largest boy should get to the table first and gather all the best food around his plate. When his little sister reaches for a nice piece of cake he slaps her; he strikes back the out stretched hands of the others, and says:

"Get away! Our father put this here, and I am the first one to get to it; so it is mine. Get away" (strike, push, shove) and, looking up to his parent, he addresses him thus: "Our father (biff), thy kingdom come (bang), thy will be done (whack)."

Would not that father say, "My will will not be done until you, with your brothers and sisters, go together to the Supply I have provided."

And if the large boy should say then: "Well, father, I will hold it as your trustee, giving to the others as I think it best for them, and seeing that all is done decently and in order," would not the father say, "I do not want benevolence, or charity, or self-denial, or Sabbath observance, but that each one shall go freely to the Supply for all that he needs."

The idea of Jesus appears to be that if each one will go freely to the Supply, there can be no poverty or lack of any kind; and His idea appears to be sound. If the supply is super-abundant, and all go freely to it, how can anybody have lack? The trouble is that we have our eyes fixed, not on the Abundance, but on the Uppermost Place.

It is as if there were a mountain of gold, to which we might go for wealth, but on our way thither we find a few scattering nuggets which have been washed down by the rains, and we stop to fight for the possession of these fragments, and so lose the whole.

In this connection, look up the parallel passages in Luke, and note the one in the twenty-second chapter, where He cautions them against that most insidious of temptations, the desire to pose as a "benefactor." No benefactors are needed where all may go to the Supply. You are to serve by inviting men to the feast, not by handing them a few crumbs from your own plate. It is not possible that there should be benefactions,

benefactors or charity in the kingdom of God; so long as there is need for these things we are not in His kingdom.

And how can we hope to establish the kingdom by practicing things which do not belong to it?

"Love Thy Neighbor"

It is in this light that we must consider His command to love one's neighbor as one's self. What does it mean, this loving one's neighbor as himself? Suppose my wife and I sit down to lunch; and there is nothing on the table but a crust of bread and a piece of pie. And suppose that I hastily grasp the pie, and say; "My dear, I certainly love you devotedly; I do wish you had some pie, also," and I swallow it, and leave her the crust; have I loved her as myself? If I love her as myself, I will desire pie for her as intensely as for myself, and I will try as hard to get it for her as for myself.

If I love you as myself, what I try to get for myself I will try to get for you, and what I try to get for my children I will try to get for your children, and I will no more rest under an injustice done to you or yours than if it had been done to me or mine.

And when we all desire for everybody all that we desire for ourselves, what is there for us to do but to stop competing for a part and turn to the abundance of the Great Whole, which is the Kingdom of God.

In the next chapter we will consider how the apostles went about solving the problems of supply, and why they failed.

REFLECTION

Wattles reads "consider the birds" as a social teaching: the earth holds enough for everyone, so anxiety and want come from how access is organized, not from real scarcity. In his parable, the biggest boy grabs the whole table and then

offers to act as the others' "trustee." The father wants not charity but for every child to reach the supply freely. Wattles is wary even of playing the "benefactor," because in a just order charity would hardly be needed. Loving your neighbor as yourself, he says, means wanting for them exactly what you want for yourself. His economic claims reflect early twentieth-century optimism and his socialist views, and readers will weigh them differently. His moral test, though, works across many beliefs: do I desire for others what I seek for me?

PRACTICE

Think of one good thing you are working toward this month: a skill, a raise, rest, better health. Name one specific person who could also benefit from it, and take one small step this week that helps them reach it too.

KEY THOUGHT

You are to serve by inviting men to the feast, not by handing them a few crumbs from your own plate.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

V

The Apostles and Their Failure

NO ONE who studies carefully the teachings of Jesus can doubt that by the phrases, "Kingdom of Heaven" and "Kingdom of God," He meant such a righteous adjustment of social relations as would have revolutionized the Society of His day; or which, if applied in our time, would revolutionize the society of this day.

You will get this idea pretty clearly if you study His use of the term "this world," and His comparison of the "world" with the kingdom. When He speaks of the "world" He never means the earth; He always refers to the existing social and governmental order; the world of men; organized society. He speaks of this world as a living, sentient thing; as loving, hating, etc.; and it can hardly be that He refers to the senseless clods and stones composing the material planet on which we live.

Thus in John 17:14, He says: "The world hath hated them, because they are not of the world."

In the same chapter He speaks of His disciples as being in the world, but not of the world; as being sent into the world; and He prays that the world may believe, and that the world may know. In the two preceding chapters He speaks of the world as being overcome. Follow this clue

through all His teachings, and you must conclude that by the "world" He means the existing order of human relationships.

The World and the Kingdom

Having come to an understanding of this, we can appreciate the contrast He draws between the world and the Kingdom. His Kingdom, He says, is "not of this world"; that is, it is not on the same basis as the world's kingdoms. "If My kingdom were of this world, then would My servants fight" (John 18:36).

In the world's kingdoms they fight; in His Kingdom they co-operate.

In the world's kingdoms they sustain the relationship of master and servant; in His Kingdom, they are "friends" (John 15:15) (See also Matthew 23:10).

The world's kingdoms are divided against themselves (Matthew 12:25), but in God's Kingdom they do not try to conquer or master one another. That is the essential thought of the life of the Kingdom—that there shall be no seeking for power over other men; over against it He places the essential thought of the world-life, which is the strife for power, and for the uppermost place.

So, when they sought to make Him king by force (John 6:15), He refused, because that would have been placing His Kingdom on the world basis of strife and competition, and a kingdom over which Jesus ruled by force of arms would, after all, differ from the world kingdoms only in degree, and not in principle. The only kingdom in the establishment of which He could assist was the Father's Kingdom; a co-operative commonwealth, in which all should have access on equal terms to God, and to the Great Supply.

So He sends His followers out, not to fight or conquer, but to go as lambs among wolves, and by teaching and living to transform the insane and struggling world into a vast brotherhood. He believed that He had

overcome the world by His demonstration, and that it must soon come to its end.

The End of the World

This brings up another point for our consideration. When He speaks of the "end of the world" it is apparent that He is not referring to some tremendous cataclysm which shall destroy the planet, but to a social change; a world revolution. In the twenty-fourth chapter of Matthew, He does, indeed, give some symbolical pictures of the darkness of the sun and moon, etc., which He quotes from the prophecies; but as we shall see in a future chapter, the "coming of the son of man" meant to Him, not His own personal return to establish a spiritual force-kingdom, but the awakening of racial Man, and his entrance into his heritage. When Man awakes and enters into his own, the world will be ended and the Kingdom will begin; that is the Coming of Man, which the prophets foretold.

That is the way Jesus interpreted them, as you will see if you study Him carefully and without prejudice. He does not appear to have had any idea that the planet would "come to an end"; or that He would actually come in personal presence to do what He steadfastly refused to do while here—set up a kingdom based on force.

The apostles caught this concept of the Kingdom, and they set forth with joyous confidence to build a united and harmonious world.

Read the second and fourth chapters of the Acts, and read the writings of the early Christian fathers, and you will see that their idea was not to build an institution for worship, in a bad world, but to build the world itself into a righteous, united and orderly society. Property was held in common, and there was no poverty among them which was not shared by all, and no riches which were not enjoyed by all.

The early Christian societies were little commonwealths, and the inspiring purpose to which they held with intense enthusiasm was the

building of the world into one great commonwealth.

The apostles were communist organizers, and the purpose of Jesus as understood by them was the establishment of a communistic state which should grow up within the kingdoms of the World, and absorb them all, not by force, but by conquest of truth; by evangelizing the world, by educating it to the brotherhood ideals and methods.

Their dream was a world of Man, where the united efforts of all should center in the development of the little child; it was this glorious vision which gave virility and power to their preaching, and it was the loss of this vision which cost the church its spiritual power. The church of today is alive in proportion as it receives this world-vision; as it sees the kingdom and helps reorganize society.

Why Communism Fails

We may here consider for a moment why the communistic experiment failed, and we shall find the reason easy to get at. Communism has always failed, and always will fail, because it interferes with the Great Purpose, which is the complete development of the individual soul. It extinguishes the individual in the mass, and takes all initiative from him. Seeking to prevent him from gaining power over other men, it robs him of power over himself. It destroys individuality for man can develop only by the free proprietary use of everything he is individually capable of using.

Capitalism robs the majority of men of the opportunity to make proprietary use of the things necessary for their individual development; Communism would rob all men of this opportunity. In this, both are the opposites of Christian socialism.

Christian Socialism

Socialism would tremendously extend private property. Its cardinal doctrine is that the individual should own, absolutely and without

question, everything which they need or can use individually; and that the right to hold private property should be limited only when we come to those things which a man cannot operate without exploiting other men. Man, under socialism, may acquire and hold all that he can use for his own development; but he may not own that which makes him master of another man.

As we approach socialism, the millions of families who are now propertyless will acquire and own beautiful homes, with the gardens and the land upon which to raise their food; they will own horses and carriages, automobiles and pleasure yachts; their houses will contain libraries, musical instruments, paintings and statuary, all that a person may need for the soul-growth of themselves and theirs, they shall own and use as they will.

But highways, railroads, natural resources, and the great machines will be owned and operated by organized society, so that all who will may purchase the product upon equal terms. Socialism, when properly understood, offers us the most complete individualism, while communism would submerge the individual in the mass.

The apostles failed because communism is a failure in the nature of things, while the world, at that time, had not evolved far enough to make socialism possible. They tried to establish for all a life which was only possible to a few.

✦

REFLECTION

Wattles argues that when Jesus spoke of "the world," he meant the existing social order, and that "the end of the world" meant a social transformation, not the destruction of the planet. In the world's kingdoms people fight for the top place; in God's Kingdom they cooperate as friends. He points to Acts, where early believers shared property, and calls the apostles "communist organizers." Yet he thinks their experiment failed, because full common ownership stifles

individual growth. His answer is Christian socialism as he defines it: private ownership of everything a person can personally use, with railroads, natural resources and great machines held in common. Many theologians and economists read these texts very differently. The chapter is best read as one reformer's vision, worth testing rather than simply accepting or dismissing.

PRACTICE

Write one sentence describing a place in your life, such as work, family or neighborhood, where people compete for the "uppermost place." Then write one practical change that would make it a little more cooperative, and try it once this week.

KEY THOUGHT

In the world's kingdoms they fight;
in His Kingdom they co-operate.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VI

The Source of Power

JESUS ASCRIBED all His marvelous power to the mental relationship which existed between Himself and the Father. He uses the terms Father and God interchangeable, and says: "My father, of whom ye say that he is your God" (John 8:54).

And in His talk with the Samaritan woman, He explains clearly His conception of God, declaring that "God is Spirit" (Not A Spirit, as the King James version has it), and that He is not to be worshipped in some particular place like Jerusalem, or on some specially consecrated mountain, but may be approached, or worshipped in spirit and in truth, anywhere.

The Father, as described by Jesus, is Universal Spirit, working in all, *through all,* and FOR ALL. He describes this spirit as making the sun to shine, and causing the rain to fall, and so as being the POWER behind nature; as clothing the lilies of the field, and causing the hair to grow on man's heads, and so as being the one and only LIFE; as quickening and leading men to truth and so as being the one and only INTELLIGENCE.

Every man is a God, according to Jesus, because it is Spirit which lives in man; He said to them: "Ye are Gods" (John 10:34). Spirit holds the earth in its orbit, makes the sun rise, sends the rain, and causes the

coming of seedtime and harvest; Spirit lives in the lily and clothes it finer than Solomon was arrayed in all his glory; Spirit lives in man.

There is only one power, only one life, only one intelligence.

Unity of Man in God

As I have said, Jesus ascribed all His power to His conscious unity of mind with this One Intelligence. "I and my father are one," said He. "I do always his will."

And He went on to declare that because He always did the will of Spirit, Universal Spirit worked in and through Him. "I do always those things that please him," said he (John 8:29). "I come, not to do mine own will, but the will of him that sent me." "I seek not mine own will, but the will of him"—and so on.

He made it perfectly plain that it was because of this unity of mind with the Father—which we call cosmic consciousness—that the Father could work through Him.

Because I will to do his will, said Jesus, my father and I act as one; and so it is not I that do the works, but the Father that worketh in me. He was *consciously* one with the one Spirit, and so all power in heaven and earth was at His service; He was consciously one with the one Life, and so He could transfigure His body, and heal others; "there went out from him a virtue (a realization of truth) that healed them all"; He was *consciously* one with the one Intelligence, and so all knowledge and all wisdom were His.

This is a point we must not lose sight of; that all that there is in the life of Jesus which transcends the ordinary, He positively declares to be due to His cosmic consciousness; to unity of mind and will with the All-Spirit.

Cosmic Consciousness

I will quote you a few more passages on this point; "He that sent me is true, whom ye know not; but I know him" (John 7:28-29). "I know him, and keep his saying" (John 8:55). "The son can do nothing of himself, but what he seeth the father do" (John 5:19). "As the father knoweth me, even so know I the father" (John 10:15). To "know" the father can have but one meaning; and that is to be conscious of Spirit; to have my own consciousness so unified with the consciousness of Spirit that what Spirit knows I know; what Spirit sees I see; and what Spirit does, I do.

My father is greater than I; I proceeded forth and came from Him; but *if I unite with Him in consciousness,* He is in me and I in Him, and He and I are one.

Jesus declares that this cosmic consciousness is the source of all power; He demonstrates that it is perfect health, both in His own person, and by healing others; "and this is life eternal to KNOW thee" (John 17:3). He asserts that it gives perfect wisdom—"The father loveth the son, and showeth him all things." "My judgment is true; for I am not alone, but I and the father" (John 8:16).

And He asserts that it is wealth; "All things that the father hath are mine" (John 16:15).

Christ's Brothers

He does not trace His power to something peculiar about His birth, but to His conscious unity with Spirit.

He does not say that God is His father alone, but that He is our father. He says; "One is your father, and all ye are brethren."

He says in the sermon on the mount; "It is your father who feeds and cares for you; be his children in mind and will, as you are in fact."

He does not assert that He is a demi-god, and that we are men; but that He is God, and we may be God, too, if we will; "He that willeth to do the will of God, shall know"; "shall enter the kingdom," and so on.

"The works that I do, ye shall do also; and greater works than these shall ye do."

The consciousness that He had, He seems to think quite possible for all of us; "That they may all be one," he prays, in the seventeenth chapter of John, "as thou, Father, art in me, and I in thee, that they may be one in us." "I in them, and thou in me, that they may be made perfect in one." What He is, we can any or all of us become, He says.

Jesus' Relationship to God

It is not within the scope of this little book to study whether Jesus really was born in a different way from other people; that inquiry must be reserved for a more pretentious work. But this is quite certain, that He Himself made no claim to being different from the rest of us, except as to the extent of His consciousness.

He was conscious of a relationship with Spirit which the world knew nothing about; this relationship existed for the world as well as for Himself, whenever the world would recognize it, and enter into it. And for all to enter into this conscious unity with Spirit would save the world from sin, sickness, ignorance and poverty; it would establish the Kingdom of God.

He could pray for no greater good than that they might be "one with the Father," even as He was one with the Father. To be one with the Father is to be one with Spirit; and to be one with Spirit is to so harmonize with it that thought, life, power, and wisdom shall come in a continuous inflow from Spirit into our minds and bodies.

Man's Relationship to God

There is, according to Jesus, one Spirit who is all the power there is, all the life there is, and all the intelligence there is; and this Spirit has children, who are of the same substances as Himself, and who have

power to think independently, and to separate themselves in consciousness from Him.

And the power to think independently implies the possibility of thinking erroneously; if man separates himself in consciousness from God, he is sure to fall into error, for he can see only an infinitesimal portion of the truth.

Man's life, man's power, and man's wisdom decrease in exact proportion to the extent of his separation in consciousness from God.

Jesus found a world of men who had lost the consciousness of God, and because of doing so had become afflicted with the most horrible diseases; had fallen into the vilest depths of sin and debauchery; had sunk to the lowest levels of poverty and misery, and were in danger of losing life itself. To this lost and struggling world, He gave a demonstration of the possibilities of a life of cosmic consciousness—of conscious unity with Spirit. He demonstrated power over nature by calming the storm, and precipitating the food elements from the atmosphere to feed the hungry multitude; He demonstrated the power of Life to heal the sick; He demonstrated the Wisdom which is beyond the limited consciousness of Man, and He demonstrated wealth; and finally, He demonstrated power over death.

And He told them how He did what He did, and how any other man might do the same, and even greater works.

The method of attaining cosmic consciousness we will consider in the next chapter.



REFLECTION

The book now turns inward. Wattles says Jesus traced his power not to a unique birth but to his conscious unity with the Father, whom Wattles describes as universal Spirit: the one power, life and intelligence in all things. Quoting "Ye are Gods" and "the works that I do, ye shall do also," he holds that every

person can share that same consciousness. This is a central New Thought idea, and it differs from traditional Christian teaching about Jesus' unique divinity, a question Wattles deliberately sets aside. Whatever your beliefs, the chapter offers a dignifying picture: you are not cut off from the source of life but connected to something larger. He links separation from God to sin, sickness and poverty; that is a historical view, never a reason to blame anyone who suffers.

PRACTICE

Sit quietly for three minutes. Breathe slowly and repeat, in your own words, a sentence that expresses connection to God, to life, or to something greater, as you understand it. Afterward, note one way that sense of connection could shape how you treat someone today.

KEY THOUGHT

There is only one power, only one life, only one intelligence.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VII

Attaining Cosmic Consciousness

"And this is Life Eternal: to know God."

COSMIC CONSCIOUSNESS or conscious unity with Eternal Spirit can only be attained by a continuous and sustained effort on the part of man. The extension of consciousness always requires a mental effort; and this mental effort, when it is a seeking for unity with Spirit, constitutes prayer.

Prayer is an effort of the human mind to become acquainted with God. It is not an effort to establish a relationship which does not exist, but to fully comprehend and recognize a relationship which already exists. Prayer can have but one object, and that is unity with Spirit; for all other things are included in that.

We do not really seek, through prayer, to get health, peace, power or wealth; *we seek to get unity with God;* and when we get unity with God, health, peace, power and wealth are ours without asking. Study the intercessory prayer, as it is called, in the seventeenth chapter of John, and you will see that Jesus asks nothing for men except that they may be one in mind with God. This is the one thing needful; all other things are contained in it.

Whoever has full spiritual consciousness has health, peace, power and wealth.

Oneness Through Prayer and Will

Jesus laid great stress on prayer in His teachings, and demonstrated His reliance upon it in His daily practice. The gospels abound with references to His praying; to His going apart to pray, continuing all night in prayer, and so on.

It is evident that His consciousness that He and the Father were one was only retained by persistently and continuously affirming and reaffirming the fact. This fact, it must be remembered, is in direct contradiction to our objective consciousness.

We appear to think, live, move and have our being entirely in ourselves and of ourselves; our physical senses deny the existence of a God. God is not found by extending the outward or objective consciousness. "God is Spirit," said Jesus, "and they who approach Him must approach Him through their own spirits."

To attain cosmic consciousness, the effort of prayer must be, first to arouse to activity the spirit in man and second, to unite that spirit in conscious union with God.

> *The spirit of man—the ego—the man himself, is aroused whenever the will acts.*

Only the man himself can will; and when he wills it is his whole personality which comes into action.

We see, then, that Jesus was perfectly scientific in laying down His first requirement for attaining cosmic consciousness—that one must will to do the will of God.

He plainly ascribes His own power to His setting His will to do the will of Cosmic Spirit; and He says;

> *"He that willeth to do the will of God shall know."*

To will to do the will of the Father, to keep His sayings, to do His works; this was the first step toward unity. And the next was the prayer of faith.

The Prayer of Faith

The prayer of faith is clearly described in Mark 11:23-24. "Whosoever shall say unto this mountain, Be thou removed, and be thou cast into the sea; and shall not doubt in his heart, but shall believe that those things which he saith shall come to pass; he shall have whatsoever he saith.

"Therefore, I say unto you, what things soever ye desire when ye pray, *believe that ye receive them* (now), and ye shall have them."

We see, here, that the prayer of faith cannot be offered twice for the same thing. As soon as you have asked, if you have real faith, your prayer changes to an affirmation of possession. Having willed to do the will of God, and having asked God to receive you into Himself, nothing is left you but to declare, "I and my Father are one."

This is the point which has been missed by most commentators—that the prayer of faith, when uttered, becomes an affirmation of possession. You cannot continue to pray for a thing when you believe that you receive it; you can only return thanks and assert that it is yours.

The Process of Receiving

First, will to do the will of God, and then (2) pray that you may be one with Him; and then (3) affirm, "I and my father are one."

And when you have definitely established in your consciousness the fact of your unity with Spirit, then draw your deductions of health, peace, power and wealth from this fact, and affirm them; otherwise you may not demonstrate them, for while they are all included in the fact of your unity with God, the mere assertion of that may not bring all the corollaries to your consciousness.

When the disciples came to Jesus asking Him to teach them to pray, He gave them the Lord's prayer; and it begins; "Thy kingdom come." When one has said that, he has asked for all there is; in the Kingdom of God no one would be without daily bread, or suffer evil; but these things are included in the prayer in order to make the thing prayed for *more definite to the understanding*.

So, the general affirmation of unity with God is not sufficiently definite to bring us health, peace, power and wealth; we do not clearly understand that these are included, and it is better to affirm them. But we must be definite and specific in our understanding of the fact of our unity with God.

"That Mind Which Was in Christ Jesus"

"I and my Father are one." That is good, but it does not convey the idea to the modern mind with sufficient distinctness.

"There is one Intelligence, and I am one with that Intelligence." Better, but somewhat clumsy.

"There is one MIND, and I am that MIND." That is a most clear-cut and concise statement of the fact; it would be hard to put it more tersely.

"There is ONE MIND." When you say that, think of the one Intelligence, permeating all things, vitalizing all things, giving coherence and purpose to all things. Get your thought fixed on this MIND, so that it seems to you that you can see and feel it! Then say: "I AM that MIND."

It is that MIND which is speaking, when I speak; which is acting when I act.

I-AM-that-MIND.

It takes affirming and reaffirming to get this fact fixed in consciousness, but all the time you put into the work is most profitably spent. You can well afford to go, as Jesus did, into the desert to fast and meditate for forty days; you can well afford to spend whole nights in prayer, if by doing so you can arrive at a full consciousness of your unity with God.

For then you will have entered the Kingdom.

"There is one MIND, and I am that MIND." Say it continuously, and always when you say it, try to comprehend all that it means. You; you who speak, are eternal mind; eternal power; eternal life.

All things are yours, and all things are possible unto you, when once you have banished the false idea of separateness from your consciousness.

Your word will be with power, and you will speak as one having authority; you will demonstrate health, power, wealth and wisdom, when the consciousness that you are the ETERNAL ONE has obtained complete possession of your mind, objective and subjective.

And you can bring this about; only faith and continuing in affirmation while you will to do the will of God, are required.



REFLECTION

Wattles describes prayer not as begging for things but as an effort to recognize a relationship with God that already exists. His method has three steps: will to do the will of God, pray to be one with Him, then affirm, "I and my Father are one." Drawing on Mark 11, he teaches that a prayer of faith turns at once into thanks and an affirmation of possession. He then offers a modern formula: "There is one MIND, and I am that MIND." Some readers will find this

deeply meaningful; others, from more traditional faiths, will feel it goes beyond what their tradition teaches. As a habit, steady prayer and gratitude can bring calm and focus. His mention of forty-day fasts reflects his own enthusiasm and is not a recommendation to follow.

PRACTICE

For one week, begin each day with two minutes of quiet in which you ask for nothing. Simply give thanks and rest in the sense of being held by something larger. Note in a journal any change in your mood or focus.

KEY THOUGHT

Prayer is an effort of the human mind to become acquainted with God.

MY OWN NOTES

CHAPTER

VIII

Demonstration and Attainment

AFTER YOU have affirmed and reaffirmed your unity with the One Mind until that unity has become a fact present to your consciousness, the next step is to become Life-conscious.

Understand that the Mind is a living mind; that it is life, itself. If you are Mind, you are also Life. There is only one Life, which is in all, and through all; and you are that Life.

So, follow your first affirmation with this; "That MIND is eternal, and it is LIFE; I am that MIND, and I am ETERNAL LIFE."

Repeat this until you have thoroughly stamped it upon your mentality, both conscious and subconscious; until you habitually think of yourself as life, and as eternal life. Now, you habitually think of yourself as a dying being, or as one moving on toward age and decay; this is an error, born of holding separate consciousness. Meet every suggestion of age, decay or death with the positive assertion: "I am ETERNAL LIFE."

Jesus said: "And this is life eternal; to know thee, the LIVING God." To know God is to be conscious of your unity with Him; how else can you know him?"

Health Consciousness

After Life-consciousness is attained, the step to Health-consciousness is easy. The One Mind is the living stuff from which you are made; and it is Pure Life. Life must be Health; it is inconceivable that an inflow of pure life should carry with it anything but health. A fountain cannot send forth sweet and bitter at the same time. A good tree cannot bring forth corrupt fruit. Light hath no fellowship with darkness. The One Mind cannot know disease; can have no consciousness of disease.

The consciousness of disease is an error, the result of judging by appearances; and we judge by appearances only so long as we retain the separate consciousness. One cannot be Life-conscious and conscious of disease at the same time; when we become fully life-conscious we lose the disease-consciousness.

So, the next affirmation is; "That Mind knows no disease; I am that Mind and I am HEALTH." Affirm it with faith; it will cure every sickness, if the affirmation is made in the consciousness that you and your Father are one.

Power Consciousness

Next comes power-consciousness; and the affirmation for this is: "That Mind is the source of all POWER, and cannot know doubt nor fear; I am that Mind, and I am PEACE and POWER."

It needs no argument to show that the source of all power cannot be afraid of anything; what could there be for it to be afraid of? Nor can the source of all power have doubts as to its being able to do any conceivable thing, or to cope with any possible combination of circumstances; what is there that all the power there is cannot do?

It is only when you conceive of yourself as separate from this power that you begin to have doubts as to your ability to do things; it is only as you hold this separate consciousness that you can be afraid.

Jesus never showed any doubt; nor did He ever manifest fear. He knew that no harm could come to Him, against His will; and none did. He was not crucified because His enemies gained a victory over Him; He went voluntarily to the cross, to make a demonstration which should finally show the truth to His disciples. "No man takes my life," said He, "I lay it down of myself; I have power to lay it down, and I have power to take it again" (John 10:18).

To have power-consciousness gives poise; poise is the peaceful consciousness of power and is the result of affirming unity with power until it becomes a present fact in consciousness. "Peace I leave with you; my peace I give unto you. Let not your heart be troubled; neither let it be afraid."

You cannot keep your heart from being afraid if you retain consciousness of yourself as something apart from Power. So, understand and affirm that you are one with Power.

Wisdom Consciousness

Wisdom-consciousness is next. Power without wisdom may be a dreadful and destructive thing, like the strength of the runaway horse; and power can be constructive only when wisely applied. So we must affirm the fact of our wisdom. The One Mind, being the source of all things, must know all things from the beginning; must know all truth.

The mind which knows all truth cannot be mistaken; mistakes are caused by a partial knowledge of the truth. Such a mind cannot know error.

Knowing ALL truth, it can only act along the lines of perfect truth; it can only entertain in consciousness the idea of perfect truth.

It cannot know good from evil; it can know only the good. To recognize anything as evil, a mind must have only a partial knowledge, and a limited consciousness. What seems to be evil is always the result of

partial knowledge. Where knowledge is perfect, there is no evil; and no one can be conscious of that which does not exist.

"God is light and in him is no darkness at all." "God is of too pure eyes to behold evil, and cannot look upon iniquity."

When we become conscious of ALL truth, we lose the consciousness of evil.

With complete consciousness judgment becomes impossible, for there is nothing to judge. You do not have to exercise judgment when you know the right way; you do not sit in judgment on others where there is no evil.

So Jesus said; "Ye judge after the flesh; I judge no man." "I am come, not to judge the world, but to save the world." "The Father judgeth no man."

Where evil and error are non-existent, there can be no judgment. To rise above the error of belief in evil, use this affirmation; "That Mind knows only TRUTH, and knows ALL truth; I am that Mind, and I am KNOWLEDGE and WISDOM."

Wealth Consciousness

Having attained consciousness of eternal life, of health, power, and wisdom, what else do you need? Wealth-consciousness; the assurance of affluence and abundance.

The one Mind is the original substance, from which all things proceed forth. There is only one element; all things are formed of one stuff.

Science is now precipitating sugar, coloring matter, and other substances from the atmosphere; that seems to be akin to what Jesus did when He fed the multitude, in the so-called miracles of the loaves and fishes. The elements which compose all visible nature are in the atmosphere, waiting to be organized into form; and the atmosphere

itself is only a condensed and palpable form of the one original substance—Spirit—God.

All things are made from, and made of, one living intelligent substance; One Mind, and you are that Mind. Therefore, you are the substance from which all things are made, and you are also the Power which makes and forms; you are wealth and abundance, for you are all there is.

So, affirm; "All things, created and uncreated, are in that Mind; I am that Mind, and I am WEALTH and PLENTY."

I Am the Way, Truth, Life

Lastly, say; "I am the WAY, and the TRUTH, and the LIFE; the LIGHT in me shines out to bless the world."

This will give you love-consciousness: the will to bless, and the will to love. Eternal life; health; power and peace; wisdom; wealth; and love; when you are conscious of all these, you have attained cosmic consciousness; you are in Christ and Christ is in you.

Statement of Being

There is one Mind, and I AM that Mind.

That Mind is eternal, and it is Life.

I am that Mind, and I am ETERNAL LIFE.

That Mind knows no disease; I am that Mind, and I am HEALTH.

That Mind is the source of all Power, and cannot know doubt nor fear; I am that Mind, and I am POWER and PEACE.

That Mind knows only Truth and knows ALL truth; I am that Mind, and I am KNOWLEDGE and WISDOM.

All things created and uncreated, are in that Mind; I am that Mind, and I am WEALTH and PLENTY.

I am the WAY, and the TRUTH, and the LIFE; the LIGHT in me shines out to bless the world.

REFLECTION

The last chapter builds a ladder of affirmations: life, health, power and peace, wisdom, wealth, and finally love. Wattles claims the health affirmation "will cure every sickness" and that wealth follows from realizing you are one with the original substance. These claims belong to the New Thought movement of his time and are not supported by medicine. Please do not use affirmations in place of medical care. Illness is never a sign of weak faith or wrong thinking; see a doctor for health concerns, and a counselor if emotional burdens feel heavy. Likewise, no statement can guarantee money; results depend on action, circumstances and luck. What can endure is the closing hope: a mind at peace, unafraid, and turned outward to bless others.

PRACTICE

Read the closing "Statement of Being" slowly once. Choose the single line that feels most helpful, perhaps the one about peace or love, and write it on a card. Each time you see it today, follow it with one kind action toward someone else.

KEY THOUGHT

I am the WAY, and the TRUTH, and the LIFE;
the LIGHT in me shines out to bless the world.

MY OWN NOTES

Jesus: The Man and His Work

A LECTURE · 1905

About This Work

Jesus: The Man and His Work is the text of a public lecture Wattles gave at the Auditorium in Cincinnati on 11 November 1905, under the auspices of the local branch of the Socialist Party. According to the short foreword, some listeners were so impressed that they asked Wattles for his manuscript and had it printed. That foreword was written by the sponsors, not by Wattles, and is reproduced in this edition without notes.

The lecture shows Wattles at his most political. Speaking to a socialist audience, he argues that the churches of his day had replaced the real Jesus with a meek, otherworldly figure who taught the poor to accept their lot. He sets out to "rescue Christ from Christianity," portraying Jesus as a learned, commanding teacher who stood for humanity against religious and economic power. From there he moves to sharp criticism of child labor, of churches funded by exploitative business, and of capitalism itself, ending with a call to ministers and listeners alike to choose justice over charity.

Readers of *A New Christ* will find many of the same arguments, sometimes in nearly the same words. The lecture is earlier, shorter and far more fiery, with stories and jokes meant for a live crowd. It reveals the Christian socialist conviction that runs beneath Wattles' later New Thought books, including *The Science of Getting Rich*.

How to read it today: this is advocacy from a specific moment in American history, when socialism was a growing movement and child

labor was widespread. These notes do not take a side in its religious or political arguments; they explain them so you can judge for yourself. Some figures, such as the claimed four-year life span of mill children, are rhetorical and not verified here.

Some material is dated. A joke about the Amish pokes fun at a real religious community, and its punchline echoes the old charge that "the Jews" killed Jesus, an idea that fed centuries of antisemitism. Wattles tells it to mock false images of Jesus, but notice what it carries. His portrait of the Pharisees is a period polemic, and phrases such as "mongrel multitude" are dated. At the same time, Wattles plainly condemns talk of "inferior races" and "lower classes." The lecture also describes a dying child in detail; if that touches your own grief, be gentle with yourself and reach out for support.

Foreword

IN THESE days of idol smashing and rapid readjustment of ideals this lecture is most timely. Delivered at the Auditorium, Cincinnati, November 11, 1905, under the auspices of the local branch of the Socialist Party, it made so favorable an impression on certain listeners that they determined to have it printed if Professor Wattles would furnish the manuscript. This he has done.

The identity between the ethics of real Christianity and Socialism is perfect. The cornerstone of each is laid in Justice, Equality, Brotherhood. Under the vile and senseless economic system in vogue these principles cannot be practiced except through the absolute sacrifice of every material interest. Who can doubt what the economic attitude of Jesus the carpenter agitator of Nazareth would be were he alive today!

The Spirit of Christ is not dead, but it no more resides in the modern church than it did in the church of His day. Where, then, do we find it? Those whose eyes are open to the truth see in the world-wide revolt of the working class the manifestation of the *real* Christianity. In it, they see the dawn of that "Peace on earth, good will to men" that Jesus proclaimed.

The reader is earnestly enjoined to read this beautiful lecture with open mind. Prejudice and intolerance are millstones about the neck of aspiring intelligence. They are a fatal handicap and cannot be discarded too quickly. Do not shy at a word, like a horse shying at a feather, for one is as ridiculous as the other. A better day is dawning and no nobler work

is presented than to lend a helping hand to the establishment of an economic system where Christianity can be practiced.

Jesus: The Man and His Work

IT IS doubtful if any man was ever more misunderstood by the people of His own time than Jesus of Nazareth. Certainly no man was ever more grossly misrepresented by succeeding generations, and especially by those who professed to be His friends and followers.

The Christian religion was first recognized by the powers of the state at an era when the interests of the ruling class demanded the utmost submission and conformity on the part of the people; and out of the needs of the kingly and priestly classes for a religious ideal which should induce men to be contented with slavery, to bow their necks to the yoke of taxation, and to submit to every form of economic evil without protest, was born the concept of the message, and of the personal character of Jesus which is accepted as orthodox today.

The picture of the man Jesus which you hold in your minds has been drawn far more from the poetry of Isaiah, written 700 years before He was born, than from the four gospels, which purport to be narratives of eye witnesses of His life and works. Such passages in Isaiah as: "He is despised and rejected of men; a man of sorrows and acquainted with grief: and we hid as it were our faces from him; he was oppressed, and he was afflicted and he opened not his mouth; he is brought as a lamb to the slaughter, and as a sheep before her shearers is dumb, so he opened not his mouth," have been quoted to show the meekness and the humility, the submissive spirit with which Christ endured wrong and injustice; and we have had held up as the saviour of the world a despised,

friendless, poverty-stricken laborer whom the upper classes regarded with scorn because of his lowly origin and station; who had no friends save fisherman, laborers, outcasts and sinners; who was often shelterless and hungry, and who bore insults and persecutions with meek submission and walked about a scornful world with his hands always uplifted in loving benediction.

And this character is held up to us as the Christian ideal. Be meek. Be submissive. Be lamb-like or sheep-like. Bow your head before the persecutor and "hump" your back to the shearer. Rejoice that it is given you to be fleeced for the glory of God. It is a good religion—for the man with the shears.

The Christ who is held up in the orthodox pulpit is rather a weak character. He is not the kind of man we would nominate for president. His followers have very little confidence in him as a practical teacher of business ethics. They have great faith in him as a revealer of spiritual things, but none at all as an organizer of the affairs of this world. If it were telegraphed over the country this afternoon that the president has resigned and that Jesus would take his place tomorrow, 95 percent of Christian business men would draw their money out of the banks for fear that Jesus would inaugurate a panic.

Jesus said of Himself, "If I be lifted up I will draw all men unto me." Well, He has not drawn all men, not even a majority of men, and I am inclined to think that He has never been lifted up. An unreal, imaginary character is being lifted up instead, and men are not being drawn by it.

Near a certain Indiana town there is a neighborhood peopled by an Amish sect. They all wear flat black hats and plain black clothes which they fasten with hooks and eyes, because buttons are not Christlike; they shave their upper lip, cut the beard square across the chin, and the hair square also. It is said that when one of the brethren needs a hair-cut his wife turns a bowl or basin bottom upward over his head and cuts away all the hair that comes below it. Attired in this fashion, and in a very strong odor of sanctity, two of these brethren were walking in the street

one day, and were met by an old farmer, a typical Hoosier character. After looking them over critically, he accosted them thus: "Say, why don't you fellows get your hair cut an' shave?" "We attire ourselves thus," said one, "because we want to look like our Savior." "Did the Savior look like you?" asked the farmer. "We believe he did." "Well," said the old man, positively, "darned if I blame the Jews for killin' him, then."

The brethren were holding up a false Christ, and so the old man was not attracted; and I want to prove to you today that the church, everywhere, is holding up a false Christ; I want to show Him to you as He was and is, the Supreme Man—the Highest Type, the incarnation and revelation of that One Great Life which is above all and through all and in us all, lifting us all toward unity with one another and with Him.

It is my task to rescue Christ from Christianity.

In the first place, then, Jesus was not despised because He was a workingman. Custom required every Jewish Rabbi, or learned man to have a trade. We read in the Talmud of Rabbi Johanan, the blacksmith, and of Rabbi Isaac, the shoemaker, learned and highly honored men. Rabbi Jesus, the carpenter would be spoken of in the same way. St. Paul, a very learned man, was a tent-maker by trade. Jesus could not, in that time and place have been despised for His station or His birth. Indeed, He was popularly supposed to be an aristocrat by birth, a son of the royal house and was frequently saluted as the son of David.

Second. He was not despised for ignorance. He was a very learned man. Whenever He went into a synagogue He was selected to read the law and teach the congregation, as the one best qualified for that work. Luke says: "There went fame of him through all the region round about and he taught in their synagogues being glorified of all." In those times of fierce religious controversy no unlearned man could have held his own in such a fashion. He was thoroughly versed in the Jewish law; the way that He silenced his adversaries with apt quotations shows Him to

have been letter-perfect. Even His enemies always addressed him as Master or Teacher, acknowledging His profound learning.

Third. He was not despised for His poverty. He had many wealthy and influential friends. Lazarus and his sisters were people of consequence. Luke says that Joanna, the wife of Chuza, the king's steward, and other women ministered unto him of their substance—that is, were supporters of His work. The king's steward was a high official, and his wife was a prominent lady. Joseph of Arimathea, who came after His body, was a well-to-do man. So probably, was Nicodemus. Jesus healed the sick in the families of rulers and of high officials, and they appear to have responded liberally in supplying His financial needs. True, He owned no real estate; but He dressed expensively, and never lacked for money.

When He was crucified His clothing was too fine to cut up, and so the soldiers cast lots for it; on the night of His betrayal, when Judas went out, it was supposed that he had gone to give something to the poor. It must have been their custom to give away money. In that country and climate their wants were few and simple, and were fully supplied. Jesus wore fine clothes and had plenty to eat and drink and had money to give away.

Read the four gospels, and you can come to no other conclusion. Jesus was not humble, in the accepted sense. He did not go about with downcast look, and a general attitude of asking permission to stay on earth. He was a man of the most impressive, commanding and powerful personal appearance. He "spoke as one having authority" and frequently we are told that great awe and fear came upon the people at His mighty words and works. In one place they were so frightened that they besought Him to leave; and John tells how certain officers sent to arrest Him in the market place lost their nerve in His commanding presence, and went back saying, "Surely never man spake like this man."

On the night of His arrest a band of soldiers approached Him in the grove, and asked for Jesus of Nazareth; and when He answered, "I am

he," such was His majesty and psychic power that they prostrated themselves; "they went backward" the account says, "and fell to the ground." Does this man I am describing seem to you like one of our Amish, or even like one of our Methodists? Yet this is the Christ of the four gospels. I would like to see one of His present-day followers knock down a platoon of policeman by saying "I am he."

Now, to be Christ-like in personality a man must be learned, well dressed, well supplied with money and be of noble and commanding appearance, speaking with authority, and possessing tremendous magnetic power.

What now, of the Christ-like attitude toward the world? One of the very best ways to understand that is by studying His reasons for taking the title He assumed—the Son of Man. He rarely spoke of Himself in any other way. This term, son of man, was common in the Jewish prophecies. It was simply an emphatic way of saying *Man.* If you wanted to emphasize your Methodism, you might say, "I am a son of Wesley," and if you wanted to emphasize your humanity, as Jesus did, "I am a son of man."

Why did He lay stress upon the fact that He was a man? You will note the position. The son of Wesley will stand for Methodism, and the son of Calvin will stand for Calvinism, but the Son of Man must stand for humanity.

The Roman empire was a great taxing machine. In the conquered provinces, the people were left, as far as possible, with their own local government and institutions of justice, the function of the Roman officials being to extort tribute, or collect taxes. Every form of extortion was practiced by governors, procurators and tax-collectors upon those who were able to pay. Open robbery, torture, kidnapping, false accusation, outrage of every kind might be practiced upon the man who had money to tempt the cupidity of the higher powers. And as the oppressed property holders had no way to meet the exactions of government but by oppressing the poor, the condition of the masses was

pitiful indeed. You will readily see that the business and property-owning classes had to get the money to pay their taxes by exploiting the poor in some way.

It is an economic axiom which is indisputable that all taxation of whatever kind, upon whomsoever levied, is wrung at last from the hard hands of the toiling poor; that is the reason they are poor. To give you an idea as to how oppressive this taxation was, we may estimate from certain passages in Josephus that the private income of Herod the Great was three and one-half millions of dollars a year. That is not as much, of course, as the income of our president today, but he has a very much larger country, and more people to tax, and while he is not allowed to use some of Herod's most effective methods, he has others of his own which lay the crude ways of the monarchs of antiquity very far in the shade.

The enormous sums which were collected from that little province brought the unhappy toilers down to the last extremity of destruction; they could go no lower and live. In Judea, at this time there were several religious sects, which were also in a way political parties, scheming for place and power, and for influence with Rome. The Pharisees, Saducees, Essenes, Samaritans, etc., disagreed on various questions, as the interpretation of prophecy, the existence of angels, the resurrection of the dead, baptism, and so on. The strife between these parties was desperately acrimonious and bitter, often to the point of personal violence. Their arguments frequently ended in riots. You will notice, as you read, that they were always ready to "take up stones" to end a dispute; often only the commanding personality of Jesus saved him from being stoned by these religious mobs. These sects were intensely eager to make converts, or proselytes. Jesus says of them that they would compass sea and land to add one to their number.

Below all these middle-class disputants were the common people, sunk in the most abject poverty—taxed, beaten, outraged, robbed, slaughtered, and no voice lifted anywhere in their behalf. No one, Jew or

Gentile, thought of demanding justice for the mongrel multitude. It is said of Jesus that He had "compassion on the multitude because they fainted and were amazed, and were like sheep without a shepherd." They had plenty of shepherds to baptize them, to interpret prophecy for them, to instruct them in "spiritual" things, and even to shear them; but none to demand a lightening of their burdens—none to cry out in their behalf for justice.

There are still shepherds who are far more concerned about correctness of doctrine than about justice. Into this maze of oppression, taxation, murder, outrage and theological discussion comes the grand figure of the Christ, saying: "The Spirit of the Lord is upon me, because he has anointed me to preach good news to the poor. I am no Pharisee; I am no Saducee; I am no Essene or Samaritan: I am a man! I come, not on behalf of Phariseeism or Samaritanism, but on behalf of humanity." A new note in religion; a new attitude. No wonder they were "amazed at his doctrine." No wonder His word was with power. No wonder they said "he speaketh as one having authority."

In John's gospel, Jesus says of Himself that the Father hath given Him authority to execute judgement because He is a man. I say that this is the only reason God ever had for giving authority to any man, and I say that if there is a man anywhere today upon whom the divine sanction rests it is not because he is a Pharisee or a Saducee, a Methodist, Presbyterian, Republican or Democrat, but because he is a man. And I also say that among all those who claim leadership today, by virtue of divine-annointment, we may apply this test with certainty—that the man who stands for humanity, first, last and all the time, against all vested interests, religious and political, is the man who stands with God. He and he only, is in the true Christian attitude—the attitude that Jesus took.

And because He took this position; because He stood for humanity against the vested religious interests of His time, He was called an infidel; because He stood for humanity against the vested economic and

political interests of His time He was called a traitor. Jesus was crucified on the charges of infidelity and treason; and He was guilty—legally—on both counts. I know no prouder titles, when justly acquired, than these: Infidel and Traitor! I pray that Great Intelligence, before whose eye all the affairs of men are spread, to write opposite my name in the book of His remembrance, Infidel—Traitor: Infidel to every church that apologizes for economic injustice; Traitor to every government that assists in the exploitation of the poor. The only sinful infidelity is infidelity to the truth; the only vile treason is treason to the weak. This was the attitude that Jesus took; He expressed all this when He assumed the title which made Him the champion of humanity—when He said, "I am the son of man." And He gave all this full expression in His teachings.

Let me quote from the sermon on the mount: "Ye have heard that it was said by them of old time, thou shalt not kill; and whosoever shall kill shall be in danger of the judgement; but I say unto you that whosoever is angry with his brother shall be in danger of the judgement, and whosoever shall say unto his brother 'Raca,' shall be in danger of the council, but whosoever shall say 'thou fool,' shall be in danger of hell fire." The expression "thou fool," does not clearly interpret the original; it would be better rendered by the phrase "you are no good," or "you are worthless."

Let me illustrate the meaning of this passage to you. I was sitting in a hotel lobby when the news came in of an Indiana coal mine horror, in which a number of poor fellows lost their lives. Two well-dressed men were discussing the affair, and one said: "Oh, well, it's only a couple of Hungarians less! A million more are ready to step into their shoes tomorrow. The world hasn't lost anything." Jesus says, whosoever shall speak of a man like *that* is in danger of hell fire. That is the exact meaning of this passage. The responsibility of all murder rests on those who degrade the public estimate of the value of human life. The killing of Filippinos on behalf of our commercial interests is paving the way for

the killing of Americans in the streets of our own cities, on behalf of those same "interests." The talk of "inferior races" is but a prelude to the talk of "lower classes." Whoever talks so is in danger of hell fire.

The doctrine of hell itself, is born of the infamous idea that there are some classes of men who are specially valuable to God; and those who teach such blasphemies walk ever on the crumbling verge of that black pit, wherein gleam the fires of eternal wrath. If anybody goes to hell, it will be those who degrade humanity.

This is what Jesus said. Now, if you turn to the 12th chapter of Matthew, you will read that the disciples were crossing the fields on the sabbath day, and that they plucked the ears of corn and ate as they went. This gave great offense to the Pharisees. They were not offended because they took the grain, for under law the right of a hungry man to life transcended the property rights of the owner of the field; none might say the famished wayfarer nay if he chose to pluck and eat. It was not, I say, because they ate, that the Pharisees were angry, but because the thing was done upon the sabbath day. The Pharisees thought that the thing most valuable to God was their church, with its institutions and observances. They would not break the sabbath to feed the hungry; they would not break it to heal the sick. God cared more for the institution than He did for the man.

And so they complained to Jesus; and He answered them: "Have ye not heard what David did when he was hungry, he and they that were with him?" and He went on to tell them how David and his companions —and David's companions at that time were a mighty tough gang— went into the temple itself, and took the shew-bread, which was sacred, and ate it—and God approved. "One standeth here," said Jesus, "greater than the temple." God cares more for a hungry man than he does for a holy house.

In Mark 2, where the same story is told, he adds: "The sabbath was made for man, and not man for the sabbath." Here is defined sharply the issue between Jesus and His opponents. They were exalting the worship,

the temple, the sabbath, the ceremonial. He exalted the man. And I for one, agree with Jesus. I feel no reverence for buildings, even though they may be magnificent structures, where a dim light falls through stained glass windows upon the sculptured forms of saints, and where robed priests chant in solemn ceremony; these things move me not at all. But when I stand in a school room and look into the bright faces of a hundred boys and girls—when I stand in the crowded market-place or in a factory, where my brothers and sisters toil to supply the needs of the world, and I realize that every life before me contains possibilities as boundless as the universe itself; when I stand in the presence of this toiling, suffering, loving, seeking, glorious, common humanity, I bare my head and bow in reverence, for here indeed I am in the very presence of Almighty God. One *is* here greater than the temple, greater than the church, greater than the sabbath.

God has a higher call for men than the observation of certain days, or the keeping of certain places holy. This whole earth is a most holy place because it is consecrated by the love of God to fulfill His purpose in the high destiny of man.

Is not this the only rational interpretation of these sayings of Christ? Have you ever heard it so in church? Theirs is a metaphysical Christ, a false Christ. This Christ I hold up today is the real Saviour.

The trouble with the churches is that they are all too much like one in Washington. It was a Calvanistic church—a very solemn place. Washington is a solemn place anyway, for people who believe in hell—they are so near their finish. A good old Methodist woman strayed into this church one Sunday and sat down. The preacher was eloquent, and presently the old lady, greatly moved, shouted heartily, "Amen!" An usher touched her gently on the shoulder and whispered: "Madam, you will please keep still." She subsided, but under the influence of the eloquent sermon, she lost herself again directly, and shouted: "Glory to God!". Again came the usher with his whispered reproof. "But sir," she said, "I've got religion." "Oh, well, madam," he answered, "this is no

place to have religion." You laugh. Perhaps you know of churches where anything is more welcome than religion.

"And Jesus took a little child, and set him in the midst and said: "Whosoever shall humble himself as this little child shall be great in the kingdom of heaven. You have, no doubt, seen a great many pictures of Jesus as he blessed the little children, and you have always seen Him surrounded by prettily dressed ladies, who were bringing nice, clean babies—the kind of children it is easy to love; the kind you cannot help blessing. The gentlemen who draw these pictures cater more to the artistic sense than to a desire to represent accurately the facts in the case.

That was undoubtedly a slave child; a child of the abyss; unwashed, uncombed, covered with vermin; human in His suffering, in His capacity for pain, but with the better portion of His humanity lying dormant in His soul visible to God but not to men. And He said, "Whoso receiveth one such little child, receiveth me."

There are a good many children in whom you find it hard to see the Christ, are there not? Let me do for you, my friends, what Jesus did for His hearers; let me bring a little child, and set Him here before you.

I went into a tenement building in the city of Chicago, one hot afternoon in the season when those buildings become great superheated ovens, with a doctor, to see some children who were sick. In one room we found a little boy—a very little boy indeed—who was dying with a fever. The room was squalid and intensely hot; there were three other children, dirty and uncared for. The mother was giving all her time to her sick baby, wetting his parched and bleeding lips, and trying by every poor device at her command to lessen his suffering. The doctor said to me that day: "I can go where grown people are dying, or dead, without being overmuch moved; I can go where children are dead, and thank God; but when I go in where these children are sick, and see what they have to bear, and how they bear it, it breaks me down and unmans me quite. I cannot bear to see it."

Poor little boy, with his bright eyes and flushed cheeks, he lay quite patiently, and only the restless movement of the wasted little hands upon the quilt betrayed his suffering. He spoke to his mother: "Mamma," he said, "it is time for papa to come in." The father was a stationary engineer, who worked near by, and it seemed that it was his custom to leave his work, now and again to run in and see his child. "Yes, honey," the mother answered, "papa will be here pretty soon." "Mamma," the child said, "when papa comes he'll say 'how is my little man' and I'll say 'all right,' so he will be glad. Don't tell him I am dying, but I think I am."

He was thinking, you see, not of himself, even in the hour of his extremity, but of his father. Well, presently the father came into the room. He was a rough, wild looking man, with uncombed hair and beard, clad only in a shirt and overalls, his face and bare arms black with coal. I have no doubt he was an ignorant man, as books go. I have no doubt he was a bad man from the orthodox and conventional standpoint; I presume he sometimes swore, and played cards for the beer, and did other dreadful things.

As he came in, he glanced anxiously at his wife, and then at us, and read the worst of tidings in our faces. His own face quivered, and his bearded lips twisted strangely; then, for the child's sake, he forced a cheerful smile and came across the room toward the bed; and as he came, upon his coal-grimed features shone with transfiguring light a father-love as holy as the love of God Himself.

The father bent above the cot. "How is my little man?" he asked. And the feeble voice piped bravely, while the parched lips writhed in a pitiful attempt to smile: "I'm all right, papa; I'm all right." It broke the man down. He burst out sobbing, and springing to his feet rushed out upon the landing to struggle for self-control. The mother, also sobbing bitterly, bent over her child again; and down the poor child's cheek rolled just one tear—of pity—for his father. That was a "cheap" child;

one of the "lower" classes. Not one of the "fittest" to survive—and so he died.

Jesus took a little child and set him in the midst of them, and said: "Whosoever shall offend one of these little ones it is better that a millstone were hanged around his neck, and he were cast into the sea." Yes, any man, or woman, or railroad system, or financial system or industrial order that stands between the child and life, is under the curse of God. I say, with Jesus, that it is more important that justice be done to one such little child than that all the corn crops of a thousand years be saved.

"Whoso shall humble himself as this little child, the same shall be great in the kingdom of heaven." How can you humble yourself as such a child? Does it mean to be childlike in spirit, teachable, credulous? No; there is only one way. Stand beside that child of the abyss and say, "Before God he is as good as I. He is entitled to everything I claim for myself and for my children, and I will never rest until all I claim for myself and mine is assured for him also." Then you will begin to be great in the Kingdom of God.

How can I love my neighbor as myself? How can I love that child as I do my own children?

One day Jesus was talking to the folks and He said: "Why are you worried about things to eat and wear? Seek a just and righteous order of things and you will have plenty." I am here to testify that Jesus told the truth. This world would produce food for ten times its population. It would clothe ten times its population more richly than Solomon was arrayed in all his glory. It would furnish building material to erect a palace larger than Rockefella mansions for every family that lives on it. Our Father has provided the raw material for the things essential to life a thousandfold more than we can use. The race is rich, abundantly rich, as a whole. The satisfaction of human needs is a problem of machinery and organization. We have the machinery pretty well perfected. It is now a problem of organization.

Seek the Father's kingdom, says Jesus, and you solve the bread and butter problem. What is a father's kingdom like? A yonder comrade, let us say, is the father of a family, and he sees his children gather about a table where he has provided bountifully for them all, as our Father has for us. Well, the biggest boy gets to the table first, and he gathers all the good things around his plate, and gets his arms around them; his little sister reaches for a piece and he slaps her; he strikes back the outstretched hands of the others and says: "Get away! Our father put this here and I've got here first and it's mine! Get away," (strike, push, shove), and looking up to the father he says, "Our father (strike), thy kingdom come (biff), thy will be done" (bang). Would not that father say, "My will will not be done until your brothers and sisters have an equal chance." ? And if the big boy should say "Well then, father, I will hold it as your trustee, and I will give the others what they need, if I can spare it." Would not the father say, "My kingdom does not consist in benevolence or charity, or self-denial, or sacrifice, or worship, or Sabbath observance, but in justice for all."

Jesus pointed out that the birds are not worried about getting something to eat. They live in the kingdom of God. We live in the kingdom of Caesar. If the time ever comes when some of the smart birds get a corner on bugs or organize a worm trust, there will be worry among them also.

Now, so far as nature is concerned there is nothing to prevent me from loving my neighbor as myself. There is plenty for him and me, too. And just what does it mean this loving ones neighbor as himself? Suppose my wife and I sat down at the table and we had nothing to eat but a crust of bread and a piece of pie. And suppose I reach out and get the pie and say, "My dear wife, how I love you! I do wish you had some pie!" and I swallow it and leave her to gnaw the crust. Which do I love best, myself or her? If I love her as myself, will I consent to hog the pie? If I love her as myself what I try to get for myself I will try to get for her. If I love you as myself, what I try to get for myself I will try to get for

you, and what I try to get for my children, I will try to get for yours and I will no more rest under an injustice done to your children than if it were done to my children.

Now can you imagine a state of society in which the good thing I do for myself shall be done for you also? I spoke one night in Chicago and at the close I got on a street car and stood beside a girl who had been one of the listeners, and she spoke to me. "Mister," she said, "I heard your speech and I liked it very much. I'm only a poor, ignorant girl but I've thought of these things, and the world as it is reminds me of one of these big jack screws they lift buildings with—you turn a handle round and round and the center part is lifted up. So, it seems as though we poor folks are at the handle. We go round forever and never get any higher. We are always in the same place. We go round to lift somebody else. And I thought it might be fixed like one of those winding stair-cases so that as we all went round we all might go up together, and the work we all do would help us all, and if a few people didn't get quite so high, some day we would all come to the top together and that would be better for us all." And I thought that if I had the power I would make all the college professors and preachers and the teachers go and sit at that poor girl's feet and learn a little political economy.

These things are hidden from the wise and prudent and revealed unto babes. The pure in heart shall see God. The average man is so wedded to the idea of the divine origin of the present order that he cannot conceive of the possibility of a change. He will not investigate, he will not consider; he simply says, "It can't be done." He is like the old Tennesseean who did not believe in railroads. They built a railroad through his vicinity and the neighbors got him to go down one day to look at the track. They had laid the track down to the river bank and had tunneled on the opposite side under a hill, but had not commenced to build the bridge. The old man took one look—that was enough. He didn't stop to ask questions. He threw up his hands and said: "Oh, by

thunder, you needn't tell me that you can make an engine that will jump that river and hit that hole in the hill! It can't be did."

Have you ever thought, oh ye of little faith, that there is a way to bridge this chasm between individual effort and united effort? Consider for a moment our public school system. We are educating our children by uniting our effort. We hold the school property in common. You are a proprietor in the school property of Marion, Ind. I am a part owner of the school property in Cincinnati. So far as that work is concerned we are all one family, are we not? It is our father's kingdom, in part, established in the midst of Caesar's kingdom, isn't it?

Suppose, in my love for my children, I devise a new text book or a more convenient desk or a more comfortable seat, anything that makes their work easier or betters the school service—then I get it adopted, and I have helped my own children, I have helped your children, I have helped every child from Maine to California. I have brightened every life and added to the happiness of every home, I have loved all as well as my own. This is the spiral stair-way plan. I like it better myself than the jack screw method.

Industry is on the other plan. If I invent a new laborsaving machine, I cause hundreds of my brothers to lose their chance to make a living, and make the problem more intense for all. Suppose the factory were like the school, an institution set apart for the supplying of a common need by united effort, would it be so? If I could, by some device, lighten my own task I would bring rest to all, and there, again, I would love my neighbor as myself.

The apostles understood it so. They started out to build a unified and harmonious world. Read the second and fourth chapters of the Acts of Apostles, and read the writings of the early Christian fathers, and you will see that the idea of Jesus and the apostles was not to build an institution for worship in a bad world, but to build the world itself into a united, harmonious, orderly and scientific society. To make society a spiral stairway, up which a redeemed humanity should march together

into unity with God. They had all things common. There was no poverty among them that was not shared by all. The early churches were little commonwealths, and the purpose which they held with intense enthusiasm was the building of the world into one great commonwealth.

The Apostles were communist organizers. The purpose of Jesus, as understood by them, was the establishment of a scientific society, which he called by its true name—the Kingdom of God; a world of unified effort, centering in the development of the little child. It was this glorious vision which gave virility and power to the preaching of the early church, and the church of today has no power because it has no purpose and no hope.

Dr. Quayle, of Indianapolis, has written a little pamphlet in which he argues that the Apostles were mistaken in their sociology. He holds that they were all right in their theology—inspired and infallible—but they were poor business men. I would suppose that the same Holy Spirit who gave them their theology must have given them their social ideas also. The communistic regime was as much a part of the life of the church as the Lord's Supper, and was far more clearly drawn from the teachings of the Master. Dr. Quayle's attitude is equivalent to saying that the Holy Ghost is an excellent old personage, very correct on doctrinal matters, but a little off when we come to the practical affairs of life.

That is exactly the attitude of the church today toward Jesus. Every modern preacher, with few exceptions, denies his Master whenever he speaks of social problems. I am not going to rail at the church; but the church charges us with infidelity, with atheism and immorality, and I am going to reply with a statement of the case and with a counter charge.

Those of you who have read Elbert Hubbard's article on the cotton mills of South Carolina, will never forget that realistic description of the awful conditions. How the thousands of baby slaves are gathered in by fraud, misrepresentation and by tempting the cupidity of their fathers; how the long hours, the close application, and the flying lint combine to

break down their feeble bodies so certainly and so speedily that the average life of a child condemned to one of these hells is only four years. It is organized murder on a wholesale scale; it is cruelty beyond words; outrage so infinite as to be inexpressible. And near many of these slaughter-houses you will find a church, built by the child-killing corporation, and there is a preacher whose salary is paid from the pitiful stipend of the dying children. In some cases it is even reported that a regular percentage is deducted from the weekly wages for the support of the gospel of that Christ who said, "Forasmuch as ye have done it unto the least of these, ye have done it unto me."

I suppose we all agree that that church is supported by the organized exploitation, even unto death, of little children? I suppose that we all agree that a business which works the lives of little children into dividends is wrong, and that a church which is supported by the fruits of such a crime is wrong, and that the spiritual life of any church cannot rise very far above the source from which it draws its financial nourishment? A church which lives by child murder can not have much divine power in its ministrations, can it?

What is the difference, in principle, between a business in the South which takes all a child's life in four years, and a business in the North which takes a man's or woman's life in twenty years? What is the difference in principle between the business of Ohio and that of South Carolina? What is the difference in principle in competition anywhere? What is the difference in principle between the source of nourishment of the church here and the church there?

Let my brethren of the pulpit charge me with heresy and with infidelity if they will; I answer with this counter charge: I say that the same power which corrupts great corporations and bribes lawmakers, which suborns perjury and spots with foul stains the robe of justice, which plants the land with brothels and saloons, and makes city government a stench in the nostrils of God, is the power that feeds the church. Organized business!

And I charge that down the no-thoroughfares of commercialism today, organized business and the church which bears the name of Jesus Christ, bound together like the Siamese twins, nourished by the same blood, fed from the same source, thinking the same thoughts, and loving the same loves, are walking side by side; and of the exploitation of men and the degradation of women, and the murder of children, equally guilty before God.

If that be infidelity, let the church make the most of it. If it be false, let the church disprove it. If it be true, let her cleanse her robes of the innocent blood, attire herself in sack cloth and with the ashes of repentance on her head, cry for mercy to Almighty God.

In the time of Jesus they were very prone to compare themselves with one another, and thank God that they were not like other men. In the 13th chapter of Luke, you will read how Jesus said to them "Think ye that those on whom the tower fell the other day were sinners above all the other people in Jerusalem, because such a thing befell them? I tell ye nay, but except ye repent ye shall likewise perish!"

Do you think, my friends, that in the day when Capitalism stands up for judgement, and the blood of its slaughtered millions cries to God for justice, it will avail a man to say, "I was a Methodist: I was sound on justification," "I was a Baptist, I was put clear under water," "I was a Catholic, I said prayers with perfect regularity every day." I tell you no but except we repent we shall all likewise perish.

Ah, how I long to give my brethren of the pulpit this vision of the Christianity of Jesus and the Apostles; this concept of the real Christ. How I long for adequate words to convey His call to them and to you!

The call of Christ! What is it and where is it? Where do we hear it? Look and listen at the pageant of your civilization; see the gorgeous shows, the display of wealth, the wonders of color, the things of art: Hear the mighty uproar of the great world of commerce, the clamor of the market, the screaming of the whistles, the ringing of the bells, the puffing of engines, the crash and rattle of machinery, the clangor of

music, the cheering of excited crowds—and now listen closer, bend down and keep still and through it all you hear another note, a minor strain growing louder and stronger day by day—the groans of despairing men, the sobs of outraged women, the feeble cries of dying children. The cry of the sorrowing for relief, the pleading of the disinherited for justice.

That, oh men and women, is the call of Christ to you. What does it mean to a minister of the gospel in the present day to answer that call? It means to stand, not for charity, but for justice; not for reform but for revolution. It means to close the doors of these splendid temples, rather than live another day by taking the gold of organized oppression. It means to go again upon the highways and the byways, saying, "The spirit of the Lord is upon us because he hath anointed us to preach good news to the poor." It means to work, not for institutions of worship, but for a commonwealth. It means to break at once and forever with the vested interests of Capitalism: to be infidel to its religion, traitor to its government: to cry with Isaiah: "Thy princes are rebellious and companions of thieves; every one loveth gifts and followeth after rewards; they judge not the widow, neither doth the cause of the fatherless come unto them; the spoil of the poor is in their houses, their hands are full of blood! Bring no more incense, sing no more songs, pray no more vain prayers; observe no more ceremonies. I will have justice, before worship, saith the Lord of Hosts!"

Yes, the call of Christ to the minister is to break once and for all and absolutely with Capitalism. Render unto Caesar the things that are Caesar's and unto God the things that are God's means that all is God's: in a redeemed world there is no room for Caesar. And my brother, sister, the call is the same to you.

Matthew tells us that when Jesus hung upon the cross the Pharisees mocked Him saying, "If thou be the son of God come down from the cross." They wanted to be led by a Son of God but they wanted to be led in easy ways, to glory, place and power. They wanted a competitive

Christ, who would lead them to competitive victory. They wanted a kingdom of God, but they wanted it to be on the general plan of this world's kingdoms. They wanted to give the poor charity not justice; to give the slave kindness not liberty. They would be good to the poor but they would not abolish poverty; they wanted to ride easily on the backs of others, not to bear others as a burden on their own shoulders. "If thou be the Son of God, come down!"

And current Christianity stands before the cross in the same attitude saying the same words, "Not that way, Master! Not to be crucified on behalf of humanity! Lead us the other way! Come down off the cross!"

My friends, the call of Christ is as it was 2000 years ago, and has ever been to bear the burdens of weak, wronged, outraged, robbed, oppressed and disinherited humanity. To join your lives to those of the poor. To feel their pains, to share their sufferings, to live for their deliverance—to bow beneath their sorrows in dark Gethsemane; to walk, thorn-crowned, with staggering feet up the steep way to Calvary; sustained because beyond the cross we see the river sepulcher, and through it shines the glory of a resurrected humanity. Lift up your heads! The day of your redemption draweth nigh; the kingdom of heaven is at hand.

Compare this call, my friends, with what you hear from the orthodox pulpit, the appeal to selfishness, the exhortation to save yourself; compare it with the appeal of orthodox politics to the appetite alone, and see if it does not move you more. Is not this Christ worthy of your following, this cause entitled to your highest service? Let us consecrate ourselves to it today. To the service of Christ in humanity, to the bringing in of the redeemed world, let us in emulation of our fathers pledge our lives, our fortunes, and our sacred honor.

REFLECTION

Wattles' lecture moves in three stages. First he clears away what he calls a false Christ: the meek, poor, sorrowful figure drawn from Isaiah, whom no one would trust to run anything. Using the Gospels, he paints Jesus instead as a learned rabbi with a trade, well supported by friends, and so commanding that soldiers fell back at his words. Second, he explains Jesus' message as he understands it. As "the Son of Man," Jesus stood for humanity against every sect and vested interest. Calling anyone worthless, ranking "inferior races" or "lower classes," putting institutions above hungry people: these, Wattles says, are what Jesus condemned. The heartbreaking story of a dying child in a Chicago tenement makes the point personal, because that child was as precious as any other. Third, he turns to society. The earth can provide for everyone, he argues; the problem is organization. His image of the jackscrew and the spiral staircase captures his hope: either a few are lifted while others turn the handle forever, or all rise together. He sees public schools as a small working example. He ends by charging the churches with depending on exploitative business and calling listeners to choose justice over charity. You may or may not share his politics or theology. His central question still speaks: does my faith, or my ethic, make me care about who is left at the handle?

PRACTICE

Sketch a jackscrew and a spiral staircase. In your work, community or congregation, name one place that works like each. Then choose one small action this month, such as volunteering, mentoring or speaking up, that helps someone move from the handle onto the stairs.

KEY THOUGHT

It is my task to rescue Christ from Christianity.

MY OWN NOTES

Hell-Fire Harrison

A NOVEL · 1910

About This Work

HELL-FIRE Harrison is Wattles' only novel. L. C. Page & Company of Boston published it in 1910, with illustrations by Frank T. Merrill. The illustrations are not reproduced here. It is a short, fast historical adventure set in eighteenth-century England, in the years after American independence. Gerald Harrison, a Virginia tobacco planter and member of the new republic's Congress, comes back to the country of his birth. He has a reputation as a cynic and a legendary swordsman. Before long he is protecting his son Richard and the spirited Mary Chester from Andrew Hogg, "The Black Hogg," a local tyrant who means to force Mary into marriage.

Why would a New Thought writer produce a swashbuckler? Read closely, the story carries his familiar themes. Harrison's calm, fearless poise wins fights before a blade is drawn. Mary refuses to make her choices out of fear. The new world appears as a place of "new soil, new people, new methods" set against tired tradition. Wattles also mocks empty religious officialism through a drinking, gambling vicar, much as he criticized dead formality in his religious writings. And the hardened cynic, whose club pretends to believe in nothing, ends the book saying "Amen" out of sheer gratitude.

Readers should know what they are walking into. The violence is graphic, and the climax is a revenge killing that the story presents as justice, carried out with no court and no law. Some jokes belong to their time and land badly today. Harrison teases about flogging a bride, and

ironic as that is, it reflects how women were treated then. He also makes a flippant remark about Jews. Dicky Dirk, a disabled man, speaks in heavy dialect and is at one point called a "crawling, staggering thing." In the end, though, he is the bravest and most loyal person in the book. These things are left as Wattles wrote them, as part of a historical text.

The notes for each chapter retell what happens, ask what it shows about Wattles' ideas, and offer a question for reflection. Read it as an entertaining period piece and as a window into its author's imagination. Enjoy the wit. Think about the poise, and also about the cost of revenge.

Chapter One

THEY WERE tremendous times. Governments were going to pieces, and kings and queens were losing their crowns, and sometimes their heads also; the many-headed beast was giving his keepers an immense amount of trouble. The air quivered with revolution, and politics was a warfare of the gods; the greatest figures in the world's history were on the stage, and acting mighty parts. England was on the verge of anarchy, and highwaymen plied their trade as actively on the streets of London as on lonely country roads; the hardest-working man in the United Kingdom was the hangman, and his labors were in vain so far as increasing the safety of life or property was the object. The tide of religious sentiment had reached its lowest ebb, and it was said that zeal for godliness would look as oddly upon a man as the clothing of his great-grandfather. Sincere men, recoiling from the emptiness of ecclesiastical officialism, became sceptics and stoics; they organized hell-fire clubs and made it their fashion to repress every sign of human interest or feeling, pretending to believe in nothing but themselves, and to consider themselves as not worth believing in. Duels were of daily occurrence; every man carried his life in his hand. Yes, they were certainly tremendous times; and it was during the maddest stage of this terrific period that Harrison came from Virginia to England to see his son, who had wintered in the mother country; and so it came about that for the first time in thirty years he visited Wycherly Castle, his birthplace and the ancestral home of his family.

He left his coach to wait at the gate and walked in through the grounds alone. He had given his elder brother, Lord Wycherly, no intimation of his coming, which was a proceeding quite in keeping with his usual ways.

Mr. Gerald Harrison, tobacco planter and member of the Congress of a certain very small but very pugnacious and self-respecting republic, was an uncommonly handsome man of fifty-two; straight as an arrow, of powerful build, and with the suppleness and activity of a youth. He was faultlessly dressed in the fashion of the time, from the silver buckles on his shoes to the crown of his three-cornered hat. Every garment that he wore was a triumph of the tailor's art; his hair was freshly powdered, his cheek was smooth and rosy, and his eye was very bright; his smile, although a trifle cynical and scornful, was good to see withal. He scanned the castle curiously as he drew near to its weather-beaten front, and laughed aloud.

"A little dirtier and more ruinous without," said he, "and I doubt not, a little draughtier and chillier within. Gad, what a place to pass away one's life in; I would rather live in jail! Thank the kind fates for making me the younger son!"

He drew a handsome box from his pocket and took snuff, using great care lest any should fall upon his spotless waistcoat, or on the ruffled bosom of his shirt; and then he walked up the steps and plied the great iron knocker lustily.

"Tell Lord Wycherly," said he to the liveried footman who opened the door, "that his brother waits."

The man gasped with astonishment, then showed him into a room and went away; presently he came back and bade him follow. In a great upper chamber he found Lord Wycherly, who arose and came across the room to greet him; and though they were the only children of their father, and had not looked into each other's faces for thirty years, they shook hands as calmly as if they had parted but the day before. After the fashion of the cynical cult to which they both belonged, it was their

pride to show neither feeling or affection; neither of the pair would, under any consideration, have betrayed emotion in greeting the other, especially in the presence of the footman, who was just leaving the room. Lord Wycherly was two years the elder, but, though very like his younger brother, he showed his age far more; his face was wrinkled and careworn.

"Time has used you well, Gerald," he said, admiringly, after they had talked awhile. "Egad, you look but little older than your son. A fine boy that; you should be proud of him."

"I should be proud to remember his mother, rather," said Harrison, "for his bringing-up was more her work than mine. And I believe he *is* a passable young fellow."

"He is like you, and yet not like you," said Lord Wycherly. "He has little of the dare-devil disposition you showed at his age; and which, if half we hear is to be credited, you have not entirely outgrown. Some strange stories have come to London of the doings of a Virginia planter whom they call Hell-fire Harrison." He shot a single keen glance at his brother's smiling face.

"The name comes from a time some years back," said Harrison calmly, "when a few of us heard that Hell-fire clubs were the fashion over here, and we must needs organize one. I was active in it, and the more strait-laced of our godly neighbors gave the name to me; and it has clung."

"I can readily believe that it has," said Wycherly grimly, "and that it has not, in all ways, been amiss. Yours has been the easiest lot, after all, Gerald; you have had the best of me. New soil, new people, new methods, and liberty to take your own way; while I have had to uphold the family name on these exhausted acres, so hampered by silly traditions that I dare not leave the old rut, or change the antiquated system in any part. Richard tells me that your plantation brings you more than all my rent-rolls bring to me, and you can do what I have never done; live as you please! Well, we could not both have the luck to be younger sons, but if 'twas to be done over, I should try to wait and let

you make your advent first. I see you still wear the old sword. Let me look at it again?"

Harrison drew his sword, and gave it to his brother, without speaking; and the other inspected it with a curious smile, making the flexible blade whistle through the air with a dextrous movement of his wrist. The weapon was a rapier, of unusual, and evidently of Oriental design, somewhat heavier than the dress swords generally worn by gentlemen in those days, double-edged for a little distance back from the point, and sharp as a razor; a tool made for service, not for show.

"Our father loved it," said Wycherly quietly, "because of the family traditions attached to it. I hardly know whether he was most pleased or sorry when you asked for it on going away. But it was yours by right; your equal in handling it never lived. Has your hand lost any of its juggler's cunning with the sword?"

Harrison took the weapon without answering, and stepped toward the great window, formed of many small panes of glass. On one of these, at about the level of his face, a blue-bottle fly was slowly crawling; he indicated it to his brother by a gesture. Then he held the sword at half arm's length before him, with the blade pointing straight upward, and with a slight but powerful movement of the wrist, caused it to bend forward with a hissing sweep. The keen point flicked the fly from the pane without a sound to show that the glass had been touched. Harrison sheathed his sword and sat down, and the brothers took snuff, smiling at each other; for an instant the bars of their cynical pretence were down, and they looked into each other's hearts; but only for an instant.

"I remember well," said the elder, "the night you cut the French Count's nose in half with that same stroke."

They talked on for some time, exchanging reminiscences of their younger days, and then Harrison said:

"I saw your coach made ready as I came up the drive; were you about to go away?"

"I was for London; the house sits to-night. But now that you are here—"

"You will go right on, Richard. My own coach waits at the gate. I am going on to Farnham to see Alicia."

"Hah," said Lord Wycherly. "Yes. Alicia will be glad to see you, Gerald. She lives alone with her servants at Farnham Court; and you will find that she shows her years even more than I show mine. After her husband died she fixed her whole heart on her son; and he grew up a fine fellow, very like your boy. But he was killed, unfortunately, in his first duel. Yes, go and see her; she always liked you. I remember that we thought at one time you were going to make a match of it."

"*She* never thought so," said Harrison smiling, "nor did I. We were only the best of friends. Yes, I think she would be pleased to see me, and I need not keep you from your seat among the lords; I know there are great matters pending. I will go on to Farnham, and we will meet later."

And presently the brothers parted at the door, with a farewell pinch of snuff, a few courteous phrases, and an air of calm indifference.

✦

REFLECTION

The novel opens in "tremendous times": revolutions, highwaymen, a busy hangman, and cynical hell-fire clubs whose members pretend to feel nothing. Gerald Harrison, a handsome Virginia planter and congressman of fifty-two, visits his elder brother, Lord Wycherly, after thirty years apart. They greet each other with studied coolness. Wycherly admits envy: the younger son found new soil, new methods, and the freedom to live as he pleases, while he is stuck in the family rut. Harrison flicks a fly off a windowpane with the tip of his famous sword, and for a moment the two brothers truly see each other. Wattles is contrasting tired tradition with the open possibilities of the new world, a theme close to his teaching on growth. He also hints that the cynic's mask hides real warmth.

PRACTICE

Where do you hide warmth or enthusiasm behind a cool, guarded pose? Think of one person who would be glad to see the real feeling, and find a small way to show it to them this week.

KEY THOUGHT

for an instant the bars of their cynical pretence were down

MY OWN NOTES

Chapter Two

"I WAS never so pleased," said Lady Alicia, "to see any person in all my life, as I am this day to see you."

She sat in the pleasant drawing-room at Farnham Court, and Harrison, bright-eyed and smiling, sat across from her.

"I take that to mean," said he, "that I am better worth seeing—"

"Don't flatter yourself! It is because I have need of you; you come in the very nick of time. But of that we will speak later. And yes, my friend, I *am* glad to see you for your own sake; to see how fresh and young you look, although you make me sense my wrinkles and sunken cheeks more keenly. Do not interrupt me; you know 'tis so. Women grow old faster than men in these times, for we must sit at home with our sorrows and let them eat out our hearts, while you forget yours in battle and diplomacy. Well, never mind. I was delighted with your son, Gerald, when I met him during the one week I spent in London last winter; a right noble youth."

"As of course he must be, with my example—"

"Chut, chut! If he does well, it is in spite of your example, and not because of it. And he *is* a splendid young fellow; even in these days of loose living, he has no bad habits."

"One," said Harrison. "He *will* go to church."

"Why, so I heard," said she, "and I rejoiced that you had not been able to make him into a case-hardened, sneering cynic, like Wycherly and the rest of you. His mother must have been a rare woman, Gerald."

"She was, Alicia," he answered. The change in his tone was very, very slight, but she noticed it and understood; and she changed the subject instantly.

"Now, as to the matter I mentioned awhile ago," said she. "Gerald, do you remember Andrew Hogg?"

"Ay; very well indeed."

"And do *you*, by any chance, remember his son?"

"A dark-faced little boy, when I left England?"

"Yes! Dark-faced and sullen, like his father, and with a worse temper, even then."

"I remember; I cuffed him, once, for torturing a helpless kitten. And has he grown up to fulfill the brilliant promise of his childhood?"

"He is a very devil! Drunken, brutal, licentious, fearing neither God nor man. He lives at Hackthorn Hall with three ruffians he brought with him from the wars, who are well dubbed the bloody three; renegade fighting men. He keeps no other servants than these three; they are all good swordsmen, and more than one life has been lost hereabout by incurring their ill-will. Andrew is nearing forty now; and as he grows older he grows worse in every way. The country people call him 'The Black Hogg.' He and his men are often away for long periods; 'tis thought that they go far from home and play the highwayman. When they are here, they spend their days in sleeping, and their nights in roistering at the hall, or at the Blue Goose Inn, in Farnham village. The whole county is afraid of Andrew Hogg."

"And what, Alicia," said Harrison, as she paused, "have I to do with this merry gentleman?"

"Do you remember Janet Ainslie?"

"Oh, right well! Gad, but she had spirit! She married Billy Chester, so they wrote me."

"Sir William Chester; and he died when their child, little Mary, was ten years old. Then, after three more years, Janet, being homeless and dependent, and very proud, married a squire of this neighborhood,

Sladden by name; and shortly afterward she also died, leaving him to rear the child. Sladden was a somewhat dull and stubborn man, and he has grown duller and more stubborn with the passing of the years, but under his care Mary has grown to be the fairest girl in all England, and 'The Black Hogg' has set his mind on marrying her."

"Well?"

"Well? It is not well. Sladden favors Andrew Hogg with all his stupid strength, and they have sworn, together, that the marriage shall take place before the end of June, and 'tis near the middle of May."

"But, Alicia, surely there is little harm in a maid's being married against her will? Why, she is not supposed to have a will afterward, in any case!"

"Not the least harm in the world," said Lady Alicia, calmly.

"Even if she does not love him," Harrison went on, "she will undoubtedly come to do so, if he flogs her frequently enough?"

"And he will certainly do that," agreed the lady.

Harrison took snuff, regarding her with his bright eyes, and his most cynical smile.

"Oh, hang it, Alicia," said he, "what do you wish me to do?"

"Why, sir," said she, knowing her man perfectly, "but you are conceited! I have not asked that you shall do anything. What can you, a single man, do against Hogg and his bloody three? I have merely given you a bit of neighborhood gossip, so that you might understand the situation and guard your tongue; for I am going to call on Mary this afternoon, and you shall ride along to protect me on the highway. It was for that I said I needed you. The roads are not safe for a woman with no protection but a couple of footmen. While you are here, I may go a-visiting."

"Humph," said Harrison.

So they set forth presently, Harrison riding a horse beside Lady Alicia's sedan-chair, and they passed the gates of Hackthorn Hall before they came to Sladden's farm, which was a little further on. When the

Virginian was introduced to Mary Chester he drew one quick breath of astonishment, and owned to himself that Lady Alicia had told the truth when she called her the fairest girl in all England. He talked with her for an hour, and found that she had a pleasant wit, and that she lacked not for a double portion of her mother's spirit.

"I have come to England," he told her as he was leaving, "seeking a wife. Are you ready to receive proposals?"

"Oh, surely, sir," said she. "What maid is not?"

"I do not seek for myself," he went on, "but for my son; and I have taken a mighty fancy that I should like you for a daughter-in-law."

"Thank you, sir! But is your son to have no voice in the matter?"

"He is a very bashful youth. But he is coming down from London in a day or so, and he shall fall in love with you."

"Ah! And can you make him do that, sir?"

"If he is so stupid as not to do it, I will flog him till he does."

"Oh, poor young man! What a dreadful alternative!"

"And if you do not fall in love with him," Harrison went on, "I will pull your ears."

"My precious ears! I'll not let them come to harm, sir. I think I love your son a little already. And does he take his bashfulness from his father, sir?"

"I think so."

"I think so too; for if you ever had any, some one has taken it."

So they bade each other a laughing farewell, and Harrison rode away beside the sedan-chair. Once out on the highway, they saw coming toward them a strange looking fellow, whose spine seemed afflicted about the hips. He wavered from side to side as he walked, and flourished his arms as if he found it hard to keep his balance. Lady Alicia stopped her bearers and Harrison at sight of him.

"See, Gerald," said she, "yonder comes Dicky Dirk. When he was born his mother was a servant at Hackthorn Hall; it was during the old Hogg's time. Young Andrew had a petty spite against this woman, and one day

he snatched the babe from her breast and dashed it on the floor. Still he held his grudge against her, and a few months later, in a drunken rage, he killed her husband, and she died of a broken heart. The boy grew up to walk as you see him; strangely crippled about the hips, and yet he is said to be as strong as a very giant in the arms and shoulders. He carries a great knife, and so got the name of Dick o' the dirk, now shortened to Dicky Dirk. He lives, the Lord knows how, mostly by doing odd jobs for the country people, and he rarely speaks, even when spoken to. Dicky, this is Mr. Harrison, of Virginia."

"Give 'ee good day, zur," said Dicky, wavering past them, and looking neither to right nor left.

"Good day, Dicky," said Harrison, riding on; and he performed the difficult feat of taking snuff on horseback, with more than his usual carefulness. Lady Alicia watched him closely, but in silence.

"Alicia," said he, after a while, "this Hogg of yours seems to be a rare soul."

"Why, so he is; and I have told you only a few of his pleasant eccentricities."

"I think I will stay in the neighborhood for a while; I was always fond of Farnham. And to prevent scandal, I will take quarters at the Blue Goose Inn."

He beamed upon her with his most pleasant smile, but she shuddered and grew cold, even as she felt that her point was gained, for the thought came to her that she had caused sentence of death to be passed on Andrew Hogg. Harrison went on quietly:

"I will write Richard, and have him down to stay with me. Get up a party of some sort for next week, Alicia, and invite Mary Chester. I will bring the boy, and we will trust in the Lord, who does all things well—with proper management on our part."

"Don't scoff," said Lady Alicia, "I will give the party on Wednesday."

REFLECTION

At Farnham Court, Lady Alicia, an old friend, tells Harrison about Andrew Hogg. Hogg is a brutal squire, guarded by three ruffians, and he plans to marry the lovely Mary Chester against her will with the support of her stepfather, Sladden. Harrison answers with outrageous cynical jokes about forced marriage and flogging. They are irony, but they also expose how little say women had then. Alicia, who knows him well, plays along. He meets Mary, enjoys her quick wit, and half-jokingly proposes her for his son. On the road they meet Dicky Dirk, crippled as a baby by Hogg's cruelty. Without a word of promise, Harrison decides to stay. The chapter shows his pose of indifference hiding a protector, and it introduces the novel's moral split between cruelty and decency.

PRACTICE

Alicia gets help by describing the need honestly instead of making demands. Is there a situation where you need support? Write down how you could explain it plainly to someone who cares about you.

KEY THOUGHT

we will trust in the Lord, who does all things well—with proper management on our part.

MY OWN NOTES

Chapter Three

SO YOUNG Richard Harrison first met Mary Chester at Lady Alicia's party, and, because their curiosity had been artfully aroused beforehand, the two young people took a mighty interest in one another.

"I've heard much of you, sir," said she, as they sat together.

"We famous men are always being talked about," said he. "And I have heard much of you, sweet Mistress Chester."

"We famous ladies are always being talked about," said she.

"Famous indeed," he answered. "Lady Alicia told me that you were the fairest girl in England; I was a little doubtful at the time, but I will swear now that she might have included Scotland, Wales and the Continent."

"Why not America also?" she asked. "But no doubt you have left some one there who is fairer than I."

"In America," he replied, "most of the good looks are given to the men, as you may have noticed."

"Why, so I had," said she, "and yet the men are not conceited, which is very strange. But I must believe all you say, for your father told me that you were a most proper youth."

"I respect my father too highly to question anything he says," said the young man.

"He told me," she went on, daringly, "that if you did not fall in love with me you should be flogged."

"I never wilfully gave him cause to flog me," said he, "and I shall not do so now."

"And he said," Mary continued, "that if I did not fall in love with you he would pull my ears."

"Such beautiful ears shall never be pulled; I shall see to it that you fall in love with me."

Most of that evening they were together, and in a day or so he called at Sladden's farm; and from that time on it was evident that they were in truth falling very deeply into love with each other. Young Richard rode to Sladden's every day, for he was no slack wooer; and Lady Alicia looked on, trembling for what might come to pass, but with a thankful heart; Harrison looked on, bright eyed and smiling, and was always near at hand when the boy passed Hackthorn Hall; Dicky Dirk, hiding in the bushes or lurching along the road, looked on, muttering to himself; and Andrew Hogg looked on, cursing. Presently he summoned Sladden to a conference, and the latter, a square-built, square-jawed, square-headed man of sixty, took his stepdaughter to task.

"What do you mean, you hussy," he demanded, "by letting this young cockerel come upon the place? Dost want to see me pitch him out upon the highway?"

Now, though Mistress Mary had received but little kindness from her stepfather, she had never treated him with disrespect, or disobeyed him until he began trying to make her accept the love of Andrew Hogg, but upon that issue she was in open war with him.

"Yes, sir," said she with a curtsey. "I think I should much enjoy looking on while you undertook to pitch Master Harrison into the highway."

"His father's a dirty rebel," said Sladden.

"But for your life, you dare not say so to his face," said she.

"If you were my own daughter," he growled, "full-grown as you are, I would whip you till you took up with Squire Hogg."

"If I were your daughter," she said with her head held very high, "no doubt but I would be willing to marry Squire Hogg; but my father was a gentleman."

"I shall forbid that whelp to come on the farm," shouted Sladden in a passion.

"And he'll come, none the less," said Mary.

Sladden did not forbid Richard the place, but when, on the next day, Mary told the young man what had happened, he urged her to marry him at once, and she refused.

"We have known each other scarcely three weeks," she said, "and if we wed now, people will say 'twas but the fear of Andrew Hogg drove me to you. Sir, I wish to be courted with all due pomp and circumstance. I sometimes think I like you very well, but again I am not sure of it, nor am I certain that you love me. Make me sure of both, and I will marry you, but I will not be driven to do so by Sladden and the black Hogg."

"By Heaven, they shall not hurry you!" said Richard, looking very like his father. "Take your time, sweet mistress, for all of them. But I will not say that I shall not hurry you myself; for I am asking you to marry me because I love you. I am as sure of that as if I had known you all my life. And love me you shall, and marry me you shall, and I am coming to see you every day, Hogg or no Hogg, Sladden or no Sladden, until you say yes to me."

And so he did, riding into the farmyard every day, tossing his bridle rein and a coin to the stable boy, and receiving Sladden's sour look with a high head and a careless smile. But Hell-fire Harrison, having been told all, redoubled his watchfulness, for he knew that the crisis was at hand.

And it was; for sitting over their liquor at Hackthorn Hall, Hogg and the bloody three were taking counsel as to the safest way of killing Richard.

"Meet the cub on the road, and run him through," said Trainor, the most reckless of the four, and the best swordsman.

"Ay; but his father is always with him, or close at hand," said Hogg. "And they say he is the best swordsman in England. Some of us will lose blood if we try that, and why run needless risk? Here is a better plan: When the young whelp is safe at Sladden's to-morrow, Harrison will ride back to the Blue Goose Inn to wait until nearly sunset; then he will come out to meet the boy and convoy him home. Now, an hour before sundown, let Trainor go to the Inn and get into conversation with this rebel. Drink with him, if he will, and fall to arguing if he will not; quarrel, but do not come to blows. Carry it off in such a way that if he leaves 'twill appear to the bystanders that he is afraid, but do not cross swords, or he will do for you." Trainor sniffed doubtfully, but Hogg went on, "Keep him there until after sunset, and then get away; apologize and eat humble pie if you must; you shall give it back to him later. Meanwhile we three will settle the young popinjay, and if the old one attacks us here, later, we will meet him at the door with our pistols, and give him no chance to come to close quarters. Will that do?"

The others accepted the plan, and so on the following afternoon, as the sun was getting low, Trainor set off for the Blue Goose Inn, and shortly after, the other three rode out upon the highway, and took their stand beneath a clump of trees to wait for Richard.



REFLECTION

Richard and Mary meet at Lady Alicia's party, trade playful compliments, and fall deeply in love. Sladden orders Mary to drop the "young cockerel." She stands her ground with dignity: "my father was a gentleman." When Richard begs her to marry him at once, she says no. They have known each other only three weeks, and she will not be pushed into marriage by fear of Hogg. She wants to be sure of her own heart and of his. Meanwhile Hogg and his men plot to keep Harrison busy at the inn while they kill Richard on the road. Mary's choice reflects an idea Wattles valued: decisions made from fear are

weak, and decisions made from clear desire are strong. Her refusal to be hurried is a quiet act of self-respect.

PRACTICE

Is there a decision you feel pressured to make out of fear or other people's urgency? Write what choosing from clarity, rather than pressure, would look like, and what you would need to know first.

KEY THOUGHT

but I will not be driven to do so
by Sladden and the black Hogg.

MY OWN NOTES

Chapter Four

TRAINOR FOUND the elder Harrison sitting by a table, in the taproom of the inn, with a bottle of wine at his elbow. Sitting down, the ruffian pushed the table so roughly that the bottle was upset. Harrison, who instantly comprehended the whole plan, rose to his feet and drew his sword.

"Draw!" said he to Trainor. "You seek to provoke a quarrel, but I bandy no words with a scoundrel of your kidney. Draw, or by Heaven, I will run you through, where you sit!"

"Would you murder me?" blustered the fellow, as half willing, half afraid, he slowly rose and drew his weapon.

"No; but I will find out whether you are the swordsman you are said to be. On guard!"

They crossed blades, and after a few passes had been exchanged, Harrison's smile grew more contemptuous.

"I see that you cannot fence," said he, "and so we may as well make a finish of it. Look out, now; I am going to slice your nose across the middle, and cut the sign of the cross on your left cheek." And, with three lightning strokes of his razor-edged sword, he carried out his threat.

"You are the devil!" cried the bully, staggering backward as he wiped the blood from his face. "I will not fight you more!"

"You are easily satisfied, my friend," said Harrison, wiping his sword carefully and sheathing it, and then he took snuff, smiling, while the

innkeeper hurried the wounded ruffian away to the village leech.

So, half an hour later, when Hogg and his two remaining scoundrels saw Richard coming in the distance, it happened that they also heard the hoofbeats of a horse coming from the opposite direction, and turning, saw Harrison, who rode past them with a courteous salute. Joining his son a little way down the road, he turned about, and the two came on together. Hogg and his friends perceived that Trainor had failed in his mission, but they did not guess how grievously, and they were puzzled as to what to do. They discussed the situation hurriedly for a few minutes, and then Andrew burst out with a great oath, declaring that the whole matter should be settled then and there. They took their stand in the centre of the highway, facing the Harrisons, who were coming in a walk, chatting carelessly together.

Andrew Hogg was a powerful man, more than six feet tall and very muscular; his swarthy face was bloated and swollen by hard drinking, and he wore his long hair unpowdered and badly combed, while his dress was slovenly. But he did not lack for brute courage, nor did either of his two companions, who were like him in a general way. They were all good swordsmen, and fighters of experience, and they awaited with confidence the coming of the Virginian and his son, who now rode up and drew rein, seeing that the way was blocked.

"Good evening, gentlemen," said Harrison. "What would you have of us?"

"A pinch of snuff!" growled Hogg, expecting a refusal.

Harrison drew his handsomely engraved snuff-box from his pocket, and riding close to Hogg, presented it, open, with a courtly gesture, and the other, who did not use snuff was so confused and taken aback that he took up a pinch with clumsy and not over-clean fingers. Harrison instantly tossed the box, with its remaining contents, into the ditch beside the road.

"What do you mean by that?" roared Hogg, his dark face turning fiery red.

"I can feed swine," said the American with his most pleasant smile, "but I will not root in the trough with them."

"By Heaven!" shouted Andrew, "be careful, or you will feel the swine's tusk!" and he laid his hand on his sword.

"Be careful yourself!" replied Harrison, unmoved. "I am too much of a Jew to eat pork, but just enough of a Christian to kill hogs, especially those possessed of devils."

Young Richard burst out laughing, while the three ruffians sat hesitating; the calm assurance of Harrison, and his evident anxiety for a fight daunted them. He faced them in silence for several seconds, still sitting within arm's length of Andrew; and then as they made no move, he spoke again.

"If you dare not fight, draw aside and let us pass," said he; and under the compelling power of his steady eye, the three involuntarily reined their horses toward the roadside. The father and son rode on slowly, conversing as if nothing had happened; and though they knew that their discomfited enemies had pistols in their holsters, neither of the pair so much as turned his head.

"We have them cowed," said Harrison. "I think we shall hear no more from them." But in that he was mistaken, good judge of men as he was; he underestimated Andrew Hogg.

That night Hogg and two of his men rode away toward London, leaving the wounded rascal, Trainor, alone at Hackthorn Hall, and no one about Farnham saw either of them for a week. During this time young Richard's wooing progressed smoothly, and his father relaxed his vigilance a little, for he came to believe that Hogg, seeing only formidable and dangerous opposition ahead, had given the whole matter up. At the end of the week came a surprise; for a Captain Keatley, with an escort of half a dozen troopers, appeared in Farnham village with a letter from the King, requesting the presence of Gerald Harrison at Saltire Castle, thirty miles away, where his majesty was making a short visit.

The letter merely set forth that the King, learning that Master Harrison, brother to his well-beloved Lord Wycherly, had but lately come from the United States of America, requested the presence of Master Harrison, so and so; and as the audience was set for the day following the one on which Harrison received the letter, it was imperative that he should set off at once with the escort. The Virginian was caught napping; he did not think of connecting Andrew Hogg with the King's invitation, which he supposed to be due to Wycherly's influence; he knew that his brother and other liberal statesmen were working to eradicate the ill feeling toward the new republic which existed at court, and he never once thought of refusing to comply with the request, which was, indeed, tantamount to a command. Richard was at Sladden's farm when the message came; so, after hastily writing him a note bidding him exercise all possible care and watchfulness, Harrison rode over to Farnham Court to bid Lady Alicia farewell for a day or so. Her suspicions were instantly aroused, and she became very anxious.

"I do not like this message, coming at this time," said she. "If you go away, I am afraid for Richard—and for Mary. There is more in this than we see, Gerald. It is only the fear of you that has held Hogg in check so long, and when he gets you away he will do some devilish thing. I would you did not have to go, but the King's commands must be obeyed."

"Tut, tut!" said Harrison. "You are frightened at shadows. I do not think our Hogg has influence enough at court to have brought all this about; it is not his doing. He and his crew are away on some cut-purse expedition; we have scared them out. I have left a word of caution for Richard, and hang it, Alicia, the boy is no baby; he can take care of himself. If I did not know that, I would stay for all of fifty kings." Lady Alicia shook her head reprovingly; in those days the conservatives clung to an exaggerated respect for the pretensions of royalty, for which the radicals manifested an equally exaggerated contempt.

"Blaspheme not the Lord's anointed!" said the lady. "But there is only one man in England who is a match for black Hogg and his bloody

three, and that is you, Gerald. Go, since you must, and come back quickly. I shall have no peace until I see you again."

So, smiling at her fears, he kissed her hand and went. It was well on in the afternoon when he rode out of Farnham with his escort. They had planned to ride until after midnight, for the moon was full, and then to lie at Shoresby until morning, reaching Saltire Castle early in the following day.

Now, the King's invitation had been brought about in this way: Hogg, going up to London to devise some means of getting rid of Harrison, had fallen in with an American tory named Cunningham, who hated the Virginian and all things connected with the republic over seas, and who had some influence at court. This man had impressed Andrew with the danger of meeting Harrison in fight, because of the latter's almost supernatural skill with the sword; and, by putting their wits together, the two had formed a cunning plan for getting him out of the way. Cunningham had procured the invitation to an audience with the King, and had seen that the letter was intrusted to Captain Keatley, an honest but somewhat thick-headed soldier, who was violently prejudiced against republican ideas. The tory had intimated to the Captain that in case Harrison should insult Royalty by declining the invitation he was to be brought to Saltire Castle by force, and the soldier, understanding that his mission was to make an arrest under pretence of an invitation to court, was quite prepared to use strenuous measures. As soon as the Virginian's back was turned on Farnham, Hogg and his three villains were to waylay Richard and kill him; and then, when Harrison returned, they were to take refuge in Hackthorn Hall and stand guard with loaded pistols, trusting to shoot him down before he could come to close quarters. They had arrived at the hall during the night previous to the coming of the King's messenger, and they watched the Virginian from a distance, as he rode away with his escort.

REFLECTION

Harrison sees through the plan at once. He forces the bully Trainor to fight and coolly marks his face with the sword. Then he rides out to meet Hogg on the highway, tosses away the snuff-box Hogg has touched, and adds a period-style jibe that includes a careless remark about Jews. With nothing but a steady gaze he makes the three ruffians give way. Here Wattles shows the power of fearless poise. But Harrison then relaxes too soon. Hogg goes to London, where an American Tory named Cunningham arranges an invitation from the King that will pull Harrison thirty miles away under escort. Alicia senses a trap. Harrison laughs at her fears and goes anyway. The chapter warns that confidence without vigilance can be exploited, and that respect for authority can be turned into a weapon.

PRACTICE

Harrison underestimated his opponent after one easy win. Think of a time you relaxed too early after a success. What small, simple check could you build into your habits to stay alert next time?

KEY THOUGHT

under the compelling power of his steady eye, the three involuntarily reined their horses toward the roadside.

MY OWN NOTES

Chapter Five

JUST AT sundown on that same evening, Richard left Sladden's house and started toward Farnham village and the Blue Goose Inn. He was on foot, and he walked briskly along the highway, whistling a merry tune. He had just passed the gates of Hackthorn Hall when up from the grass where they had been sitting, rose Andrew Hogg and the bloody three, and sauntered out in front of him in such a way as to bar his progress; and they stood looking at him in evil fashion. Young Richard saw murder in their eyes, and he sent one swift glance up and down the road, thinking of his father; whereat black Andrew laughed aloud.

"Useless to look for father to protect you, little man," he mocked. "He's many a long mile on his way to Saltire Castle. So you must fight your own battle for once."

"I have no doubt that he is gone, Hogg," said Richard coolly, "else you four would not dare show your heads abroad. Say what you want, you cut-throat scoundrel, or get out of my way."

"Oh!" said Hogg. "Now hear him try to roar, this puppy who is pretending to be a lion's cub! Why, this is what I want, my dear young friend. I want you to go back to London, and never come near Farnham, or see Mistress Mary Chester again."

"And what if I refuse your very reasonable request?"

"We'll run you through the body, and leave you lying here for the carrion crows to peck at."

"Do you want Mistress Mary yourself, Hogg?"

"Ay, and mean to have her."

"If you were not such an infernal coward," said Richard, as if considering, "how easily you and I might settle this whole matter."

"What do you mean, whelp?"

"Let your three thieves sit down again while you and I fight it out without interference, and let the best man have her. If you can best me fairly, I will go back to London as you say."

"Good!" roared Andrew, drawing his sword. "Sit down, men, and watch me clip this young cock's spurs. On guard, boy, and you shall howl for quarter, or I'll run you through." The other three sat down upon the grass, and the two men in the road crossed swords.

We have said that Andrew Hogg was a good swordsman; but he was not long in learning that young Richard was a better one. The youth had been carefully trained by his father, and had a fair share of the latter's marvellous skill. It was but a few moments until Hogg was bleeding from a wound in the shoulder, and was looking greatly worried and amazed. Richard pressed the fighting, for he hoped to disable his adversary and take to his heels before the other three could come upon him, knowing that he had no chance against all of them; but this opportunity was not to be given him, for Andrew, hard pressed, called for help and the other three rushed to his assistance. Richard defended himself gallantly, but without hope. Attacked on all sides, he was soon wounded in the sword arm and disarmed, and two of his enemies grasped him by the wrists while a third, kneeling behind him, clasped him about the knees. Andrew stood in front, furious with his defeat and the pain of his wounded shoulder.

"I'll finish you now!" he shouted, presenting his sword's point for a thrust. Young Richard saw his deadly purpose in his eye, and his own glance wavered for a single instant; he was young, and he loved, and it was hard to die. Then his look grew steady again, and he stood very straight with his eye on Hogg's, and smiled while the cowardly villain ran him through the body. His knees gave way and he sank in the dust of

the highway, but as he went down he swayed forward and spit in Andrew's face.

"For her!" he whispered, as his eyes closed. Hogg, frothing with fury, raised his sword for another thrust; but just at that instant there came a strange moaning howl from a thicket beside the road, and he held his hand and stood glaring into the shadows, for it was growing dusk. The four drew close together around the body of their victim, and stood trembling; they were all superstitious, and moreover, the dread of Hell-fire Harrison was coming heavily upon them.

"Let be!" said Trainor, tremulously, grasping Hogg's arm as he raised it again. "He's dead enough. Come on," and the four started off toward the Hall. As soon as they were out of sight, Dicky Dirk came from the thicket, lurching from side to side in desperate haste. He bent over the prostrate body for a moment, and then, by exercising all the strength of his powerful arms, hoisted it upon his shoulders and staggered off toward Farnham Court.

It was quite dark when he kicked open the great door and shambled into the entrance-hall with his bloody burden. Lady Alicia chanced to be at hand, giving her servants some directions for the night. When she saw what Dicky carried she screamed aloud, for Richard's arms hung limp on either side of his bearer's neck, and his blood was dripping from his own and Dicky's clothing; so she was justified in thinking him quite dead. She turned upon one of her two footmen, like a fury.

"Take the best horse in the stable," said she, "and ride toward Saltire Castle. Kill your horse, if need be, but overtake Gerald Harrison and tell him Andrew Hogg has killed his son!" And the man ran out instantly.

They carried Richard into Lady Alicia's own room, and sent the other footman for a physician; and meanwhile the lady and Dicky Dirk, who had spoken not a word since coming into the house, worked together to stanch the flow of blood. Presently the Farnham apothecary came, and relieved them of their task. He was well-skilled in dealing with wounds, as were most of the surgeons of that day, and he worked long

and patiently before Richard's condition was to his liking. It was ten o'clock when he turned to Lady Alicia and said:

"No vital part was touched, my Lady; it was almost a miracle. With the best of nursing, the lad will live."

"Thank God!" the lady gasped, but Dicky, turning in silence, left the house and went swaying off across the fields toward Sladden's farm. Notwithstanding his disability he got over the ground rapidly, and it was less than an hour later when, under his hand, the heavy iron knocker woke the sleeping echoes of the farmhouse. He knocked continuously until he heard footsteps within, and then stood waiting.

✦

REFLECTION

With his father gone, Richard is ambushed on the road by Hogg and his three men. He proposes a fair duel and is winning it when the others rush in, disarm him, and hold him while Hogg runs him through. Richard meets death standing straight and smiling. His last defiant act is for Mary. A strange howl from the thicket scares the superstitious killers away. It is Dicky Dirk, the man everyone overlooks, who carries Richard to Farnham Court, where a skilled apothecary declares he will live. The violence is vivid, but the chapter's heart is courage and loyalty. Wattles sets the cowardice of a gang beside the steadiness of one young man, and he turns the despised outsider into the hero of the hour.

PRACTICE

Dicky was ignored by almost everyone, yet he was the one who acted. Who in your life or community is easy to overlook? This week, take time to really notice them, and ask what you might learn from them.

KEY THOUGHT

he was young, and he loved, and it was hard to die.

MY OWN NOTES

Chapter Six

SLADDEN HIMSELF opened the door a very little; but a heavy fist was dashed against it, sending it flying wide, and Dicky Dirk came lurching in. The cripple's hands and face were stained with blood, and his clothing was soaked with it; his manner showed excitement, and his look was wild and fierce. The farmer, knowing well the strength of those long and hairy arms, kept out of his way, staring in blank amazement.

"Where's Mistress Mary?" demanded Dicky.

"What's that to you?" growled Sladden. "Get out, you villain; I want to lock my door again."

"Will zee Mistress Mary," said Dicky.

"You can't see her, you bloody ruffian! What pot-house brawl have you been into? Get out. Mistress Mary has been in her bed these two hours."

"Call her."

"Now, curse your impudence! Get out, or I'll call help to throw you out. What do you want with her?"

"I'll call her zelf," said Dicky, starting toward the stairway. He knew the house well, having been often employed there. Sladden sprang before him with an oath, but the cripple put his hand on his knife and came on, and the Squire stepped aside. Dicky went up the stairs, and knocked at Mary's door, and it was quickly opened by the girl herself. She had been sitting at the window, looking at the moon and dreaming

of her lover, and was fully dressed. She cried out, when she saw her bloody visitor.

"Dicky," she said sharply, "is it Richard?"

"Ay," said Dicky. "T' hog met un on t' high rowd, an' t' four fought un, an' run swourd through un." She leaned against the wall, with her face as white as snow.

"Is he dead?" she whispered, trembling.

"I carried un on back to Farnham Court," Dicky replied, "an' t' leech says a'll live, if un has good nursin'." The color came back to her face with a rush.

"Why, that he shall have, Dicky!" said she. "Wait you for me," and she began throwing some of her apparel into a portmanteau. When it was filled she turned again to the cripple, who stood waiting at the door.

"Take me to Farnham Court," said she, and they went down the stair together. Sladden, with two of the farm-hands whom he had called, was waiting in the hall below.

"What does this mean?" he asked, astonished. "Where are you going?"

"I am going to Richard Harrison," she said, "who was attacked upon the road to-night by that cowardly murderer Andrew Hogg and his crew, no doubt with your full knowledge and connivance."

"You shameless hussy! Will you go to him unwed?" Her cheek grew hot, and her eye flashed hotter still.

"Dicky," said she, "if yonder man lifts hand to stop me, kill him!"

"I wull!" growled Dicky, drawing his great knife and lurching forward; and Sladden and his bumpkins backed against the wall and let them pass. It was midnight when they reached Farnham Court, where Lady Alicia greeted Mary with joyful astonishment, and yet with an anxious face.

"How is Richard?" were the girl's first words.

"He is conscious, Mary; full of hope and courage, but very weak from the great loss of blood."

"But will he live?"

"With proper nursing; so the surgeon says."

"I have come to nurse him." Lady Alicia looked perplexed.

"But Mary—" she said, and hesitated. She was thinking of Andrew Hogg, and the fear possessed her that when he heard of Mary's presence at Richard's bedside he would come in a rage to finish his work and carry the girl away. And Mary, seeing her hesitation and remembering Sladden's insult, misunderstood her. She raised her head high, and turned instantly to Dicky Dirk.

"Dicky," said she, "will you do me a kindness?"

"Ay," said Dicky, promptly.

"Then go to Farnham parsonage for Vicar Slade, and bring him here; bring him, Dicky, whether he will or no. Tell him he is to marry me to Richard Harrison, and then we shall see who will keep a wife from her husband."

Dicky wavered out into the night, and Mary turned again to Lady Alicia, with a heaving breast and a triumphant look.

"Will any one have a better right than I?" she demanded.

The lady's eyes shone as she clasped the girl in her arms and kissed her.

"It was not of that I was thinking, Mary," said she. "But of—well, never mind; you have chosen the right way." She turned suddenly to the sleepy footman, who was sitting in the hall.

"Thomas," she said, "what weapons have we in the house?"

"Only a couple of muskets, my Lady."

"Load them, and bring them here, and keep the front door barred. Let no one enter until you are certain that he is a friend."

"You fear Hogg?" said Mary. "I had not thought of him."

"God send Gerald Harrison back before Black Andrew hears of this!" said Lady Alicia. They put their arms around each other, and went up to the door of Richard's room, and the woman who was watching whispering to them that he had fallen asleep, they sat down outside to wait. After a little time, Dicky Dirk came, leading the shivering

clergyman by the arm. Vicar Slade was a typical parson of those times; a fox-hunting, gambling, hard-drinking man of the world, very much more rogue than saint; the type of ecclesiastic who brought religion into disrepute, and drove men like Gerald Harrison to the profession of open atheism. In common with all of Farnham, the Vicar was much afraid of Andrew Hogg, and it was evident that he was badly frightened; his clothing was disheveled, and Dicky grasped him tightly above the elbow.

"A was feard o' t' hog," said Dicky, "an' wouldn't come; zo I browt un."

"This is a most outrageous proceeding, Lady Alicia," said the clergyman in a quivering voice.

"It is not Lady Alicia's doing, Mr. Slade," said Mary, gently. "It was I who sent for you, to exercise your holy office in marrying me to Richard Harrison. Let him loose, Dicky."

"No," said Dicky, "a'll run off." And he kept his grip upon the parson's arm.

"I know enough of all this," quavered the vicar, "to be aware that I must answer to Andrew Hogg if I marry you."

"Must answer to me if ee doan't," said Dicky, putting his hand on his knife.

"You are surely between two fires, Mr. Slade," said Lady Alicia, smiling in spite of herself, at the man's terror, "for without doubt Dicky will do you a mischief if you refuse to perform this ceremony."

"That I wull!" growled Dicky.

"I call upon you to witness then," said Slade, "that I do it under compulsion, and in fear for my life. If you have a prayer-book in the house, Lady Alicia, have it fetched; and then I am ready, since I must."

They sat waiting until Richard awoke, and then went together into his room, Dicky keeping near the parson, with a watchful eye upon him. When Mistress Mary saw the white face upon the pillow she came very near losing the self-possession she had retained so bravely. She stopped short, and stood for an instant with both her clenched hands pressed

against her throat. Then she went quickly to the bedside, and bent above him, smiling. And seeing who it was, he looked with wonder for a moment, and then smiled back at her.

"Angel!" he whispered softly. She stooped, and laid her cheek against his.

"Richard, my dear love," said she, "do not try to move or speak. You are sorely hurt, and I have come to be with you night and day. And I have brought the parson to marry us, if you will have me, Richard."

"Will I?" he whispered, smiling. "Ay, and be run through fifty times to get the chance." She put her finger on his lips.

"You are only to say yes and no, sir," said she, "and not to excite yourself at all. Do you understand?"

"Yes and no, sir," said he. She drew a ring from her finger, and placed it under the poor nerveless hand, which lay upon the cover.

"It was my mother's wedding ring, and shall be mine," she said. "When the time comes, I can slip my finger into it; do not try to raise your hand. Dicky, you have been our friend this night, and you shall give me away. Go on, Mr. Slade; we are ready."

So they were married, with Lady Alicia and the serving-woman for witnesses; and Dicky Dirk gave the bride away. Then Mary put them all out of the room, and sitting down beside her husband, held his hand and sang to him softly until he went to sleep again. Day was breaking when all this was over, and Lady Alicia sat down in the hall, with her one footman and her two loaded muskets, to watch for Andrew Hogg, while Dicky Dirk hurried off across the fields, weaving from side to side and clutching at the air in his haste, and reaching the gates of Hackthorn Hall, sat down to wait for Gerald Harrison.

REFLECTION

Covered in blood, Dicky bursts into Sladden's house to tell Mary. She packs a bag, faces down her stepfather with Dicky's knife as protection, and hurries to Richard's side. When Lady Alicia hesitates, Mary takes it as a doubt about her honor and sends Dicky to drag the frightened Vicar Slade from his bed. She marries Richard at his bedside, using her mother's ring, with Dicky giving her away. Wattles makes the vicar a "fox-hunting, gambling, hard-drinking" clergyman. That reflects his criticism of religion as hollow office rather than living faith, which he believed drove sincere people to unbelief. The forced ceremony is pure melodrama. Its real point is Mary's decisiveness: once her heart is sure, she acts at once, without asking anyone's permission.

PRACTICE

Mary acted the moment she was certain. Is there a commitment you keep weighing without deciding? Write down what would make you sure, and one small step you could take today to find out.

KEY THOUGHT

and then we shall see who will
keep a wife from her husband.

MY OWN NOTES

Chapter Seven

HARRISON AND his escort rode in a leisurely fashion along the road to Saltire Castle, beguiling the time with pleasant conversation. The night air was cool and fresh, and the moon was shining brilliantly. The two gentlemen rode abreast in front, with the troopers following a little way behind. It was past midnight, and they had come in sight of the lights of Shoresby, where they were to rest until morning, when they heard a horse galloping hard behind them, and drew rein to see what the occasion of such haste might be. And the rider proved to be Lady Alicia's footman, bare-headed and splashed with mud, who rode up and spoke to Harrison.

"My Lady sent me, sir," said he, "to tell you that Andrew Hogg has killed your son." And he added: "I saw his body brought in."

Captain Keatley cried out in horrified astonishment, and turned sharply to Harrison. An instant comprehension of the whole plot came to the Virginian. He realized that Lady Alicia had been right, and that the King's invitation had been procured to get him out of the way while his son was murdered. But whatever passed in his mind, his countenance did not change in the least, and his voice was calm and natural as he answered:

"Ah! In that case, much as I regret to lose your pleasant company, Captain, I suppose I must turn back." He waited an instant for a reply, and then slowly turned his horse about.

Captain Keatley hesitated in some perplexity. He had been very favorably impressed by Harrison, and he felt a keen sympathy for the man who met such dreadful news with so gallant and unwavering a front; and also, there began to dawn upon his mind a suspicion that he, himself, had been made an instrument in carrying out some vile plot. On the other hand, he had his instructions from Cunningham, and his almost superstitious reverence for the King's command, and, for a moment, he could not decide between his sympathy and what he conceived to be his duty. As the American started his horse on the backward way, Keatley found voice, and said:

"But, sir, his Majesty ordered me to bring you to him, and if I return without you, what shall I tell him?"

Harrison slowly turned his horse about again, coming face to face with the soldier; he rode up until his horse's head overlapped the captain's thigh, and their faces were scarcely twelve inches apart. The moonlight fell full on the Virginian's countenance; he was smiling pleasantly, but Keatley's blood ran cold as he caught his look, for his eyes were like coals of fire, yet when he spoke his voice was soft and low.

"Tell him," said Harrison, "to go to Hell!" Captain Keatley leaned backward as if he had received a blow, and uttered an exclamation of horror.

"And tell him," the other went on, "that if I had believed you to be a co-conspirator with Andrew Hogg in this, I would have run my sword through you the instant I had the news. Good morning, Captain." He wheeled his horse about for the third time, and rode back past the troopers in a walk, and no one lifted a hand to hinder him. Captain Keatley rode on to Saltire Castle, and reported simply that Harrison had turned back on hearing of the death of his son, and that he had thought it right to let him go. So great was his admiration for the American's courage that he never mentioned the affront which had been offered to Royalty.

Once out of earshot of his escort, Harrison gave his horse the spur, leaving Lady Alicia's man to follow at a slower pace, and rode with all speed toward Farnham. At the first tavern he secured a fresh mount, leaving his own steed for the serving-man to bring along. What passed with him during that lonely ride, whether he laughed or cried or kept his stoical composure through it all, no one will ever know. He dearly loved his son, and he believed him dead, and his heart must have burned with a fierce lust for vengeance upon the murderers, but when, in the early morning, he sprang from his saddle at the Blue Goose Inn, his face was as serene as ever. He went straight to his apartment, exchanging no word with any one, and there he removed all traces of his rapid ride by a bath and a change of garments. The sun was just rising when, immaculately dressed, and with every frill and ruffle in its place, with his hair freshly powdered and his rosy cheek smooth shaved, he set off afoot and at a careless pace toward Hackthorn Hall. No one was astir at the inn save the lout of a stable-boy who had taken his horse. No one yet knew of the happenings overnight, and so he went on, still believing that his son was dead. As he entered the gate of Hackthorn Hall, Dicky Dirk rose up beside him.

"Been waitin' for ee," said Dicky.

"How came you so bloody?" asked Harrison.

"Picked up thy boy."

"Hah! Yes. Well, Dicky, what do you want with me?"

"To zee ee kill Hogg."

"No, Dicky," said Harrison, "I will do this work quite alone. I want neither help nor spectators." He was about to start on, but Dicky stopped him by throwing up one of his huge hands.

"Look ee!" he said, and his hoarse voice trembled in a sudden outburst of rage, "Hogg broak ma back; killed ma fayther with swourd, an' broak ma moader's heart. I've carried dirk for vifteen year to kill un, an' by Goad, I'll zee un die." Harrison stood quite still for a moment, gazing into the cripple's passion-distorted face.

"Ay, ay?" said he. "Well, Dicky, your claim seems to take precedence over mine; though I am sorry for it. Come on, then, you shall not only see him die, but you may finish him yourself." He started on, and Dicky followed at his heels.

They walked slowly up the gravelled drive which led to the house, a strangely paired couple indeed; the smiling, splendid gentleman, looking about him with an air of half indifferent interest as he sauntered along, and behind him the blood-stained cripple, beating the air with his huge hands, and making fearful grimaces in the sudden giving way to his long hidden hatred of black Andrew Hogg.

Hogg and his men had held high carnival all night, celebrating the murder of Richard, and as day was breaking they had decided that Trainor should stand guard in the grounds with his pistol, against the possible coming of Harrison, while the others went to sleep. They had been in their beds but an hour or so when the Virginian arrived, and Trainor, sitting at the foot of a great tree beside the driveway, was drowsing also, with an empty bottle beside him. So Harrison walked up to him, and stood for a moment looking down at the nodding head and bandaged face.

"Kick him awake," he said to Dicky, and the cripple brought one of his heavy hands down on the sleeper's head with a resounding slap. Trainor leaped to his feet on the instant, and seeing at the first glance who his visitors were, he proved his readiness by firing his pistol, which had been ready in his hand, point blank at Harrison. The Virginian sprang aside, and Dicky struck up the fellow's arm, so the bullet went wide of the mark, and Harrison, whipping out his sword, ran the man through. He fell upon the driveway, and Dicky, bending over him and seeing that the sword-thrust had gone rather low, drove his dirk with great precision through the ruffian's heart. Harrison drew a handkerchief from his pocket and wiped his sword carefully before sheathing it; and Dicky wiped his knife upon his bloody sleeve.

"You seem to have a good workman's taste in these matters, Dicky," said the American as they started on. "You do not like to leave an imperfectly finished job behind you."

When they came to the front of the house, Harrison paused and inspected the silent building reflectively; he expected to be fired at from the windows, but nothing of the kind happened, and there was no sign of life.

"They must be still asleep," he said to Dicky. "I wish we had a way to break down the door."

"Wait," said the cripple, shambling off around the house, and presently he came back carrying a great axe. He went up the steps, and swinging the tool with all the strength of his powerful arms, began to batter at the lock of the heavy oaken door. The sound of the crashing blows reverberated through the house like thunder, and Harrison kept close watch upon the windows, but still he saw no sign of life. Presently, the thick wood about the lock having been beaten to fragments, the door swung open, and the Virginian stepped in with Dicky close behind him.

✦

REFLECTION

On the moonlit road, Lady Alicia's footman reaches Harrison with news that his son is dead. Harrison grasps the whole plot at once, yet his face does not change. When Captain Keatley asks what to tell the King, Harrison gives a shocking answer, and the honest soldier, moved by his courage, lets him go. Harrison rides back through the night, bathes, dresses immaculately, and walks to Hackthorn Hall. There Dicky claims an older right to Hogg's death, and the two kill the drowsy guard. Wattles admires composure under pressure. A modern reader may also see grief hidden behind a mask and turned into vengeance outside any law. If loss hits you hard, sharing it with a trusted person or a counselor is often wiser than carrying it alone.

PRACTICE

Harrison kept every feeling hidden. Is outward calm always strength? Think of a recent hard moment. Who could you have told how you really felt, and what might have changed if you had?

KEY THOUGHT

his face was as serene as ever.

MY OWN NOTES

Chapter Eight

FROM ACROSS the entrance hall came three pistol shots in quick succession, but the bullets whistled harmlessly above Harrison's head, for the nerves of Hogg and his two remaining scoundrels were not in condition for effective target practice. After carousing until nearly daylight, they had been aroused out of their first drunken sleep by Dicky's crashing blows upon the door, and tumbling out of bed half-dressed, as they had retired, they had run down the stairs carrying swords and pistols. When Harrison stepped inside the door they fired hastily, and now, their firearms which had been their chief reliance against the terrible Virginian, being empty and useless they dashed them to the floor and drew their swords. They were truly a loathsome sight as they stood huddled together by the farther wall; their uncombed hair hung in tangled masses about their bloated and desperate faces, and the fear in their burning eyes was like that of rats caught in a trap. Stepping at once between them and the stairway, Harrison came on, smiling and calm. At a little distance from them he halted and drew his sword, and then clapping it under his arm, took a pinch of snuff. Returning the box to his pocket, and carefully brushing off a speck which had fallen on the front of his ruffled shirt, he saluted courteously.

"Good morning, gentlemen," said he. "I am sorry to disturb you so early, but my business is urgent; I have come to rob the hangman of a job."

At that, Andrew Hogg knowing that he must fight for his life as he had never fought before, burst out in cursing and sprang forward, calling out to his men, and the three fell upon Harrison. And now Dicky Dirk, looking on, saw such an exhibition of skill in fence as few have witnessed in this world. Harrison's sword became a glittering wall of steel; it seemed to encase him from head to foot like a suit of armor. He did not leap and spring about to dodge their thrusts, but stood still, beating aside their blades with his own flying weapon. His quickness of eye and hand, his strength of arm and wrist, were marvellous; it was the skill of a wizard, a prestidigitator, rather than that of a merely expert swordsman. They could not reach him with their thrusts or blows, they could not even make him give back an inch, or step aside; and they were compelled to keep in front of him by Dicky, who, whenever one of them stepped out to take the fencer on the side, came quickly in behind the fellow and made him jump toward the front again for fear of getting the huge dirk between his shoulders. And so the fight went on for several minutes.

Then Harrison laughed out suddenly, a ringing laugh, which echoed through the house above the sound of clashing steel, and panting breaths, and muttered curses.

"It is time," he said. "Let us finish." He made a quick forward stroke with his sword, so deadly swift that the blade sung with a shrill whistling note; and one of the two henchmen of Andrew Hogg went down with his throat cut, his head being nearly severed from his body.

"*Richard!*" said Harrison softly, and though he smiled, his eyes were terrible to see. Another lightning stroke pierced the other ruffian through the heart, and Andrew, now mad with fear, faced Harrison alone. The Virginian dropped the point of his sword and stepped back.

"Hogg," said he, "I came to kill you; but I found Dicky on the same errand, and his rights to be your executioner seem to precede mine. You made him fatherless and motherless, and the crawling, staggering thing he is, while you have only made me childless. Dicky shall kill you,

Hogg, but I will put out your eyes first. On guard!" And they crossed swords again.

It was soon over. Two dextrous strokes of the razor-edged blade, and the point was slashed through each of Andrew's eyes; he dropped his sword and clapped his hands to his bloody face, howling with pain and fright; and Dicky, laughing as fiends may laugh in hell, lurched forward, and driving his great knife through the black villain's heart, left it sticking there.

They left the house without a word, and walked out to the highway. There Harrison paused, and said quietly:

"Is my son's body at Lady Alicia's, Dicky?"

"A' bain't no boady," said Dicky. "A's livin'."

"What?" cried Harrison sharply, startled for once out of his composure.

"I zaw Hogg run un through, right yonder," said Dicky, "while t'others held un fast; a' stood straight, an' spit in t' hog's face when swourd went home. I picked un oop, an' carried un vor dead to Farnham Court; but t' leech says un'll live, if has good nursin'."

"Now, by all the gods!" cried Harrison. "But this is the greatest news man ever told to man! Good nursing, sayest thou? Why, that he shall have, Dicky."

"Zo Mistress Mary zaid," said Dicky.

"What?"

"I went to t' farm at midnight," said the cripple, "an' to her bedroom door, an' told her. 'Why then,' says she, 'good nursin' he shall have,' an' packed her portmantle. Sladden would stop her, an' says she, 'Dicky, kill him.' Zo I pulled dirk, an' Sladden run."

"Go on, thou bravest-hearted knight that ever stood by lady in distress," said Harrison. "What happened next?"

"When we coom to t' Court," said Dicky, "t' Lady was for not lettin' maid stay; an' Mistress Mary zaid to me, 'Dicky, go bring Parson Slade to

marry me to Richard; we'll zee who keeps wife from her husband.' Zo I browt parson, and a' married un."

"Now, by all the gods!" said Harrison again, but very softly now, and somewhat as if he choked, "but here's a lady! A right noble lady, on my soul! And what more, prince of story-tellers?"

"No more," said Dicky. "I came here to wait for 'ee. An' now t' hog is dead I've nowt to stay here for; will 'ee tak me to Ferginny?"

"Will I take you? Ay, that I will. Whither I go, thou shalt go, and my people shall be thy people; unfortunately for the rest of the quotation, I have no God, but if ever I find one, he shall be thy God also, Dicky."

"Doan't woant no Goad," said Dicky Dirk.

Lady Alicia, still watching with her loaded musket, greeted Harrison with joyful relief when, serene and smiling, he came a half hour later to Farnham Court.

"All's well," said she, "now that you are here to protect your own. I have been in dreadful fear lest Hogg should come with his bloody three to finish his work and carry your daughter away."

"Hogg and his bloody three will trouble no one more, Alicia," said he, "for Dicky Dirk and I have been to Hackthorn Hall."

She was silent in awe for a moment, well knowing what his words implied.

"What word did you send the King, when you turned back?" she asked. He laughed at this, truly a woman's question at such a time.

"I sent him word," said he, "that he might go to Hell!" Lady Alicia, trained to the greatest reverence for Royalty, cried out in horror.

"Do not be alarmed, my dear Alicia," said Harrison, taking snuff. "Now that things have turned out so much better than I thought, I shall not insist upon his going; I will write Wycherly this morning to tell him so. And now, how is Richard?"

"Doing well, and happy in the love of his dear young wife; thank God!"

"Why then," said Hell-fire Harrison, "it will be the first time in forty years, but I think, Alicia, that I shall have to say Amen!"

✦

REFLECTION

The climax is brutal. Harrison holds off Hogg's men behind a wall of steel and kills two of them. He blinds Hogg, and Dicky finishes him. Only afterward does Harrison learn that Richard is alive, and that Mary has married him. For once his composure breaks. Overjoyed, he promises to take Dicky to Virginia, borrowing the Book of Ruth's words of loyalty, though he jokes that he has no God to share. The novel ends with the old cynic admitting that, for the first time in forty years, he must say "Amen." Whatever one thinks of the revenge, the arc is clear. A man who pretended to believe in nothing is softened by love and gratitude, a turn that fits Wattles' lifelong teaching on thankfulness.

PRACTICE

The cynic ends in thankfulness. What good thing in your life deserves your own "Amen" today? Write it down in a sentence or two, and say thank you to someone connected with it.

KEY THOUGHT

it will be the first time in forty years, but I think, Alicia, that I shall have to say Amen!

MY OWN NOTES

The 30-Day Practice

Wattles believed that ideas change a life only when they become habits, and that habits are built one ordinary day at a time. This practice gives you thirty such days.

Each day has a short passage from Wattles, a note telling you where it comes from, and a simple task. Read the passage slowly, perhaps twice. Then do the task and write a few lines on the ruled page. What did you notice? What was hard? What, if anything, changed? Fifteen minutes is enough. If you miss a day, just carry on. You are not taking a test.

The four weeks follow the shape of Wattles' teaching. Week one is about vision and the Certain Way: knowing what you want and why. Week two turns to gratitude, faith and the will. Week three is about action: doing today's work well, giving more than you take, and living what Wattles called the advancing life. Week four widens the circle to health habits, greatness of character, service and love, and the last two days are for looking back and looking ahead.

Two notes before you start. None of these tasks asks you to fast, skip meals or change your diet. If a health question comes up, talk to a doctor. And if a day touches something heavy, such as money worries, illness or grief, it is fine to go gently, to talk with someone you trust, or to seek professional help. The practice exists to serve you.

DAY

1

The Desire to Live More

The desire for riches is really the desire for a richer, fuller, and more abundant life; and that desire is praiseworthy.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, THE RIGHT TO BE RICH

Wattles says we live for the body, the mind and the soul. Draw three columns with those headings and write down what "more life" would mean in each. Leave money out of it for now. Notice which column is easiest to fill and which is hardest.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

2

A Certain Way

From all these things, we must come to the conclusion that getting rich is the result of doing things in a Certain Way.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, THERE IS A SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH

Wattles thought the way you do things mattered more than talent or circumstance. Circumstances matter too, but think about what is in your hands. List three ways of working, speaking or deciding that you would like to make your own "certain way." Choose one and practice it today.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

3

First in Thought

All the forms that man fashions with his hands must first exist in his thought; he cannot shape a thing until he has thought that thing.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, THE FIRST PRINCIPLE IN THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH

Think of one thing you have made or achieved: a meal, a garden, a finished project. Trace it back to the moment it was only an idea. Then write down one idea you are carrying right now that has not yet taken shape.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

4

Create, Don't Compete

You are to create, not to compete
for what is already created.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, INCREASING LIFE

Notice today when you feel you are in a race against someone, for attention, credit, a sale or a place in line. Each time, ask: what could I add here instead of trying to win? Write down one moment where the question changed what you did.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

5

A Clear Picture

You must form a clear and definite mental picture of what you want; you cannot transmit an idea unless you have it yourself.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, THINKING IN THE CERTAIN WAY

Write one paragraph describing something you want as if it were already part of your life. Make it concrete: where you are, what you are doing, who is with you. Leave out vague words like "better" or "more." Read it once tonight.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

6

What Your Desire Tells You

The fact that you want to be is proof that you can be.

MAKING THE MAN WHO CAN, WHAT YOU DESIRE

You may see Wattles' claim as a promise or as a clue. Name one thing you have long wanted to be or do. Ask what ability or interest that wish points to, and write one small step that would let that ability grow this week.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

7

Keep Your Face Toward It

That clear mental picture you must have continually in mind, as the sailor has in mind the port toward which he is sailing the ship; you must keep your face toward it all the time.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, THINKING IN THE CERTAIN WAY

Look back over the week. Reread your picture from Day 5 and refine it if you like. Then choose a small reminder that will bring it to mind during the day, such as a note in your wallet or a word on your phone's lock screen.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

8

The Habit of Thanks

It is necessary, then, to cultivate the habit of being grateful for every good thing that comes to you; and to give thanks continuously.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, GRATITUDE

Tonight write down ten things from today that you are grateful for, however small: a kind word, a hot drink, a bus that came on time. Try to name each one specifically. Notice how you feel when you finish.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

9

Looking at the Best

The grateful mind is constantly fixed upon the best; therefore it tends to become the best; it takes the form or character of the best, and will receive the best.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, GRATITUDE

Choose one person you find difficult. Write down three genuine good qualities they have, or three things you have received through them. Gratitude does not excuse real harm, so if the person has hurt you, choose someone else.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

10

Faith Grows from Gratitude

Gratitude has a twofold effect; it strengthens your own faith, and it brings you into close and harmonious relations with the Supreme.

THE SCIENCE OF BEING WELL, FAITH

Whatever your beliefs, take five quiet minutes to give thanks, whether in prayer, in words spoken aloud, or in a letter you do not send. Afterward write down whether your confidence in the day ahead feels any different.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

11

The Will Turned Inward

That is the legitimate use of the will in getting what you want—to use it in holding yourself to the right course.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, HOW TO USE THE WILL

Wattles warns against using willpower to push other people. Today use yours only on yourself. Pick one commitment you made earlier this week and keep it, especially at the moment you would rather not. Write down what that moment felt like.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

12

Choosing Your Attention

The sole legitimate use of the will is in determining to what you shall give your attention, and what you shall think about the things to which your attention is given.

THE SCIENCE OF BEING WELL, USE OF THE WILL

Pay attention to what pulls at your attention today: news, feeds, worries, conversations. Three times, deliberately turn your attention to something you have chosen. Note what you turned away from and what you turned toward.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

13

A Little Stillness

Get by yourself in the quietest place you can find, and where you may be free from interruption for a little while.

THE NEW SCIENCE OF LIVING AND HEALING, NATURE AND DEVELOPMENT OF WILL POWER

Find ten minutes of quiet, even if that means a parked car or a closed bathroom door. Sit, breathe and do nothing else. Don't try to solve anything. Afterward write a line or two about how you feel.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

14

The Habit of Thought

It is the habitual, not the periodical thought that decides your destiny.

THE SCIENCE OF BEING GREAT, HURRY AND HABIT

Look back over week two. Which thought about yourself do you repeat most often? Write it down honestly. Then write a fairer and more hopeful version that is still true, and repeat it to yourself at least five times today.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

15

Act Where You Are

You cannot act where you are not; you cannot act where you have been, and you cannot act where you are going to be; you can act only where you are.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, ACTING IN THE CERTAIN WAY

Make a short list of what is actually in front of you today: tasks, people, choices. Choose one thing you have been putting off until conditions are better, and do the first part of it now.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

16

Efficient Action

Do, every day, all that you can do that day, and do each act in an efficient manner.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, EFFICIENT ACTION

Wattles also says you are "not to overwork." So choose three tasks for today and no more, and do each one with your full attention and as well as you can. In the evening, note which of them felt strongest and why.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

17

Use What You Have

Do not waste any time considering how you would use certain things if you had them; consider, simply, how to use what you have.

HOW TO GET WHAT YOU WANT, THE RIGHT WAY TO GET WHAT YOU WANT

Make an honest list of the resources you already have, such as skills, time, contacts, tools and experience. Circle one that you are underusing. Write down one way to put it to work this week.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

18

More Than You Take

Give every man more in use value than you take from him in cash value; then you are adding to the life of the world by every business transaction.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, HOW RICHES COME TO YOU

Think of one person you serve, whether a customer, a colleague, a client or a family member. Ask what would make what you give them more useful in their life, not just more impressive. Do one such thing today.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

19

Never Hurry

Go as fast as you can, but never hurry.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, GETTING INTO THE RIGHT BUSINESS

Each time you catch yourself rushing today, stop for one breath. Bring your goal to mind and think of one thing you are thankful for. Then go on at a steady pace. Count how many times you caught it.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

20

The Impression of Increase

Convey the impression of advancement with everything you do, so that all people shall receive the impression that you are an Advancing Man, and that you advance all who deal with you.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, THE IMPRESSION OF INCREASE

In each conversation today, try to leave the other person a little better off: an encouraging word, a useful idea, real interest in their plans. Don't boast and don't pretend. Write down one exchange that felt different.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

21

Take the Next Step

Do not wait for an opportunity to be all that you want to be; when an opportunity to be more than you are now is presented and you feel impelled toward it, take it.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, THE ADVANCING MAN

Look back over week three. Is there an opportunity in front of you right now that is smaller than your dream but larger than where you are? Write it down, along with what is holding you back and the first step you could take.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

22

Breathe

Straighten up; fill your lungs FULL; stretch your chest and straighten your spine, and exhale easily.

THE SCIENCE OF BEING WELL, BREATHING

Three times today, stop and do what this line describes, comfortably and without strain. If possible, do it once outdoors. If you have a lung or heart condition, keep it gentle. Notice how your mood changes, if it does.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

23

Rest

It is in sleep that the brain of man is recharged with vital energy, and the Principle of Health within him is given new strength.

THE SCIENCE OF BEING WELL, SLEEP

Tonight, give yourself a calmer last half-hour before bed. Put screens away, let in some fresh air if that is comfortable and safe, and choose a peaceful thought to fall asleep with. In the morning, note how you slept. If sleep is a long-standing struggle, consider talking to a doctor.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

24

One Unhurried Meal

Do not anticipate the taste of the next thing; keep your mind centered on the taste of what you have in your mouth.

THE SCIENCE OF BEING WELL, HOW TO EAT

Eat one of your normal meals today slowly and with attention, without changing what or how much you eat. Put your phone away and notice the taste. Give thanks before you begin, if you like. Write down what you noticed.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

25

No Common People

There are undreamed of possibilities in the common lives all around us; in a large sense, there are no "common" people.

THE SCIENCE OF BEING GREAT, ANY PERSON MAY BECOME GREAT

Choose someone you see often but rarely think about, such as a neighbor, a cashier or a coworker. Today, pay real attention to them, ask a sincere question, and listen. Write down one thing you learned.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

26

Greatness at Home

It is a great person who can always be poised, assured, calm, and perfectly kind and considerate at home.

THE SCIENCE OF BEING GREAT, ACTION AT HOME

Choose one moment at home today, at a meal, when you arrive or at bedtime, and be at your calmest and kindest in it. Wattles also warns against meddling, so go one day without correcting anyone's habits. Note what happens.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

27

A Great Servant

Lincoln was a great man because
he knew how to be a great servant.

THE SCIENCE OF BEING GREAT, JESUS' IDEA OF GREATNESS

Do one act of service today that makes use of your real strengths. Do it freely and without making yourself small, and without expecting thanks. Then write down what it gave you and what it gave the other person.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

28

Love Your Neighbor

If I love her as myself, I will desire pie for her as intensely as for myself, and I will try as hard to get it for her as for myself.

A NEW CHRIST, HIS TEACHINGS ABOUT WEALTH

Think of someone close to you and something good you want for yourself. Ask honestly whether you want that good for them just as much. Then take one concrete step toward it on their behalf.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

29

Looking Back

Too much stress cannot be laid on the importance of frequent contemplation of the mental image, coupled with unwavering faith and devout gratitude.

THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH, SUMMARY OF THE SCIENCE OF GETTING RICH

Read through your notes from the past four weeks. Mark the three days that meant the most to you and the one that was hardest. Write down what you have learned about your vision, your gratitude and your way of acting.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

DAY

30

Small Things, Right Course

As he sees the true and right course in small things, he must take that course.

THE SCIENCE OF BEING GREAT, A SUMMARY OF THE SCIENCE OF BEING GREAT

Choose three practices from this month to keep. Write each one down with a time and place it will happen. Then pick a date about a month from now to come back to these pages and see how you are doing.

TODAY I WILL

☐ read ☐ held my vision ☐ one step taken

Quick Finder

Find the situation that fits your day, then turn to the chapters and practice days listed beside it.

When you feel stuck at work — The Science of Getting Rich: Acting in the Certain Way; Making the Man Who Can: Promoting Yourself · Day 15, 21

When you don't know what you really want — The Science of Getting Rich: Thinking in the Certain Way; Making the Man Who Can: What You Desire; How to Get What You Want: Concluding Thoughts · Day 5, 6

When you feel guilty about wanting more — The Science of Getting Rich: The Right to Be Rich; The Science of Getting Rich: Increasing Life · Day 1

When money worries crowd your mind — The Science of Getting Rich: Is Opportunity Monopolized?; The Science of Getting Rich: Gratitude · Day 8, 17

When you are thinking about changing careers — The Science of Getting Rich: Getting into the Right Business; How to Get What You Want: The Right Way to Get What You Want · Day 17

When you want to start small — How to Get What You Want: The Right Way to Get What You Want; Making the Man Who Can: Becoming What You Want to Be · Day 17, 30

When you are always in a hurry — The Science of Getting Rich: Getting into the Right Business; The Science of Being Great: Hurry and Habit · Day 19

When you have lost your sense of gratitude — The Science of Getting Rich: Gratitude; The Science of Being Well: Faith · Day 8, 9, 10

When doubt creeps in — The Science of Getting Rich: How to Use the Will; The Science of Getting Rich: Further Use of the Will · Day 11

When your thoughts run away with you — The Science of Being Well: Use of the Will; The New Science of Living and Healing: Nature and Development of Will Power · Day 12, 13

When you want to pray or meditate — The New Science of Living and Healing: Nature and Development of Will Power; A New Christ: Attaining Cosmic Consciousness; The Science of Being Great: A Mental Exercise · Day 13

When you run your own business — The Science of Getting Rich: How Riches Come to You; The Science of Getting Rich: The Impression of Increase; Making the Man Who Can: The Advancing Thought · Day 18, 20

When you are tempted to win at someone else's expense — The Science of Getting Rich: Increasing Life; The Science of Getting Rich: How Riches Come to You · Day 4, 18

When you keep putting things off — The Science of Getting Rich: Acting in the Certain Way; The Science of Getting Rich: Efficient Action · Day 15, 16

When you catch yourself talking yourself down — Making the Man Who Can: Talk That Builds; The Science of Getting Rich: Some Cautions, and Concluding Observations · Day 14

When a plan falls through — The Science of Getting Rich: Some Cautions, and Concluding Observations; The Science of Being Great: Hurry and Habit · Day 19

When you feel small or ordinary — The Science of Being Great: Any Person May Become Great; The Science of Being Great: Heredity and Opportunity · Day 25

When home life is tense — The Science of Being Great: Action at Home · Day 26

When you give so much to others that nothing is left for you — The Science of Being Great: Action at Home; The Science of Being Great: Serving God · Day 27

When you feel alone or unsure of the next step — The Science of Being Great: Action Abroad; The Science of Being Great: Hurry and Habit · Day 13, 21

When you want calmer daily habits of breath, rest and eating — The Science of Being Well: Breathing; The Science of Being Well: Sleep; The Science of Being Well: How to Eat · Day 22, 23, 24

When you want to understand Wattles' health teaching (as history, not medical advice) — The Science of Being Well: The Principle of Health; The New Science of Living and Healing: The Source of Work-Power · Day 22, 23

When you wonder what Jesus taught about wealth and justice — A New Christ: His Teachings About Wealth; Jesus: The Man and His Work: Jesus: The Man and His Work · Day 28

When you want the philosophy behind it all — What Is Truth?: Substance; What Is Truth?: Man and His Powers; The Science of Getting Rich: The First Principle in the Science of Getting Rich · Day 3

When you need the whole method on one page — The Science of Getting Rich: Summary of the Science of Getting Rich; The Science of Being Well: A Summary of the Science of Being Well; The Science of Being Great: A Summary of the Science of Being Great · Day 29, 30

A Glossary

Advancing Man — Wattles' name for a person who is visibly growing and who helps everyone they deal with to grow as well. He saw this as the best possible reputation in business and in life.

Cash value — The market price of a thing, the money that changes hands. Wattles contrasts it with use value and asks that we always give more in use value than we take in cash value.

Certain Way — Wattles' shorthand for his whole method. It means a clear vision, held with faith and purpose and gratitude, together with efficient action in your present place. He believed results follow from how things are done, not from talent or luck.

Christian socialism — The belief that the ethics of Jesus call for a society of equality and shared access to the earth's wealth. Wattles held this view and expressed it most fully in *A New Christ* and the Jesus lecture.

Competitive plane — The level of thought on which people assume the supply is limited and fight over existing wealth, positions and power. Wattles saw it as the source of hurry, fear and exploitation.

Conception of Health — In *The Science of Being Well*, an understanding of how a healthy person looks, acts and does things, which the reader is asked to hold in mind and live up to. It is not a detailed picture of the organs.

Consecration — In *The Science of Being Great*, the decision to obey the highest and best that one perceives within oneself, without exception.

Cosmic consciousness — A sense of oneness with God and the whole of life. The term was made widely known by Richard Maurice Bucke's book

Cosmic Consciousness (1901), and Wattles uses it in *A New Christ* for the awareness he believed Jesus had and others can attain.

Creative plane — The opposite of the competitive plane. On it a person seeks to create new wealth and value rather than to take what others have, in the belief that there is enough for all.

Dewey, Edward Hooker — An American physician known as "the no-breakfast doctor," whose views on fasting and sleep shaped *The New Science of Living and Healing*. His ideas are historical, not current medical advice.

Efficient action — An act done with full attention and with one's vision and purpose behind it. Wattles held that a life built from such acts, done "without haste, worry, or fear," must succeed.

Elizabeth Towne — A New Thought writer, editor and publisher in Holyoke, Massachusetts, who published *The Nautilus* and most of Wattles' books.

Fletcherism — The practice, made popular around 1900 by the American writer Horace Fletcher, of chewing every mouthful until it is liquid. Wattles recommends it in *The Science of Being Well*.

Formless Substance — The one original, living, intelligent stuff from which, Wattles taught, all things are made. He also calls it Original Substance, Thinking Substance and God.

God among gods — A phrase from *The Science of Being Great*. It describes an attitude of meeting every person as an equal, neither above nor below oneself, in the belief that the same divine nature is in all.

Gratitude, Law of — Wattles' teaching that thankfulness draws the mind into harmony with the source of all good, keeps it fixed on the best, and strengthens faith. He compares it to the principle that action and reaction are equal.

Hurry — For Wattles, a sign that one has slipped from the creative into the competitive mind. His rule is "Go as fast as you can, but never hurry."

Idealization — In *The Science of Being Great*, forming a clear mental picture of oneself at one's best and holding it until it becomes the habitual way of seeing oneself.

Identification — In *The Science of Being Great*, recognizing that one is already one with God and taking that awareness as the ground for action.

Impression of increase — The sense of advancement and growth that Wattles asks us to give every person we meet, in business and outside it.

Inner Light — The guiding perception within each person that, in Wattles' view, impels them toward the right and the best.

Mental image — The clear, definite picture of what one wants, held steadily with faith, purpose and gratitude. It is the starting point of the Certain Way.

Mind-body — In *The Science of Being Well*, the body of "mind-stuff" that Wattles believed permeates and governs the physical body.

Monism — The philosophical view that all things are, at bottom, one Substance. In the Preface to *The Science of Getting Rich* Wattles names it as the foundation of his teaching.

More than filling your present place — Wattles' evolutionary principle of success: do your present work completely and well, and add something beyond it, because growth comes from surplus life.

The Nautilus — Elizabeth Towne's New Thought magazine, published in Holyoke, Massachusetts. Wattles wrote for it, and his series *What Is Truth?* appeared in it in 1909.

New Thought — An American spiritual movement of the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries. It taught that thought shapes life and that health, prosperity and character can be improved by right thinking.

Power-consciousness — In *How to Get What You Want*, the feeling of knowing that you can do a thing and how to do it.

Principle of Health — In *The Science of Being Well*, the life-power within each person that Wattles believed is moved by faith and quickened by thinking in the Certain Way.

Principle of Power — In *The Science of Being Great*, the power of growth in every person, by which, Wattles believed, anyone may develop toward greatness.

Realization — In *The Science of Being Great*, the step from vision to action: expressing the ideal of oneself in everyday deeds.

Swedenborg, Emanuel — A Swedish scientist and mystic (1688–1772) whose idea of a continual inflow of divine life Wattles cites more than once.

Thinking Stuff — Another of Wattles' names for the Formless Substance, used to stress that it thinks and takes the form of its thoughts.

Use value — What a thing is actually worth in someone's life, how much it adds to their living. Wattles asks that every exchange give the other person more use value than the cash value they pay.

Will — In Wattles' teaching, the power to direct one's own attention and thought. He insists it should be used only on oneself, never to pressure other people.

Afterword: The Certain Way Today

More than a century after Wattles wrote, the shelves are full of books that promise to make readers rich, healthy and successful. Many of them descend in one way or another from him. So it is fair to ask what in his teaching still holds up.

Some of it does not. Wattles believed that right thinking would bring wealth "with mathematical certainty," and we now know that life is not an equation. Economies crash. People fall ill. Discrimination, debt and sheer bad luck can defeat the clearest vision and the hardest work. His health advice was the alternative medicine of his day, and much of it is unsafe to follow without a doctor. A reader who takes him literally on every point may end up blaming themselves, or others, for things no one could control. That would be a sad result for a writer who wanted more life for everyone.

Much else in his books has worn remarkably well. Know what you want, clearly and concretely. Give thanks, every day and specifically. Do today's work fully and well instead of waiting for better conditions. Don't hurry. Speak hopefully, since what we say shapes what we notice. Choose where your attention goes. Treat every person as an equal. Above all, give more in use value than you take in cash value. These are habits of attention, gratitude and character, not magic, and they make a life better whatever the bank balance says.

His central distinction may matter more now than it did in 1910. The competitive mind sees every gain as someone else's loss. The creative mind asks what it can add. In a world that often feels like a zero-sum

scramble, that question is worth carrying into every job, every business and every home.

Wattles himself did not live to enjoy the success his books would have. He died a few months after the three "Science" books appeared. But he believed that every life holds more possibility than its present circumstances show, and that we help others most by becoming the most we can be. You do not have to accept all of his metaphysics to take that belief seriously, or to test it one ordinary day at a time.

Further Reading

In this annotated series

James Allen, *As a Man Thinketh* (1903) and *Out from the Heart* (1904)

Florence Scovel Shinn, *Your Word Is Your Wand* (1928)

Christian D. Larson, *Your Forces and How to Use Them* (1912)

William Walker Atkinson, *Thought Vibration* (1906)

Prentice Mulford, *Thoughts Are Things*

Marcus Aurelius, *Meditations*, translated by George Long (1862)

Other classics in the public domain

Ralph Waldo Emerson, *Essays: First Series* (1841). Wattles names Emerson in his Preface as one of the philosophical foundations of his teaching.

Richard Maurice Bucke, *Cosmic Consciousness* (1901). The book that made the term widely known.

William James, *The Varieties of Religious Experience* (1902). A sympathetic, scholarly look at the "mind-cure" movement and religious experience in Wattles' time.